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Important Monthly Current Affairs Capsule – July 2026



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IMPORTANT DAYS

Goods and Services Tax (GST) Day 2026 Observed on 1 July

- **Goods and Services Tax (GST) Day** is observed every year in **India** on **1 July** to commemorate the implementation of the **Goods and Services Tax (GST)**.
- **1 July 2026** marks the **9th anniversary** of the launch of the **GST** regime in India.
- **GST** was implemented on **1 July 2017**, replacing multiple indirect taxes with a **single, unified indirect tax system** across the country.
- The introduction of **GST** is considered one of India's most significant **economic and tax reforms**, creating the concept of **"One Nation, One Tax."**
- The idea of introducing **GST** was first recommended by the **Kelkar Task Force on Indirect Taxes** in **2003**.
- The primary objectives of **GST** are to **simplify the indirect tax structure**, **eliminate the cascading effect of taxes**, **promote ease of doing business**, and **create a unified national market**.

Chartered Accountants Day 2026 Observed on 1 July

- **Chartered Accountants Day** is observed every year in **India** on **1 July** to commemorate the establishment of the **Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI)**.
- **1 July 2026** marks the **77th Chartered Accountants Day**.
- The **Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI)** was established on **1 July 1949** as a statutory body under the **Chartered Accountants Act, 1949**, enacted by the **Parliament of India**.
- The day recognises the significant contribution of **Chartered Accountants (CAs)** in **nation-building**, **financial management**, **corporate governance**, **taxation**, and **economic development**.

About Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI)

- Established: 1 July 1949
- Established Under: Chartered Accountants Act, 1949
- Headquarters: New Delhi
- President: CA. Prasanna Kumar D

National Doctors' Day 2026 Observed on 1 July

- **National Doctors' Day** is observed every year in **India** on **1 July** to honour the contributions of doctors and healthcare professionals.

- The day commemorates the **birth and death anniversary** of **Dr. Bidhan Chandra Roy**, a renowned physician, educationist, and the **second Chief Minister of West Bengal**.
- **National Doctors' Day** has been observed annually since **1991**.
- The day is organised by the **Indian Medical Association (IMA)** to recognise the dedication and service of the medical fraternity.
- **Dr. Bidhan Chandra Roy** was born on **1 July 1882** in **Patna**, then part of the **Bengal Presidency, British India**.

World Sports Journalists Day 2026 – 2 July

- **World Sports Journalists Day** is observed every year on **2 July** to recognise the contribution of **sports journalists** in promoting sports and delivering accurate sports coverage to the public.
- The day was established in **1994** by the **International Sports Press Association (AIPS)** to commemorate the **70th anniversary** of the organisation.
- The **International Sports Press Association (AIPS)** was founded on **2 July 1924** in **Paris, France**, during the **1924 Summer Olympics**.
- In **1883**, the **New York World** became one of the first newspapers to establish a **full-time sports department**, marking a significant milestone in sports journalism.

About International Sports Press Association (AIPS)

- Full Form: International Sports Press Association (AIPS)
- Founded: 2 July 1924
- Headquarters: Lausanne, Switzerland

World UFO Day 2026 – 2 July

- **World UFO Day** is observed every year on **2 July** to raise awareness about **Unidentified Flying Objects (UFOs)**, encourage scientific discussion on unexplained aerial phenomena, and promote the search for extraterrestrial life.
- The day commemorates the **Roswell Incident** of **July 1947**, when debris recovered near **Roswell, New Mexico (United States)** was believed by many to be from a UFO, although the **United States Air Force** later stated it was part of a classified military project.
- The term **UFO (Unidentified Flying Object)** was coined by **Edward J. Ruppelt**, a **United States Air Force** officer, in **1952**.

International Plastic Bag Free Day 2026 – 3 July

- **International Plastic Bag Free Day** is observed every year on **3 July** to encourage people to reduce the use of **single-use plastic bags** and help eliminate **plastic pollution**.

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- The day spreads awareness that a **plastic bag-free world is possible** by promoting sustainable and environmentally friendly alternatives.
- The initiative was established by the **Bag Free World** organisation, which launched campaigns promoting a plastic-free world.
- The **first International Plastic Bag Free Day** was observed on **3 July 2008**, initiated by **Rezero**, a member of **Zero Waste Europe**.
- In **2015**, the **European Union** adopted directives to reduce the consumption of **single-use plastic bags**.

World Zoonoses Day 2026 Observed on 6 July

- **World Zoonoses Day 2026** is observed globally on **6 July 2026** to raise awareness about **zoonotic diseases**, which are diseases that spread between **animals and humans**.
- The day commemorates the **first successful administration of the rabies vaccine** by **Louis Pasteur**, a French biologist and microbiologist, to **Joseph Meister** on **6 July 1885**, after he was bitten by a rabid dog.
- The observance aims to promote awareness about the **prevention, surveillance, and control of zoonotic diseases** through the **One Health** approach, which recognises the interconnected health of humans, animals, and the environment.
- According to the **World Health Organization (WHO)**, **over 60% of known infectious diseases** in humans and **about 75% of emerging infectious diseases** originate from animals.

About World Health Organization (WHO)

- Established: 1948
- Headquarters: Geneva, Switzerland
- Director-General: Dr. Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus

International Day of Cooperatives 2026 Observed on 4 July

- **International Day of Cooperatives 2026** was observed globally on **4 July 2026**, the **first Saturday of July**.
- The **2026 theme** is **"Cooperatives for a Peaceful World"**, highlighting the role of cooperatives in promoting peace, social cohesion, inclusion, solidarity, and sustainable development.
- The **International Cooperative Alliance (ICA)** has observed the day since **1923**.
- The **United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)** officially proclaimed the **International Day of Cooperatives** in **1992** through **Resolution 47/90**, with the first joint **United Nations (UN)**

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observance held in **1995**, marking the centenary of the **International Cooperative Alliance (ICA)**.

- The **International Cooperative Alliance (ICA)** was established in **1895** in **London, United Kingdom**, and is currently headquartered in **Brussels, Belgium**.

About International Cooperative Alliance (ICA)

- Established: 1895
- Headquarters: Brussels, Belgium
- President: Ariel Guarco
- Director General: Jeroen Douglas

World Population Day 2026 – July 11

- **World Population Day** is observed every year on **11 July** to create awareness about global population-related issues and their impact on society.
- The **United Nations (UN)** recognised **11 July as World Population Day in 1989** to raise awareness about population-related challenges.
- **World Population Day was first observed on 11 July 1990** in more than **90 countries** with the support of **United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA)** offices, governments and civil society organisations.
- **Historical Timeline of World Population Growth:**
- In **1804**, the world population reached **1 billion**.
- In **1927**, the global population doubled and reached **2 billion**.
- In **1989**, the world population reached **3 billion**, and the **United Nations recognised 11 July as World Population Day**.

About United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA)

- **Established:** 1969
- **Headquarters:** New York, United States
- **Executive Director**: Diene Keita.

World Malala Day 2026 Observed on 12 July

- **World Malala Day** is observed annually on **12 July** to honour **Malala Yousafzai** and raise awareness about the **right to education**, **women's empowerment**, and **children's rights** across the world.

- The **United Nations (UN)** declared **12 July** as **Malala Day** in recognition of **Malala Yousafzai's** contribution to promoting **girls' education** and **human rights**.
- **Malala Yousafzai** was born on **12 July 1997** in **Mingora, Pakistan**. In **2014**, at the age of **17**, she became the **youngest-ever recipient of the Nobel Peace Prize** for her advocacy of girls' education.
- In **2007**, the **Taliban** took control of her hometown and banned **girls from attending school**. In **2009**, Malala began writing an anonymous blog for **British Broadcasting Corporation (BBC) Urdu**, highlighting life under Taliban rule.
- In **2017**, **Malala Yousafzai** joined the **University of Oxford** for higher education and continues to campaign globally for **girls' education** and **women's rights** through the **Malala Fund**.

World Youth Skills Day 2026: 15 July to

- **World Youth Skills Day** is observed every year on **15 July** to highlight the importance of **skill development among youth** and the need to equip young people with skills required for **employment, entrepreneurship, and self-employment**.
- **World Youth Skills Day 2026** focuses on creating awareness about the importance of investing in **Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET)** and developing future-ready skills among young people.

About United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)

- Established: 1945
- Headquarters: New York, United States
- President: Annalena Baerbock

World Day for International Justice 2026 Observed on 17 July

- **World Day for International Justice 2026** was observed globally on **17 July 2026** to recognise and promote the importance of the **international justice system**.
- The day is also known by various names such as **International Justice Day**, **World Day for International Justice**, and **Day of International Criminal Justice**.
- The observance aims to acknowledge the efforts of **international courts and tribunals** in delivering justice to victims of war crimes, crimes against humanity, genocide, and other serious international crimes.

About International Criminal Court (ICC)

- Established: 2002
- Headquarters: The Hague, Netherlands

Nelson Mandela International Day 2026 Observed on 18 July

- **Nelson Mandela International Day 2026** was observed globally on **18 July 2026** to honour the life, legacy, and humanitarian contributions of **Nelson Rolihlahla Mandela**, the former **President of South Africa**.
- The day, also known as **Mandela Day**, encourages people across the world to **serve their communities** and promote **peace, equality, justice, and human dignity**.

World Chess Day 2026 Celebrated on 20 July

- **World Chess Day** is observed every year on **20 July** to commemorate the establishment of the **International Chess Federation (FIDE)** in **1924** at **Paris, France**.
- **World Chess Day 2026** aims to promote chess as a universal game that develops **strategic thinking, problem-solving skills, creativity, and intellectual growth**.
- The **International Chess Federation (FIDE)** was established on **20 July 1924** in **Paris, France** by chess organisations from **Argentina, Czechoslovakia, France, Poland, Romania, Spain, Switzerland, and Yugoslavia**.

International Moon Day 2026 Observed on 20 July

- **International Moon Day** is observed every year on **20 July** to commemorate the anniversary of the **first human landing on the Moon** during the **Apollo 11 mission** and to promote **international cooperation in space exploration**.
- **International Moon Day 2026** marks the **57th anniversary of the Apollo 11 Moon landing**, which took place on **20 July 1969**.
- The main objective of **International Moon Day 2026** is to promote awareness about the importance of **international collaboration, scientific research, and sustainable exploration of the Moon**.

World Brain Day 2026 Observed on 22 July

- **World Brain Day** is observed every year on **22 July** to create awareness about **brain health**, prevent **neurological disorders**, and promote better treatment, rehabilitation, and care for people affected by brain-related disabilities.
- The day was established by the **World Federation of Neurology (WFN)** to highlight the importance of **neurology research**, early diagnosis, and global efforts towards improving brain health.

About World Federation of Neurology (WFN)

- Established: 22 July 1957

- Headquarters: London, United Kingdom
- Founded In: Belgium

National Broadcasting Day 2026 Observed on 23 July

- **National Broadcasting Day** is observed every year on **23 July** in India to commemorate the **first-ever radio broadcast in the country**, which took place on **23 July 1927**.
- **National Broadcasting Day 2026** marks the beginning of organised radio broadcasting in India and highlights the role of broadcasting in **information dissemination, education, entertainment, and national development**.
- The first radio broadcasting service in India was started by the **Indian Broadcasting Company (IBC)** in **1927**.

Kargil Vijay Diwas 2026 Commemorates 27 Years of India's Victory in the Kargil War

- **Kargil Vijay Diwas** is observed every year on **26 July** to honour the **bravery, courage, and supreme sacrifice of Indian Armed Forces personnel** during the **Kargil War of 1999**.
- **Kargil Vijay Diwas 2026** marks the **27th anniversary** of India's victory in the **Kargil War**, which was fought between **India and Pakistan from May to July 1999**.
- The day commemorates the successful completion of **Operation Vijay**, launched by the **Indian Armed Forces** to recapture strategic locations occupied by Pakistani forces in the **Kargil sector**.

World Nature Conservation Day is observed on 28 July 2026

- **World Nature Conservation Day 2026** is observed on **28 July 2026** across the world to create awareness about the importance of conserving nature, protecting biodiversity, and preserving natural resources.
- The day highlights the need for maintaining a **healthy and sustainable environment** for present and future generations.
- The major objective of **World Nature Conservation Day** is to promote the conservation of **endangered plants and animal species** and protect ecosystems from environmental degradation.

About International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN)

- The International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) was established on 5 October 1948 in Fontainebleau, France.
- Headquarters: Gland, Switzerland

World Day Against Trafficking in Persons 2026 Observed on 30 July

- **World Day Against Trafficking in Persons** is observed every year on **30 July** to raise awareness about **human trafficking**, highlight the challenges faced by victims, and promote the protection of their rights.
- The **theme for World Day Against Trafficking in Persons 2026** is **"Trapped Behind the Scam"**, focusing on the exploitation of victims through fraudulent schemes and organised trafficking networks.

International Friendship Day 2026 Observed on 30 July

- **International Friendship Day** is observed every year on **30 July** across the world to highlight the importance of **friendship, peace, solidarity and mutual understanding** among people and communities.
- The day is celebrated by the **United Nations (UN)** to promote the idea that friendship between individuals, cultures and nations can contribute to **building peace and strengthening global cooperation**.
- In **India**, Friendship Day is generally celebrated on the **first Sunday of August**. In **2026**, it will be observed on **2 August**.

BANKING, FINANCE & BUSINESS

Reserve Bank of India Proposes New Master Directions to Regulate Call, Notice and Term Money Markets

- The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has released **draft directions** to broaden participation in the **Term Money Market** by allowing **All India Financial Institutions (AIFIs), eligible Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs), Housing Finance Companies (HFCs), and companies** to participate.
- The draft directions aim to **deepen liquidity, strengthen the short-term funding market, and improve the efficiency** of India's money market.
- Under the proposed framework, **AIFIs and eligible NBFCs/HFCs** will be permitted to participate as **both borrowers and lenders** in the Term Money Market.
- **Companies** will be allowed to participate **only as lenders**, thereby expanding the availability of funds in the short-term money market.

Reserve Bank of India Issues Draft Master Directions for Secondary Market Transactions in Government Securities

- **The Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has issued **draft directions** to simplify and consolidate regulations governing **secondary market transactions in Government Securities (G-Secs)**, including **'When Issued' (WI) trading, short selling, and Government Securities Lending (GSL)** under a **single regulatory framework**.
- The draft framework aims to **enhance transparency, improve market liquidity, strengthen price discovery, and increase retail participation** in the Government Securities (G-Secs) market.
- To promote **retail investor participation**, RBI has proposed allowing **individual investors** to buy and sell Government Securities through their **demat accounts** using the **NDS-OM (Negotiated Dealing System–Order Matching) platform** or the **Stock Broker Connect facility**.
- The **minimum transaction size** for retail investors under the proposed framework will be **₹10,000**.

Cabinet Approves ₹30,000 Crore Additional Investment in National Investment and Infrastructure Fund to Boost Infrastructure Development and Mobilise Institutional Capital

- **The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, approved an **additional Government investment of ₹30,000 crore** in the **National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF)** to strengthen investments in infrastructure and other nationally important sectors.
- With this approval, the **Government of India's total commitment to NIIF** has increased from **₹30,000 crore to ₹60,000 crore**.
- **National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF)** is **India's Sovereign Anchored Fund**, professionally managed by **National Investment and Infrastructure Fund Limited (NIIFL)**.
- The **Government of India (GoI)** holds a **49% shareholding in NIIF**, while the remaining investment comes from domestic and global institutional investors.

About Ministry of Finance :

- Cabinet Minister : Nirmala Sitharaman
- Minister of State : Pankaj Choudhary

Union Minister Nirmala Sitharaman Begins Four-Day Official Visit to France to Strengthen India–France Economic and Strategic Cooperation

- **Union Minister for Finance and Corporate Affairs, Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman**, embarked on an official visit to France to strengthen the **India–France Strategic Partnership** and promote economic cooperation, investment, technology collaboration, and innovation.

- A key engagement of the visit is the **India–France Economic & Financial Dialogue (EFD)**, which will be co-chaired by Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman and **Roland Lescure**, Minister of Economy, Finance and Industrial and Energy Sovereignty of France, at **Aix-en-Provence**.
- During the Economic & Financial Dialogue (EFD), India and France will discuss greater bilateral cooperation across various sectors and further strengthen economic relations between the two countries.

PayGlocal Introduces Google Pay Card Payments to Enable Seamless Global Transactions for Indian Merchants

- **PayGlocal**, an India-based cross-border payments platform, launched **Google Pay Card Payments** on its International Payment Gateway to simplify global digital payments for Indian merchants.
- The integration enables Indian merchants to access over **1 billion customers** across more than **90 countries** through a single integration.
- The initiative aims to facilitate seamless cross-border transactions, **increase merchant activations by 40%**, and improve the efficiency of cross-border e-commerce.
- The Google Pay integration offers **secure, tokenized, and biometrically authenticated** payment transactions for enhanced safety and convenience.
- **Apple Pay is already live** on the PayGlocal International Payment Gateway, complementing the newly launched Google Pay Card Payments.

Kakinada Cooperative Town Bank Achieves Reserve Bank of India Tier-III Status with Deposits Crossing ₹2,000 Crore

- **Kakinada Cooperative Town Bank**, an Urban Cooperative Bank (UCB) in Andhra Pradesh (AP), secured **Tier-III status** under Reserve Bank of India (RBI) norms after its total deposits crossed **₹2,000 crore**.
- The bank achieved Tier-III classification with **zero Net Non-Performing Assets (NPAs)**, reflecting its strong financial health.
- Following this achievement, Kakinada Cooperative Town Bank became the **2nd-largest Urban Cooperative Bank (UCB)** among the 46 UCBs in Andhra Pradesh.
- The bank's total business has **exceeded ₹2,040 crore**, marking a significant growth milestone.

Reserve Bank of India Stress Tests Project Banks' Gross Non-Performing Asset Ratio to Rise Marginally to 1.9% by March 2028 Under Baseline Scenario

- The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** released its **Financial Stability Report (FSR)**, highlighting **geopolitical fragmentation** and the rapid growth of **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** as major **emerging risks** to the global economy and financial system.
- **RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra** stated that the **Indian economy remains resilient** despite global uncertainties, supported by strong economic growth, low inflation, healthy financial institution balance sheets, and **robust macroeconomic fundamentals**.
- The **Gross Non-Performing Asset (GNPA) ratio** of Scheduled Commercial Banks (SCBs) **declined to a multi-decade low of 1.8% in March 2026**, reflecting significant improvement in banking sector **asset quality**.

Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India Approves Two New General Insurance Licences Following 100% Foreign Direct Investment Reforms

- **The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) Chairman Ajay Seth** announced that the **IRDAI** has approved **two new general insurance licences** following the Government of India's decision to allow **100% Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** in the insurance sector.
- The **FDI limit** in the insurance sector was **increased from 74% to 100% under the automatic route** in the **Union Budget 2026–27**, encouraging greater foreign investment.
- The enhanced **100% FDI policy** has attracted strong interest from **global insurance companies**, enabling **foreign promoters to hold full ownership** in Indian insurance companies.
- **IRDAI** has already approved **one proposal** allowing a foreign promoter to **significantly increase its stake** in an Indian insurer, while **another proposal is currently under regulatory examination**.

About IRDAI:

- Headquarters (HQ): Hyderabad, Telangana, India
- Founded: 1999

Bank of Baroda and Japan's Mizuho Bank Forge Strategic Alliance to Strengthen Merger & Acquisition and Cross-Border Financing

- **Bank of Baroda (BoB)** and Japan's **Mizuho Bank** signed a **strategic partnership agreement** to strengthen cooperation in **Merger & Acquisition (M&A) financing**, **structured lending**, **cross-border financing**, and **corporate & investment banking services**.

- The partnership was announced in **Mumbai on 30 June 2026**, marking a significant step towards enhancing **India–Japan banking collaboration**.
- The collaboration combines **Mizuho Bank's global network, cross-border expertise, and structured finance capabilities** with **Bank of Baroda's strong domestic presence and deep corporate relationships** in India.
- Under the agreement, both banks will **jointly originate, structure, co-underwrite, and syndicate acquisition financing** for both domestic and cross-border M&A transactions.

About Bank of Baroda (BoB) :

- **Bank of Baroda (BoB)** is an Indian **Public Sector Bank (PSB)** headquartered in **Vadodara, Gujarat**.
- **MD & CEO : Dr. Debadatta Chand**.

Securities and Exchange Board of India Sets Up Expert Working Group Led by Ananta Barua to Review Debenture Trustee Regulations

- **The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)** constituted an **Expert Working Group (EWG)** at **New Delhi, Delhi** to review the regulatory framework governing **Debenture Trustees**.
- The Expert Working Group (EWG) is **chaired by Ananta Barua**, Former SEBI Whole-Time Member (WTM), with **Rajnish Kumar**, Former Chairman of State Bank of India (SBI), serving as **Co-Chairperson**.
- The committee will comprehensively review the **SEBI (Debenture Trustees) Regulations, 1993** in view of the evolving Indian debt market and increasing investor participation.
- The EWG will examine stakeholder representations, **review net-worth norms**, and recommend measures to **simplify, rationalise, and strengthen** the regulatory framework.
- The review aims to align regulations with evolving debt market developments, **enhance investor protection**, and strengthen the **role, accountability, and functions of Debenture Trustees**.

About SEBI :

- Established : 12 April 1988 as an executive body and was given statutory powers on 30 January 1992 through the SEBI Act, 1992
- Headquarters : Mumbai, Maharashtra
- Chairman : Tuhin Kanta Pandey
- SEBI is the regulatory body for securities and commodity markets in India under the ownership of the Ministry of Finance (MoF), GoI.

CGST Delhi South Marks GST Pakhwada 2026 with Taxpayer Outreach and Officer Felicitation

- **CGST Delhi South Commissionerate** observed **GST Day 2026** under the theme **"सुगम कर व्यवस्था, सशक्त राष्ट्र" (Simple Tax System, Strong Nation)**.
- The celebrations were organised as part of **GST Pakhwada 2026**, reaffirming the Commissionerate's commitment to **taxpayer facilitation** and **participative governance**.
- **Outreach programmes** were conducted by divisions including **Okhla, Connaught Place, and Vasant Kunj** to engage taxpayers and tax professionals, promote **GST awareness**, address concerns, and encourage **voluntary tax compliance**.
- The Commissionerate organised **'Samvad'**, an **Open Dialogue and Grievance-Redressal Session**, chaired by the **Commissioner, CGST Delhi South**, with participation from Additional, Deputy, and Assistant Commissioners.
- The **'Samvad' session** was attended by representatives from the **Embassies of Iraq and Singapore**, trade associations, and stakeholders from the **hotel, aviation, transport, and construction sectors**.

Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India Grants Standalone Health Insurance Licence to Prudential HCL Health Insurance

- **IRDAI (Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India)** granted a **Certificate of Registration** to **Prudential HCL Health Insurance Limited** to operate as a **Standalone Health Insurance (SAHI) Company** in India.
- The approval was granted during the **136th Authority Meeting of IRDAI** held on **29 June 2026**.
- **Prudential HCL Health Insurance Limited** is a **joint venture** between the UK-based **Prudential Group (70% stake)** and India's **HCL Group (30% stake)**.
- The company combines **Prudential's global insurance expertise** with **HCL Group's domestic market presence** to strengthen India's health insurance sector.
- With this approval, the **total number of Standalone Health Insurance (SAHI) Companies** operating in India has **increased to 8**.

Punjab & Sind Bank Unveils Customer-Centric Digital Banking Initiatives on Its 119th Foundation Day

- **Punjab & Sind Bank (PSB)** celebrated its **119th Foundation Day** by launching **customer-centric digital banking initiatives**, a **new Vision & Mission Statement**, and **technology-driven banking solutions** at **New Delhi, Delhi**.
- The event was attended by **Debashish Prusty** and **Hari Har Mishra** (Additional Secretaries, Department of Financial Services – DFS), **Ashish Madhorao** (Joint Secretary, DFS), and

representatives from **National Housing Bank (NHB)**, **Industrial Finance Corporation of India (IFCI)**, **Life Insurance Corporation (LIC)**, and **Coal India Limited (CIL)**.

About Punjab & Sind Bank (PSB):

- Founded: 1908
- Headquarters: New Delhi, India
- Managing Director & CEO: Swarup Kumar Saha
- Tagline: "Where Service Is A Way of Life"

SBI Life and Indian Institute of Technology Bombay Join Hands to Establish AI & Cyber Innovation Hub for India's Insurance Sector

- **SBI Life Insurance Company Limited** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bombay**, Mumbai, Maharashtra, to establish the **"Bharat AI & Cyber Innovation Hub for Insurance."**
- The **Bharat AI & Cyber Innovation Hub for Insurance** is a **joint research and innovation centre** aimed at developing **indigenous AI-powered cyber defence systems** and **deep-technology solutions** for the insurance sector.
- The MoU was signed by **Prof. S.V. Kulkarni** (Dean – Research & Development, IIT Bombay) and **Vishal Bhati** (Chief Information and Digital Officer, SBI Life Insurance).
- The innovation hub will undertake joint research in **Artificial Intelligence (AI), Cyber Security, Quantum Technologies**, and **digital/next-generation insurance systems**.

National Payments Corporation of India Partners with HSBC India and JP Morgan Payments for Real-Time Foreign Exchange Settlement in Cross-Border Unified Payments Interface Transactions

- **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)** partnered with **HSBC India** and **JP Morgan Payments** to enable **real-time Foreign Exchange (FX) settlement** for **cross-border Unified Payments Interface (UPI)** transactions.
- The initiative aims to improve the **international payment experience** by providing **greater transparency, faster settlement**, and **real-time currency conversion** for Indian users.
- Under the partnership, **HSBC India** will serve as the **banking partner**, providing **real-time Foreign Exchange (FX) rates** through direct **Application Programming Interface (API)** integration.

- **HSBC India's** global banking network will support secure, **24×7 cross-border transactions**, making overseas UPI payments faster and more efficient.
- **JP Morgan Payments** will facilitate **real-time FX conversion** and **multi-currency settlement**, enhancing the efficiency of international digital payments.

India and France Hold High-Level Economic & Financial Dialogue in Aix-en-Provence

- Union Finance Minister **Nirmala Sitharaman** and France's Minister of Economy, Finance, Industrial, Energy, and Digital Sovereignty **Roland Lescure** co-chaired the **India-France Economic and Financial Dialogue (EFD)** in **Aix-en-Provence, France**.
- The **India-France Economic and Financial Dialogue (EFD)** was held to strengthen the **India–France Special Global Strategic Partnership** through high-level discussions on economic, financial, investment, trade, and technological cooperation.
- The dialogue was held following the commitment made by Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** and French President **Emmanuel Macron** during the latter's **February 2026 visit to India**.

Razorpay and NPCI Bharat BillPay Limited Launch Banking Connect to Transform Mobile-First NetBanking Payments

- **Razorpay**, in partnership with **NPCI Bharat BillPay Limited (NBBL)**, a wholly-owned subsidiary of the **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)**, launched **Banking Connect**, a **mobile-first NetBanking solution**, in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.
- **Banking Connect** modernises **NetBanking** by offering **unified multi-bank integration**, along with **QR-based and intent-driven payment flows**, improving payment efficiency and customer experience.
- The Banking Connect ecosystem is currently supported by **State Bank of India (SBI), HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank, Federal Bank, AU Small Finance Bank, and YES Bank**, with additional banks expected to join.
- **NPCI Bharat BillPay Limited (NBBL)** is a **wholly-owned subsidiary** of the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI).

Asian Development Bank Sanctions USD 182.89 Million Loan for Karnataka Public School Transformation

- The **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** has approved a **USD 182.89 million** (Japanese Yen equivalent) loan for **Karnataka** to strengthen the public school system under the **Strengthening Karnataka Public Schools Program**.

- The programme aims to establish **500 Integrated Karnataka Public School Clusters**, providing seamless education from **pre-primary to secondary level**.
- The initiative is expected to benefit **over 1 million students**, including female students and disadvantaged learners, by expanding access to **high-quality education** and improving academic performance.
- The programme is financed through ADB's **Results-Based Lending (RBL)** mechanism and is aligned with the Government of Karnataka's education reforms and the **National Education Policy (NEP) 2020**.
- It is ADB's **first large-scale support** for public school transformation in India through the **Results-Based Lending modality**.

About ADB :

- Formation : 19 December 1966
- Headquarters : Philippines
- President : Masato Kanda
- Members : 69 countries

Reserve Bank of India Levies Monetary Penalty on Bank of Baroda and GIC Housing Finance for Regulatory Violations

- The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** imposed a combined monetary penalty of **Rs. 66.7 lakh** on **Bank of Baroda (BoB)** and **GIC Housing Finance** for non-compliance with regulatory directions.
- The penalties were imposed for violations related to **Know Your Customer (KYC) norms**, **lending guidelines**, and the **Fair Practices Code for Lenders**.
- The RBI detected these deficiencies during its **supervisory inspection** of the institutions.
- **Bank of Baroda (BoB)** was penalized **Rs. 63.6 lakh** for **charging interest rates higher than the contracted rates**, failing to upload KYC records to the **Central KYC Records Registry (CKYCR)** within the prescribed timelines, and violating the **Fair Practices Code for Lenders**.

Asian Development Bank Sanctions USD 230 Million Loan to Upgrade Chennai's Water Supply and Sanitation Infrastructure

- The **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** approved a **USD 230 million (approximately Rs. 1,920 crore) loan** to modernise and expand Chennai's water supply and sanitation infrastructure in Tamil Nadu (TN).

- The **Chennai Urban Water and Sanitation Modernisation Project** is expected to benefit around **4.5 million residents** in the Greater Chennai Area.
- The project is aligned with the **Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation (AMRUT) 2.0** and the **Urban Challenge Fund**, supporting India's urban infrastructure modernisation.
- The project includes the upgradation of **7 water pumping stations** and **38 sewer pumping stations** to enhance operational efficiency.

Paytm Europe Receives Payment Institution Licence Approval from Luxembourg's Commission de Surveillance du Secteur Financier

- **Paytm Europe Payments S.A.**, the European arm of **One97 Communications (Paytm)**, secured a **Payment Institution (PI) Licence** from Luxembourg's financial regulator, **Commission de Surveillance du Secteur Financier (CSSF)**.
- The PI Licence was officially registered on the CSSF list of payment institutions with effect from **2 July 2026**.
- The licence authorises Paytm Europe to offer regulated payment services across the **European Economic Area (EEA)**.
- The regulatory approval followed Paytm's **May 2026** announcement that **Paytm Cloud Technologies Limited (PCTL)** would invest an additional **EUR 9 million** in Paytm Europe Payments S.A.

Nine Years of Goods and Services Tax: Transforming India's Tax System and Driving Economic Growth

- **Goods and Services Tax (GST)** was launched on **1 July 2017** under the vision of **"One Nation, One Tax"**, replacing **17 indirect taxes and 13 cesses** with a unified indirect tax system.
- GST eliminated the **cascading effect of taxes (tax on tax)**, created a common national market, and strengthened the vision of **"Ek Bharat – Shreshtha Bharat."**
- GST is a **destination-based consumption tax**, where tax revenue accrues to the State in which goods or services are finally consumed.

Reserve Bank of India Penalises Five Star Business Finance, Can Fin Homes, and Pahal Financial Services for Know Your Customer and Fair Practices Code Violations

- The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** imposed **monetary penalties** on **Five Star Business Finance Limited**, **Can Fin Homes Limited**, and **Pahal Financial Services Private Limited** for violating **Know Your Customer (KYC) Directions** and the **Fair Practices Code**.

- **Five Star Business Finance Limited** was penalised **₹6.20 lakh** by the RBI.
- **Can Fin Homes Limited** was penalised **₹2.70 lakh** by the RBI.
- **Pahal Financial Services Private Limited** was penalised **₹3.10 lakh** by the RBI.
- **Five Star Business Finance Limited** was penalised for **failing to implement robust software** to identify and report **suspicious transactions**.
- **Five-Star Business Finance Limited** also failed to disclose the **risk gradation methodology** and the **rationale for charging different interest rates** to borrowers.
- **Can Fin Homes Limited** was fined for **not clearly disclosing the bifurcation of principal and interest components** in loan instalments collected from borrowers.

India's External Debt Reaches US$ 762.8 Billion at End-March 2026

- India's **external debt** increased to **US$ 762.8 billion** as of **31 March 2026**, registering an increase of **US$ 26.3 billion** over the previous year.
- The **external debt-to-GDP ratio** rose from **19.8% (March 2025)** to **20.8% (March 2026)**.
- The share of **short-term external debt** increased to **19.6%** of total external debt.
- The ratio of **short-term external debt to foreign exchange reserves** increased to **21.6%**, indicating higher short-term repayment obligations.
- **US dollar-denominated debt** remained the **largest component** of India's external debt, accounting for **55.5%** of the total.
- The **currency-wise composition** of India's external debt was: **US Dollar – 55.5%**, **Indian Rupee – 29.4%**, **Japanese Yen – 6.4%**, **Special Drawing Rights (SDR) – 4.3%**, and **Euro – 3.7%**.
- **Non-financial corporations** held the **largest share** of India's external debt at **36.4%**.

Reserve Bank of India Penalises Repco Home Finance and True Credits for Regulatory Compliance Violations

- The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** imposed a **monetary penalty of ₹70,000** on **Repco Home Finance Limited** for violating the **Fair Practice Code**.
- The RBI also imposed a **monetary penalty of ₹3.10 lakh** on **True Credits Private Limited** for non-compliance with **Know Your Customer (KYC) Directions**.

- **Repco Home Finance Limited** failed to disclose its **risk gradation methodology** and the **rationale for charging different interest rates** to different categories of borrowers in application forms and sanction letters.
- **True Credits Private Limited** failed to conduct **Enhanced Due Diligence (EDD)** for certain customers onboarded through **non-face-to-face modes**, violating the RBI's KYC Directions.
- The penalties were imposed after **statutory inspections** based on the companies' financial position as of **31 March 2025**.

Reserve Bank of India Releases ₹3.19 Lakh Crore State Market Borrowing Calendar for July–September 2026 Quarter

- The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** expanded the **Benchmark Issuance Strategy (BIS)** from **9 States to 18 States and the Union Territory of Delhi** from **Q2 of FY 2026–27**.
- The expansion of the Benchmark Issuance Strategy (BIS) aims to **enhance transparency**, **improve price discovery**, and provide **greater clarity to investors** in **State Government Securities (SGSs)**.
- Under the Benchmark Issuance Strategy (BIS), **State Development Loans (SDLs)** are issued in **pre-announced benchmark maturity buckets** through a **fixed issuance calendar**.

Government Expands Additional National Pension System Investment Options for Central Autonomous Body Employees

- The **Government of India (GoI)** has extended **two additional investment choices** under the **National Pension System (NPS)** to employees of **Central Autonomous Bodies (CABs)** covered under NPS.
- The **Department of Expenditure, Ministry of Finance**, extended the applicability of the **Department of Financial Services (DFS) Notification dated 13 November 2025** to NPS subscribers employed in Central Autonomous Bodies (CABs).
- These additional investment choices were earlier available only to **Central Government employees** covered under NPS and have now been extended to **CAB employees**.
- The **Aggressive Life Cycle Fund (LC-75)** has been renamed as **LC-75-High** and allows **equity exposure of up to 75%**, making it suitable for subscribers seeking higher long-term growth potential.

Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme 5.0 Surpasses 4.11 Lakh Loan Guarantees, Covering Over ₹1.55 Lakh Crore

- **Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) 5.0** was approved by the Union Cabinet on **5 May 2026** to provide **liquidity support** to businesses affected by the **West Asia geopolitical situation**.
- ECLGS 5.0 is designed to provide **risk mitigation** to **Member Lending Institutions (MLIs)** by enabling them to extend **additional credit** to borrowers facing cash-flow disruptions.
- The scheme provides **100% guarantee coverage** on additional loans to **Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs)** and **90% guarantee coverage** for other business segments, encouraging higher lending by financial institutions.

Japan Bank for International Cooperation Sanctions JPY 80 Billion Green Loan to POWERGRID for Renewable Energy Transmission Project

- **Power Grid Corporation of India Limited (POWERGRID)**, a **'Maharatna' Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE)** under the **Ministry of Power (MoP)**, secured a **Japanese Yen (JPY) 80 billion Green Loan** from the **Japan Bank for International Cooperation (JBIC)**.
- The JPY 80 billion Green Loan is among India's largest **green financing arrangements** for the **power transmission sector** and supports the integration of **Renewable Energy (RE)** into the national power grid.
- The loan agreement was signed in **June 2026** to finance the **Khavda–Nagpur High Voltage Direct Current (HVDC) Transmission Project**.
- The **Khavda–Nagpur HVDC Project** will evacuate renewable energy from the **Khavda Renewable Energy Park, Gujarat**, and transmit it to **Nagpur, Maharashtra**.

About JBIC :

- **Japan Bank for International Cooperation (JBIC)** is a **policy-based financial institution**, wholly owned by the **Government of Japan**, and was established in **1999**.
- Headquarters : Tokyo, Japan
- President & CEO : Tadashi Maeda

Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India Partners with Institute of Public Auditors of India to Curb Dark Patterns in Digital Insurance Platforms

- The **Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)** has launched a crackdown on **"Dark Patterns"** in digital insurance platforms to curb **mis-selling**, improve

transparency, strengthen **consumer protection**, and enhance **public trust** in the insurance sector.

- **Dark Patterns** are **deceptive design techniques** used on websites and mobile applications that **manipulate users** into sharing personal information, accepting unwanted products, paying hidden charges, facing difficult policy cancellations, or receiving unsolicited calls and messages.
- **Common examples** of Dark Patterns include **forcing users to share personal details** before viewing insurance products, making **policy cancellation difficult**, **spam calls**, **hidden charges**, and **misleading website/app interfaces**.
- IRDAI has partnered with the **Institute of Public Auditors of India** to **independently monitor** insurance companies and digital insurance platforms for **9 months** to identify the use of Dark Patterns.

About IRDAI :

- **Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)** is an **autonomous statutory body** under the **Ministry of Finance**.
- Established : **1999**
- Current Chairman : **Ajay Seth**.

Department of Financial Services Insurance Division Achieves 2nd Position in Group A of May 2026 Grievance Redressal Assessment & Index Rankings

- The **Department of Financial Services (DFS)** under the **Ministry of Finance** (through its Banking and Insurance Divisions) receives **more than 2.50 lakh grievances annually**.
- The DFS has consistently featured among the **Top 10 Ministries/Departments** in the **Grievance Redressal Assessment & Index (GRAI)** rankings since November 2025.
- In the **GRAI Rankings for May 2026**, the **Insurance Division** secured the **2nd position in Group A** (ministries/departments registering 500 or more grievances).
- In the same May 2026 GRAI Rankings, the **Banking Division** secured the **6th position in Group A**.

Gujarat International Finance Tec-City and Vietnam's Da Nang Financial Centre Forge Memorandum of Understanding to Strengthen Bilateral Financial Cooperation

- **Gujarat International Finance Tec-City (GIFT City)**, India's **International Financial Services Centre (IFSC)**, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Vietnam International Financial Center–Da Nang (VIFC-DN)** in **New Delhi, Delhi**.

- The MoU aims to support the development of **Vietnam's International Financial Centre**, promote **cross-border investments**, and strengthen **financial and business linkages** between India and Vietnam.
- The partnership focuses on **financial services**, **financial technology (FinTech)**, **digital innovation**, **capacity building**, financial sector development, and the exchange of institutional knowledge and best practices.

Adani Group's Kutch Copper Receives London Metal Exchange (LME) Certification for Grade A Copper Cathodes

- **Kutch Copper Limited (KCL)**, a subsidiary of **Adani Enterprises Limited (AEL)**, secured **London Metal Exchange (LME) certification** for its **"Adani Copper" Grade A copper cathodes**.
- The **LME approval** allows Adani Copper Grade A cathodes to be delivered with warrants eligible for issuance against **LME Copper Futures Contracts** from **10 July 2026**.
- The **LME listing** places Adani Copper among the world's leading copper brands, providing **global recognition**, **international market credibility**, and strengthening Adani Group's presence in the metals sector.
- **LME-listed copper cathodes** can be stored under **LME-approved warehouse warrants** and used as **collateral**, enhancing **global tradability, liquidity, and financing flexibility**.

About London Metal Exchange (LME) :

- **London Metal Exchange (LME)** is the world's largest exchange for **industrial metals trading**, providing **global benchmark prices**, **hedging facilities**, and physical delivery of **non-ferrous metals**.
- LME trades major industrial metals including **Copper, Aluminium, Zinc, Lead, Nickel, and Tin**.
- London Metal Exchange (LME) was established in **1877** and is headquartered in **London, United Kingdom (UK)**.

NTPC Establishes Wholly Owned Mauritius Subsidiary to Develop Floating Solar and Battery Energy Storage System Project

- **NTPC Limited** has incorporated a **wholly owned subsidiary (WOS)** named **NTPC (Mauritius) Energy** in **Mauritius** to strengthen its international presence and expand its clean energy portfolio.

- NTPC (Mauritius) Energy will develop a proposed **Floating Solar Photovoltaic (FSPV) Project** integrated with a **Battery Energy Storage System (BESS)** in Mauritius.
- The **Floating Solar Photovoltaic (FSPV) project** will generate renewable electricity using floating solar panels installed on water bodies, improving efficient **land and water resource utilization**.

Reserve Bank of India Implements Revamped Integrated Ombudsman Scheme 2026 from July 1,2026

- **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** introduced the **Reserve Bank–Integrated Ombudsman Scheme (RB-IOS), 2026**, replacing the Integrated Ombudsman Scheme, 2021, with effect from **1 July 2026**.
- RB-IOS, 2026 aims to provide a **faster, simpler, free, and non-adversarial mechanism** for resolving customer complaints against **RBI-regulated financial entities**.
- Complaints, appeals, and awards filed under the 2021 Scheme will continue to be governed by the earlier provisions.
- The scheme follows the **"One Nation, One Ombudsman"** approach, allowing customers to file complaints **without considering the geographical location** of the customer or the regulated entity.

Asian Development Bank Revises India's FY27 Growth Outlook Down to 6.6% and Raises Inflation Projection to 5.2%

- **The Asian Development Bank (ADB)** lowered **India's GDP Growth Forecast for FY2026–27 (FY27)** to **6.6%** from the earlier projection of 6.9% (April 2026).
- ADB attributed the downward revision to **high global energy prices**, which are reducing household incomes and affecting **domestic demand**.
- ADB retained India's GDP Growth Forecast for **FY2027–28 (FY28)** at **7.3%**, supported by policy measures, stronger exports, and improving global economic conditions.
- ADB increased **India's Inflation Forecast for FY2026–27** to **5.2%** from 4.5%, citing higher global oil prices, a **weaker Indian Rupee**, and **persistent food inflation**.

About Asian Development Bank :

- Formation : 19 December 1966
- Headquarters : Philippines
- President : Masato Kanda

- Members : 69 countries

International Monetary Fund Projects India's FY27 Economic Growth at 6.4% in July 2026 World Economic Outlook Update

- **The International Monetary Fund (IMF)** released the **World Economic Outlook (WEO) Update – July 2026** titled **"Global Economy in Crosscurrents of War and Technology"**.
- The IMF projected **India's Gross Domestic Product (GDP) Growth at 6.4% for FY2026–27 (FY27)**, slightly lower than the 6.5% forecast issued in April 2026.
- IMF revised **India's FY2027–28 (FY28) GDP Growth Forecast upward to 6.7%**, compared to the earlier estimate of 6.5%.
- India's Gross Domestic Product (GDP) recorded a **7.7% Growth during FY2025–26 (FY26)**.
- **Global Economic Growth** is projected by the IMF at **3.0% in 2026**, improving further to **3.4% in 2027** due to a gradual recovery in global economic activity.

About International Monetary Fund (IMF):

- The **International Monetary Fund (IMF)** is a global financial institution that promotes international monetary cooperation, financial stability, and economic growth while providing financial assistance to member countries facing balance of payments issues.
- Founded Year: 1944
- Headquarters: Washington, D.C., United States
- Managing Director: Kristalina Georgieva
- Members: 191 countries

India's Financial Intelligence Unit–India Earns Best Egmont Case Award 2026 Runner-Up Recognition for Cyber Fraud Investigation

- **Financial Intelligence Unit–India (FIU-IND)** secured the **Runner-up position** at the **Best Egmont Case Award (BECA) 2026** during the **Egmont Group Plenary** held in **Baku, Azerbaijan**.
- The achievement came under the leadership of **Shri Amit Mohan Govil**, Director, FIU-IND.
- The **Best Egmont Case Award (BECA)** is one of the highest honours of the Egmont Group, recognising excellence in **financial intelligence**, **international cooperation**, and efforts to combat **money laundering** and **terrorist financing**.

- FIU-IND's case was selected as one of only **two finalist cases** from **182 member jurisdictions** of the Egmont Group, before being declared the Runner-up.

National Stock Exchange Introduces India's First Animal-Friendly Stock Market Index – Nifty500 Ahimsa

- **NSE Indices Limited**, the index services subsidiary of the **National Stock Exchange (NSE)**, launched the **Nifty500 Ahimsa Index**.
- The **Nifty500 Ahimsa Index** is a **thematic index** that tracks companies from the **Nifty 500 universe** whose business practices follow the principles of **Ahimsa (non-violence)**.
- The index **excludes companies** involved in activities that **harm animals**, enabling **values-based and ethical investing**.
- The index was developed in collaboration with the **Ahimsagain Foundation** using the **Ahimsa Investment Movement (AIM) Framework**.
- Under the AIM Framework, companies are classified into **Green, Orange, and Red bands** based on the impact of their products, services, and business practices on **animals**.

World Bank Approves $890 Million to Expand India's Rooftop Solar Programme and Green Jobs

- The **World Bank Board of Executive Directors** approved an **$890 million financing package** for India's national rooftop solar programme on **9–10 July 2026**.
- The funding supports **PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana**, India's flagship residential rooftop solar scheme for rural and urban households.
- The scheme aims to install rooftop solar systems in **10 million households** across India, promoting **clean energy generation** and grid-connected electricity supply.
- The financing package includes an **$820 million loan** from the **International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD)**, a **$60 million concessional loan** from the **Clean Technology Fund (CTF)**, and a **$10 million grant** from the IBRD's **Livable Planet Fund**.

About World Bank:

- The World Bank is an international financial institution that provides loans and grants to the governments of low and middle-income countries for the purpose of pursuing capital projects.
- The World Bank consists of 5 institutions: The International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD), The International Development Association (IDA), The International

Finance Corporation (IFC), The Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA), and The International Centre for Settlement of Investment Disputes (ICSID).

- Founded Year: 1944
- Headquarters: Washington, D.C., United States
- President: Ajay Banga
- Members:189 countries

Reserve Bank of India Rolls Out Three Major Surveys to Support Monetary Policy Decisions

- **The Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** launched the **Inflation Expectations Survey of Households (IESH)**, **Rural Consumer Confidence Survey (RCCS)**, and **Urban Consumer Confidence Survey (UCCS)** to collect household feedback on inflation, economic conditions, employment, income, and spending.
- The surveys provide critical inputs for **monetary policy formulation** ahead of the **Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) meeting** scheduled from **3–5 August 2026**.
- The **Inflation Expectations Survey of Households (IESH)** is conducted across **19 cities** to assess households' inflation expectations based on their individual consumption baskets.
- IESH gathers **qualitative responses** on general and product-specific price movements for the **next 3 months and 1 year**.

AU Small Finance Bank Limited and Zaggle Launch Co-Branded Retail Credit Card with Visa, RuPay, and Unified Payments Interface Benefits

- **AU Small Finance Bank Limited (AU SFB)** partnered with **Zaggle Prepaid Ocean Services Limited (Zaggle)** to launch the **AU Zaggle Co-Branded Retail Credit Card** on the **Visa and RuPay payment networks** through the **zagg.money platform**.
- The **AU Zaggle Co-Branded Retail Credit Card** offers **customizable rewards**, **Zagg Coins-to-cashback**, **Unified Payments Interface (UPI) support**, and **contactless payment benefits**, providing customers with a personalized digital credit card experience.
- Cardholders can earn **accelerated Zagg Coins** on **UPI and contactless transactions**, along with **higher cashback** upon achieving specified spending milestones.

About AU Small Finance Bank (AU SFB) :

- **AU Small Finance Bank (AU SFB)** was established in **1996** as a vehicle finance company and became a **Small Finance Bank (SFB) in 2017**.
- **AU Small Finance Bank (AU SFB)** is headquartered in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**, and is led by its Founder, Managing Director (MD), and Chief Executive Officer (CEO), **Sanjay Agarwal**.

IDFC FIRST Bank Introduces Digital EPFO Payment Facility for Online EPF Contributions

- **IDFC FIRST Bank** has launched **Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) Payment Services** through integration with the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) under the **Ministry of Labour and Employment**.
- The new service enables employers and establishments to make **Employees' Provident Fund (EPF) contributions digitally** by initiating payments through the **EPFO Portal** and completing them via IDFC FIRST Bank's **Retail and Corporate Internet Banking platforms**.
- The integration provides a **fully digital, secure, and paperless payment solution** for Provident Fund (PF) contributions.

About IDFC FIRST Bank :

- IDFC FIRST Bank is a **Private Sector Bank** headquartered in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.
- **Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** : **V. Vaidyanathan**

Bank of Baroda Agrees to USD 600 Million Settlement in NMC Health Lending Dispute

- **Bank of Baroda (BoB)** has entered into a joint out-of-court settlement with **NMC Health PLC** and **NMC Healthcare Ltd**, agreeing to pay **USD 600 million (around ₹5,100 crore)** to resolve claims related to its lending exposure to the collapsed UAE-based NMC Group.
- The settlement ends the long-running legal proceedings before the **Abu Dhabi Global Market (ADGM) Court** and the **UK Insolvency and Companies Court**, avoiding prolonged litigation and legal expenses.
- The settlement was reached **without any admission of liability or wrongdoing** by Bank of Baroda.
- The agreement resolves **all claims against Bank of Baroda** arising from the NMC Health case.

About Bank of Baroda :

- Founded : 20 July 1908
- Headquarters : Vadodara, Gujarat, India
- MD & CEO : Debadatta Chand

Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority Forms Accelerated Scaling of Global Capital Ecosystem and NPS Development Committee to Boost National Pension System Through Global Pension Fund Investments

- **Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA)** has constituted the **ASCEND (Accelerated Scaling of Global Capital Ecosystem and NPS Development) Committee** to

strengthen the **National Pension System (NPS)** by attracting **global pension fund investments** into India.

- The ASCEND Committee will prepare a roadmap for collaboration between Indian pension funds under the NPS framework and leading global pension funds to channel **long-term, stable capital** into **infrastructure** and other strategic sectors, while safeguarding NPS subscribers' interests.
- The ASCEND Committee is chaired by **Dinesh Khara**, Chairman of the **NPS Trust**.

About PFRDA:

- Established: 2003 (Statutory status from PFRDA Act, 2013)
- Under which Ministry: Ministry of Finance, Government of India
- Headquarters: New Delhi
- Chairman: Sivasubramanian Ramann
- **Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA)** is the **statutory regulator** responsible for the regulation and supervision of the pension sector in India and functions under the **Ministry of Finance**, Government of India.

Central Public Sector Enterprises Required to Settle All Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Invoices Through Trade Receivables Discounting System Under New MSME Notification

- The **Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME)**, through a notification issued on **30 June 2026**, mandated all operating **Central Public Sector Enterprises (CPSEs)** to settle MSME invoices for goods and services through **Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS) platforms** authorised by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**.
- The new mandate implements a key announcement of the **Union Budget FY2026–27**, aimed at strengthening **MSME financing** and ensuring **timely payments**.
- Under the new framework, CPSEs must route and settle MSME invoices through TReDS, enhancing **transparency, accountability, and payment discipline**.
- CPSEs are required to disclose details of MSME invoices processed through TReDS and obtain a **Statutory Auditor's Certificate** confirming **TReDS registration and compliance** during the annual audit.
- The initiative will facilitate **collateral-free working capital** for MSMEs by enabling **invoice discounting** before the payment due date, improving their **liquidity**.

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman Reviews Reserve Bank of India's FCNR(B), External Commercial Borrowings and Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings Swap Schemes with Bank

Chiefs

- **Union Finance Minister Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman** reviewed the progress of **RBI's Swap Facility Schemes** for **FCNR(B) Deposits**, **External Commercial Borrowings (ECBs)**, and **Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings (OFCBs)** with MDs & CEOs of **Public Sector Banks (PSBs)** and **Public Financial Institutions (PFIs)** in **New Delhi**.
- The meeting was attended by Secretaries of the **Department of Financial Services (DFS)**, **Department of Economic Affairs (DEA)**, **Department of Revenue (DoR)**, **Chief Economic Advisor (CEA)**, **RBI Deputy Governor**, and other senior officials.
- **Eligibility Period**: FCNR(B) Deposits are eligible under the scheme until **30 September 2026**.
- **Eligibility Period**: ECBs and OFCBs are eligible under the scheme until **31 December 2026**.

Central Bureau of Narcotics Dismantles Illegal Mephedrone Lab in Pune Under Operation Vajra, Arrests Two Key Kingpins

- The **Central Bureau of Narcotics (CBN), Madhya Pradesh Unit**, dismantled a sophisticated **Mephedrone (MD) manufacturing laboratory** in **Pune, Maharashtra**, under **Operation Vajra**.
- The operation led to the **arrest of two chief conspirators** of an interstate synthetic drug trafficking syndicate from **Ujjain (Madhya Pradesh)** and **Jodhpur (Rajasthan)**.
- **Operation Vajra** was conducted by the **Preventive Branch, Office of the Deputy Narcotics Commissioner, CBN, Neemuch**, based on specific intelligence, between **1–10 July 2026**.

About Central Bureau of Narcotics (CBN) :

- **Central Bureau of Narcotics (CBN)** is a regulatory and law enforcement agency under the **Ministry of Finance**, responsible for supervising the legal cultivation of opium poppy, regulating the international trade of psychotropic substances and precursor chemicals, and combating drug trafficking.
- **CBN Headquarters** is located in **Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh**.
- During the calendar year **2026**, CBN registered **142 cases**, made **193 arrests**, and dismantled **4 clandestine drug laboratories**.
- These enforcement actions support the Government of India's vision of **"Nasha Mukt Bharat" (Drug-Free India)** by targeting organised narcotics networks.

Five Indian States Achieve Upper-Middle-Income Status While India Remains a Lower-Middle-Income Economy: World Bank

- According to the **World Bank Country Income Classification (FY2027)**, **India** continues to be classified as a **Lower-Middle-Income Economy**.

- India's **Gross National Income (GNI) per capita** under the **Atlas Method** was **USD 2,760 (2025)**, and the country has remained in the Lower-Middle-Income category since **2009**.
- The **World Bank** classifies economies annually on **1 July** based on the previous year's **Gross National Income (GNI) per capita** calculated using the **Atlas Method**.
- Under the **FY2027 World Bank Income Classification**, **Low Income** economies have GNI per capita of **USD 1,175 or less**, **Lower-Middle Income** economies have **USD 1,176–4,635**, **Upper-Middle Income** economies have **USD 4,636–14,375**, and **High Income** economies have **above USD 14,375**.

United Nations Conference on Trade and Development World Investment Report 2026: India Becomes the World's 11th-Largest Foreign Direct Investment Recipient

- According to the **United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD) World Investment Report 2026**, India became the **11th-largest recipient** of **Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** in the world in **2025**, improving from **13th position** in **2024**.
- **FDI inflows** into India increased by **44%**, rising from **USD 27.09 billion (2024)** to **USD 38.89 billion (2025)**.
- India's improved ranking was driven by **policy support for advanced manufacturing**, **infrastructure development**, and deeper integration into **Global Value Chains (GVCs)**.
- India's strong FDI performance contrasted with **developing economies**, where FDI inflows increased by only **2%**, while **developing Asia** recorded **3% growth**.

Standard Chartered Becomes First Bank in India to Process SWIFT Retail Cross-Border Remittance in 37 Seconds

- **Standard Chartered** became the **first bank in the world** to successfully process a **cross-border remittance** under **SWIFT's new Retail Payments Framework**.
- The **first live cross-border transaction** was completed from **Australia to India** in just **37 seconds**, demonstrating **near real-time international payments**.
- The transaction was initiated by **Westpac (Australia)** and routed through **Standard Chartered** using the **SWIFT** (Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication) network.

Bank of Maharashtra Unveils 'FinSpark'26' National Cybersecurity Hackathon

- **Bank of Maharashtra (BoM)**, one of India's leading Public Sector Banks (PSBs), launched **"FinSpark'26"**, a national-level **cybersecurity hackathon**, under the theme **"Securing the Future of Banking"**.

- **FinSpark'26** aims to encourage **students and dropouts** across India to develop **innovative solutions** for real-world **cybersecurity challenges** in the banking sector.
- The hackathon is being organised by **Bank of Maharashtra (BoM)** in association with the **Indian Banks' Association (IBA)**, **Department of Financial Services (DFS)**, Government of India (GoI), and **COEP Technological University, Pune**.

About Bank of Maharashtra:

- Headquarters: Pune, Maharashtra
- Founded: September 16, 1935
- MD & CEO: Nidhu Saxena
- Tagline: "One Family One Bank"

National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development Launches Gramodyam Programme to Promote Rural Entrepreneurship in India

- **National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)** launched **Gramodyam**, an **entrepreneurship development programme for rural youth**, during its **45th Foundation Day celebrations**.
- **Gramodyam** aims to **identify, nurture, mentor, and empower aspiring rural entrepreneurs** by helping them establish **sustainable rural enterprises** and generate **employment opportunities**.
- The programme seeks to **convert local ideas into viable businesses**, promoting **sustainable economic growth** in rural India.

About NABARD:

- It is an All India Development Financial Institution (DFI) and an apex Supervisory Body for overall supervision of Regional Rural Banks, State Cooperative Banks and District Central Cooperative Banks in India.
- Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra
- Founded: July 12, 1982 by the Government of India
- Chairman: Shaji K V

Indian Mercantile Co-operative Bank Removed from the Second Schedule of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934

- **Indian Mercantile Co-operative Bank Limited., Lucknow** has been **excluded from the Second Schedule of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Act, 1934**, through a notification dated **4 June 2026**, published in the **Gazette of India (Part III – Section 4)** on **22 June 2026**.

- With its removal from the **Second Schedule**, the bank loses its status as a **Scheduled Bank** under the **RBI Act, 1934**.
- **Scheduled Bank status** is granted under **Section 42 of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934**, subject to compliance with prescribed **regulatory requirements**.
- To qualify as a **Scheduled Bank**, a bank must satisfy conditions such as **minimum capital requirements**, maintenance of **Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR)/reserve requirements**, and compliance with **RBI's regulatory and supervisory norms**.

Reserve Bank of India Organises 3rd Annual Internal Ombudsmen Conference in Mumbai

- The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** organised the **3rd Annual Conference of Internal Ombudsmen (IO)** in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.
- The conference brought together **Internal Ombudsmen (IOs)** from various **Regulated Entities (REs)**, including **Banks**, **Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)**, **Credit Information Companies (CICs)**, and other regulated institutions, along with **RBI Ombudsmen** and **senior RBI officials**.

Axis Max Life Introduces 'Smart RISE' Retirement Plan Combining Guaranteed Income and NIFTY 50-Linked Annuity

- **Axis Max Life Insurance Limited** launched **Axis Max Life Smart Retirement Income with Sustained Earnings Plan (Smart RISE)**, a retirement-focused insurance product designed to provide stable post-retirement income.
- **Smart RISE** combines a **Guaranteed Annuity** with a **Variable Annuity** linked to the **NIFTY 50 Index**, offering both fixed income and market-linked growth potential.
- The plan aims to provide **predictable retirement income**, **equity market participation**, **financial security**, and **long-term legacy planning**.

About Axis Max Life Insurance Limited :

- Established : **2000**
- **Managing Director (MD) & Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** : **Sumit Madan**
- It is an 80:20 joint venture between Max Financial Services and Axis Bank.
- The company is a subsidiary of the publicly listed Max Financial Services.

Ministry of Commerce and Industry Reports India's Quarter 1 of Financial Year 2026–27 Exports at USD 232.73 Billion

- The **Ministry of Commerce and Industry (MoC&I)** released **India's Trade Data** for **Quarter 1 (Q1: April–June)** of **Financial Year 2026–27 (FY27)** and for the month of **June 2026**.

- According to the data, **India's total exports** during **Q1 FY27** stood at **USD 232.73 billion**, while **total imports** were estimated at **USD 270.15 billion**.
- **Merchandise exports** during **Q1 FY27** increased to **USD 129.32 billion**, compared to **USD 111.57 billion** in **Q1 FY26**, reflecting strong growth in **goods exports**.
- **Service exports** during **April–June FY27** were estimated at **USD 103.41 billion**, up from **USD 97.41 billion** during the corresponding period of **FY26**.

About Ministry of Commerce and Industry :

- **Cabinet Minister :** Piyush Goyal
- **Minister of State :** Jitin Prasada

Reserve Bank of India Proposes One-Time Approval Framework for Institutional Investors to Hold Significant Stakes in Banks

- **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has released a **draft amendment** proposing a **one-time approval mechanism** for eligible institutional investors to acquire and retain **major shareholding (5% or more)** in the same banking company without seeking repeated approvals.
- Under the proposed framework, **prior RBI approval** will continue to be **mandatory** for the **first acquisition** of a major shareholding in a bank.
- After obtaining the one-time approval, eligible investors can increase or retain their stake in the same bank **up to 10%** of the paid-up share capital or voting rights **without seeking fresh RBI approval** every time their holding falls below and later exceeds 5%.

Reserve Bank of India Approves Type-II NBFC Licence for Delhivery Financial Services

- **Delhivery Financial Services Private Limited**, a wholly-owned subsidiary of **Delhivery Limited**, received **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** approval for the grant of a **Certificate of Registration (CoR)** as a **Type-II Non-Banking Financial Company–Non-Deposit Taking (NBFC-ND)**.
- RBI clarified that the **Certificate of Registration (CoR)** will be issued subject to the **submission of specified documents** to the satisfaction of the central bank, as mentioned in the approval letter.
- The approval will enable Delhivery Financial Services to **expand its financial services offerings** and strengthen its **logistics ecosystem**.

About Non-Banking Financial Company (NBFC) :

- A **Non-Banking Financial Company (NBFC)** is a financial institution registered under the **Companies Act, 1956 or Companies Act, 2013**, and is primarily regulated by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** under the **RBI Act, 1934**.
- NBFCs provide services such as **loans and advances** and **investments in shares, stocks, bonds, debentures, and government securities**, but they **cannot accept demand deposits** like banks.
- Based on liabilities, NBFCs are classified into **NBFC-Deposit Taking (NBFC-D)** and **NBFC-Non-Deposit Taking (NBFC-ND)**.
- **NBFC-ND** is further classified into **Type-I NBFC-ND** (does not accept public funds and has no customer interface) and **Type-II NBFC-ND** (accepts public funds and has a customer interface).

About RBI :

- Established: 1 April 1935 under the **Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934**, and serves as India's central bank.
- Nationalised: 1 January 1949
- Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra
- Governor: Sanjay Malhotra (26th Governor)
- Deputy Governors: Rohit Jain, Shirish Chandra Murmu, Swaminathan Janakiraman, Poonam Gupta
- Wholly Owned by RBI:
  - ➔ BRBNMPL – Bharatiya Reserve Bank Note Mudran Private Limited
  - ➔ DICGC – Deposit Insurance and Credit Guarantee Corporation
  - ➔ ReBIT – Reserve Bank Information Technology Private Limited
  - ➔ RBIH – Reserve Bank Innovation Hub
- Promoted by RBI (Now Government-owned):
  - ➔ NABARD – National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development
  - ➔ NHB – National Housing Bank
- The RBI is responsible for **monetary policy, currency management**, and **regulation of the financial system**.

Bloomberg Launches Electronic Trading Platform for Indian Government Bonds

- **Bloomberg** has facilitated the **first electronic trade** in **Indian Government Bonds (IGBs)** through its **Bloomberg Terminal** by integrating it with the **Negotiated Dealing System–Order Matching (NDS-OM)**.

- The new platform enables **Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs)** to electronically execute, monitor, allocate, and settle trades in Indian Government Bonds (IGBs) with domestic and international banks through a **single integrated platform**.
- The **Bloomberg Terminal** is directly connected to **NDS-OM**, which is operated by **Clearcorp Dealing Systems (India) Ltd.**, providing an **end-to-end electronic workflow** for trading **Government Securities (G-Secs)**.
- The first electronic trade on the Bloomberg-NDS-OM platform was successfully executed by **State Street Investment Management**.

About Negotiated Dealing System–Order Matching (NDS-OM) :

- **NDS-OM (Negotiated Dealing System–Order Matching)** is an **anonymous, screen-based electronic order-matching platform** for secondary market trading in **Government Securities (G-Secs)**.
- **Launched**: **2005** by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**.
- **Operated by**: **Clearcorp Dealing Systems (India) Ltd.**, with trade settlement guaranteed by the **Clearing Corporation of India Limited (CCIL)**.
- **Tradable Instruments**: **Central Government Securities (G-Secs)**, **State Development Loans (SDLs)**, and **Treasury Bills (T-Bills)**.

Reserve Bank of India Mandates Banks and Non-Banking Financial Companies to Auction Bad Loan-Acquired Immovable Assets Within Seven Years

- **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has issued final prudential norms for **Banks, Small Finance Banks (SFBs), and Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)** regarding **Specified Non-Financial Assets (SNFAs)** acquired while resolving stressed loans or **Non-Performing Assets (NPAs)**.
- A **Specified Non-Financial Asset (SNFA)** is an **immovable asset (such as property)** acquired by a lender in full or partial settlement of its claims against a borrower, and can be acquired only when the lender's exposure is classified as a **Non-Performing Asset (NPA)**.
- SNFAs may be acquired against **full or partial extinguishment** of a lender's exposure on a **non-recourse basis**.

Financial Action Task Force Removes Algeria and Namibia from Grey List After Anti-Money Laundering and Combating the Financing of Terrorism Compliance Review

- **The Financial Action Task Force (FATF)** released its updated **High-Risk Jurisdictions** and **Jurisdictions under Increased Monitoring (Grey List)** following the **FATF Plenary Meeting** held from **17–19 June 2026**.
- Under the **High-Risk Jurisdictions subject to a Call for Action (Black List)**, **North Korea (DPRK)**, **Iran**, and **Myanmar** continue to remain on the list.
- **Myanmar**, which was added to the High-Risk Jurisdictions list in **October 2022**, continues to remain under **enhanced due diligence** requirements as per the latest FATF review.
- FATF has advised all member countries to apply **enhanced due diligence** for transactions involving North Korea, Iran, and Myanmar, while ensuring that **humanitarian assistance**, legitimate **Non-Profit Organisation (NPO)** activities, and **remittances** are not disrupted.

About FATF :

- **FATF** is an **inter-governmental organisation** established in **1989** to develop and promote global standards for combating **Money Laundering (ML)**, **Terrorist Financing (TF)**, and **Proliferation Financing (PF)**.
- The **FATF Plenary**, the organisation's **highest decision-making body**, meets **three times every year** and updates the High-Risk Jurisdictions (Black List) and Jurisdictions under Increased Monitoring (Grey List) after each meeting.

Digital India BHASHINI Division and Punjab National Bank Partner to Introduce Multilingual Artificial Intelligence Solutions for Inclusive Digital Banking

- **Digital India BHASHINI Division (DIBD)**, under the **Digital India Corporation (DIC)**, **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Punjab National Bank (PNB)** to develop **multilingual Artificial Intelligence (AI) solutions** for inclusive banking under the **BHASHINI for Seva/Sanchalan** initiative.
- The MoU was signed by **Amitabh Nag, Chief Executive Officer (CEO), DIBD**, and **Atish Kumar Rout, Chief General Manager (CGM-Digital)**, Digital Banking Transformation Division, PNB.
- The objective of the partnership is to **integrate BHASHINI's language translation Application Programming Interfaces (APIs)** and reference applications into **PNB's digital banking platform**, enabling **language-inclusive banking services**.

About Punjab National Bank (PNB):

- Founded: 1894

- Headquarters: New Delhi, India
- Managing Director & CEO: Ashok Chandra
- Tagline: "The Name You Can Bank Upon"

Private Sector Banks Lead Non-Performing Assets Write-offs in FY2025–26, Surpassing Public Sector Banks

- According to the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Financial Stability Report (FSR)**, **Private Sector Banks** wrote off **49.7%** of their **Non-Performing Assets (NPAs)** in **FY2025–26**, compared to **24.3%** by **Public Sector Banks (PSBs)**.
- **Public Sector Banks (PSBs)** held the largest share of bad loans, accounting for **63.2%** of the total NPAs in the **Indian banking system**.
- The **Indian banking sector** wrote off approximately **₹1.28 lakh crore** of bad loans during **FY2025–26**, with an overall **write-off ratio of 33.2%**.
- **Foreign Banks** recorded a **write-off ratio of 39.6%** during **FY2025–26**.

ICICI Prudential Life Board Approves Proposal to Rebrand as ICICI Life Insurance Limited

- The Board of **ICICI Prudential Life Insurance** approved a proposal to rename the company as **ICICI Life Insurance Limited**, subject to approval from the **Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)**.
- The proposed name change follows **Prudential Corporation Holdings'** decision to acquire a **75% stake** in **Bharti Life Insurance**, requiring it to be reclassified from a **Promoter** to an **Investor** in ICICI Prudential Life Insurance.
- The renaming aims to align the company's corporate identity with its **revised promoter structure** after Prudential Corporation Holdings reduces its shareholding from about **22% to below 10%**.

Reserve Bank of India Issues Draft Foreign Investment Rules, 2026 to Modernise India's Foreign Investment Framework

- The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has released the **Draft Foreign Exchange Management (Foreign Investment) Rules, 2026** for public consultation to modernise India's foreign investment regulatory framework.
- Foreign Investment in India is currently governed by the **Foreign Exchange Management (Non-Debt Instruments) Rules, 2019 (NDI Rules)**.

- The **Union Budget 2026–27** announced a comprehensive review of the NDI Rules to create a modern, simplified and investor-friendly framework for foreign investments.

Reserve Bank of India Releases FY26 Financial Inclusion-Index at 70 and Announces Final Specified Non-Financial Assets Prudential Framework

- The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** released the **Financial Inclusion Index (FI-Index)** for **FY 2025–26**, with the index rising to **70.0 in March 2026** from **67.0 in March 2025**.
- The improvement in the **FI-Index** was mainly driven by an increase in the **Usage sub-index**, reflecting the **deepening of financial inclusion** across India.
- Growth was recorded across **all sub-indices** of the **Financial Inclusion Index (FI-Index)** during **FY 2025–26**.
- The **RBI** developed the composite **Financial Inclusion Index (FI-Index)** in consultation with the **Government of India (GoI)** and other stakeholders to measure the extent of financial inclusion across the country.
- The **FI-Index** was first published in **August 2021** for the financial year ending **March 2021**.

Government & Reserve Bank of India Enhance FinTech Regulations to Strengthen Consumer Protection and Digital Finance

- The **Government of India (GoI)** continuously engages with financial sector regulators and other stakeholders to review issues related to the **FinTech ecosystem**, including **digital lending platforms** and **payment aggregators**.
- The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** issued the **Framework for Self-Regulatory Organisation(s) in the FinTech Sector (SRO-FT Framework)** on **30 May 2024** to establish regulatory standards, promote **ethical conduct**, ensure **market integrity**, resolve disputes, and enhance **transparency and accountability** among FinTech entities.
- The **RBI** issued the **Master Directions on Digital Payment Security Controls** in **February 2021**, mandating banks to implement **minimum security standards** across internet banking, mobile banking, card payments, and other digital payment channels to combat **cyber threats**.

Department of Land Resources and Reserve Bank of India Innovation Hub Partner to Integrate Digital Land Governance with Digital Lending

- The **Department of Land Resources (DoLR)** under the **Ministry of Rural Development (MoRD)** held a high-level meeting with the **Reserve Bank of India Innovation Hub (RBIH)** to strengthen the convergence of **Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI)** for **land governance** and **digital lending**.

- The initiative aims to create a **secure, interoperable land-credit ecosystem** to improve **institutional credit access** for farmers and rural citizens.
- The meeting was chaired by **Narendra Bhooshan**, Secretary, **DoLR**, who interacted with **Sahil Kini**, Chief Executive Officer (CEO), **RBI Innovation Hub (RBIH)**, along with senior officials from both organisations.

About ULI :

- **Unified Lending Interface (ULI)** is a **Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI)** developed by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** to enable **faster and seamless credit delivery**.
- **ULI** facilitates **consent-based sharing of information** among borrowers, data providers, and lenders through **data interoperability**.

Government and Reserve Bank of India Enhance Digital Lending Oversight with Stronger Regulations and Consumer Protection Measures

- The **Government of India (GoI)** is continuously engaging with the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** and other regulators/stakeholders to curb the operations of **fake and illegal loan apps** in the country.
- The **RBI** operationalised the **Digital Lending Apps (DLAs) Directory** on its official website with effect from **1 July 2025** to help customers verify whether a **Digital Lending App (DLA)** is associated with an **RBI Regulated Entity (RE)**.
- The **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)** has blocked **87 illegal loan lending applications** under **Section 69A of the Information Technology Act, 2000** after following the prescribed legal process.
- The **Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2025**, notified on **22 October 2025**, authorised **sectoral regulators** to issue directions for **blocking illegal online content** from public access.

Government Strengthens Financial Inclusion Through Banking, Insurance, Pension and Credit Schemes

- The **Government of India (GoI)** launched the **National Mission for Financial Inclusion (NMFI)**, namely **Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY)**, in **August 2014** to promote **financial inclusion** and provide **universal banking services** to every **unbanked household**.
- The **PMJDY** is based on the guiding principles of **"Banking the Unbanked, Securing the Unsecured, and Funding the Unfunded."**

- Under **PMJDY**, a total of **58.63 crore Jan Dhan Accounts** have been opened with total **deposits of ₹3,08,333 crore** as on **1 July 2026**.

Government of India Revises Windfall Tax: Raises Duty on Diesel & Aviation Turbine Fuel Exports, Cuts Petrol Export Tax

- The **Government of India (GoI)** increased the **windfall gains tax** on **diesel** and **Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF)** exports, while **reducing the tax** on **petrol** exports.
- According to the **Ministry of Finance (MoF)** notification, the revised tax rates came into effect from **16 July 2026**.
- **Windfall Tax** is a government-imposed tax on industries that earn **sudden extraordinary profits** due to external factors such as **geopolitical crises**, with the objective of redirecting these gains towards **societal benefits**.
- The **Special Additional Excise Duty (SAED)** on **diesel exports** was increased from **₹8.5 per litre to ₹15.5 per litre**.

India's Total Exports Grow 11.37% to USD 232.73 Billion in Q1 FY27

- **India's total exports (Merchandise + Services)** increased by **11.37%** to an estimated **USD 232.73 billion** during **April–June FY2026–27**, compared to **USD 208.98 billion** in the corresponding period of the previous financial year.
- **Merchandise exports** grew by **15.92%** to **USD 129.32 billion**, reflecting strong performance in **manufacturing and value-added sectors**.
- **Non-petroleum exports** increased by **12.44%** to **USD 106.30 billion**, indicating **broad-based export growth** beyond petroleum products.
- **Services exports** remained robust at **USD 103.41 billion** during **April–June FY2026–27**, supporting **India's overall export performance**.

Reserve Bank of India Data Shows India's Outward Foreign Direct Investment Declined 47.9% to USD 3 Billion in June 2026

- According to provisional data released by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**, India's **Outward Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** declined by **47.9% Year-on-Year (Y-o-Y)** to **USD 3 billion** in **June 2026**, compared to **USD 5.74 billion** in **June 2025**.
- On a **month-on-month basis**, Outward FDI also declined from **USD 4.5 billion in May 2026** to **USD 3 billion in June 2026**.
- Outward FDI comprises three components: **Equity Commitments**, **Debt (Loans) Commitments**, and **Guarantees**, all of which recorded a decline in June 2026.

- **Equity Commitments** declined sharply to **USD 738 million** in June 2026, compared to **USD 2.2 billion** in June 2025 and **USD 1.25 billion** in May 2026.
- **Debt Commitments** decreased to **USD 469.87 million** in June 2026, from **USD 568.54 million** in June 2025 and **USD 645.75 million** in May 2026.
- **Guarantees** issued by Indian entities to overseas subsidiaries and ventures declined to **USD 1.78 billion** in June 2026, compared to **USD 2.97 billion** in June 2025 and **USD 2.61 billion** in May 2026.

National Stock Exchange Introduces Electronic Gold Receipts for Exchange-Traded Ownership of Physical Gold

- Electronic Gold Receipts (**EGRs**) are **exchange-traded securities** introduced by the **National Stock Exchange (NSE)** that represent ownership of **physical gold** stored in **SEBI-regulated vaults**.
- The **NSE** launched the **Electronic Gold Receipts (EGR) Segment** in **May 2026** to provide a **regulated, transparent and secure platform** for buying and selling gold in electronic form.
- **Gold** backing every **EGR** is stored in **SEBI-regulated vaults**, allowing investors to own **physical gold** without storing it at home or in bank lockers.
- **EGRs** are held in **demat form**, can be bought and sold like **shares on stock exchanges**, and follow a **T+1 settlement cycle**, with receipts credited to the buyer's **demat account** on the next trading day.

Securities and Exchange Board of India Alerts Listed Companies and Regulated Entities Against Rising "Boss Scam" Cyber Fraud

- The **Securities and Exchange Board of India** (**SEBI**) has warned regulated entities and listed companies against the rising "**Boss Scam**", a cyber fraud primarily targeting **finance and accounts departments**.
- In a **Boss Scam**, fraudsters impersonate **Chief Executive Officers (CEOs)**, **Managing Directors (MDs)**, or other **senior executives** to deceive employees into making **unauthorised fund transfers**.
- **SEBI** issued the advisory after receiving inputs from the **Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C)** regarding the increasing number of **Boss Scam** incidents.
- The **Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C)**, through its **National Cybercrime Threat Analytics Unit (NCTAU)**, had also issued a similar advisory warning organisations about **Boss**

Scam frauds involving fake messages claiming to be from authorities such as the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**.

Reserve Bank of India Issues Commercial Banks–Governance Amendment Directions, 2026 Effective from 1 October 2026

- The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has issued the **Commercial Banks–Governance Amendment Directions, 2026**, which will come into effect from **1 October 2026**.
- The **Amendment Directions** aim to **strengthen board governance**, improve **decision-making**, and enhance **corporate governance** in the Indian banking sector.
- The revised framework shifts from a **prescriptive, theme-based approach** to a **principle-based governance framework**, providing greater flexibility to bank boards.

Reserve Bank of India Authorises EbixCash as India's First Authorised Dealer Category-II Entity to Offer Trade Remittance Services

- **EbixCash World Money Limited** became the **first Authorised Dealer Category-II (AD-II) entity in India** to receive **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** authorisation to offer **Trade Remittances** and **Family Maintenance Remittances**, a segment previously dominated by **banks**.
- The **RBI approval** marks a significant expansion of the role of **AD-II entities** in India's **foreign exchange and remittance ecosystem**.
- Under the enhanced licence, **EbixCash** can facilitate **Trade Remittances up to ₹25 lakh per transaction**.

About EbixCash :

- **EbixCash** was initially established as a **Full Fledged Money Changer (FFMC)** in **1999**.
- It was later upgraded to an **RBI-regulated Authorised Dealer Category-II (AD-II) entity**.
- **Corporate Headquarters: Noida, Uttar Pradesh (UP)**.

ICRA Projects India's Q1 FY27 Real Gross Domestic Product Growth at 6.4–6.6%

- **ICRA Limited**, a domestic credit rating agency, has projected **India's Real Gross Domestic Product (GDP) Growth** at **6.4–6.6%** for **Q1 (April–June) FY2026–27 (FY27)**.
- The projected growth is driven by **broad-based economic activity**, despite **elevated energy prices** and **limited input availability**, which continue to put pressure on **manufacturing margins**.
- **India's Real GDP** had grown by **7.8%** in **Q4 (January–March) FY2025–26 (FY26)**.

- **ICRA's Business Activity Monitor (BAM)** recorded **12% Year-on-Year (YoY) growth** in **June 2026**, the **highest growth in the last 32 months**, compared to **9.4% YoY in May 2026**.

EnKash Launches India's First Unified Payments Interface-Enabled Meal Card for Employee Benefits

- **EnKash**, India's leading **business payments and spend management platform**, became the **first company in India** to launch a **Unified Payments Interface (UPI)-enabled Meal Card**.
- The **UPI-based Meal Card** enables employees to make **direct payments** from their **meal balance** by scanning **eligible UPI QR Codes** at **food and grocery merchants**.
- The **UPI-enabled Meal Card** is supported by **EnKash's existing payments and prepaid infrastructure**, ensuring **seamless digital transactions**.

About EnKash :

- **EnKash** was established in **2018** and is recognized as **India's first full-stack payments and spend management platform**.
- **EnKash** holds the following key regulatory licences:
  - ➔ **Payment Aggregator (PA) Licence**
  - ➔ **Prepaid Payment Instrument (PPI) Licence**
  - ➔ **Bharat Connect (BBPOU) Licence**
- **Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister Report: India Accounted for 8.2% of Global Gross Domestic Product in Purchasing Power Parity Terms in 2025

- According to a working paper published by the **Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister (EAC-PM)**, **India** accounted for **8.2% of the world's Gross Domestic Product (GDP)** in **2025** based on **Purchasing Power Parity (PPP)**.
- The report highlights that **India contributes more than 10%** of **global savings** and **global investment**, reflecting its increasing importance in the world economy.
- The **International Monetary Fund (IMF)** projects **India's share of global GDP** to rise to **9.7% by 2030**, indicating sustained economic growth over the decade.
- The working paper is titled **"The World in Purchasing Power Parity (PPP): Trends since 1992"**.

Securities and Exchange Board of India Grants Approval to Carnelian Asset Management to Enter the Mutual Fund Business

- The **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)** approved **Carnelian Asset Management & Advisors Private Limited** to launch its **Mutual Fund (MF) business**.
- The approval enables **Carnelian Asset Management** to offer **active and passive mutual fund schemes** across **equity**, **debt**, and **hybrid asset classes** to **retail investors**.
- With this approval, the company can expand its **integrated wealth management platform** by providing **SEBI-regulated mutual fund products**.
- The approval allows **Carnelian** to diversify beyond its existing businesses of **Portfolio Management Services (PMS)**, **Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs)**, and **offshore investment strategies**.

Reserve Bank of India Temporarily Closes Mumbai's RBI Monetary Museum for Renovation

- The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** announced the **temporary closure** of the **RBI Monetary Museum** in **Mumbai** from **22 July 2026** for **renovation work** until further notice.
- The **RBI Monetary Museum** was established by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** and is **India's first museum** dedicated to documenting, preserving, and showcasing the country's **monetary heritage**.
- The museum also promotes **research on the evolution of money in India**, highlighting the **historical development** of the nation's monetary system.
- The **RBI Monetary Museum** is located in the **Amar Building**, **Fort area**, **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

Punjab National Bank and Andhra Pradesh Government Sign Memorandum of Understanding to Establish India's First Bank-Led Quantum Finance Hub

- **Punjab National Bank (PNB)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Government of Andhra Pradesh (AP)** to establish the **PNB Quantum Finance Hub** at the **Amaravati Quantum Valley (AQV)** in **Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh**.
- The **PNB Quantum Finance Hub** is **India's first bank-led Quantum Finance Hub**, marking a major milestone in the adoption of **Quantum Computing (QC)** in the banking and financial services sector.
- With this collaboration, **PNB** became the **first bank in India** to partner with a **state government** for establishing a dedicated **Quantum Finance Facility**.

About Punjab National Bank (PNB) :

- **E**stablished : **19 May 1894** and commenced operations on **12 April 1895**.
- **PNB** is **India's second-largest Public Sector Bank (PSB)** after the **State Bank of India (SBI)**.

- Headquarters : **Dwarka, New Delhi, Delhi**.
- **Managing Director (MD)** and **Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** : **Ashok Chandra**.

DBS Bank Named World's Best Corporate Bank at the 2026 Global Bank Awards

- **DBS Bank Limited**, a **Singapore-based** multinational banking and financial services corporation, was named the **World's Best Corporate Bank** at the **2026 Global Bank Awards** presented by **Global Finance magazine**.
- **DBS Bank** became the **first Southeast Asian bank** to win the **World's Best Corporate Bank** title since the award category was introduced in **2005**.
- The recognition highlights **DBS Bank's** leadership in **corporate banking**, **innovation**, **customer service**, and **financial excellence**.
- **DBS Bank** also held the title of **"Safest Bank in Asia"** by **Global Finance magazine** for **17 consecutive years (2009–2025)**.

London Stock Exchange to Introduce Extended Near-24-Hour Trading with LSE 24 Next Year

- The **London Stock Exchange (LSE)** announced the launch of **LSE 24**, a new **after-hours trading platform** designed to provide **near-continuous trading** for global investors.
- **LSE 24** will offer trading from **5:00 PM to 7:50 AM (London Time)**, significantly extending the exchange's **trading hours**.
- **Client testing** of the **LSE 24** platform is expected to begin by the **end of 2026**.
- The **commercial launch** of **LSE 24** is planned for the **first half (H1) of 2027**.

About London Stock Exchange (LSE) :

- The **London Stock Exchange (LSE)** was established in **1801**, making it one of the world's oldest **stock exchanges**.
- The **headquarters** of the **London Stock Exchange (LSE)** is located in **London, United Kingdom (UK)**.
- The **LSE** is one of the world's largest **stock exchanges**, providing trading services in **equities**, **bonds**, **Exchange-Traded Products (ETPs)**, and other **financial instruments**.

Government Eases Foreign Direct Investment Norms for Export-Oriented Inventory-Based E-Commerce of Indian-Manufactured Goods

- The **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)** under the **Ministry of Commerce and Industry (MoC&I)** relaxed the **Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) Policy** by allowing foreign-funded e-commerce companies to operate an **inventory-based model** exclusively for the **export of goods manufactured or produced in India**.

- The policy change aims to **boost India's exports** by enabling foreign-invested e-commerce platforms to **procure, stock, warehouse, and export** Indian-made products directly to overseas consumers, thereby **improving global market access** for domestic manufacturers and sellers.

SBI Life Insurance Becomes Principal Partner of India's Para Sports Team for the 2026 Season

- **SBI Life Insurance Company Limited**, one of India's leading private life insurers, entered into a **strategic partnership** with the **Paralympic Committee of India (PCI)**.
- Under the partnership, **SBI Life Insurance** became the **Principal Partner** of the **Indian Contingent** for the **2026 Para Sport Season**.
- The collaboration aims to **recognise, encourage, and highlight** the achievements of India's **para-athletes**, celebrating their **dedication, resilience, and high performance**.

About SBI Life Insurance :

- **SBI Life Insurance Company Limited** was incorporated in **October 2000**.
- The company was registered with the **Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)** in **March 2001**.
- **SBI Life Insurance** offers a wide range of insurance products, including **protection, pension, savings, and health insurance solutions** for **individual and group customers**.

Government Reports Gross Non-Performing Assets of Scheduled Commercial Banks Fall to 1.73% by March 2026

- **Gross Non-Performing Assets (GNPAs)** of **Scheduled Commercial Banks (SCBs)** declined to **1.73% as of March 2026**, compared to **2.75% in March 2024**, indicating a significant improvement in the **asset quality** of India's banking sector.
- **Minister of State (MoS) for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary** informed the **Rajya Sabha** that the decline in NPAs reflects the impact of sustained **Government and Reserve Bank of India (RBI) reforms**.
- **Public Sector Banks (PSBs)** reduced their **Gross NPAs** from **₹6.16 lakh crore in March 2021 to ₹2.45 lakh crore in March 2026**, showing a substantial improvement in financial health.

Nepal Allows Indian and Nepali Citizens to Carry ₹200 and ₹500 Indian Currency Notes up to ₹25,000 Across the Border

- **Nepal** has permitted **Indian and Nepali citizens** to carry **Indian currency notes of ₹200 and ₹500 denominations** (issued on or after **9 November 2016**) into or out of Nepal up to a **maximum limit of ₹25,000 per person**.

- The decision was notified by the **Nepal Rastra Bank (NRB)**, the central bank of Nepal, to facilitate smoother **cross-border travel, tourism, trade, and business** between **India and Nepal**.
- **Indian ₹500 and ₹1,000 notes** issued before **9 November 2016** continue to remain **prohibited** in Nepal.

National Stock Exchange Launches India's First Domestic Benchmark-Based Indian Natural Gas Futures Contract

- **The National Stock Exchange (NSE)** announced the launch of **India's first exchange-traded energy derivative**, the **Indian Natural Gas Futures**, with trading commencing from **27 July 2026**.
- The **Indian Natural Gas Futures** contract is linked to a **domestic benchmark**, providing India's first exchange-traded natural gas derivative based on domestic gas prices.
- The contract was launched under the trading symbol **NATGASIND** after receiving approval from the **Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)** for trading in the **Commodity Derivatives Segment**.
- The **cash-settled contract** is benchmarked to the **Indian Gas Exchange (IGX) Gujarat (Dahej) Hub** price.

About National Stock Exchange (NSE) :

- Established : **1992**
- Headquarters : **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

VIYONA Fintech Secures Bharat Connect Approval to Operate as Customer Operating Unit

- **VIYONA Fintech**, a **Hyderabad, Telangana-based fintech infrastructure startup**, received approval from the **Bharat Bill Payment System (BBPS)**, now known as **Bharat Connect**, to operate as a **Customer Operating Unit (COU)**.
- The **COU certification** enables **VIYONA Fintech** to provide **interoperable digital bill payment services** across India through the **Bharat Connect platform**.
- Under the approval, **VIYONA** can offer **Bharat Connect-powered bill payment services** for **electricity, water, gas, broadband, mobile recharges, Direct-to-Home (DTH) subscriptions, insurance premiums, loan EMIs, educational fees**, and other approved bill payments.

About VIYONA Fintech :

- **E**stablished : **2018**
- Headquarters : **Hyderabad, Telangana**.

Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs Grants Customs Clearance to Vizhinjam International Seaport for Export-Import Cargo Operations

- **Vizhinjam International Seaport Limited (VISL)**, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, received final approval from the **Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC)** to commence **Export-Import (EXIM) cargo operations** from **18 August 2026**.
- The **CBIC** notified **VISL** as a **Customs Port** under the **Customs Act, 1962**, enabling the port to handle **direct EXIM cargo operations**.

About CBIC :

- **Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC)** was established in **1964** and is headquartered in **New Delhi, Delhi**.
- **CBIC** functions under the **Department of Revenue (DoR)**, **Ministry of Finance (MoF)**.
- The current Chairman of CBIC is **Vivek Chaturvedi**.

State Bank of India to Become First Indian Bank to Issue Perpetual Bonds in 2026

- **State Bank of India (SBI)** is set to become the first Indian bank to issue **Basel III-compliant Additional Tier-I (AT-1) Perpetual Bonds** in **2026**.
- SBI plans to raise **₹5,000 crore** through the issuance of **AT-1 Perpetual Bonds**, with the issue expected within the next two weeks.
- The proposed AT-1 Perpetual Bonds will carry a **five-year call option**, allowing SBI to redeem the bonds after five years, subject to **regulatory approval**.
- The bond issue is part of SBI's broader plan to raise up to **₹60,000 crore** during the financial year through **Infrastructure Bonds, Basel III-compliant AT-1 Bonds, and Tier-II Bonds**.

About State Bank of India (SBI):

- Founded Year: 1955
- Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India
- Chairman: Challa Sreenivasulu Setty
- Slogan: "The Banker to Every Indian"

Government Approves Reserve Bank of India Proposal to Introduce ₹10 and ₹20 Polymer Banknotes for Field Trials

- The **Government of India (GoI)** has approved the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** proposal to conduct field trials of **1 billion (100 crore)** polymer banknotes each in the **₹10 and ₹20 denominations**, marking a major step towards introducing more durable and secure currency notes in India.

- The proposal was submitted by the **RBI**, with the recommendation of its **Central Board**, under **Section 25 of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934**, seeking approval for **field trials** and the **regular issuance** of ₹10 and ₹20 polymer banknotes after successful completion of the trials.
- The proposed field trial covers **₹3,000 crore worth of polymer banknotes** (₹10 and ₹20 denominations) to evaluate their performance under real-world conditions.
- **Polymer banknotes** are printed on a **non-fibrous, non-porous polymer (plastic) substrate** instead of conventional paper substrate, making them **longer-lasting**, more **resistant to wear and tear, dirt, moisture, and contamination**, and **more secure against counterfeiting**.

Reserve Bank of India Proposes Demat-Only Securitisation Notes While Retaining ₹1 Crore Minimum Investment Limit

- The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** has released draft amendments proposing that all **Securitisation Notes (SNs)** must be issued, held, and transferred only in **dematerialised (demat) form** to enhance **transparency, efficiency, liquidity, and investor protection** in the securitisation market.

What are Securitisation Notes?

- **Securitisation Notes (SNs)** are financial instruments created by **pooling assets** such as home loans, vehicle loans, and other retail loans, which are then sold to investors, enabling **banks and Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)** to raise fresh funds for further lending.

Delhi High Court Directs Winding Up of Paytm Payments Bank Following Reserve Bank of India Licence Cancellation

- The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** cancelled the banking licence of **Paytm Payments Bank Limited (PPBL)** with effect from **24 April 2026** under **Section 22(4) of the Banking Regulation Act, 1949**.
- Following the licence cancellation, the RBI approached the **Delhi High Court** seeking the winding up of Paytm Payments Bank Limited (PPBL) and the appointment of an **Official Liquidator**.
- The Delhi High Court appointed **Shri Girikumar M. Nair**, former Chief General Manager (CGM) of the **State Bank of India (SBI)**, as the **Official Liquidator** to supervise the bank's liquidation process.

India Records All-Time High Exports of US$863.1 Billion in FY 2025–26, Led by Strong Merchandise and Services Trade

- India's total exports reached a record **US$863.1 billion in FY 2025–26**, comprising **Merchandise Exports of US$441.8 billion** and **Services Exports of US$421.3 billion**, reflecting strong growth in India's external trade.
- The Government of India stated that **Free Trade Agreements (FTAs)** with the United Arab Emirates (**UAE), United Kingdom (UK), Australia, Oman, New Zealand, Mauritius, and EFTA member countries** have expanded market access, diversified export destinations, and boosted export growth.
- Among FTA partners, **ASEAN** emerged as India's largest merchandise export destination with exports worth **US$38.42 billion**, followed by the **United Arab Emirates (UAE) at US$37.36 billion**, **SAFTA countries at US$25.77 billion**, the **United Kingdom (UK)**, and **Singapore**.

Axis Finance Unveils 'Drishti' Platform to Enhance Retail and Micro, Small and Medium Enterprise Credit Operations

- **Axis Finance Limited (AFL)** launched **'Axis Finance Drishti'**, an in-house **Business Rules Engine (BRE)** and configurable digital platform to strengthen **credit decision-making, risk management, and lending efficiency** across **Retail and Micro, Small and Medium Enterprise (MSME) lending**.
- The platform aims to enable **faster, data-driven, scalable, and consistent credit assessments**, while **enhancing customer experience** and improving the overall **loan approval process**.

About Axis Finance Limited (AFL) :

- It is a **Non-Deposit-Taking Non-Banking Financial Company (NBFC)** and a **wholly owned subsidiary of Axis Bank**.
- **It** was incorporated in **1995** and is headquartered in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

OmniCard Introduces India's First Unified Payments Interface-Based Flexi Benefits Wallet for Employee Tax Savings

- **OmniCard Platform**, developed by **Eroute Technologies Private Limited**, launched India's first **Flexi Benefits Basket** on the **Unified Payments Interface (UPI)**, providing a single employee-controlled digital wallet for **tax-efficient employee benefits**.
- The **Flexi Benefits Basket** is built on OmniCard's **RBI-licensed Prepaid Payment Instrument (PPI) platform** and can be used at nearly **60 million UPI-accepting merchants** across India.

- The platform enables employees to allocate benefit allowances across multiple tax-efficient categories, including **Meals, Fuel, Telecom, Books & Periodicals, Gadgets, and other eligible benefits**.

About OmniCard :

- **OmniCard** was launched in **July 2021** as an **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-powered Corporate Spend Management Platform** and payment ecosystem in India.

Edelweiss Mutual Fund Introduces India's First Real Estate Investment Trusts-Focused Passive Index Fund

- **Edelweiss Mutual Fund (MF)** launched the **Edelweiss Nifty REITs & Realty Index Fund**, India's first Real Estate Investment Trusts **(REITs)-oriented open-ended passive index fund**.
- The fund tracks the **Nifty REITs & Realty Total Return Index (TRI)** and aims to provide low-cost, long-term capital appreciation through **diversified exposure to listed REITs and listed real estate companies**.

Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation to Replace Wholesale Price Index with Producer Price Index for Gross Domestic Product Deflation

- The **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)** announced that the **Output Producer Price Index (PPI)** will replace the **Wholesale Price Index (WPI)** as the **GDP deflator** for quarterly and annual **Gross Domestic Product (GDP)** estimates, wherever applicable.
- The **Producer Price Index (PPI) series** was released by the **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)** in **June 2026** to improve GDP measurement and align **India's National Accounts** with international statistical standards.
- The **Output PPI** will be used for **GDP deflation**, improving the accuracy of **real GDP growth estimates** by reducing distortions caused by the earlier methodology.

Asian Development Bank Sanctions USD 850 Million to Support India's Prime Minister Surya Ghar Rooftop Solar Programme

- The **Asian Development Bank (ADB)** approved an **USD 850 million loan** to support the **Government of India (GoI)** in accelerating rooftop solar adoption under the **Prime Minister Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana (PMSG-MBY)**.
- The funding is provided under **Subprogram 2** of the **Accelerating Affordable and Inclusive Rooftop Solar Systems Development Program**, which builds on **Subprogram 1** approved in

November 2025 that established the policy, institutional, digital, financing, and market framework for large-scale rooftop solar deployment.

- The **Pradhan Mantri Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana (PMSG-MBY)** aims to install rooftop solar systems for **10 million low- and middle-income households** and achieve **30 Giga-Watt (GW)** of cumulative residential rooftop solar capacity by **FY 2026–27 (FY27)**.

Reserve Bank of India Penalises Six Companies, Including Muthoot Finance, for Violating Non-Banking Financial Company Regulatory Norms

- The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** imposed **monetary penalties on six companies**, including **Muthoot Finance**, for non-compliance with various provisions of the **RBI Act** and **Non-Banking Financial Company (NBFC)** regulations.
- **Muthoot Finance** was fined **₹5.80 lakh** for failing to **periodically review the risk categorisation** of customer accounts and for not deploying **robust software** to effectively identify and report **suspicious financial transactions**.
- **Avail Financial Services** was penalised **₹6.20 lakh** because its **Managing Director** held **directorships in two other Middle Layer NBFCs**, and the company violated the prescribed **single-party exposure limit**.
- **Satya MicroCapital** was fined **₹3.10 lakh** for failing to classify certain **restructured accounts** as **Non-Performing Assets (NPAs)** in accordance with RBI regulations.
- **PAN Emami Cosmed** was also fined **₹3.10 lakh** for non-compliance with **RBI regulatory provisions**.
- **Dhani Loans and Services** and **Muthoot Vehicle and Asset Finance** were each penalised **₹2.70 lakh** for violating **RBI's regulatory norms**.

Piramal Finance and Muthoot Fincorp Partner to Expand Affordable Housing and Loan Against Property Financing Across India

- **Piramal Finance** entered into a **co-lending partnership** with **Muthoot Fincorp** to expand access to **affordable housing finance** and **Loan Against Property (LAP)** solutions across India.
- The partnership aims to improve the availability of **formal credit** for **aspiring homeowners, self-employed professionals, small business owners, and underserved borrowers**, particularly in **Tier-2, Tier-3, semi-urban, and rural areas**.

Revolut Launches Revolut Bank Australia After Securing Full Banking Licence, Marking Its First APAC Banking Entity

- Global fintech company **Revolut** received a full **Authorised Deposit-taking Institution (ADI) licence** from the **Australian Prudential Regulation Authority (APRA)**, officially launching as **Revolut Bank Australia**.
- With this approval, Revolut became the **first global fintech** to secure a full unrestricted ADI licence in **Australia**, marking its **first banking entity** in the **Asia-Pacific (APAC)** region.

About Revolut :

- **Revolut**, founded in **2015** and headquartered in **London, United Kingdom**, is a global digital banking and fintech company providing banking, payments, foreign exchange, investment, and cryptocurrency services, with **more than 75 million customers worldwide**.
- **Founder and CEO** : **Nik Storonsky**

NATIONAL AND STATE NEWS

Union Home Minister Amit Shah Launches Bharat Taxi in Gujarat

- **Union Minister for Home Affairs and Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah** launched **Bharat Taxi** in **Gandhinagar, Gujarat**.
- **Bharat Taxi** is a **cooperative-based mobility platform** developed under the **Ministry of Cooperation** with the vision of **"Sahakar Se Samriddhi" (Prosperity through Cooperation)**.
- The platform enables vehicle operators, known as **"Sarathis"**, to become **shareholders** of the cooperative, ensuring **ownership, financial security, and better earnings**.
- **Bharat Taxi** provides services through **two-wheelers, auto-rickshaws, and four-wheel taxis**, offering reliable and affordable transport services.

About Gujarat:

- **Chief Minister:** Bhupendra Patel
- **Governor:** Acharya Devvrat
- **Capital:** Gandhinagar
- **National Parks:** Gir National Park, Blackbuck National Park, Vansda National Park, Marine National Park
- **Wildlife Sanctuaries:** Nal Sarovar Bird Sanctuary, Velavadar Blackbuck Sanctuary, Kutch Desert Wildlife Sanctuary, Barda Wildlife Sanctuary, Purna Wildlife Sanctuary

Union Home Minister Launches Pilot Project of PM Family Care Tracker (PM-FCT)

- **Union Minister for Home Affairs and Cooperation Amit Shah** launched the pilot project of the **Prime Minister Family Care Tracker (PM-FCT)** in **Gandhinagar, Gujarat**.

- The **Prime Minister Family Care Tracker (PM-FCT)** is an integrated digital platform designed to ensure that **pregnant women, mothers, and children** receive all eligible **government welfare benefits** through continuous monitoring.
- The platform tracks beneficiaries from **pregnancy to 18 years of age**, covering **health, nutrition, education, and social welfare** services.
- Each beneficiary is assigned a **unique digital identity** linked to the **Birth Registration Number** or **Ayushman Bharat Health Account (ABHA) ID** for seamless tracking.
- The **PM-FCT** integrates data from multiple departments and covers nearly **18 government schemes**, including **Pradhan Mantri Matru Vandana Yojana (PMMVY)**, **Janani Suraksha Yojana (JSY)**, **Pradhan Mantri Poshan Shakti Nirman (PM POSHAN)**, **Mission Vatsalya**, **Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana (SSY)**, **PM CARES for Children**, and the **National Child Labour Project (NCLP)**.

About Prime Minister Family Care Tracker (PM-FCT)

- **Launched By: Government of Gujarat** (Pilot Project)
- **Launch Venue: Gandhinagar, Gujarat**
- **Objective:** To provide **integrated digital tracking** of maternal and child health, nutrition, education, and welfare benefits from **pregnancy to 18 years of age**.
- **Unique Identification: Birth Registration Number** or **Ayushman Bharat Health Account (ABHA) ID**.
- **Key Feature: Real-time beneficiary tracking** with **automated alerts** for missed services and welfare benefits.

Youth Co:Lab National Innovation Challenge 2026 Concludes; Six Youth-Led Startups Selected

- The **8th edition of the Youth Co:Lab National Innovation Challenge 2026** concluded with the selection of **six youth-led startups** for developing **scalable and high-impact solutions** to address sustainability challenges.
- The initiative is **co-led** by the **United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) India** and the **Citi Foundation**, in partnership with the **Atal Innovation Mission (AIM), National Institution for Transforming India (NITI) Aayog**, and implemented by the **T-Hub Foundation**.
- The challenge received **more than 350 applications** from youth-led startups across **28 States**.
- The selected startups pitched their ideas before a distinguished jury at the **National Innovation Dialogue** held on **4 June 2026**.

About United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)

- Headquarters: New York, United States
- Administrator: Alexander De Croo
- Established: 1965

Ministry of Civil Aviation Launches AIR SUVIDHA 2.0 to Strengthen Public Health Surveillance at Airports

- The **Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA)** and **Delhi International Airport Limited (DIAL)** launched **AIR SUVIDHA 2.0**, an upgraded **contactless Passenger Health Self-Declaration Portal**, to strengthen **public health surveillance** at points of entry.
- The portal has been launched in response to the ongoing **Ebola/Bundibugyo Virus Disease (BVD)** outbreak.
- The launch follows the **World Health Organization (WHO)** declaration of the Ebola/Bundibugyo Virus Disease outbreak in the **Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC)** and **Uganda** as a **Public Health Emergency of International Concern (PHEIC)** on **17 May 2026** under the **International Health Regulations (IHR), 2005**.
- According to the **WHO**, the current outbreak has been confirmed as **Bundibugyo Virus Disease (BVD)**.

About Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA)

- Union Minister: Kinjarapu Rammohan Naidu
- Constituency: Srikakulam (Andhra Pradesh)
- Minister of State: Murlidhar Mohol
- Constituency: Pune (Maharashtra)

Maharashtra Approves India's First Offshore Airport Project

- **Maharashtra** has approved the development of **India's first offshore airport**, marking a major milestone in the country's aviation infrastructure.
- The project received **in-principle approval** from **Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis** following a proposal by the **Maharashtra Airport Development Company (MADC)**.
- The proposed airport will be developed **off the coast of Palghar district** to enhance air connectivity in the **Mumbai Metropolitan Region (MMR)**.
- An **offshore airport** is built over the sea on an **artificial island** or **offshore platform**, helping overcome land constraints in densely populated coastal cities.
- The airport will be located about **4.75 kilometres from the proposed Uttan–Virar Sea Link**, with plans to provide direct connectivity in the future.

About Maharashtra:

- **Chief Minister:** Devendra Fadnavis
- **Governor:** Jishnu Dev Varma
- **Capital:** Mumbai
- **National Parks:** Tadoba National Park, Gugamal National Park, Chandoli National Park, Navegaon National Park, Sanjay Gandhi National Park
- **Wildlife Sanctuaries:** Bhimashankar Wildlife Sanctuary, Koyna Wildlife Sanctuary, Radhanagari Wildlife Sanctuary, Lonar Wildlife Sanctuary, Nagzira Wildlife Sanctuary, Phansad Wildlife Sanctuary, Tungareshwar Wildlife Sanctuary, Thane Creek Flamingo Wildlife Sanctuary

Union Health Minister Launches Samagra Shishu Bal Swasthya Karyakram (SSBSK)

- **Union Minister of Health and Family Welfare Jagat Prakash Nadda** launched the **Samagra Shishu Bal Swasthya Karyakram (SSBSK)** during the **16th Central Council of Health and Family Welfare (CCHFW) Meeting**.
- SSBSK is a **national child health initiative** that provides a **unified framework for home- and community-based care** for children from **birth to 36 months**.
- The programme integrates the **Home-Based Newborn Care (HBNC)** and **Home-Based Care for Young Child (HBYC)** programmes into a single framework.
- Guided by the vision **"पहले तीन साल सम्पूर्ण देखभाल" (Comprehensive Care During the First Three Years)**, it focuses on improving child survival, nutrition, growth, and early childhood development.
- SSBSK uses **Decision Support Systems (DSS)**, child-wise digital tracking, referral mechanisms, and automated alerts for continuous monitoring.
- It integrates with the **JANANI Portal**, **U-WIN Portal**, **Maternal and Perinatal Death Surveillance and Response (MPCDSR) Portal**, **Rashtriya Bal Swasthya Karyakram (RBSK) 2.0 Portal**, and **POSHAN Tracker** using **Ayushman Bharat Health Account (ABHA)** and **Baal-ABHA IDs**.

About Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW)

- **Union Minister: Jagat Prakash Nadda**
- **Ministers of State: Anupriya Patel** and **Prataprao Jadhav**

Union Health Minister Launches 'Ayushman Sarathi' WhatsApp Chatbot for PM-JAY

- **Union Minister for Health and Family Welfare Jagat Prakash Nadda** launched **Ayushman Sarathi**, the official **WhatsApp chatbot** for the **Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY)**.

- The chatbot has been developed by the **National Health Authority (NHA)** to provide **secure, real-time, and 24×7 access** to **PM-JAY** services through **WhatsApp**.
- **Ayushman Sarathi** enables beneficiaries to **check eligibility**, **apply for**, **download**, and **manage** their **Ayushman Card** using secure **Application Programming Interface (API)** integration.
- Beneficiaries can complete **electronic Know Your Customer (e-KYC)**, **link Aadhaar**, **lock or unlock their Ayushman Card**, and apply for the **Ayushman Vaya Vandana Card** for senior citizens aged **70 years and above**.

Government Establishes Bureau of Port Security (BoPS)

- The **Government of India** has established the **Bureau of Port Security (BoPS)** under the **Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways** to strengthen maritime security.
- **BoPS** will serve as the **apex regulatory authority** for the security of **ships, ports, and port infrastructure**, including protection against **cyber threats**.
- The Bureau has been constituted through an **Official Gazette notification** and is modelled on the **Bureau of Civil Aviation Security (BCAS)**.
- Initially, **BoPS** will function under the **Directorate General of Shipping**, which is being renamed as the **Directorate General of Maritime Administration (DGMA)**.
- During the transition period, **Shyam Jagannathan**, **Director General of Maritime Administration (DGMA)**, will serve as the **Director General of BoPS**.

Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act, 2025 Comes into Force from 1 July 2026

- The **Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB-G RAM G) Act, 2025** comes into force across India from **1 July 2026**.
- The Act strengthens the rural employment framework by increasing the **statutory wage employment guarantee from 100 days to 125 days** for every eligible rural household.
- Ahead of the nationwide rollout, **Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers Welfare and Rural Development Shivraj Singh Chouhan** stated that no eligible rural worker should remain without employment even for a single day.
- The Act aims to enhance **livelihood security**, create **durable community assets**, strengthen **village economies**, and promote **sustainable rural development** under the vision of **Viksit Bharat @2047**.

- The **Central Government** has made an **interim allocation of ₹95,692.31 crore** to **States and Union Territories** for implementation.
- The launch will be attended by **Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers Welfare and Rural Development Shivraj Singh Chouhan**, **Chief Minister of Andhra Pradesh N. Chandrababu Naidu**, **Deputy Chief Minister of Andhra Pradesh Pawan Kalyan**, Union Ministers of State, and other dignitaries.

India's Unemployment Rate Falls to Eight-Year Low of 3.1% in 2025: National Statistics Office

- **India's unemployment rate** declined to **3.1% in 2025**, the **lowest level in the last eight years**, according to the **National Statistics Office (NSO)**.
- The unemployment rate has steadily declined since **2017–18**, reflecting improvements in **employment generation**, **economic recovery**, and **labour market participation**.
- The decline supports India's commitment to achieving **full and productive employment by 2030** under the **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)**.
- **States with the highest urban female unemployment (2025):**
  - **Arunachal Pradesh: 18.4%**
  - **Himachal Pradesh: 18.3%**
  - **Bihar: 16.8%**
  - **Nagaland: 15.7%**
  - **Rajasthan: 14.6%**

Government Directs Meta to Pause WhatsApp Username Feature Rollout

- The **Government of India** has directed **Meta** to **temporarily pause the rollout of the WhatsApp Username feature** in India.
- The Centre has asked Meta to submit a **detailed explanation within three days** regarding the feature's functioning, privacy safeguards, security measures, and regulatory compliance.
- Until consultations are completed, **Meta has been instructed not to introduce the feature in India**.
- The proposed **WhatsApp Username feature** will allow users to connect **without sharing their mobile phone numbers**, using **unique usernames** instead.
- The feature aims to **enhance user privacy**, reduce the need to share personal phone numbers, and provide an alternative way to discover and contact users.

About Meta Platforms

- **Founded:** 2004

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- **Headquarters:** Menlo Park, California, United States
- **Chief Executive Officer (CEO):** Mark Zuckerberg

MECON Limited Granted Miniratna Category-I Status

- The **Ministry of Steel** has granted **Miniratna Category-I** status to **MECON Limited**, marking a significant milestone for one of India's leading engineering and consultancy **Central Public Sector Enterprises (CPSEs)**.
- The recognition highlights MECON's **consistent financial performance**, including **continuous profitability during the last three financial years** and a **net worth of ₹535.42 crore** as on **31 March 2026**.
- The **Ministry of Steel** approved the grant of **Miniratna Category-I** status on **1 July 2026**.
- **MECON Limited** is a **Schedule 'A' Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE)** under the administrative control of the **Ministry of Steel**.
- It was established in **1959** and is headquartered in **Ranchi, Jharkhand**.

About MECON Limited

- Established: 1959
- Headquarters: Ranchi, Jharkhand
- Administrative Ministry: Ministry of Steel

About Jharkhand:

- **Chief Minister:** Hemant Soren
- **Governor:** Santosh Kumar Gangwar
- **Capital:** Ranchi
- **National Parks:** Betla National Park, Hazaribagh National Park
- **Wildlife Sanctuaries:** Dalma Wildlife Sanctuary, Hazaribagh Wildlife Sanctuary, Koderma Wildlife Sanctuary, Palamau Wildlife Sanctuary, Palkot Wildlife Sanctuary, Topchanchi Wildlife Sanctuary

Akashvani Launches 'Swar Prerna Veethika' to Celebrate 90 Years of Public Service Broadcasting

- As **Akashvani** completes **90 years of public service broadcasting**, it has launched **Swar Prerna Veethika**, a **permanent photo gallery** dedicated to India's legendary musicians.
- The initiative was inaugurated by **Padma Vibhushan Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia** at the **Akashvani Rang Bhavan Auditorium, New Delhi**.

- The gallery celebrates **Akashvani's contribution to preserving and promoting Indian music** and forms part of its **year-long 90th anniversary celebrations**.
- The initiative also marks the beginning of preparations for the **centenary of radio broadcasting in India in 2027**.
- **Swar Prerna Veethika** is a specially curated photo gallery established to honour legendary musicians who have enriched India's musical heritage through their association with **Akashvani**.

National Awareness Programme Marks Conclusion of 'Nasha Mukt Bharat Saptah'

- **Union Minister for Social Justice and Empowerment Dr. Virendra Kumar** led the concluding **National Awareness Programme** of **'Nasha Mukt Bharat Saptah'**, held at **Dev Sanskriti Vishwavidyalaya (DSVV), Haridwar, Uttarakhand**.
- The programme was organised to commemorate the **International Day Against Drug Abuse and Illicit Trafficking**, observed annually on **26 June**.
- The week-long campaign was conducted under the theme **"Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan – Viksit Bharat Ki Pehchaan."**
- At the Haridwar event, **Dr. Virendra Kumar** led a **'Nasha Mukt Rally'** with the participation of nearly **4,000 citizens**.
- He also administered the **'Pledge Against Drug Abuse'** and the **'Ageing with Dignity Pledge'**.

Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment

- **Union Minister: Dr. Virendra Kumar** (**Lok Sabha Constituency – Tikamgarh, Madhya Pradesh**)
- **Ministers of State: Ramdas Athawale** and **B. L. Verma**

Government Notifies Employees' Provident Fund Scheme, 2026 with Revised Withdrawal Rules

- The **Central Government** has notified the **Employees' Provident Fund (EPF) Scheme, 2026**, introducing significant changes to the **partial withdrawal rules** for members of the **Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO)**.
- The revised scheme came into effect on **29 June 2026**.
- The scheme introduces a **minimum balance requirement**, expands the list of **eligible purposes for partial withdrawals**, and supports the Government's **digital transformation** initiatives.
- Under the new rules, EPFO members must retain at least **25% of the balance** in their **Employees' Provident Fund (EPF)** account before making any partial withdrawal.

- The minimum balance requirement applies to both **employee contributions** and **employer contributions**.

About Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO)

- Established: 1952
- Parent Ministry: Ministry of Labour and Employment
- Headquarters: New Delhi

Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Launched Nationwide

- **Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers Welfare and Rural Development Shivraj Singh Chouhan** launched the **Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) [VB-G RAM (G)]** from **Mukkavaripalli village, Tirupati district, Andhra Pradesh**.
- The launch event was attended by **Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu** and **Deputy Chief Minister Pawan Kalyan**.
- The mission is being implemented under the **Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act, 2025**, which came into force from **1 July 2026**.
- The Act increases the **statutory wage employment guarantee from 100 days to 125 days** per financial year for every eligible rural household.

Gujarat Police Launch 'Operation Surakshit Cyberspace' to Enhance Cyber Safety for Women and Children

- **Gujarat Police** launched **'Operation Surakshit Cyberspace'**, a **28-day statewide campaign**, from **1 July to 28 July 2026** to strengthen cyber safety for **women and children**.
- The campaign combines **technology-driven policing**, **cyber awareness programmes**, **victim outreach**, and **coordinated enforcement** to prevent cybercrimes.
- The initiative is being implemented under the guidance of **Director General of Police G.S. Malik** and coordinated by the **Criminal Investigation Department (CID) Crime–Women Cell**.
- The campaign aims to prevent cybercrimes such as **cyberstalking**, **online harassment**, **online exploitation**, **identity theft**, **financial fraud**, and **digital privacy violations**.

International Booker Prize to be Renamed as Bukhman International Booker Prize from 2027

- The **International Booker Prize** will be officially renamed the **Bukhman International Booker Prize** from **2027** following a **10-year funding agreement (2027–2036)** with **Bukhman Philanthropies**.

- The annual **prize money will increase from £50,000 to £100,000**, making it one of the world's richest international literary awards.
- The prize money will continue to be **shared equally between the author and the translator**, recognising the important contribution of translators.
- Each shortlisted book will continue to receive **£5,000**, shared equally between the author and translator(s).

Government Launches Electronic Overseas Citizen of India (e-OCI) Card for Digital Travel Convenience

- The **Government of India** has launched the **Electronic Overseas Citizen of India (e-OCI) Card**, enabling eligible **Overseas Citizen of India (OCI)** cardholders to carry a **secure digital version** of their **Overseas Citizen of India (OCI)** card on their smartphones.
- The **Electronic Overseas Citizen of India (e-OCI) Card** can be generated and downloaded through the **Official Overseas Citizen of India Services Portal** by existing **Overseas Citizen of India (OCI)** cardholders.
- The digital card can be presented to **immigration authorities, airline staff, and other authorised officials** as proof of **Overseas Citizen of India (OCI)** status during travel.
- The initiative eliminates the need to carry the **physical Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) booklet** on every journey, offering greater convenience for frequent travellers.

Uttar Pradesh Rashtriya Parivarik Labh Yojana Provides ₹30,000 Financial Assistance to Bereaved Families

- The **Uttar Pradesh Rashtriya Parivarik Labh Yojana**, implemented under the **National Family Benefit Scheme (NFBS)**, provides **one-time financial assistance of ₹30,000** to **Below Poverty Line (BPL)** families following the death of their primary earning member.
- The scheme aims to provide immediate financial support to economically weaker families facing hardship due to the loss of their sole breadwinner.
- The financial assistance is transferred **directly to the Aadhaar-linked bank account** of the eligible beneficiary through the **Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT)** mechanism.
- Applications under the scheme are accepted **only through the online portal**, enabling eligible families across Uttar Pradesh to apply digitally.

West Bengal Receives Geographical Indication (GI) Tags for Three Traditional Products

- **West Bengal** has received **Geographical Indication (GI)** registration for **three traditional products** from **Hooghly district—Chandannagar's Jalbhara Sandesh**, **Janai's Manohara**, and **Balagarh's Traditional Wooden Boats (Dingi Boats)**.
- The **Geographical Indication (GI)** tags were granted by the **Government of India**, providing legal protection and promoting the unique identity of these products in domestic and international markets.
- **Jalbhara Sandesh**, one of Bengal's iconic sweets, was created in the **19th century** by renowned confectioner **Surya Modak** and is popularly known as **"Jamai Thokano Mishti"**.
- The sweet is distinguished by its **liquid rose-flavoured syrup filling**, enclosed within a sandesh resembling an **ice apple kernel**, giving it the name **"Jalbhara"**, meaning **"filled with liquid."**

About West Bengal:

- **Chief Minister:** Suvendu Adhikari
- **Governor:** R. N. Ravi
- **Capital:** Kolkata
- **National Parks:** Sundarbans National Park, Jaldapara National Park, Gorumara National Park, Singalila National Park, Neora Valley National Park, Buxa National Park
- **Wildlife Sanctuaries:** Senchal Wildlife Sanctuary, Buxa Wildlife Sanctuary, Raiganj Wildlife Sanctuary, Ballavpur Wildlife Sanctuary, Chintamani Kar Bird Sanctuary, Lothian Island Wildlife Sanctuary, West Sundarban Wildlife Sanctuary

Himachal Pradesh Receives Geographical Indication (GI) Tags for Eight Traditional Products

- **Himachal Pradesh** has received **Geographical Indication (GI)** registration for **eight traditional products**, taking the total number of **GI-tagged products in the state to 17**.
- The newly registered **Geographical Indication (GI)** products are:
    - **Spiti Seabuckthorn (Chharma)**
    - **Salooni Safed Makka (White Maize)**
    - **Chamba Metal Art**
    - **Sirmauri Loiya** (traditional woollen garment)
    - **Kinnauri Topi**
    - **Sepuvadi of Mandi**
    - **Kinnauri Apple**
    - **Kinnauri Jewellery**

- The **Geographical Indication (GI)** tags recognise the unique agricultural, cultural, and artisanal heritage of Himachal Pradesh and provide legal protection against unauthorised imitation.

About Himachal Pradesh:

- **Chief Minister:** Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu
- **Governor:** Kavinder Gupta
- **Capital:** Shimla
- **National Parks:** Great Himalayan National Park, Pin Valley National Park, Inderkilla National Park, Khirganga National Park, Simbalbara National Park
- **Wildlife Sanctuaries:** Pong Dam Lake Wildlife Sanctuary, Renuka Wildlife Sanctuary, Kalatop-Khajjiar Wildlife Sanctuary, Kibber Wildlife Sanctuary, Kais Wildlife Sanctuary, Daranghati Wildlife Sanctuary, Kugti Wildlife Sanctuary

India and Mali Launch India-Mali Forum for the Promotion of Exports

- **India** and **Mali** jointly launched the **India-Mali Forum for the Promotion of Exports** in **Bamako**, marking the **first institutionalised bilateral platform** to strengthen trade and commercial cooperation between the two countries.
- The **two-day forum** was organised under the theme **"Reinforcing Trade and Strategic Partnerships"** to promote collaboration in **trade, investment, manufacturing, infrastructure, and strategic sectors**.
- The forum was jointly organised by the **Ministry of Industry and Trade of Mali**, the **Embassy of India in Bamako**, and the **Malian Agency for the Promotion of Exports (APEX-Mali)**.
- The Indian delegation was led by **Amit Kumar, Joint Secretary (Foreign Trade–Africa), Department of Commerce**, and **Dr. N. Nandakumar, Ambassador of India to Mali**.

About Mali

- Capital: Bamako
- Currency: West African CFA Franc (XOF)
- President (Transition): Assimi Goïta
- Prime Minister: Abdoulaye Maïga

National Commission for Women (NCW) Launches 24×7 Women Helpline 14490

- The **National Commission for Women (NCW)** has launched a **24×7 toll-free Women Helpline (14490)** to provide **immediate assistance, complaint registration, psychological counselling, and grievance redressal** for women in distress.

- The helpline has been introduced as part of the **Digital India** initiative to improve access to institutional support through a technology-enabled platform.
- **Women and girls aged 18 years and above** can use the helpline to report cases related to **domestic violence, harassment, workplace exploitation, dowry-related issues, abuse, and other forms of gender-based violence**.
- The new helpline **14490** is integrated with the **existing National Commission for Women (NCW) helpline number 7827170170**, providing a simple and easily accessible contact point.

About National Commission for Women (NCW)

- Established: 1992
- Headquarters: New Delhi
- Founded under: National Commission for Women Act, 1990
- Chairperson: Vijaya Rahatkar

Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI) Launches Free Email ID Update Facility Through Aadhaar App

- The **Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI)** has launched a new digital facility enabling **Aadhaar holders to add or update their email ID through the official Aadhaar App**, eliminating the need to visit an Aadhaar Seva Kendra or enrolment centre.
- The facility became available from **1 July 2026** and will be **free of cost for six months**.
- The initiative aims to promote **self-service Aadhaar updates** and encourage residents to keep their Aadhaar details up to date.

About Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI)

- Established: 2009
- Headquarters: New Delhi
- Parent Ministry: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)
- Chief Executive Officer (CEO): Saurabh Vijay

Prime Minister Narendra Modi Inaugurates CG Semi Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT) Facility in Gujarat

- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** inaugurated the **CG Semi Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT) Facility** at **Sanand, Gujarat**, marking a major milestone in India's semiconductor manufacturing journey.
- The facility has been developed under the **Semicon India Programme** to strengthen India's semiconductor ecosystem by expanding **chip assembly, packaging, and testing** capabilities.

- The project supports India's vision of building a **complete semiconductor value chain**, covering **chip design, fabrication, assembly, packaging, and testing**, while promoting technological self-reliance.

Delhi Government Launches Mission Kayakalp to Modernise Government Schools

- The **Delhi Government** has launched **Mission Kayakalp**, a comprehensive initiative to modernise the infrastructure of **government schools** and provide students with a **safe, clean, inclusive, and technology-enabled learning environment**.
- The mission aims to upgrade school infrastructure through **repair of school buildings, modernisation of laboratories, improvement of sanitation facilities, provision of safe drinking water, and enhancement of campus amenities**.
- According to **Chief Minister Rekha Gupta**, the objective is to transform government schools into **modern, clean, and inspiring centres of learning**.
- **Mission Kayakalp** focuses on improving the **quality of educational infrastructure**, ensuring **safe and hygienic learning conditions**, strengthening **water and sanitation facilities**, upgrading **science laboratories and other educational facilities**, and enhancing **accessibility for children with disabilities**.

About Delhi (National Capital Territory):

- **Chief Minister:** Rekha Gupta
- **Lieutenant Governor:** Taranjit Singh Sandhu
- **Capital:** New Delhi
- **National Parks:** None
- **Wildlife Sanctuaries:** Asola Bhatti (Indira Priyadarshini) Wildlife Sanctuary

India to Chair Ninth Session of United Nations Trade and Development (UNCTAD) Intergovernmental Group of Experts on Consumer Protection

- **India** will chair the **Ninth Session of the Intergovernmental Group of Experts (IGE) on Consumer Protection Law and Policy**, organised by the **United Nations Trade and Development (UNCTAD)**.
- The **three-day meeting** will be held at the **Palais des Nations, Geneva, Switzerland**.
- The session will bring together **policymakers, regulators, consumer protection authorities, and international organisations** to discuss emerging consumer protection challenges and strengthen international cooperation.

- The **Intergovernmental Group of Experts (IGE) on Consumer Protection Law and Policy** functions under the **United Nations Guidelines for Consumer Protection (UNGCP)** and serves as the principal global platform for cooperation on consumer protection policies.

About United Nations Trade and Development (UNCTAD)

- **Established: 1964**
- **Headquarters: Geneva, Switzerland**
- **Secretary-General: Rebeca Grynspan**
- **Objective:** To promote inclusive and sustainable trade, investment, finance, and development**,** particularly for developing countries.

India Commemorates 125th Birth Anniversary of Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee

- **India** commemorated the **125th birth anniversary of Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee** on **6 July 2026**, honouring his contributions as a **statesman, educationist, lawyer, parliamentarian, and nationalist leader**.
- **Dr. Syama Prasad Mookerjee** was born on **6 July 1901** in **Calcutta (now Kolkata), West Bengal**.
- He served as **India's first Minister for Industry and Supply** in the **first Union Cabinet** headed by **Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru** after Independence and played a key role in laying the foundation for India's industrial development.
- In **1934**, at the age of **33**, he became the **youngest Vice-Chancellor of the University of Calcutta**, where he introduced academic reforms, promoted research, encouraged the use of Indian languages, and strengthened higher education.

Delhi Government Approves ₹8,300 Crore 'Clean Air, Healthy Delhi' Project

- The **Delhi Government** approved the **₹8,300 crore 'Clean Air, Healthy Delhi' Project** to combat **air pollution** and improve environmental quality in the national capital.
- The **seven-year project** will be implemented from **September 2026 to August 2033** and aims to accelerate Delhi's air pollution mitigation plan in line with the **National Clean Air Programme (NCAP)**.
- The project will be supported by the **World Bank** and other **multilateral institutions**, with **65% of the funding** provided by the **World Bank** and the remaining **35%** contributed by the **Delhi Government**.

- **Chief Minister Rekha Gupta** announced that the project will be implemented across **all districts of Delhi**, with a stakeholder workshop scheduled for **10 July 2026** to finalise the implementation roadmap.
- The initiative will focus on major pollution sources, including **transport, road dust, construction and demolition (C&D) waste, solid waste management, industries, green spaces, and water pollution**.

About National Clean Air Programme (NCAP)

- **Launched: 2019**
- **Ministry: Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)**
- **Objective:** To reduce **air pollution** by implementing city-specific action plans and strengthening **air quality monitoring and management** across India.

Uttar Pradesh Cabinet Approves Renaming of Jalalabad as Parashurampuri

- The **Uttar Pradesh Cabinet**, chaired by **Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath**, approved the proposal to rename **Jalalabad** town in **Shahjahanpur district** as **Parashurampuri**.
- The decision was taken after the **Central Government** conveyed **no objection** to the proposal, paving the way for the state government's approval.
- Following the Cabinet's decision, the concerned departments will complete the required **administrative and legal formalities** to officially implement the new name.
- According to the state government, the renaming was based on the demand of local residents to reflect the town's **historical, cultural, and religious significance**.

West Bengal Approves Implementation of Pradhan Mantri Cha Shramik Protsahan Yojana with ₹313.3 Crore Package

- The **West Bengal Government** approved the implementation strategy of the **Pradhan Mantri Cha Shramik Protsahan Yojana (PMCSPY)** to improve the socio-economic conditions of **tea garden workers** in **North Bengal**.
- The **state-level committee** approved a **special assistance package of ₹313.3 crore**, which is expected to benefit **over 3 lakh tea plantation workers and their families**.
- The scheme aims to enhance **education, healthcare, worker welfare infrastructure, and essential public services** for tea garden workers.
- The **₹313.3 crore** package has been allocated under three major components:

- ₹177 crore for **Cha Shramik Shiksha Yojana (CSSY)** to upgrade educational infrastructure and improve access to quality education.
- ₹72 crore for **Cha Shramik Swasthya Suraksha Yojana (CSSSY)** to strengthen healthcare facilities and medical infrastructure.
- ₹63 crore for **Cha Shramik Ashray Yojana (CSAY)** to construct **321 rest sheds**, including **88 in hilly areas** and **233 in the North Bengal plains**.

About Pradhan Mantri Cha Shramik Protsahan Yojana (PMCSPY)

- **Launched By: Government of India**
- **Objective:** To improve the **social and economic well-being** of tea garden workers through better **education, healthcare, welfare infrastructure, and essential public services**.
- **Target Beneficiaries: Tea plantation workers and their families**.
- **Focus Area: Tea-growing regions**, particularly **North Bengal** in West Bengal.

Sirsa Kinnow Becomes Haryana's First Fruit to Receive Geographical Indication (GI) Tag

- **Sirsa Kinnow** became the **first fruit from Haryana** to receive the **Geographical Indication (GI) tag**, recognising its unique quality and geographical origin.
- The **Geographical Indications Registry, Chennai** granted the **GI registration** to the **Kharisuverian Farmer Producer Company, Sirsa**.
- The **GI application** was filed on **16 June 2023**, and the **registration certificate** was issued on **28 March 2026**.
- The **GI tag** recognises the **distinctive taste, quality, and characteristics** of **Sirsa Kinnow**, which are attributed to the region's favourable climatic and geographical conditions.
- **Sirsa Kinnow** is known for its **sweet taste, high juice content, large fruit size, and attractive colour**, making it one of the premium kinnow varieties in India.

Uttar Pradesh Cabinet Approves Uttar Pradesh Data Centre Policy 2026

- The **Uttar Pradesh Cabinet**, chaired by **Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath**, approved the **Uttar Pradesh Data Centre Policy 2026** to establish the state as a leading hub for **green and Artificial Intelligence (AI)-enabled data centres**.
- The policy aims to attract **investments of over ₹2 lakh crore** and expand the state's **data centre capacity to 2 GW**.
- It replaces the **Uttar Pradesh Data Centre Policy 2021**, which expired in **January 2026**, with a renewed framework for advanced data centre infrastructure.

- The policy promotes the development of **AI-ready, energy-efficient, and environmentally sustainable data centres**.
- It provides **special incentives for GPU-based technologies** to support **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** and high-performance computing.

Gujarat to Construct Its First Two Air-Filled Rubber Dams Using South Korean Technology

- **Gujarat** is developing its **first two air-filled rubber dams** using **advanced technology from South Korea** to strengthen **water resource management** and modernise irrigation infrastructure.
- The two dams are being constructed on the **Heran River** at **Rajvasana** in **Chhota Udepur district** and on the **Ambika River** at **Pathakwadi** in **Tapi district**.
- The projects aim to **improve irrigation facilities, enhance groundwater recharge, increase water storage capacity, and mitigate floods**, benefiting thousands of farmers across the state.
- The **Rajvasana Rubber Dam** is being constructed at a cost of **₹82.97 crore**, is **75% complete** (as of **6 July 2026**), is expected to be commissioned by **September 2027**, and will provide irrigation to over **3,420 hectares** of agricultural land.
- The **Pathakwadi Rubber Dam** is being developed at a cost of **₹79.13 crore**, is **nearly 90% complete**, and will provide assured irrigation to around **650 hectares** of agricultural land.
- The two projects involve a **combined investment of over ₹162 crore** and mark Gujarat's first use of **air-filled rubber dam technology**.

Ministry of Cooperation Celebrates Fifth Foundation Day; Announces Cooperative Life Insurance Company and Expansion of Bharat Taxi

- The **Ministry of Cooperation** celebrated its **Fifth Foundation Day** with major announcements to strengthen the **cooperative movement** in India.
- **Union Minister for Cooperation Amit Shah** announced the establishment of a **Cooperative Life Insurance Company** to enhance the cooperative sector's presence in the **life insurance industry**.
- The proposed **Cooperative Life Insurance Company** aims to **strengthen the cooperative movement**, promote **financial inclusion**, and provide wider access to **life insurance products**.

- **Amit Shah** stated that **Indian Farmers Fertiliser Cooperative Limited (IFFCO)-TOKIO General Insurance Company Limited** is already operating in the insurance sector and that India currently has **26 life insurance companies**.

About Ministry of Cooperation:

- **Cabinet Minister:** Amit Shah
- **Constituency:** Gandhinagar, Gujarat
- **Ministers of State (MoS):** Krishan Pal, Murlidhar Mohol

Government Raises Onion Procurement Price for Price Stabilisation Buffer by 13%

- The **Government of India** increased the **procurement price of onions** for the **Price Stabilisation Buffer (PSB)** by **13%**, from **₹1,875 per quintal** to **₹2,125 per quintal**, with effect from **4 July 2026**.
- The decision was announced by the **Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution** to ensure **better remuneration for onion farmers** while strengthening the government's buffer stock.
- Procurement of onions for the **Price Stabilisation Buffer (PSB)** is being carried out through the **National Agricultural Cooperative Marketing Federation of India (NAFED)** and the **National Cooperative Consumers' Federation of India Limited (NCCF)**.
- The revised procurement price marks the **fifth upward revision** during the current procurement season, with prices increasing from **₹12.70 per kilogram** at the beginning of the season to **₹21.25 per kilogram**.

About National Agricultural Cooperative Marketing Federation of India (NAFED)

- Established: 1958
- Headquarters: New Delhi
- Administrative Ministry: Ministry of Cooperation
- Objective: To promote cooperative marketing of agricultural produce and support procurement, storage, and price stabilisation of agricultural commodities.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi Inaugurates and Launches Major Development Projects in Rajasthan and Gujarat

- **Prime Minister (PM) Narendra Modi** visited **Rajasthan** and **Gujarat**, where he **inaugurated**, **dedicated**, and **laid the foundation stones** for several major infrastructure and connectivity projects.

- In **Jodhpur, Rajasthan**, the Prime Minister inaugurated the newly developed **₹480 crore terminal building at Jodhpur Airport**, designed to handle **up to 2 million passengers annually**.
- He also launched the **Modified Ude Desh ka Aam Nagrik (UDAN) Scheme** to strengthen **regional air connectivity**, particularly in **remote and underserved areas**.

About Modified Ude Desh ka Aam Nagrik (UDAN) Scheme

- Launched By: Ministry of Civil Aviation
- Launched In: 2016 under the National Civil Aviation Policy (NCAP), 2016
- Objective: To make air travel affordable and enhance regional air connectivity by connecting unserved and underserved airports across India.
- Implementing Agency: Airports Authority of India (AAI)

About Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited (HPCL)

- Established: 1974
- Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra
- Chairman and Managing Director (CMD): Shri Vikas Kaushal

29th National Conference on e-Governance (NCeG) 2026 Held in Jaipur

- The **Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG)**, under the **Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions**, in collaboration with the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)** and the **Government of Rajasthan**, organised the **29th National Conference on e-Governance (NCeG) 2026** at the **Rajasthan International Centre, Jaipur, Rajasthan**.
- The conference was inaugurated by **Rajasthan Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma**.
- The theme of the conference was **"Viksit Bharat 2047: AI-enabled, Data-driven & Secure Digital Governance."**

About Rajasthan:

- **Chief Minister:** Bhajan Lal Sharma
- **Governor:** Haribhau Bagade
- **Capital:** Jaipur
- **National Parks:** Ranthambore National Park, Sariska National Park, Keoladeo Ghana National Park, Desert National Park, Mukundra Hills National Park
- **Wildlife Sanctuaries:** Mount Abu Wildlife Sanctuary, Kailadevi Wildlife Sanctuary, Kesarbagh Wildlife Sanctuary, Todgarh-Raoli Wildlife Sanctuary, Jawahar Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary,

Sitamata Wildlife Sanctuary, Ramgarh Vishdhari Wildlife Sanctuary, Bhensrodgarh Wildlife Sanctuary, Phulwari Wildlife Sanctuary

Natural History Museum of Mizoram University Notified as India's 21st Designated Repository

- The **Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)** has notified the **Natural History Museum (NHM), Mizoram University, Aizawl**, as **India's 21st Designated Repository** under **Section 39 of the Biological Diversity Act, 2002**.
- The notification was issued on **19 June 2026** following the recommendation of the **National Biodiversity Authority (NBA)**.
- The designation strengthens **India's scientific infrastructure** for preserving **authenticated biological specimens** and supports **long-term biodiversity conservation**.
- A **Designated Repository** is an institution officially recognised to preserve biological specimens collected under the **Biological Diversity Act, 2002**, maintain reference collections for scientific research, support species identification and classification, and conserve India's biological resources.

About Mizoram:

- **Chief Minister:** Lalduhoma
- **Governor:** Vijay Kumar Singh
- **Capital:** Aizawl
- **National Parks:** Murlen National Park, Phawngpui (Blue Mountain) National Park
- **Wildlife Sanctuaries:** Dampa Wildlife Sanctuary, Khawnglung Wildlife Sanctuary, Lengteng Wildlife Sanctuary, Tawi Wildlife Sanctuary, Thorangtlang Wildlife Sanctuary, Tokalo Wildlife Sanctuary

Ministry of Tribal Affairs Launches TribeX, India's First Digital Learning Platform for Tribal Heritage

- The **Ministry of Tribal Affairs** launched **TribeX**, **India's first dedicated digital learning platform** for **tribal arts, culture, languages, and traditional knowledge**.
- The platform was launched by **Union Minister for Tribal Affairs Jual Oram** during the **National Workshop on Strengthening Tribal Research Institutes (TRIs)** held in **Bhubaneswar, Odisha**.
- **TribeX** is a comprehensive digital platform that integrates **education, digital documentation, research, knowledge preservation, and skill development** related to India's tribal heritage.

- The platform provides learners with authentic access to tribal knowledge through **tribal artisans, scholars, and cultural experts**, helping preserve indigenous traditions in digital form.

About Ministry of Tribal Affairs:

- Cabinet Minister: Jual Oram
- Constituency: Sundargarh, Odisha
- Ministers of State (MoS): Durgadas Uikey

Prime Minister Narendra Modi Visits Prambanan Temple Complex in Indonesia; ASI to Undertake Restoration Project

- **Prime Minister (PM) Narendra Modi** visited the **Prambanan Temple Complex** in **Yogyakarta, Indonesia**, reaffirming the centuries-old cultural and civilisational ties between **India and Indonesia**.
- **Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto** accompanied the Prime Minister during the visit, and both leaders unveiled a **commemorative plaque** marking the commencement of the **Archaeological Survey of India (ASI)**-led conservation and restoration project.
- The restoration project follows the understanding reached during **President Prabowo Subianto's State Visit to India in 2025**, when both countries agreed to explore India's assistance in preserving Indonesia's historic temples.

About Indonesia

- **Capital:** Jakarta
- **President of Indonesia:** Prabowo Subianto
- **Currency:** Indonesian Rupiah

Union Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan Launches PRAGATI Initiative to Promote Regenerative Agriculture

- **Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers Welfare and Rural Development, Shivraj Singh Chouhan**, launched the **PRAGATI (Promoting Regenerative Agriculture, Growth, Agri-Entrepreneurship and Transformative Innovation)** initiative.
- The initiative aims to **empower 20,000 rural agri-entrepreneurs** and improve the livelihoods of **20 lakh small and marginal farmers** through sustainable agriculture, rural entrepreneurship and technology-driven farming.

- PRAGATI seeks to transform Indian agriculture by promoting regenerative farming, climate-resilient agriculture, digital innovation, value addition and agri-entrepreneurship, making farming more profitable while reducing cultivation costs.

About Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare:

- **Cabinet Minister:** Shivraj Singh Chouhan
- **Constituency:** Vidisha, Madhya Pradesh
- **Ministers of State (MoS):** Ram Nath Thakur, Bhagirath Choudhary

Uttar Pradesh Launches 'Guru Dakshina' Cashless Medical Scheme for Teachers

- The **Government of Uttar Pradesh** launched the **Chief Minister Teacher Cashless Medical Scheme**, popularly called **"Guru Dakshina"**, to provide **cashless medical treatment** to teachers, **Shiksha Mitras**, instructors and their eligible family members.
- The scheme was announced by **Chief Minister (CM) Yogi Adityanath**, who described it as the government's **"Guru Dakshina"** to the teaching community in recognition of their contribution to nation-building.
- The **Uttar Pradesh Government** will bear the **entire annual insurance premium of around ₹447 crore** (about **₹3,000 per teacher annually**), ensuring beneficiaries receive treatment without paying any premium.

Government Notifies Navi Mumbai International Airport as Designated Port for Drug Imports

- The **Government of India** has notified **Navi Mumbai International Airport** as a **designated port for the import of drugs** under **Rule 43A of the Drugs Rules, 1945**.
- The notification was issued by the **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare** on **8 July 2026** after consultation with the **Drugs Technical Advisory Board (DTAB)** under the provisions of the **Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940**.
- With this amendment, **Navi Mumbai International Airport** has been added to the list of authorised ports through which **pharmaceuticals and medicines** can be legally imported into India.

Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) Introduces EPFO 3.0 Reforms with New Employees' Provident Fund (EPF) Withdrawal Rules 2026

- The **Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO)** introduced major reforms under its **EPFO 3.0** digital initiative to make **Employees' Provident Fund (EPF)** withdrawals faster, simpler, and fully digital.
- The reforms include **3-day online claim settlement, an increased auto-settlement limit of ₹5 lakh, simplified withdrawal categories, a 12-month uniform eligibility period for most partial withdrawals, and a mandatory 25% minimum balance retention rule**.
- Eligible **Aadhaar-linked** and **Know Your Customer (KYC)-verified** online advance claims will now be settled within **3 working days**, compared to the earlier **7–20 days**.
- The **auto-settlement limit** for eligible advance claims has been increased from **₹1 lakh to ₹5 lakh**, reducing manual intervention and speeding up claim processing.

Union Ministry of Education Releases All India Survey on Higher Education (AISHE) Reports 2022–23 and 2023–24

- The **Union Ministry of Education** released the **All-India Survey on Higher Education (AISHE) Reports** for **2022–23** and **2023–24**, highlighting record growth in **higher education enrolment**, **Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER)**, **women's participation**, **Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics (STEM)** education, and enrolment of **Scheduled Castes (SCs)**, **Scheduled Tribes (STs)**, and **Other Backward Classes (OBCs)**.
- The **All-India Survey on Higher Education (AISHE)** is the **Government of India's annual web-based survey** that collects data from universities, colleges, and standalone higher education institutions on student enrolment, faculty, infrastructure, academic programmes, examination results, and institutional facilities.
- **Total enrolment** in higher education reached an **all-time high of 4.5 crore students** in **2023–24**, registering a **31.5% increase** from **3.42 crore** in **2014–15**.

India Launches Letter of Authorisation (LoA) Regime for Sustainable High-Seas Fishing to Boost Blue Economy

- **Vice President Jagdeep Dhankhar** launched the new **Letter of Authorisation (LoA) regime** to promote **sustainable high-seas fishing**, enhance the income of fishing communities, and strengthen **India's Blue Economy**.

- The **Letter of Authorisation (LoA)** is a regulatory mechanism that authorises **Indian fishing vessels** to undertake fishing operations in the **Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ)** and the **high seas** through a simplified and transparent approval process.
- The initiative aims to promote **sustainable deep-sea fishing**, increase access to **high-value marine species**, reduce pressure on **overexploited coastal fisheries**, and improve the utilisation of marine resources.

About Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying:

- **Cabinet Minister:** Rajiv Ranjan Singh (Lalan Singh)
- **Constituency:** Munger, Bihar
- **Ministers of State (MoS):** Prof. S. P. Singh Baghel, George Kurian

Jharkhand Unveils Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy 2026–31 Roadmap to Boost Digital Economy

- The **Government of Jharkhand** unveiled the **Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy 2026–31 Roadmap** to position the state as a leading **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-driven governance** and **technology hub**.
- The roadmap was presented during the **National Stakeholder Consultation 2026** in **New Delhi**.
- The roadmap aims to attract **more than ₹10,000 crore** in **private investment**, establish **50+ Global Capability Centres (GCCs)**, support **1,000 Artificial Intelligence (AI) startups**, and create **over one lakh Artificial Intelligence (AI)-enabled jobs** during **2026–31**.
- The **Government of Jharkhand** plans to invest **₹1,150 crore** over five years to develop **Artificial Intelligence (AI) infrastructure**, strengthen **digital governance**, promote **innovation**, and build a robust technology ecosystem.

Uttar Pradesh to Implement Nishulk Boring Yojana 2026 for Free Borewell Installation

- The **Government of Uttar Pradesh** is set to implement the **Uttar Pradesh Nishulk Boring Yojana 2026** to provide **free borewell (boring) installation** and **subsidised pump sets** for eligible farmers to improve irrigation facilities and agricultural productivity.
- The scheme primarily targets **small and marginal farmers**, enabling them to access **groundwater for irrigation**, reduce dependence on **monsoon rainfall**, and increase crop yields.
- Originally launched in **1985**, the **Uttar Pradesh Nishulk Boring Yojana** continues to strengthen irrigation infrastructure and support sustainable agricultural development across the state.
- Under the scheme, eligible farmers will receive **free agricultural borewell installation** along with **pump sets of up to 5 Horsepower (HP)** at subsidised rates or free, depending on eligibility.

Delhi Makes Pink Saheli Smart Card Mandatory for Free Bus Travel from 1 August 2026

- The **Government of Delhi** has made the **Pink Saheli Smart Card** mandatory for women to avail **free travel** on **Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC)** and **Delhi Integrated Multi-Modal Transit System (DIMTS) Cluster** buses from **1 August 2026**.
- The **Pink Saheli Smart Card** will replace the existing **paper-based pink ticket** system as part of the government's initiative to **digitise public transport services**, improve transparency, and prevent misuse of the free travel scheme.
- From **1 August 2026**, **paper pink tickets will no longer be valid**. Eligible women passengers must carry the **Pink Saheli Smart Card** and **tap it on the card reader** while boarding the bus to avail free travel.
- To facilitate implementation, the **Government of Delhi** has established **50 authorised registration centres** across the city, where eligible women can apply for the **Pink Saheli Smart Card**.

Uttar Pradesh Implements Mahila Udyam Nidhi Yojana 2026 to Promote Women Entrepreneurship

- The **Government of Uttar Pradesh** is implementing the **Uttar Pradesh Mahila Udyam Nidhi Yojana 2026** to provide **affordable credit** to women entrepreneurs for establishing or expanding **micro and small enterprises**, with the objective of promoting **self-employment** and **financial independence**.
- The scheme, implemented through **Uttar Pradesh Mahila Nidhi**, was originally launched in **2016** to improve women's access to **institutional finance** and encourage entrepreneurship across the state.
- Under the scheme, eligible women can avail loans ranging from **₹50,000 to ₹10 lakh** at a concessional interest rate of around **4%**. **Collateral is not required** for loans up to **₹2 lakh**, making credit more accessible to first-time entrepreneurs.
- The scheme aims to promote **women entrepreneurship**, strengthen **financial inclusion**, support **micro-enterprises**, generate **self-employment opportunities**, and improve the socio-economic status of women in **Uttar Pradesh**.

About Uttar Pradesh:

- **Chief Minister:** Yogi Adityanath
- **Governor:** Anandiben Patel
- **Capital:** Lucknow
- **National Parks:** Dudhwa National Park

- **Wildlife Sanctuaries:** Katarniaghat Wildlife Sanctuary, Kishanpur Wildlife Sanctuary, Hastinapur Wildlife Sanctuary, Chandraprabha Wildlife Sanctuary, Kaimur Wildlife Sanctuary, Bakhira Wildlife Sanctuary, Nawabganj Bird Sanctuary, Okhla Bird Sanctuary

Gujarat Launches 'Viksit Gujarat – Data Centre Policy 2026–29' to Promote Digital Infrastructure

- The **Government of Gujarat** launched the **'Viksit Gujarat – Data Centre Policy 2026–29'** to position the state as a leading hub for **hyperscale data centres**, **Artificial Intelligence (AI) infrastructure**, **cloud computing**, and **digital services**.
- **Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel** unveiled the policy in **Gandhinagar, Gujarat**, with the objective of attracting **domestic and global investments** in digital infrastructure and strengthening the state's technology ecosystem.
- The policy recognises **data centres** as **strategic infrastructure** and aims to support the growing demand for **digital payments, cloud services, Artificial Intelligence (AI), e-governance, and modern digital businesses**.
- The policy provides several **fiscal incentives**, including **capital subsidies**, **interest subsidies**, **power tariff support**, **State Goods and Services Tax (SGST) reimbursement**, **electricity duty reimbursement**, **stamp duty exemptions**, and assistance for **desalination plants**.

Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) to Establish Centre for High Altitude Medicine and Public Health Research in Keylong, Himachal Pradesh

- **Union Health Minister Jagat Prakash Nadda** will lay the foundation stone of the **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) Centre for High Altitude Medicine and Public Health Research** at **Keylong, Himachal Pradesh**.
- The centre aims to strengthen **climate-resilient healthcare and biomedical research** across India's **Himalayan region** by developing scientific solutions for high-altitude and climate-sensitive areas.
- The existing **ICMR field station at Keylong** will be upgraded into a **full-fledged multidisciplinary research hub** for research, innovation, and capacity building in high-altitude healthcare.

About Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)

- **Established: 1911** (as Indian Research Fund Association); renamed as **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) in 1949**
- **Ministry: Ministry of Health and Family Welfare**
- **Headquarters: New Delhi**

- **Objective:** Promote and coordinate biomedical research to address public health challenges in India.

Ahmedabad Creates Guinness World Record by Planting 3.61 Lakh Saplings in One Hour Using Miyawaki Technique

- **Ahmedabad Municipal Corporation (AMC)** created a new **Guinness World Record** by planting **3,61,000 saplings in a single hour** through the **largest Miyawaki plantation drive in one hour**.
- The record-breaking plantation campaign was organised on **12 July 2026** at **Bhadaj near Gota-Godhavi Canal, Ahmedabad, Gujarat**, under the guidance of **Union Home Minister Amit Shah**.
- The initiative involved participation from more than **25,000 volunteers**, including **students, National Cadet Corps (NCC) cadets, government officials, law enforcement personnel, organisations, and local residents**.

West Bengal Renames 'Khela Hobe Diwas' as 'Ayushman Diwas' to Promote Healthcare Awareness

- The **West Bengal Government** has announced that **August 16** will be observed as **'Ayushman Diwas'** instead of **'Khela Hobe Diwas'**, shifting the focus towards healthcare awareness and promotion of the **Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB-PMJAY)**.
- The announcement was made by **West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari** and coincides with the completion of the **first 100 days of the BJP-led government** in the state.
- **Ayushman Diwas** aims to spread awareness among citizens about the benefits, eligibility criteria, and utilisation of cashless healthcare services under the **Ayushman Bharat scheme**.
- **Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB-PMJAY)** is the flagship health assurance scheme of the **Government of India**, providing financial protection against major medical expenses.
- Under **AB-PMJAY**, eligible families receive **cashless health insurance coverage of up to ₹5 lakh per family per year** for secondary and tertiary hospitalisation.
- Beneficiaries can avail treatment at **empanelled government and private hospitals** across India, reducing out-of-pocket healthcare expenditure.

India Observes 3rd NAMASTE Day to Recognise Contribution of Sanitation Workers

- India is set to observe the **3rd NAMASTE Day**, marking **three years since the launch of the National Action for Mechanized Sanitation Ecosystem (NAMASTE) Scheme**.

- The nationwide celebrations are being led by the **Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment**, with the main event scheduled at **Rabindra Sadan, Kolkata, West Bengal**.
- The observance aims to recognise the **valuable contribution of sanitation workers** and highlight their role in maintaining public health and cleanliness.
- **National Action for Mechanized Sanitation Ecosystem (NAMASTE)** Scheme focuses on transforming sanitation work by promoting **mechanised cleaning of sewer and septic tanks** and eliminating hazardous manual cleaning practices.

Centre of Excellence on Human-Wildlife Conflict and National Human-Wildlife Conflict Portal Launched at WII-SACON, Coimbatore

- **Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change Bhupender Yadav** inaugurated the **Centre of Excellence (CoE) on Human-Wildlife Conflict** at the **Wildlife Institute of India–Sálim Ali Centre for Ornithology and Natural History (WII-SACON), Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu**.
- Along with the Centre of Excellence, the **National Human-Wildlife Conflict Portal** was also launched to strengthen data management, knowledge sharing, and decision-making for reducing human-wildlife conflicts across India.
- The inauguration was followed by the **National Workshop on Human-Wildlife Conflict**, which brought together policymakers, forest officials, scientists, researchers, technology experts, and conservation practitioners from across the country.

About Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)

- Union Minister: Bhupender Yadav
- Constituency: Alwar, Rajasthan
- Minister of State: Kirti Vardhan Singh

About Tamil Nadu:

- **Chief Minister:** C. Joseph Vijay
- **Governor:** Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar (Additional Charge)
- **Capital:** Chennai
- **National Parks:** Guindy National Park, Gulf of Mannar Marine National Park, Indira Gandhi (Anamalai) National Park, Mudumalai National Park, Mukurthi National Park, Palani Hills National Park
- **Wildlife Sanctuaries:** Mudumalai Wildlife Sanctuary, Kalakad Wildlife Sanctuary, Point Calimere Wildlife Sanctuary, Vedanthangal Bird Sanctuary, Sathyamangalam Wildlife Sanctuary,

Srivilliputhur Grizzled Squirrel Wildlife Sanctuary, Pulicat Lake Wildlife Sanctuary, Megamalai Wildlife Sanctuary

Kamarajar Port Limited Becomes India's Second Major Port to Achieve 18 Metre Operational Draft

- **Kamarajar Port Limited (KPL)** in **Tamil Nadu** has become the **second major port in India** to achieve an **operational draft of 18 metres**, after **Visakhapatnam Port**.
- The achievement was announced by the **Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways** after the successful completion of the **Capital Dredging Phase VI Project** at Kamarajar Port.

Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) Launches Centralised IT Enabled Services (CITES 2.01) Platform for Unified Provident Fund Services

- The **Government of India** launched the upgraded **Centralised IT Enabled Services (CITES 2.01)** platform for the **Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO)**, migrating around **34 crore member accounts** from more than **120 decentralised databases** into a single **unified national system**.
- The platform was launched by **Union Minister for Labour and Employment Mansukh Mandaviya** and aims to modernise EPFO services, improve efficiency, enable faster claim settlements, and provide seamless services to members across India.
- The upgraded system will enable the crediting of **Provident Fund interest for 2025–26 by 15 July 2026**, much earlier than the usual **October–November timeline**.
- Interest at **8.25% for 2025–26**, amounting to an estimated **₹1.44 lakh crore**, will be automatically processed for around **34 crore EPFO members** and verified by field authorities before being credited to members' accounts.

Navi Mumbai International Airport Notified as Authorised Port for Drug Imports Under Drugs Rules, 1945

- The **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW)** notified **Navi Mumbai International Airport, Maharashtra** as an **authorised port of entry for the import of drugs** under the **Drugs Rules, 1945**.
- The notification was issued through an amendment to **Rule 43A of the Drugs Rules, 1945** after consultation with the **Drugs Technical Advisory Board (DTAB)** under the provisions of the **Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940**.
- With the inclusion of **Navi Mumbai International Airport**, the total number of notified ports of entry for the import of drugs through **air, sea, road, and rail routes** has increased to **42**.

India Supports Palestine's Bid for Full United Nations Membership and Announces New Aid Package

- **India** has reiterated its support for **Palestine's application for full membership of the United Nations (UN)** and reaffirmed its commitment to the establishment of an **independent, sovereign, and peaceful Palestine**.
- India expressed its support during international meetings held in **Brussels, Belgium and New York, United States of America**, highlighting the importance of the **two-state solution** for achieving lasting peace in **West Asia**.
- India maintained that **dialogue and diplomacy** remain the most effective approaches for ensuring peace and stability between **Israel and Palestine**.

About United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees in the Near East (UNRWA)

- Established: 1949
- Headquarters: Amman, Jordan and Gaza City, Palestine
- Commissioner-General: Philippe Lazzarini.

Central Vista Redevelopment Area Renamed as Kartavya Bhawan Area

- The **Government of India** has officially renamed the **Central Vista redevelopment area** as the **Kartavya Bhawan Area** (also referred to as the **Kartavya Bhawan Complex**).
- **Union Minister of Housing and Urban Affairs, Manohar Lal**, announced that the term **"Central Vista"** should no longer be used in official communications and government documents, and should be replaced with **"Kartavya Bhawan Area"**.
- The announcement was made during the **Foundation Day celebrations of the Central Public Works Department (CPWD)**.

Unjha Cumin (Jeera) and Unjha Fennel (Saunf) Receive Geographical Indication (GI) Tag

- The **Geographical Indications Registry** has granted the **Geographical Indication (GI) tag** to **Unjha Cumin (Jeera)** and **Unjha Fennel (Saunf)**, recognising them as unique agricultural products originating from **Unjha, Mehsana district, Gujarat**.
- The **GI certification** strengthens the global identity of **Gujarat's spice sector**, enhances export opportunities, improves farmers' income, and protects the products from imitation and misuse.
- The registration was facilitated through the joint efforts of the **Unjha Agricultural Produce Market Committee (APMC)**, **Department of Horticulture and Farmers' Welfare, Government of Gujarat**, **Sardarkrushinagar Dantiwada Agricultural University (SDAU)**, and the **Entrepreneurship Development Institute of India (EDII)**.

Directorate General of Foreign Trade Notifies Tariff Rate Quota (TRQ) Allocation Procedure Under India–Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)

- The **Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT), Ministry of Commerce and Industry** has notified the **Tariff Rate Quota (TRQ) allocation procedure** under the **India–Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)**.
- The **India–Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)** came into force on **1 June 2026** to enhance **bilateral trade, investment, and economic cooperation** between **India** and **Oman**.
- Under the agreement, specified goods imported from **Oman** will be eligible for **preferential tariff treatment**, including **reduced or zero customs duty**, within the prescribed quota limits.

About Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT)

- Parent Ministry: Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Government of India
- Established: 1991 (replacing the Chief Controller of Imports and Exports)
- Headquarters: New Delhi
- Director General: Lav Aggarwal

Centre Proposes Autonomous Hill Development Councils in Every District of Ladakh Under Article 371 Framework

- The **Central Government** has proposed the establishment of **Autonomous Hill Development Councils (AHDCs)** in **every district of Ladakh** to strengthen **local self-governance** while preserving the region's unique identity.
- At present, **Leh** and **Kargil** have Autonomous Hill Development Councils.
- The proposal extends the system to the newly created districts of **Sham, Nubra, Changthang, Zanskar, and Drass**.

Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation Introduces India's First Trial Index of Services Production (ISP)

- The **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)** has introduced India's first **trial version of the Index of Services Production (ISP)** to measure the monthly performance of the **formal services sector**.
- The **Index of Services Production (ISP)** has been launched with the **base year 2024–25** and provides a short-term indicator to track changes in the output of India's services economy.

- Similar to the **Index of Industrial Production (IIP)**, which measures output in **manufacturing, mining, and electricity sectors**, the ISP will monitor monthly production trends in key **service industries**.
- The pilot ISP covers **19 service sub-sectors**, accounting for around **60% of India's services sector**, which contributes more than **50% of India's Gross Value Added (GVA)**.

About Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation:

- **Minister of State (Independent Charge):** Rao Inderjit Singh
- **Constituency:** Gurgaon, Haryana

Indian Grey Hornbill Successfully Reintroduced to Gir Forest After More Than 60 Years

- The **Gujarat Forest Department** has successfully reintroduced the **Indian Grey Hornbill** to the **Gir Forest**, marking the return of the species after an absence of more than **60 years**.
- The species had disappeared from the **Gir ecosystem** during the **1950s–1960s**, primarily due to **hunting pressure**.
- Scientific assessments confirmed that the reintroduced hornbills have **survived, established permanent territories, adapted to the habitat, and successfully bred for four consecutive breeding seasons**, making it one of **India's most successful bird reintroduction programmes**.

Karnataka to Establish India's First Government-Driven Artificial Intelligence (AI) University

- **Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar** announced that the state will establish **India's first government-driven Artificial Intelligence (AI) University** during **Google I/O Connect India 2026** held at the **Bangalore International Exhibition Centre (BIEC), Bengaluru**.
- The initiative aims to position **Karnataka as an "AI-native State"** by promoting **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-driven education, research, innovation, and governance**.
- The proposed **AI University** will serve as a **centre of excellence** for Artificial Intelligence by developing **world-class AI talent**, promoting **advanced AI research**, encouraging **innovation and entrepreneurship**, and strengthening collaboration among **academia, industry, and government**.

About Karnataka:

- **Chief Minister:** D. K. Shivakumar
- **Governor:** Thawarchand Gehlot
- **Capital:** Bengaluru

- **National Parks:** Bandipur National Park, Bannerghatta National Park, Nagarhole (Rajiv Gandhi) National Park, Kudremukh National Park, Anshi (Kali) National Park
- **Wildlife Sanctuaries:** Bhadra Wildlife Sanctuary, Brahmagiri Wildlife Sanctuary, Cauvery Wildlife Sanctuary, Dandeli Wildlife Sanctuary, Mookambika Wildlife Sanctuary, Pushpagiri Wildlife Sanctuary, Sharavathi Valley Wildlife Sanctuary, Someshwara Wildlife Sanctuary, Talakaveri Wildlife Sanctuary, Ranebennur Blackbuck Wildlife Sanctuary

International Gas Union (IGU) Releases World Liquefied Natural Gas Report 2026

- The **International Gas Union (IGU)** has released the **World LNG Report 2026**, providing a comprehensive review of the global **Liquefied Natural Gas (LNG)** industry and market trends.
- **Global LNG trade** reached a record **437 million tonnes in 2025**, registering a **6.3% increase**, the strongest annual growth since **2022**.
- The growth was driven by expanding LNG supplies from the **United States, Qatar, Australia, Russia**, and other major producing countries.
- **Canada** and **Mauritania/Senegal** became new LNG-exporting countries, marking the **first new LNG export markets since 2022**.

About International Gas Union (IGU)

- **Established: 1931**
- **Headquarters: London, United Kingdom**
- **Nature:** Global non-profit organisation representing the natural gas and LNG industry.
- **Objective:** Promote the sustainable development of the **natural gas, liquefied natural gas (LNG), hydrogen, and renewable gas** sectors through international cooperation and knowledge sharing.

India Launches Campaign for United Nations Security Council (UNSC) Non-Permanent Membership for 2028–29

- **India** has officially launched its campaign for election as a **Non-Permanent Member of the United Nations Security Council (UNSC)** for the **2028–2029** term.
- **External Affairs Minister Dr. S. Jaishankar** launched India's candidature at the **United Nations (UN) Headquarters, New York**, and unveiled **SHANTI** as India's guiding vision for the campaign.
- **SHANTI** stands for **Securing Holistic Advancement through Norms, Trust and Integrity**, reflecting India's approach to promoting **global peace, security, multilateral cooperation, and equitable development**.

About United Nations Security Council (UNSC)

- Organisation: United Nations (UN)
- Established: 1945
- Headquarters: New York, United States

Union Cabinet Approves Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme (MPMS) with ₹62,500 Crore Outlay

- The **Union Cabinet**, chaired by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, approved the **Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme (MPMS)** with a total outlay of **₹62,500 crore** to strengthen India's mobile phone manufacturing ecosystem.
- The scheme aims to **boost domestic manufacturing**, **increase value addition**, **strengthen supply chains**, **promote Indian mobile brands**, and position **India as a global hub for mobile phone manufacturing** under the **Make in India** initiative.
- **MPMS** will be implemented for **five years**, from **FY 2026–27 to FY 2030–31**, and will provide **performance-linked incentives** to eligible manufacturers.

About Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology:

- **Cabinet Minister:** Ashwini Vaishnaw
- **Constituency:** Rajya Sabha, Odisha
- **Ministers of State (MoS):** Jitin Prasada

Government Revises Special Additional Excise Duty (SAED) on Petroleum Product Exports

- The **Government of India** has revised the **Special Additional Excise Duty (SAED)**, commonly known as the **windfall tax**, on the export of petroleum products with effect from **16 July 2026**.
- According to the **Ministry of Finance**, the revised rates will remain effective for the **fortnight beginning 16 July 2026** and will be reviewed in the next fortnightly revision.
- The revised **SAED** rates are:
    - **Diesel (Exports):** Increased from **₹8.5/litre** to **₹15.5/litre**
    - **Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF) (Exports):** Increased from **₹7.5/litre** to **₹14.5/litre**
    - **Petrol (Exports):** Reduced from **₹4/litre** to **₹2.5/litre**

Kolkata Metro to Introduce Driverless Train Operations on Green and Purple Lines

- **Kolkata Metro** is set to introduce **driverless metro train operations** on the **Green Line** and **Purple Line**, marking a major milestone in India's urban public transport system.
- The **Commissioner of Railway Safety (CRS)** has approved **driverless operations on the Green Line** after successfully completing safety inspections and trials.
- With the launch, **Kolkata** will become one of the few Indian cities, after **Delhi** and **Bengaluru**, to operate **Grade of Automation 4 (GoA-4)** driverless metro services.

About Kolkata Metro

- Established: 1984 (India's first metro railway)
- Headquarters: Kolkata
- First Metro in India: Kolkata Metro became India's first metro rail system on 24 October 1984.

Ministry of Heavy Industries Invites Global Bids for Advanced Chemistry Cell (ACC) Battery Manufacturing Under PLI Scheme

- The **Ministry of Heavy Industries (MHI)** has invited **global bids** to establish **10 GWh of Advanced Chemistry Cell (ACC) battery manufacturing capacity** under the **Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme for ACC Batteries**.
- The bidding marks the **final phase** of the **₹18,100 crore PLI Scheme**, aimed at creating a **robust domestic ACC battery manufacturing ecosystem** and reducing India's dependence on imported batteries.
- **Both domestic and global manufacturers** are eligible to participate in the bidding process.

About Ministry of Heavy Industries:

- **Cabinet Minister:** H. D. Kumaraswamy
- **Constituency:** Mandya, Karnataka
- **Ministers of State (MoS):** Bhupathi Raju Srinivasa Varma

Cabinet Approves National Investment Policy for Urea-2026 (NIPU-2026)

- The **Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA)**, chaired by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, approved the **National Investment Policy for Urea-2026 (NIPU-2026)** to promote **self-reliance in urea production** under the **Atmanirbhar Bharat** initiative.
- **NIPU-2026** has been introduced by the **Department of Fertilizers** to encourage investment in **new gas-based urea manufacturing plants** across the country.
- The policy replaces the **New Investment Policy (NIP)-2012**, whose investment window closed in **October 2019**.

About Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers:

- **Cabinet Minister:** J. P. Nadda
- **Constituency:** Gujarat (Rajya Sabha)
- **Ministers of State (MoS):** Anupriya Patel

India and European Union Hold Third Trade and Technology Council (TTC) Meeting in Brussels

- **India** and the **European Union (EU)** held the **3rd India–European Union Trade and Technology Council (TTC) Meeting** in **Brussels, Belgium**, to deepen cooperation in **trade, technology, innovation, and resilient supply chains**.
- During the meeting, both sides discussed expanding collaboration in **Artificial Intelligence (AI), semiconductors, electric vehicles (EVs), renewable energy technologies, digital technologies, high-performance computing, and secure digital infrastructure**.
- The meeting also focused on building **trusted and resilient supply chains**, enhancing **bilateral trade and investment**, and promoting **economic resilience** amid global trade and technology disruptions.

Union Cabinet Approves Semicon 2.0 with ₹1.275 Lakh Crore Outlay

- The **Union Cabinet**, chaired by **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, approved **Semicon 2.0**, India's next-generation semiconductor policy, with a total outlay of **₹1,27,500 crore**.
- **Semicon 2.0** aims to strengthen India's **semiconductor design, manufacturing, packaging, research, innovation, and talent development ecosystem**, while building a **resilient semiconductor supply chain** and promoting **technological self-reliance**.
- The programme builds upon **Semicon 1.0** and seeks to establish a **comprehensive semiconductor ecosystem**, covering **chip design, fabrication, packaging, materials, equipment, research, and skilled workforce development**.

Uttar Pradesh Launches Kaushal Setu and Kaushal Sarathi Digital Platforms for Skill Development

- **Uttar Pradesh Government** launched two digital platforms, **Kaushal Setu** and **Kaushal Sarathi**, during the celebration of **World Youth Skills Day 2026** to modernise vocational training and improve skill development services in the state.
- The platforms aim to bring **vocational training online**, enhance **transparency in skill development programmes**, and strengthen cooperation between **industries, training institutions, and job seekers**.
- The two portals have been introduced to improve the functioning of the **Uttar Pradesh Skill Development Mission (UPSDM)**.
- **Kaushal Setu** is the official digital portal of the **Uttar Pradesh Skill Development Mission (UPSDM)** that allows training centres and institutions to register and apply online.

Karnataka Introduces Draft Karnataka Apartment (Ownership and Management) Bill, 2025

- **Karnataka Government** has released the draft **Karnataka Apartment (Ownership and Management) Bill, 2025 (KAOMA)** to modernise apartment management, strengthen the rights

of apartment owners, and resolve long- standing disputes in the state's growing real estate sector.

- The proposed Bill aims to introduce **joint ownership of land and common facilities**, create a legal framework for **redevelopment of old apartment buildings**, and align apartment regulations with the **Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act (RERA), 2016**.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi Inaugurates Advanced Healthcare Facilities at Post Graduate Institute of Medical Education and Research (PGIMER), Chandigarh

- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** inaugurated the **Advanced Mother and Child Centre** and the **Advanced Neurosciences Centre** at the **Post Graduate Institute of Medical Education and Research (PGIMER), Chandigarh**.
- Prime Minister also laid the **foundation stone for a 150-bed Modern Critical Care Block** under the **Pradhan Mantri Ayushman Bharat Health Infrastructure Mission (PM-ABHIM)**.
- These healthcare projects aim to improve access to **advanced medical facilities**, strengthen **emergency healthcare preparedness**, and promote **medical education and research** in **Northern India**.

Maharashtra to Implement National e-Vidhan Application (NeVA) for Digital Transformation of Legislature

- **Maharashtra Government** is set to implement the **National e-Vidhan Application (NeVA)** programme, a **Mission Mode Project** under the **Digital India Programme** initiated by the **Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs, Government of India**.
- The implementation of **NeVA** follows the vision of **"One Nation One Application"** and aims to digitise the functioning of the **Maharashtra Legislative Assembly** and **Maharashtra Legislative Council**.
- The initiative will improve **efficiency, transparency, accessibility, and public participation** in legislative processes by reducing dependence on paper-based systems.
- A high-level meeting was held at **Vidhan Bhawan, Mumbai** to accelerate the implementation of **National e-Vidhan Application (NeVA)** in Maharashtra.

NITI Aayog Launches Investment Friendliness Index (IFI) to Assess Investment Readiness of States and Union Territories

- **NITI Aayog** has introduced the **Investment Friendliness Index (IFI)** to assess the readiness of **36 States and Union Territories (UTs)** in attracting and sustaining investments based on governance, economic, and infrastructure parameters.

- The index aims to provide policymakers with insights into the **strengths and weaknesses of different States and Union Territories** and support reforms to improve the **investment climate and ease of doing business**.
- The **Investment Friendliness Index (IFI)** is not intended as a competition among States but as a **benchmarking mechanism** to provide data-based feedback and encourage policy improvements.
- The first edition of the index evaluated States and Union Territories using **84 indicators** grouped under **eight key pillars**.

About NITI Aayog

- Full Form: National Institution for Transforming India
- Established: 1 January 2015
- Headquarters: New Delhi
- Chairperson: Prime Minister of India
- The Chief Executive Officer (CEO) is Nidhi Chhibber

Shabdalok: India's First Immersive Language Museum Inaugurated in Kolkata

- **Shabdalok (Museum of Words)**, India's **first immersive language museum**, was inaugurated by **Union Home Minister Amit Shah** at the **National Library, Kolkata, West Bengal**.
- The museum has been established by the **Ministry of Culture, Government of India** to preserve and showcase India's rich linguistic heritage through modern technology.
- **Shabdalok** aims to educate visitors about the evolution of Indian languages, from **oral traditions to written literature**, through interactive and immersive experiences.

National Highways Authority of India Launches Digital Local Pass and MargMitra Help Centre on RajmargYatra Mobile App

- The **National Highways Authority of India (NHAI)** launched **Digital Local Pass** and **MargMitra Help Centre** on the **RajmargYatra Mobile App** to enhance digital services for **National Highway** users.
- The initiatives support the **Digital India** programme by providing **paperless**, **technology-driven**, and **user-friendly** highway services.
- The **Digital Local Pass** enables eligible commuters to apply for and obtain **monthly toll passes online**, eliminating the need to visit toll plazas or submit physical documents.

About National Highways Authority of India (NHAI)

- Established: 1988

- Parent Ministry: Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH)
- Headquarters: New Delhi
- Chairperson: Santosh Kumar Yadav

Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) Celebrates 98th Foundation Day with Roadmap for Viksit Krishi and Samruddh Kisan

- The **Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)** celebrated its **98th Foundation Day** at the **Bharat Ratna C. Subramaniam Auditorium, NASC Complex, New Delhi**, where **Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare and Rural Development Shivraj Singh Chouhan** presented a roadmap for **"Viksit Krishi and Samruddh Kisan"** under the vision of **Viksit Bharat 2047**.
- The Minister announced major targets including development of **100 Climate Smart Villages**, reaching **ICAR technologies to 100 million farmers**, launching **"One Institute-One Grand Innovation"**, establishing an **ICAR Open Digital Knowledge Platform**, strengthening action against **fake seeds and pesticides**, and making ICAR financially self-reliant through technology commercialisation.

About Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)

- Established: 16 July 1929
- Headquarters: New Delhi
- Parent Ministry: Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare
- Director General: Dr. M. L. Jat

Delhi Cabinet Approves Parivartan Scheme to Replace Old Commercial Vehicles with BS-VI and Electric Vehicles

- The **Delhi Cabinet**, chaired by **Chief Minister Rekha Gupta**, approved the implementation of the **Parivartan Scheme**, a flagship initiative of the **Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH)**, to promote cleaner commercial transportation in the **National Capital Region (NCR)**.
- **Parivartan (Programme for Accelerated Renewal and Incentivization of Vehicle Assets)** aims to replace **BS-IV and older commercial vehicles** with **BS-VI-compliant** or **electric vehicles (EVs)** to reduce vehicular emissions and improve air quality.
- The scheme covers **Light Goods Vehicles (LGVs)**, **Medium Goods Vehicles (MGVs)**, **Heavy Goods Vehicles (HGVs)**, and **commercial buses** that are **BS-IV or older**.

About Ministry of Road Transport and Highways:

- **Cabinet Minister:** Nitin Jairam Gadkari

- **Constituency:** Nagpur, Maharashtra
- **Ministers of State (MoS):** Ajay Tamta, Harsh Malhotra

Mukhyamantri Swasth Bastar Abhiyan Improves Maternal and Child Health Outcomes in Chhattisgarh

- The **Mukhyamantri Swasth Bastar Abhiyan** has significantly improved **maternal and child healthcare** in **Bastar region**, particularly in **Sukma district**, one of **Chhattisgarh's** most **Left-Wing Extremism (LWE)-affected** districts.
- The initiative was launched by **Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai** on **14 April 2026** in **Sukma** to provide **accessible healthcare services** in remote and tribal areas with limited medical infrastructure.
- The campaign focuses on **preventive healthcare**, **maternal and child health**, **early disease detection**, and **timely treatment** through doorstep healthcare services.

About Chhattisgarh:

- **Chief Minister:** Vishnu Deo Sai
- **Governor:** Ramen Deka
- **Capital:** Raipur
- **National Parks:** Indravati, Kanger Valley, Guru Ghasidas National Parks
- **Wildlife Sanctuaries:** Achanakmar, Barnawapara, Udanti Wild Buffalo, Sitanadi Wildlife Sanctuaries

Supreme Court Directs Centre to Frame Uniform Post-Retirement Benefits Policy for Retired High Court Judges

- The **Supreme Court of India** directed the **Central Government** to constitute a **committee within two weeks** to recommend a **uniform post-retirement benefits scheme** for **retired Chief Justices and High Court judges** across the country.
- The direction was issued while hearing a petition highlighting **unequal post-retirement benefits** provided to retired High Court judges by different **State Governments**.
- A **Supreme Court Bench** comprising **Chief Justice of India Surya Kant**, **Justice V. Mohan**, and **Justice Joymalya Bagchi** observed that varying benefits across states violate the principles of **equality** and **dignity**.
- The committee has been tasked with preparing **uniform national guidelines**, examining the **financial assistance mechanism** for states, and recommending a **common post-retirement benefits policy**.

India Approves First Dengue Vaccine 'QDENGA' for Public Use

- **India** has approved its **first dengue vaccine**, **QDENGA**, after receiving marketing authorisation from the **Drug Controller General of India (DCGI)**, marking a major milestone in the country's fight against **dengue**.
- **QDENGA**, developed by **Takeda Biopharmaceuticals (Japan)**, is a **live attenuated tetravalent dengue vaccine** that provides protection against all **four dengue virus serotypes (DENV-1, DENV-2, DENV-3, and DENV-4)**.
- The vaccine is approved for individuals aged **4 to 60 years**, irrespective of whether they have had a previous dengue infection.
- **QDENGA** is administered in a **two-dose schedule** and **does not require pre-vaccination screening**, making it easier to include in immunisation programmes.
- **QDENGA** was first approved in **2022**, is currently approved in **43 countries**, and more than **32 million doses** have been administered worldwide. It is also included in the **national immunisation programmes** of **Brazil, Argentina, Colombia, and Indonesia**.

Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs Approves ₹2,719.80 Crore Urban Development Projects for Ahmedabad under Urban Challenge Fund

- The **Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA)** approved **six transformative urban development projects** worth **₹2,719.80 crore** for **Ahmedabad, Gujarat** under the **Urban Challenge Fund (UCF)**.
- The projects aim to **modernise urban infrastructure**, implement **smart city solutions**, improve **water and sanitation facilities**, and enhance **citizen services** in Ahmedabad.
- The approved projects include **sewerage network rehabilitation, Intelligent Water Management System (IWMS), Integrated Sludge Management Facility, Intelligent Traffic Management System (ITMS), and Automatic Fare Collection System (AFCS)**.

About Urban Challenge Fund (UCF)

- **Launched By: Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA)**
- **Type: Centrally Sponsored Scheme (CSS)**
- **Financial Period: Financial Year 2025–26 to Financial Year 2030–31** (extendable up to **Financial Year 2033–34**)
- **Central Assistance: ₹1 lakh crore**
- **Objective:** Promote **market-based financing**, balanced regional development, and transformation of urban infrastructure through innovative projects.

- The scheme focuses on three major areas:
  - **Creative Redevelopment of Cities**
  - **Cities as Growth Hubs**
  - **Water and Sanitation**
- Under the funding framework of the **Urban Challenge Fund**, the **Central Government provides 25% of the project cost**, while cities mobilise at least **50% through municipal bonds, bank loans, or Public-Private Partnerships (PPPs)**.
- The remaining **25%** is contributed by **States, Union Territories (UTs), Urban Local Bodies (ULBs), or additional market financing**.

Employees' Provident Fund Organisation Launches VISHWAS 2026 Scheme for Dispute Resolution

- The **Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO)** under the **Ministry of Labour and Employment (MoL&E)** launched **VISHWAS 2026**, a **one-time dispute resolution scheme** for the amicable settlement of damages and penalty-related disputes.
- The scheme is applicable to disputes under **Section 14B of the Employees' Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952** and **Section 128 of the Code on Social Security, 2020**.
- **VISHWAS 2026** aims to promote **voluntary compliance, reduce litigation, and ensure faster settlement of pending disputes** through a **transparent, fully digital, and time-bound process**.

About Ministry of Labour and Employment:

- **Cabinet Minister:** Mansukh Mandaviya
- **Constituency:** Gujarat
- **Ministers of State (MoS):** Shobha Karandlaje

India's First Deep Geothermal Wells Commissioned at Puga Valley, Ladakh

- **Lieutenant Governor of Ladakh V. K. Saxena** commissioned **India's first two 1,000-metre-deep geothermal wells** at **Puga Valley, Ladakh**, developed by **Oil and Natural Gas Corporation Limited (ONGC) Energy Centre**.
- The geothermal wells will support the development of India's first **1 Megawatt (MW) demonstration-scale geothermal power plant** at **Puga Valley**, located at an altitude of over **14,000 feet above sea level**.

About Oil and Natural Gas Corporation Limited (ONGC)

- Established: 1956
- Headquarters: New Delhi
- Parent Ministry: Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas (MoPNG)
- Category: Maharatna Central Public Sector Undertaking (CPSU)
- Chairman and Chief Executive Officer (CEO): Arun Kumar Singh

NITI Aayog Launches Roadmap to Make India a Leading Bioeconomy Powerhouse by 2035

- The **National Institution for Transforming India (NITI Aayog)** launched the **"Roadmap for Building India as a Leading Bioeconomy Powerhouse by 2035"** at the **National Media Centre, New Delhi**.
- The roadmap was formally launched by **Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science and Technology, Dr. Jitendra Singh**, in the presence of **Prof. Gobardhan Das, Member, NITI Aayog**, and **Nidhi Chhibber, Chief Executive Officer (CEO), NITI Aayog**.
- The roadmap has been developed by the **NITI Frontier Tech Hub (NITI-FTH)** in consultation with the **Department of Biotechnology (DBT)** under the **Ministry of Science and Technology (MoST)**, **Association of Biotechnology Led Enterprises (ABLE)**, industry, academia, and other stakeholders.

Uttar Pradesh Launches Mini Nandi Farmer Prosperity Scheme to Promote Indigenous Dairy Farming

- The **Government of Uttar Pradesh** launched the **Mini Nandi Farmer Prosperity Scheme** to promote **scientific dairy farming** using **high-yielding indigenous cattle breeds** and enhance farmers' income through financial assistance.
- The scheme provides **50% subsidy up to ₹11.80 lakh** for establishing a **10-cow dairy unit** with an estimated project cost of **₹23.60 lakh**.
- The funding pattern includes **50% government subsidy**, **15% beneficiary contribution**, and **35% bank loan**.

Common Service Centres 4.0 Strengthen Digital Service Delivery and Rural Self-Employment

- The **Common Service Centres (CSC) Scheme**, launched under the **Digital India Programme**, has expanded digital public service delivery through **CSC 4.0**, enabling citizens in **rural and semi-urban areas** to access government, financial, and digital services.
- **Common Service Centres** are operated by **Village Level Entrepreneurs (VLEs)**, who act as the link between citizens and government services while promoting **self-employment and digital inclusion**.

- Under **CSC 4.0**, centres are being connected through **BharatNet** to provide high-speed internet connectivity and improve access to digital services in remote areas.

About Common Service Centres (CSC)

- **Launched: 2006**
- **Ministry: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology**
- **Objective:** To provide digital government, financial, educational, healthcare, and citizen-centric services through technology-enabled centres, especially in rural India.

Tamil Nadu's Killai Becomes State's First Climate-Resilient Village

- **Killai village** in **Cuddalore district, Tamil Nadu**, has been recognised as the **first Climate-Resilient Village** in the State.
- Located near the **Pichavaram Mangrove Forest**, the village has adopted a **community-based climate adaptation model** to address challenges such as **cyclones, floods, coastal erosion, sea-level rise, and saltwater intrusion**.

India Achieves 99.6% Broad Gauge Railway Electrification; Becomes World's Second Most Electrified Railway Network

- **Indian Railways** has achieved **99.6% electrification of its Broad Gauge (BG) railway network**, becoming the **second most electrified railway system in the world** after **Switzerland (100%)**.
- According to the **International Union of Railways (UIC)** report (June 2025), **India (99.6%)** ranks ahead of **China (82%)**, **Spain (67%)**, **Japan (64%)**, **France (60%)**, and the **United Kingdom (39%)** in railway electrification.
- Since **2014**, Indian Railways has electrified **48,072 route kilometres**, compared to **21,801 route kilometres** electrified during the previous six decades, making it one of the world's fastest railway electrification programmes.

About Indian Railways

- Established: 1853
- Ministry: Ministry of Railways
- Headquarters: New Delhi
- Railway Minister: Ashwini Vaishnaw
- Chairman and Chief Executive Officer, Railway Board: Satish Kumar

President Droupadi Murmu Unveils Mahatma Gandhi Statue in North Macedonia

- **President Droupadi Murmu** inaugurated a **statue of Mahatma Gandhi** at the **Museum of the City of Skopje**, **Skopje, North Macedonia**, during her **three-nation visit to Europe**.
- The event was attended by **President Gordana Siljanovska-Davkova of North Macedonia**, highlighting the strengthening of **India–North Macedonia bilateral relations**.
- The statue symbolises India's commitment to promoting **peace, non-violence (Ahimsa), truth (Satya), and humanity**, reflecting the universal values advocated by **Mahatma Gandhi**.

About North Macedonia

- **Capital:** Skopje
- **Currency:** Macedonian Denar
- **President:** Gordana Siljanovska-Davkova

Madhya Pradesh Cabinet Approves Uniform Civil Code Bill, 2026

- The **Madhya Pradesh Cabinet** approved the **Uniform Civil Code (UCC) Bill, 2026**, making **Madhya Pradesh** the **fourth state** after **Uttarakhand, Gujarat, and Assam** to adopt a **Uniform Civil Code** framework.
- The Bill seeks to establish **uniform civil laws** for all citizens in matters relating to **marriage, divorce, inheritance, adoption, maintenance, succession, and live-in relationships**, irrespective of religion.
- The Bill was approved during a **special Cabinet meeting in Bhopal** and will be introduced in the **Madhya Pradesh Legislative Assembly** during the **Monsoon Session**.
- The **Uniform Civil Code** is based on **Article 44** of the **Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSP)** in the **Constitution of India**, which directs the State to endeavour to secure a uniform civil code for all citizens.

About Uniform Civil Code (UCC)

- The **Uniform Civil Code (UCC)** aims to provide a **common set of civil laws** governing **marriage, divorce, inheritance, adoption, maintenance, and succession** for all citizens, irrespective of religion.
- It is based on **Article 44** under the **Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSP)** of the **Constitution of India**.
- **Article 44** states that **"The State shall endeavour to secure for the citizens a Uniform Civil Code throughout the territory of India."**
- The **Directive Principles of State Policy** are **non-justiciable** but serve as guiding principles for governance and policymaking.

About Madhya Pradesh:

- **Chief Minister:** Mohan Yadav
- **Governor:** Mangubhai Chhaganbhai Patel
- **Capital:** Bhopal
- **National Parks:** Kanha National Park, Bandhavgarh National Park, Pench National Park, Panna National Park, Satpura National Park, Sanjay National Park, Madhav National Park, Van Vihar National Park, Mandla Plant Fossils National Park
- **Wildlife Sanctuaries:** Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary, National Chambal Wildlife Sanctuary, Kuno Wildlife Sanctuary, Pachmarhi Wildlife Sanctuary, Pench Wildlife Sanctuary, Panna Wildlife Sanctuary, Nauradehi Wildlife Sanctuary, Singhori Wildlife Sanctuary, Bori Wildlife Sanctuary

Maharashtra to Develop India's First Artificial Intelligence-Powered Bird Sanctuary at Thane Creek Flamingo Sanctuary

- The **Government of Maharashtra** approved the development of **India's first Artificial Intelligence (AI)-powered bird sanctuary** at the **Thane Creek Flamingo Sanctuary (TCFS)** with an investment of **₹45 crore**.
- The project will establish the country's **first Artificial Intelligence-based bird detection and monitoring centre**, integrating advanced technology with **wildlife conservation** and **eco-tourism**.
- **Thane Creek Flamingo Sanctuary (TCFS)** is located between **Mumbai and Navi Mumbai, Maharashtra**, and was declared **India's first flamingo sanctuary** in **2015**.

Maharashtra Launches Bharat Taxi Cooperative Taxi Service to Promote Driver Ownership

- The **Government of Maharashtra** launched **Bharat Taxi**, a **cooperative taxi service platform**, at the **Navi Mumbai International Airport, Maharashtra**, to provide **affordable, transparent, and reliable transportation services**.
- The service was inaugurated by **Devendra Fadnavis, Chief Minister of Maharashtra**, along with **Murlidhar Mohol, Union Minister of State for Cooperation**.
- Bharat Taxi is based on the vision of **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's "Sahakar Se Samriddhi" (Prosperity through Cooperation)**, aiming to strengthen the cooperative model in the transport sector.

India to Host International Type 1 Diabetes Summit 2026 in Jodhpur

- **India** will host the **International Type 1 Diabetes Summit 2026** from **30 July to 1 August 2026** in **Jodhpur, Rajasthan**, bringing together **leading medical experts, researchers, government officials, healthcare professionals, and patient representatives** from across the world.
- The summit is being organised by **Friends of Mewar**, **Breakthrough T1D**, and the **William J. Clinton Foundation** to promote **global collaboration** in **Type 1 diabetes research, treatment, technology, and patient care**.
- The official announcement of the summit was made at the **Constitution Club of India, New Delhi**.

Mission Golden Spice Launched to Promote Meghalaya's Lakadong Turmeric as a Global Premium Spice

- **Union Minister for Communications and Development of North Eastern Region, Jyotiraditya M. Scindia**, along with **Meghalaya Chief Minister Conrad K. Sangma**, launched the **Mission Golden Spice – Integrated Lakadong Turmeric Value Chain Enhancement Project** at **Sanchar Bhavan, New Delhi**.
- The mission is a **₹175.45 crore convergence-led initiative** to transform **Lakadong turmeric** into a **globally recognised premium spice** by strengthening its entire value chain.
- The project has been launched under the **"Unlock the Economic Potential of India's Northeast (USP)"** initiative of the **Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region**.
- The mission will be implemented over **five years (2025–2030)** in **two phases**:
    - **Phase I:** Value Chain Strengthening
    - **Phase II:** Expansion and Scale-up
- The initiative is being implemented by the **Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region** in collaboration with the **North Eastern Council.**

About Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region:

- **Cabinet Minister:** Jyotiraditya M. Scindia
- **Constituency:** Madhya Pradesh
- **Ministers of State (MoS):** Sukanta Majumdar

About Meghalaya:

- **Chief Minister:** Conrad Kongkal Sangma
- **Governor:** C. H. Vijayashankar
- **Capital:** Shillong
- **National Parks:** Nokrek National Park, Balphakram National Park

- **Wildlife Sanctuaries:** Nongkhyllem Wildlife Sanctuary, Siju Wildlife Sanctuary, Narpuh Wildlife Sanctuary, Baghmara Pitcher Plant Wildlife Sanctuary

India Accepts World Trade Organization Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies; Becomes 123rd Member

- **India** formally accepted the **World Trade Organization (WTO) Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies**, becoming the **123rd member** to join the global agreement.
- **Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal** deposited India's **Instrument of Acceptance** with **World Trade Organization Director-General Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala** at the **World Trade Organization Headquarters in Geneva, Switzerland**.
- The **Agreement on Fisheries Subsidies** was adopted by consensus during the **12th World Trade Organization Ministerial Conference** held in **Geneva, Switzerland**, in **June 2022** and entered into force on **15 September 2025** after acceptance by **two-thirds of World Trade Organization members**.

About World Trade Organization (WTO)

- **Established: 1995**
- **Headquarters: Geneva, Switzerland**
- **Members: 166**
- **Director-General: Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala**
- **Objective:** To regulate international trade, promote free and fair trade, and resolve trade disputes among member countries.

Union Cabinet Approves Amendments to Public Examinations Act, 2024 to Introduce Stricter Penalties for Exam Paper Leaks

- The **Union Cabinet** approved amendments to the **Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024** to impose **stricter penalties** for **exam paper leaks** and other organised examination malpractices.
- The proposed amendments aim to strengthen the legal framework to **prevent organised cheating**, ensure **fair and transparent public examinations**, and restore public confidence in the examination system.
- The amended Bill will be introduced in **Parliament** for approval.
- Under the proposed amendments, the **minimum imprisonment** for offences related to **exam paper leaks** has been increased from **3 years to 5 years**.

Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre Directs GitHub to Remove Bitchat Repositories over

National Security Concerns

- The **Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C)**, under the **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)**, directed **GitHub** to remove repositories related to **Bitchat**, a **decentralised peer-to-peer messaging application**, citing **national security** and **law enforcement concerns**.
- The directive was issued on **23 July 2026** under:
    - **Section 79(3)(b) of the Information Technology Act, 2000**
    - **Rule 3(1)(d) of the Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021**
- **Bitchat** is an **open-source, decentralised messaging application** developed by **Jack Dorsey**, former **Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Twitter**, and uses **Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE) mesh networking** instead of the internet or mobile networks.

Government of India Releases Factsheet Highlighting Cotton as India's 'White Gold'

- The **Government of India (GoI)** released a **factsheet** describing **Cotton** as India's **"White Gold"**, highlighting its significant contribution to the **agriculture, textile, and export sectors**.
- Cotton supports the livelihoods of nearly **6 million farmers** and **40–50 million people** across the **textile value chain**.
- **India ranks 1st globally** in **cotton cultivation area**, with **114.84 lakh hectares**, accounting for nearly **38% of the world's cotton cultivation area**.
- India is the **2nd largest producer** and **2nd largest consumer** of cotton globally.
- **Cotton production** for **2025–26 (Provisional)** is estimated at **290.91 lakh bales (4.95 million tonnes)**.

About Cotton Corporation of India Limited (CCI)

- Established: 1970
- Headquarters: Navi Mumbai, Maharashtra
- Administrative Ministry: Ministry of Textiles (MoT)
- Chairman and Managing Director (CMD): Lalit Kumar Gupta

Ministry of Coal Releases 'AAROH: Annual Report on Mine Closure' to Promote Scientific Mine Closure and Sustainable Land Reuse

- The **Ministry of Coal (MoC)** released **'AAROH: Annual Report on Mine Closure'** in **New Delhi, Delhi**, showcasing **India's progress in scientific mine closure, ecological restoration, and sustainable post-mining land utilisation**.

- The report, prepared by the **Coal Controller Organisation (CCO)**, is **India's first comprehensive documentation** of **scientific coal mine closure and mine repurposing practices**.
- The report documents the successful scientific closure of **42 coal mines**, including **33 mines closed during the last year**, and serves as a **knowledge repository** for future mine closure and reclamation projects.

About Ministry of Coal:

- **Cabinet Minister:** G. Kishan Reddy
- **Constituency:** Secunderabad, Telangana
- **Ministers of State (MoS):** Satish Chandra Dubey

Government Constitutes High-Powered Exam Security Task Force to Strengthen Public Examination System

- The **Government of India** has constituted a **High-Powered Exam Security Task Force** to strengthen the country's examination system and prevent **paper leaks, impersonation, and examination malpractices**.
- The **six-member task force** will be chaired by **Infosys Co-founder Nandan Nilekani**.
- The committee has been formed to recommend **technology-driven reforms** for making **competitive examinations more secure, transparent, and credible**.

Uttarakhand to Radio-Collar Elephants Ahead of Haridwar Kumbh Mela 2027 to Enhance Human-Wildlife Safety

- The **Uttarakhand Forest Department**, in collaboration with the **Wildlife Institute of India (WII)**, has launched a **radio-collaring project** to monitor wild elephants ahead of the **Haridwar Kumbh Mela 2027**.
- The initiative aims to **minimise human-elephant conflict**, ensure the **safety of pilgrims**, and conserve wildlife by enabling **real-time tracking of elephant herds**.
- Under the project, **radio collars** will be fitted on the **lead elephants** of selected herds, allowing forest officials to monitor the movement of the entire herd, as elephants generally move together.

HCL Technologies to Establish Artificial Intelligence-Optimised Data Centre and Global Technology Centre in Odisha

- **HCL Technologies (HCLTech)** announced plans to establish an **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-optimised Data Centre** and a **Global Technology Centre** in **Bhubaneswar, Odisha**.

- The project will be developed in collaboration with the **Government of Odisha** and **Sarvam AI**, with an estimated investment of **₹15,000 crore**.
- The facilities will be established at the proposed **Odisha Sovereign Artificial Intelligence Park**, which aims to strengthen **India's sovereign Artificial Intelligence capabilities**.

About HCL Technologies (HCLTech)

- Founded: 1991
- Headquarters: Noida, Uttar Pradesh
- Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director: C. Vijayakumar

Digital India BHASHINI Division Organises 'BHASHINI Rajyam: State Engagement Workshop' in Goa to Promote Multilingual Artificial Intelligence

- The **Digital India BHASHINI Division (DIBD)**, under the **Digital India Corporation** and the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, in collaboration with the **Department of Information Technology, Electronics and Communications, Government of Goa**, organised the **'BHASHINI Rajyam: State Engagement Workshop'** in **Panaji, Goa**.
- The workshop aimed to **advance multilingual Artificial Intelligence (AI)** and strengthen **language-first Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI)**, with a special focus on the **Konkani language**.

About Digital India BHASHINI Division (DIBD)

- Headquarters: New Delhi
- Parent Organisation: Digital India Corporation
- Administrative Ministry: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)
- Chief Executive Officer (CEO): Amitabh Nag

Ministry of Information and Broadcasting Launches "Gems of India" Challenge to Promote Grassroots Digital Creators

- The **Ministry of Information and Broadcasting (MIB)** has launched the **Pilot Phase of the "Gems of India" Challenge**, a national initiative aimed at **identifying, nurturing and promoting grassroots digital creators** across India.
- The initiative focuses on strengthening India's **creative economy (Orange Economy)** by encouraging citizens to showcase the culture, heritage, tourism, traditions, history and unique achievements of their districts through digital storytelling.

- The challenge is implemented through **MyWAVES**, the citizen creator platform available under the **WAVES Over-The-Top (OTT) platform**, which enables users to create, upload and share original content.

About Ministry of Information and Broadcasting:

- Cabinet Minister: Ashwini Vaishnaw
- Constituency: Rajya Sabha, Odisha
- Ministers of State (MoS): L. Murugan

Gujarat Launches e-Zero First Information Report (e-Zero FIR) System for Faster Action Against Cyber Financial Frauds

- The **Government of Gujarat** launched the **e-Zero First Information Report (e-Zero FIR) System** to enable victims of **cyber financial fraud** to lodge complaints **without visiting a police station**.
- The system was launched by **Harsh Sanghavi**, **Minister of State for Home, Industries, Transport, Youth and Sports, Government of Gujarat**, in **Gandhinagar, Gujarat**.
- The initiative aims to **speed up cybercrime investigations**, **improve the chances of recovering defrauded money**, and make the **cybercrime reporting process faster and more citizen-friendly**.

BRICS Science Academies Forum Meeting 2026 Held at Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad, Telangana

- The **2nd BRICS (Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa) Science Academies Forum Meeting 2026** was held at the **Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad (IIT Hyderabad), Telangana**.
- The theme of the forum was **"Harnessing Artificial Intelligence for Sustainable Development and Strengthening Global South Cooperation"**.
- The meeting brought together representatives from **BRICS member countries and partner countries** to discuss the role of **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** in sustainable development and global cooperation.
- The forum focused on the **3C approach of Artificial Intelligence (AI)**:
    - **Collective approach**
    - **Collaborative approach**
    - **Context-sensitive approach**

About Indian National Science Academy (INSA)

- Established: 1935
- Headquarters: New Delhi
- President: Shekhar C. Mande
- Objective: Promote and advance scientific research, innovation, and international scientific cooperation.

About Telangana:

- **Chief Minister:** A. Revanth Reddy
- **Governor:** Shiv Pratap Shukla
- **Capital:** Hyderabad
- **National Parks:** Mahavir Harina Vanasthali National Park, Kasu Brahmananda Reddy National Park, Mrugavani National Park
- **Wildlife Sanctuaries:** Kawal Wildlife Sanctuary, Eturnagaram Wildlife Sanctuary, Kinnerasani Wildlife Sanctuary, Pakhal Wildlife Sanctuary, Pranahita Wildlife Sanctuary, Manjeera Wildlife Sanctuary, Shivaram Wildlife Sanctuary

Himachal Pradesh Launches Mukhyamantri Machhuara Samman Nidhi Yojana for Reservoir Fishermen

- **Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu**, **Chief Minister of Himachal Pradesh**, launched the **Mukhyamantri Machhuara Samman Nidhi Yojana** to provide **financial assistance and social security** to fishermen engaged in **reservoir fisheries** during the annual fishing ban period.
- The scheme aims to support fishermen whose livelihood is affected during the **temporary fishing ban period** and provide them with financial stability.
- The scheme will be implemented with an estimated annual expenditure of **₹1.20 crore** by the **Himachal Pradesh Government**.
- Under the scheme, eligible fishermen will receive lump-sum financial assistance **of ₹3,500 each** during the fishing ban period.

Indian Railways Approves ₹163 Crore Project to Upgrade Electric Traction System on Parbhani–Mudkhed Section

- **Indian Railways** has sanctioned a **₹163 crore** project to upgrade the **electric traction system** on the **Parbhani–Mudkhed double line section** in the **Nanded Division** of the **South-Central Railway (SCR)**.

- The project includes the upgradation of the existing **1×25 Kilovolt (kV) electric traction system** to the **2×25 kV electric traction system** along **164 Track Kilometres (TKM)**, along with associated **power supply infrastructure**.
- The upgraded **2×25 kV traction system** will provide a more reliable and efficient power supply, enabling the section to handle **higher freight and passenger traffic**.

About South-Central Railway

- Zone Headquarters: Secunderabad, Telangana
- Established: 1966
- General Manager: Shri Sanjay Kumar Srivastava

Assam Exports First International Consignment of Purabi Ice Cream to Bhutan

- **Assam** achieved a major milestone in its dairy sector by exporting the **first international consignment of 5,627 litres of Purabi Ice Cream** to **Bhutan**, marking the beginning of **value-added dairy exports** from the **North Eastern Region**.
- The export consignment was flagged off by **Chief Minister of Assam, Himanta Biswa Sarma**, in **Guwahati** on **28th July 2026**.

About Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA)

- Established: 1986
- Ministry: Ministry of Commerce and Industry
- Headquarters: New Delhi
- Chairman: Abhishek Dev

Government Allocates Record ₹95,692 Crore for Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) in FY 2026–27

- The **Government of India** has allocated **₹95,692 crore** for the **Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) [VB-G RAM (G)] Act, 2025** during the **Financial Year 2026–27**.
- **Union Minister for Rural Development, Shivraj Singh Chouhan**, informed the **Lok Sabha** that this is the **highest-ever Budget Estimate allocation** made for any **rural employment programme** in India.
- The **VB-G RAM (G) Act, 2025** provides a **statutory guarantee of 125 days of wage employment** in a financial year to every **willing rural household demanding work**.

Union Minister Bhupender Yadav Launches National Tiger Conservation Authority Eco-Tourism Webpage

- **Global Tiger Day** was celebrated on **29th July 2026** by the **National Tiger Conservation Authority (NTCA)** in **New Delhi** to promote **tiger conservation** and strengthen public awareness about protecting wildlife and natural habitats.
- **Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Bhupender Yadav**, addressed the event and called for a **conservation-oriented lifestyle** and a stronger societal connection with nature.
- The event was attended by **Union Minister of State for Environment, Forest and Climate Change Kirti Vardhan Singh**, senior government officials, wildlife experts, forest personnel, students, and other stakeholders.

About Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change:

- **Cabinet Minister:** Bhupender Yadav
- **Constituency:** Rajasthan
- **Ministers of State (MoS):** Kirti Vardhan Singh

Gulf of Khambhat (Kalpasar) Project: Gujarat's Coastal Freshwater Reservoir Initiative

- The **Government of Gujarat** has proposed the ambitious **Gulf of Khambhat Project, also known as the Kalpasar Project**, as a major **water resources development initiative**.
- The project aims to create one of the world's largest **coastal freshwater reservoirs** through the construction of a dam across the **Gulf of Khambhat, Gujarat**.
- The information regarding the project was provided by **Minister of State for Jal Shakti Raj Bhushan Choudhary** in a written reply to a question in the **Rajya Sabha**.

India Becomes the World's Second-Largest Supplier of Seafarers: BIMCO-ICS Seafarer Workforce Report 2026

- According to the **BIMCO-ICS Seafarer Workforce Report 2026**, **India** has become the **world's second-largest supplier of seafarers**, contributing **311,936 maritime professionals** to the global shipping industry.
- India now accounts for **12.16% of the global seafaring workforce**, ranking **second** after the **Philippines**, and ahead of **China**, the **Russian Federation**, and **Indonesia**.
- The report estimates the **global seafaring workforce** at **2.57 million**, while the global demand stands at **2.55 million**, highlighting a **shortage of qualified officers** in the maritime industry.

About BIMCO

- **Full Form: Baltic and International Maritime Council**
- **Headquarters: Denmark**

- The President of BIMCO for 2026 is **Paul Pathy**
- **Objective:** To represent the global shipping industry by promoting safe, efficient, and sustainable maritime trade.

About International Chamber of Shipping (ICS)

- **Headquarters: London, United Kingdom**
- **Established: 1921**
- **Objective:** To represent the interests of the global shipping industry and promote safe, secure, and environmentally sustainable shipping.

Delhi Government Approves Delhi Lakshmi Yojana to Provide Monthly Financial Assistance to Women

- The **Delhi Government** approved the **Delhi Lakshmi Yojana**, a welfare scheme aimed at the **economic empowerment and social security of women**.
- The decision was taken at a **Cabinet meeting** chaired by **Chief Minister Rekha Gupta** at the **Delhi Secretariat**.
- Under the scheme, **eligible women** will receive **financial assistance of ₹2,500 per month**.
- The **Delhi Government** has allocated **₹5,110 crore** for the implementation of the scheme in the **2026–27 Budget**.

India to Establish First Telecom Manufacturing Zone in Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh

- **Union Minister for Communications and Development of North Eastern Region, Jyotiraditya M. Scindia**, announced that **India's first Telecom Manufacturing Zone (TMZ)** will be established in **Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh**.
- The **Department of Telecommunications (DoT), Ministry of Communications**, and the **Government of Madhya Pradesh** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** for **Phase I** of the project at **Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi**, in the presence of **Chief Minister Mohan Yadav**.
- The **Telecom Manufacturing Zone (TMZ)** will be developed over **350 acres** on a **plug-and-play model**, with the **Central Government** providing **₹493 crore** as **100% financial assistance** for developing core infrastructure during the first phase.

About Ministry of Communications:

- **Cabinet Minister:** Jyotiraditya M. Scindia
- **Constituency:** Madhya Pradesh
- **Ministers of State (MoS):** Dr. Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani

President Droupadi Murmu Marks Four Years in Office with New Citizen-Centric Initiatives at

Rashtrapati Bhavan

- **President Droupadi Murmu** completed **four years in office**.
- To mark the occasion, she inaugurated and laid the foundation stones for several citizen-centric and sustainable initiatives at **Rashtrapati Bhavan** and the **President's Estates** on **28 July 2026**.
- The President launched an **e-Audio Guide** for visitors to **Rashtrapati Bhavan**, available in **Hindi, English and 14 other Indian languages**, along with a **sign language module** to improve accessibility for visitors.
- She launched the **third edition of e-Upahaar**, featuring **300 curated Presidential gifts** for public auction. The auction will be conducted from **5 August to 5 September 2026**.

Chhattisgarh Launches DWEEPTI Yojana to Empower Women in the Renewable Energy Sector

- **Chhattisgarh** has launched the **DWEEPTI Yojana (Decentralised Women Empowerment on Energy and Policy for Transformative Inclusion)**, the country's **first women-led distributed renewable energy policy**, aimed at empowering **rural women Self-Help Groups (SHGs)** in the solar energy sector.
- The scheme has been developed by the **Panchayat and Rural Development Department, Government of Chhattisgarh**, in collaboration with **Transform Rural India**, under the **Green Economy Transition Mission**.

Lok Sabha Passes Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026

- The **Lok Sabha** passed the **Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026** by a **voice vote** to strengthen the legal framework against the use of unfair means in public examinations and protect the interests of students and job aspirants.
- **Key provisions of the Amendment Bill include:**
    - Punishment for individuals using unfair means has been increased from **3–5 years** to **5–10 years** imprisonment, with the maximum fine raised from **₹10 lakh to ₹50 lakh**.
    - For **service providers** involved in examination malpractices, the maximum fine has been increased from **₹1 crore to ₹5 crore**, and the debarment period from conducting public examinations has been extended from **4 years to 8 years**.
    - Punishment for **directors and senior management** of service providers has been enhanced to **5–10 years' imprisonment**, along with a maximum fine of **₹5 crore**.

- Punishment for **organised examination-related crimes** has been increased from **5–10 years** to **7–10 years' imprisonment**, while the maximum fine has been enhanced from **₹1 crore to ₹10 crore**.

About Ministry of Earth Sciences:

- **Minister of State (Independent Charge):** Dr. Jitendra Singh
- **Constituency:** Udhampur, Jammu & Kashmir

10th India Mobile Congress 2026 to be Held in New Delhi with Theme "Scale without Boundaries"

- **Union Minister for Communications and Development of North Eastern Region Jyotiraditya M. Scindia** unveiled the theme **"Scale without Boundaries"** for the **10th edition of the India Mobile Congress (IMC) 2026**, which will be held from **7–10 October 2026** at **Yashobhoomi (India International Convention and Expo Centre), New Delhi**.
- Organised by the **Department of Telecommunications (DoT), Ministry of Communications**, and the **Cellular Operators Association of India (COAI)**, **India Mobile Congress (IMC)** is Asia's largest digital technology forum that brings together global technology companies, telecom operators, policymakers, startups, investors, researchers, and innovators.

INTERNATIONAL NEWS

United Arab Emirates Conducts Landmark Trial of First Inter-Emirate Etihad Rail Passenger Service

- The **United Arab Emirates (UAE)** successfully completed the inaugural trial run of the first **Etihad Rail passenger train** from **Fujairah to Mohamed bin Zayed City Station, Abu Dhabi**, marking a major milestone in the country's transport infrastructure.
- The Etihad Rail passenger service represents the **UAE's first inter-emirate passenger railway network**, designed to provide seamless rail connectivity across the emirates.
- The trial run marks the beginning of final testing operations before the start of commercial passenger services.
- Regular passenger services on the Etihad Rail network will commence on **30 September 2026**, connecting **Abu Dhabi, Dubai, Al Dhaid, and Fujairah**.
- The railway network will be expanded in phases, reaching the **Al Dhafra Region by December 2026** and **Sharjah by March 2027**.

About UAE :

- President : Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan

- Prime Minister : Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum
- Capital : Abu Dhabi
- Currency : Emirati dirham

Union Minister Piyush Goyal Concludes Official United Kingdom Visit Ahead of India–UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement Implementation

- **Union Minister Piyush Goyal**, Ministry of Commerce and Industry (MoCI), undertook a **3-day official visit to London, United Kingdom (UK)** from **25–27 June 2026**.
- The visit was held ahead of the implementation of the **India–UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA)** and the **Double Contribution Convention (DCC)**, both scheduled to come into force on **15 July 2026**.
- During the visit, Piyush Goyal held a high-level bilateral meeting with **Peter Kyle, UK Secretary of State for Business and Trade**, to discuss regulatory alignment, customs coordination, and the implementation of the India–UK CETA and DCC.

Mukesh Ambani, Sunil Bharti Mittal and Lakshmi N. Mittal Join International Telecommunication Union's Artificial Intelligence for Good Global Commission as Founding Members

- The **International Telecommunication Union (ITU)**, a **United Nations (UN)-backed agency**, launched the **Artificial Intelligence (AI) for Good Global Commission** in **Geneva, Switzerland**.
- The AI for Good Global Commission was launched with **44 founding members** to strengthen **global AI governance, digital inclusion, trust, and innovation frameworks**.
- India is represented among the founding members by **Mukesh Ambani** (Chairman & Managing Director of Reliance Industries), **Sunil Bharti Mittal** (Founder & Chairman of Bharti Enterprises Limited), and **Lakshmi N. Mittal** (Executive Chairman of ArcelorMittal S.A.).

Key Highlights of Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi's Official Visit to India

- Japanese Prime Minister **Sanae Takaichi** paid a **3-day official visit to India** from **1–3 July 2026** at the invitation of Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** to participate in the **16th India-Japan Annual Summit**.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi held a bilateral meeting with PM Sanae Takaichi at **Hyderabad House, New Delhi**, focusing on **economic cooperation**, **resilient semiconductor supply chains**, and **critical technologies**.
- The **16th India-Japan Annual Summit** was held in **New Delhi**, where both countries announced **16 key outcomes** to deepen bilateral cooperation.

- The **16 key outcomes** cover strategic sectors including **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, **economic security**, **clean energy**, **critical minerals**, **mobility**, **biotechnology**, **pharmaceuticals**, and **financial services**.

India Participates in Inaugural United Nations Global Dialogue on Artificial Intelligence Governance Led by Kirti Vardhan Singh

- **Union Minister of State (MoS) Kirti Vardhan Singh** represented India at the **inaugural United Nations (UN) Global Dialogue on Artificial Intelligence (AI) Governance** held in **Geneva, Switzerland**, from **6–7 July 2026**.
- Kirti Vardhan Singh represented both the **Ministry of External Affairs (MEA)** and the **Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)**.
- India reaffirmed its **"AI for All"** vision, advocating **responsible, inclusive, human-centric AI**, human rights protection, regulatory oversight, and safeguards against the **misuse of AI**.

World Intellectual Property Organization Report 2026 Highlights India as a Global Innovation Leader with 7.9% Growth in Intangible Investment

- The **World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO)** and **Luiss Business School (LBS)** jointly released the **3rd edition of the World Intangible Investment Report 2026**.
- The **World Intangible Investment Report 2026** highlights **India** as the **fastest-growing major economy in intangible investments** among the world's 15 largest economies.
- India's intangible investment reached **USD 78.2 billion in 2023**, registering an **annual growth of 7.9%**.
- India recorded the **highest intangible investment growth of 7.9%**, surpassing **Japan (4.8%)**, the **Philippines (4.6%)**, and the **United States of America (USA) (4.4%)**.
- According to the report, the **United States of America (USA), Japan, and Germany** were the **largest investors in absolute terms** in intangible investments.
- **Sweden, the United States of America (USA), and France** recorded the **highest intangible investment intensity** globally.

About World Intellectual Property Organization :

- **Formation :** 14 July 1967
- **Headquarters :** Geneva, Switzerland
- Director General **:** Daren Tang

- **Members :** 194 member states
- **Parent Organization :** United Nations Economic and Social Council

Prime Minister Narendra Modi Concludes Historic New Zealand Visit, Strengthening Bilateral Strategic Partnership

- **Prime Minister (PM) Narendra Modi** visited **New Zealand** from **10–11 July 2026** as the final leg of his **three-nation tour**, which included **Indonesia**, **Australia**, and **New Zealand**.
- The visit was made at the invitation of **Christopher Luxon**, Prime Minister of New Zealand.
- PM Narendra Modi arrived in **Auckland**, where he was received by PM Christopher Luxon, marking the **first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to New Zealand in 40 years**.

India Enhances Global Role in Food Safety Standards at the 49th Codex Alimentarius Commission (CAC49)

- **The 49th Session of the Codex Alimentarius Commission (CAC49)** was held from **6–11 July 2026** in **Geneva, Switzerland**, where **India** achieved major success in the development of **science-based global food standards**.
- At **CAC49**, **seven Codex standards and guidelines** developed under **India's chairmanship and co-chairmanship** were officially adopted, highlighting India's growing leadership in the **global food safety framework**.
- The **Government of India (GoI)** also secured approval for new work on developing a **Codex Standard for Cashew Kernels** under the **Codex Committee on Processed Fruits and Vegetables (CCPFV)**.
- The **Indian delegation** was led by **Rajit Punhani, Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** of the **Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI)**, along with technical experts from **FSSAI** and the **Spices Board**.

About Ministry of Health and Family Welfare :

- Cabinet Minister : J. P. Nadda
- Minister of State : Anupriya Patel, Prataprao Ganpatrao Jadhav

Ukraine and 9 European Countries Launch Anti-ballistic Missile Coalition to Strengthen Europe's Missile Defence

- **Ukraine and nine European countries** announced the formation of an **Anti-ballistic Missile Coalition** to strengthen Europe's defence against the growing ballistic missile threat.
- The announcement was made on the sidelines of the **Coalition of the Willing (CoW) Summit** held in **Paris, France**, which brought together over 30 countries and at least 25 Heads of State.

- The primary objective of the Anti-ballistic Missile Coalition is to develop a **shared ballistic missile defence capability** for Europe.
- The **10 founding members** of the coalition are **Ukraine, Denmark, France, Germany, Italy, the Netherlands, Norway, Spain, Sweden, and the United Kingdom (UK)**.

About Ukraine :

- President : Volodymyr Zelenskyy
- Prime Minister : Serhii Koretskyi
- Capital : Kyiv
- Currency : Ukrainian hryvnia

United Nations Issues First Global Scientific Artificial Intelligence Assessment, Calls for Stronger AI Governance

- The **United Nations (UN)** released the **Preliminary Report of the Independent International Scientific Panel on Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, the **first UN-commissioned scientific assessment** of Artificial Intelligence (AI).
- The report warns that **AI development is advancing faster than global governance** and urges governments to **strengthen AI regulatory frameworks** and **international cooperation**.
- The report was prepared by a **40-member Independent International Scientific Panel on AI**, comprising scientists and experts from **all five UN regions**.
- The panel is **co-chaired by Yoshua Bengio** (Turing Award laureate) and **Maria Ressa** (Nobel Peace Prize laureate).

About United Nations (UN) :

- **Established** : 1945
- **Headquarters** : New York City, the United States of America (USA)
- **Secretary-General** : António Guterres

SOFI 2026 Report: Global Hunger Eases Slightly, but SDG-2 Zero Hunger Target Remains Out of Reach

- The **United Nations (UN) Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)** released the **State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World (SOFI) 2026 report** titled **"Understanding and Addressing the High Cost of a Healthy Diet."**
- The report estimated that **645 million people** (**7.8% of the global population**) faced hunger in **2025**, showing a slight improvement from **8.1%** in the previous year.

- Despite this progress, the world remains off track to achieve **Sustainable Development Goal (SDG)-2: Zero Hunger by 2030**.

Zanzibar President Hussein Ali Mwinyi Pays Official Visit to India from 17–20 July 2026

- **President of Zanzibar** and **Chairman of the Revolutionary Council**, **Hussein Ali Mwinyi**, paid an **official visit to India** from **17–20 July 2026** at the invitation of **Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan**.
- The delegation included **First Lady Mariyam Mwinyi**, along with **ministers** and **senior government officials** from Zanzibar.
- **IIT Madras Zanzibar** is **India's first international IIT campus**, marking a significant milestone in India's global higher education outreach.

About Zanzibar :

- President : Hussein Mwinyi
- Capital : Zanzibar City
- Currency : Tanzanian shilling

France Becomes First European Union Nation to Ban Social Media Access for Children Under 15

- **France** became the **first country in Europe** to approve a law **banning children below the age of 15** from accessing **social media platforms**, aiming to protect minors from **harmful online content**, **digital addiction**, **cyberbullying**, and **online abuse**.
- The legislation was passed by both chambers of the **French Parliament** as a flagship initiative of **President Emmanuel Macron's government**.
- The law is part of France's broader strategy to strengthen **child safety**, **mental well-being**, and **responsible digital usage**.

About France :

- President : Emmanuel Macron
- Prime Minister : Sébastien Lecornu
- Capital : Paris

President Droupadi Murmu Concludes State Visits to Moldova, North Macedonia, and Romania (19–25 July 2026)

- **President Droupadi Murmu** undertook a week-long **State Visit** to **Moldova, North Macedonia, and Romania** from **19–25 July 2026** to strengthen **bilateral cooperation** in **trade, technology, tourism, education, innovation, and strategic partnerships**.

About Moldova :

- President : Maia Sandu
- Prime Minister : Vasile Tofan
- Capital : Chi□inău
- Currency : Moldovan leu

About North Macedonia :

- President : Gordana Siljanovska-Davkova
- Prime Minister : Hristijan Mickoski
- Capital : Skopje
- Currency : Macedonian denar

About Romania :

- President : Nicu□or Dan
- Prime Minister : Ilie Bolojan
- Capital : Bucharest
- Currency : Romanian leu

Sarnath Recognized as India's 45th United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization World Heritage Site

- The Ancient Buddhist Site of **Sarnath in Uttar Pradesh (UP)** was inscribed on the **United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization** (**UNESCO) World Heritage List** during the **48th Session of the World Heritage Committee (WHC)** held in **Busan, South Korea**.
- With this inscription, Sarnath became **India's 45th UNESCO World Heritage Site (WHS)** and the **4th UNESCO World Heritage Site in Uttar Pradesh**, after the **Taj Mahal, Agra Fort, and Fatehpur Sikri**.
- Sarnath was included in UNESCO's **Tentative List in 1998**, and India submitted its nomination dossier in **January 2025** for the **2025–26 World Heritage cycle**.

About UNESCO World Heritage Convention :

- The **UNESCO World Heritage Convention** is an international treaty adopted in **1972** to identify, protect, conserve, and preserve cultural and natural heritage of **Outstanding Universal Value (OUV)**.
- The Convention is officially known as the **"Convention Concerning the Protection of the World Cultural and Natural Heritage"** and is administered by the **UNESCO World Heritage Committee (WHC)**.

- World Heritage Sites are selected based on their **Outstanding Universal Value (OUV)** and must satisfy one or more of **UNESCO's 10 selection criteria**.
- The Convention recognizes **three categories of heritage**: **Cultural Heritage, Natural Heritage, and Mixed Heritage Sites**.
- The Convention promotes **international technical, financial, scientific, and conservation cooperation** among member countries for the protection of heritage sites.
- Countries that ratify the Convention are known as **State Parties** and are responsible for **identifying, protecting, conserving, and managing** their World Heritage Sites.
- India ratified the UNESCO World Heritage Convention in **1977**.

Confederation of Indian Textile Industry and European Apparel and Textile Confederation Launch EU–India Textile Dialogue to Facilitate India–EU FTA Implementation

- The **Confederation of Indian Textile Industry (CITI)** and the **European Apparel and Textile Confederation (EURATEX)** jointly launched the **EU–India Textile and Apparel Dialogue (TAD)** to strengthen bilateral cooperation and support the effective implementation of the **India–EU Free Trade Agreement (FTA)**.
- The **mandate for the EU–India Textile and Apparel Dialogue (TAD)** was signed on **14 July 2026** during **Bharat Tex 2026** in **New Delhi** by **Ashwin Chandran**, **Chairman of CITI**, and **Mario Jorge Machado**, **President of EURATEX**.
- The **EU–India Textile and Apparel Dialogue (TAD)** provides a **structured bilateral industry platform** for continuous dialogue between **Indian and European textile and apparel industries**.

APPOINTMENTS & RESIGNATIONS

Dilip Asbe Joins Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication Supervisory Board as India's Representative

- **Dilip Asbe**, Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of the **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)**, was appointed to the **Supervisory Board** of the **Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication (SWIFT)**.
- Dilip Asbe's appointment coincides with SWIFT's transition from a single-tier Board of Directors to a **two-tier governance structure** comprising a **Supervisory Board** and a **Management Board**.
- The SWIFT Supervisory Board will consist of **12 members**, expandable to 15 members in exceptional cases.

About NPCI:

- **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)** was established in **2008** as the umbrella organisation for retail payment systems in India.
- NPCI was promoted by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** and the **Indian Banks' Association (IBA)**.
- NPCI Headquarters: **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.
- Key Initiatives: Unified Payments Interface (UPI), Immediate Payment Service (IMPS), RuPay (domestic card payment network), Bharat Bill Payment System (BBPS), Aadhaar Enabled Payment System (AePS)

Appointments Committee of the Cabinet Approves Appointment of New Heads for Bureau of Police Research & Development, National Crime Records Bureau and Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel National Police Academy

- The **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)**, chaired by Prime Minister **Narendra Modi**, approved the appointments of senior **Indian Police Service (IPS)** officers to **three key police and law enforcement institutions** based on a proposal from the **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)**.
- **Alok Kumar Mittal**, a 1993-batch IPS officer of the **Haryana cadre**, was appointed as **Director General (DG)** of the **Bureau of Police Research & Development (BPR&D)**.

Mahesh Muralidhar Pai Named as South Indian Bank Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer with Reserve Bank of India Approval

- The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** approved the appointment of **Mahesh Muralidhar Pai** as the **Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** of **South Indian Bank (SIB)**.
- Mahesh Muralidhar Pai has been appointed for a **3-year term** effective from **1 October 2026**, subject to completion of all statutory and regulatory formalities.
- He will succeed **P. R. Seshadri**, who will remain in office until **30 September 2026** (having stepped down earlier from active responsibilities to pursue personal interests).
- Mahesh Muralidhar Pai currently serves as **Chief General Manager (CGM)** at **Canara Bank**.

About South Indian Bank:

- Founded Year: 1929
- Headquarters: Thrissur, Kerala, India
- Slogan: "Experience Next-Gen Banking"

InsuranceDekho Names Sourav Ganguly as Brand Ambassador, Unveils 'Khul Kar Khelo' Campaign

- **InsuranceDekho**, an **Insurtech platform**, appointed former Indian cricket captain **Sourav Ganguly** as its **Brand Ambassador**.
- Along with the appointment, InsuranceDekho launched the **'Khul Kar Khelo' campaign** to empower **insurance advisors** across India.
- **Theme:** The 'Khul Kar Khelo' campaign is inspired by Sourav Ganguly's **fearless leadership**, highlighting his role in supporting teammates and nurturing a generation of successful cricketers.
- **Objective:** The campaign aims to help insurance advisors **grow their businesses**, increase earnings, expand customer reach, and strengthen their role as **micro-entrepreneurs** while promoting **financial protection** for Indian families.

About InsuranceDekho :

- Founded : **2016**.
- Headquarters : **Gurugram, Haryana**.
- InsuranceDekho operates under the legal name **Girnar Insurance Brokers Private Limited**.

BI Veteran Baldev Prakash Takes Charge as MD & CEO of SBICAP Securities

- **SBICAP Securities**, the full-service brokerage arm and wholly-owned subsidiary of the State Bank of India (SBI), appointed **Baldev Prakash** as its **Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO)**.
- Baldev Prakash joined SBICAP Securities on deputation from SBI, where he was serving as **Deputy Managing Director (DMD)** and **Group Chief Risk Officer (GCRO)**.
- He brings more than **35 years of experience** in banking and financial services.
- His expertise covers **retail banking, corporate banking, foreign exchange, digital banking, risk management, and financial services**.

OpenAI Appoints Prabhjeet Singh as India Managing Director and Unveils GPT-5.6 AI Model Family

- **OpenAI** has appointed **Prabhjeet Singh**, former Head of Uber India and South Asia, as the **Managing Director (MD) for India Operations**.
- As Managing Director, Prabhjeet Singh will lead **consumer growth, enterprise adoption, and strategic partnerships** for OpenAI in India.
- OpenAI also announced the limited preview release of its latest AI model family, **GPT-5.6**.

- The GPT-5.6 rollout will be **phased**, while the company coordinates with the **United States (U.S.) Government** for wider public availability.
- GPT-5.6 introduces **three variants**: **Sol (flagship model)**, **Terra (mid-tier model)**, and **Luna (base model)**.

Air Marshal Tejinder Singh Assumes Charge as Chief of Integrated Defence Staff

- **Air Marshal Tejinder Singh** assumed charge as the **Chief of Integrated Defence Staff to the Chairman Chiefs of Staff Committee (CISC)** on **1 July 2026**.
- He was commissioned into the **Fighter Stream of the Indian Air Force (IAF)** on **13 June 1987**.
- He is a **Category 'A' Qualified Flying Instructor** with over **4,500 hours of flying experience**.
- He has commanded a **Fighter Squadron**, a **Radar Station**, a premier **Fighter Base**, and served as **Air Officer Commanding (AOC), Jammu & Kashmir**.
- Before becoming CISC, he served as the **Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief (AOC-in-C), South Western Air Command**.

Lt Gen Sandeep Jain Takes Charge as Vice Chief of the Army Staff

- **Lt Gen Sandeep Jain, AVSM, SM** assumed the appointment of **Vice Chief of the Army Staff (VCOAS)**.
- Lt Gen Sandeep Jain is an alumnus of the **National Defence Academy (NDA)** and was commissioned into the **MAHAR Regiment** in **June 1988**.
- He has nearly **four decades of distinguished military service**, holding numerous command and staff appointments across diverse operational environments.
- He has commanded an **Infantry Battalion** in semi-desert terrain and also during the **United Nations Mission in South Sudan (UNMISS)**.
- His command appointments include an **Infantry Brigade in a Strike Corps**, a **Counter Insurgency Force**, and a **Pivot Corps in Northern Command**.

Government Reappoints Central Board of Direct Taxes Chairman Ravi Agrawal for an Additional Six-Month Term

- The **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)** has reappointed **Ravi Agrawal** as the Chairman of the **Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT)** on a contract basis for six months, from **1 July 2026 to 31 December 2026**, or until further orders, whichever is earlier.
- Ravi Agrawal was first appointed as CBDT Chairman in **June 2024**, succeeding **Nitin Gupta**.

- His initial one-year tenure was extended by another year in **June 2025**, and has now been extended again through a **six-month contractual reappointment**.
- The reappointment will be governed by the usual terms and conditions applicable to **re-employed Central Government officers**.
- For this reappointment, the Government of India relaxed the relevant **Recruitment Rules**.

Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit Assumes Charge as Vice Chief of the Air Staff of the Indian Air Force

- **Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit, PVSM, AVSM, VM, VSM** assumed charge as the **Vice Chief of the Air Staff (VCAS), Indian Air Force (IAF)** on **1 July 2026**.
- He succeeded **Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor, SYSM, PVSM, AVSM, VM**, who superannuated on 30 June 2026 after 40 years of distinguished service.
- Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit was commissioned into the **Fighter Stream of the Indian Air Force** on **6 December 1986**.
- He is an alumnus of the **National Defence Academy (NDA)**, Defence Services Staff College (Bangladesh), and the **National Defence College (NDC)**.
- He has over **3,500 hours of flying experience** and is an **Experimental Test Pilot** as well as a **Qualified Flying Instructor**.

Anupam Misra Assumes Charge as Chairman and Managing Director of Hindustan Copper Limited

- **Anupam Misra** assumed charge as the **Chairman and Managing Director (CMD)** of **Hindustan Copper Limited (HCL)**.
- **Anupam Misra** succeeded **Sanjiv Kumar Singh**, who **superannuated on 30 June 2026**.
- He holds a **B.Tech. (Hons.) in Civil Engineering from IIT Kharagpur**, a **PGDM from IIM Lucknow**, and has completed **Executive Programmes at IIM Ahmedabad and IIM Calcutta**.
- **Anupam Misra** is a management professional with over **33 years of experience** in **marketing, international trade, and business development**.
- Prior to joining HCL, he served as **Director (Marketing)** at **Fertilisers and Chemicals Travancore Limited (FACT)** from **July 2020 to June 2026**.

About Hindustan Copper Limited :

- **Founded :** 1967

About Ministry of Mines :

- Cabinet Minister : G. Kishan Reddy
- Minister of State : Satish Chandra Dubey

Biswanath Sinha Assumes Office as Chief Secretary of Kerala

- **Biswanath Sinha**, a **1992-batch Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officer** of the **Kerala cadre**, assumed charge as the **Chief Secretary (CS) of Kerala**.
- Biswanath Sinha's tenure as Chief Secretary of Kerala will **continue until September 2028**.
- He succeeded **Dr. A. Jayathilak**, a 1991-batch IAS officer, who **retired on 30 June 2026**.
- Biswanath Sinha has over **three decades of administrative experience** in **internal security, police administration, vigilance, and disaster management**.

Tamil Nadu Appoints Former Indian Space Research Organisation Scientist Mylswamy Annadurai to Head School Education Curriculum Design Committee

- **Government of Tamil Nadu (TN)** appointed former Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) scientist **Mylswamy Annadurai** as the **Chairman of the Curriculum Design Committee (CDC)** for School Education for a **3-year tenure**.
- The **Curriculum Design Committee (CDC)** will lead **curriculum modernization** for around **1.3 crore students** across Tamil Nadu.
- The primary objective is to strengthen **Science, Technology, Artificial Intelligence (AI), critical thinking skills**, and bridge the gap between teaching and learning systems.
- **Mylswamy Annadurai** served as a scientist at **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** from **1982 to 2018**.
- He is popularly known as the **"Moon Man of India"** for his significant contributions to India's space programme.

Ravi Shankar Takes Charge as Executive Director of the Reserve Bank of India

- The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** appointed **Ravi Shankar** as **Executive Director (ED)** with effect from **1 July 2026**.
- As Executive Director, Ravi Shankar will oversee the **Department of Statistics and Information Management (DSIM)**.
- Before his promotion, Ravi Shankar was serving as **Adviser-In-Charge** of the **Department of Statistics and Information Management (DSIM)**.
- Ravi Shankar is a central banker and statistician with **over three decades of experience** at the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).
- During his RBI career, he has worked in the areas of **banking statistics, corporate data, government securities markets, settlement systems, debt management**, and **economic analysis**.

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Bijay Kumar Mohanty Takes Over Additional Charge as Chairman and Managing Director of Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency Limited

- **Bijay Kumar Mohanty**, currently serving as **Director (Finance)** and **Chief Financial Officer (CFO)** of **Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency Limited (IREDA)**, has assumed **additional charge** as **Chairman and Managing Director (CMD)** of IREDA.
- His appointment is effective from **1 July 2026** for a period of **three months**, following the **superannuation of Pradip Kumar Das** on **30 June 2026**.
- **Bijay Kumar Mohanty** also serves on the Board of **IREDA Global Green Energy Finance IFSC Limited**, a wholly-owned subsidiary of IREDA.

Former Chief Election Commissioner Rajiv Kumar Named Part-Time Chairman of HDFC Bank

- **HDFC Bank Limited** appointed **Rajiv Kumar**, former **Chief Election Commissioner (CEC)** of India, as its **Part-Time Chairman** for a period of **3 years**, effective from the date of approval by the **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)**.
- **Rajiv Kumar** has also been appointed as an **Additional Independent Director** on the Board of HDFC Bank for a **4-year term**, effective from **30 June 2026**.
- He will succeed **Keki Mistry**, who was serving as the **Interim Chairman** of HDFC Bank.
- **Keki Mistry** was appointed as Interim Chairman after **Atanu Chakraborty** voluntarily stepped down in **March 2026**, citing ethical concerns and issues inconsistent with his personal values.

About HDFC Bank:

- Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India
- Managing Director & CEO: Sashidhar Jagdishan
- Tagline: "We understand your world"

Rear Admiral (Retd.) C. Raghuram Takes Over as Chairman & Managing Director of Hindustan Shipyard Limited

- **Rear Admiral (Retd.) Chadrasekhran (C.) Raghuram** assumed charge as the **Chairman and Managing Director (CMD)** of **Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL)** at Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh.
- C. Raghuram succeeded **Captain Ganti Venkateswarlu**, who had been holding the additional charge of CMD since **January 2026**.
- C. Raghuram was commissioned into the **Indian Navy (IN)** on **10 November 1989**.
- He brings over **35 years of experience** in **naval engineering, ship maintenance, and strategic planning**.

Keiko Fujimori Elected as President of Peru After 2026 Runoff Victory

- **Keiko Fujimori**, leader of the conservative **Popular Force Party**, was declared the winner of **Peru's 2026 Presidential Election** after a closely contested runoff.
- Keiko Fujimori is scheduled to assume office on **28 July 2026** as the **President of Peru**.
- She will succeed interim President **José María Balcázar**.
- With her swearing-in, Keiko Fujimori will become Peru's **10th President in a decade**, reflecting the country's prolonged political instability.
- Keiko Fujimori is the daughter of former Peruvian President **Alberto Fujimori**.
- She is one of the most prominent leaders of the **Fujimorism** political movement in Peru.

About Peru :

- Capital : Lima
- Currency : Peruvian sol

United States Federal Reserve Appoints Three Indian-Origin Experts to Head Monetary Policy Review Task Forces

- The **United States Federal Reserve (US Fed)** appointed three Indian-origin experts—**Raghuram Rajan**, **Raj Chetty**, and **Asha Sharma**—to lead three of its five task forces reviewing the US Federal Reserve's **Monetary Policy Framework**.
- The five task forces were announced by **US Federal Reserve Chair Kevin Warsh** as part of a comprehensive review of the Fed's monetary policy framework.
- **Raghuram Rajan**, Professor of Finance at the University of Chicago Booth School of Business and former Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), was appointed to head the **Balance Sheet Policy Task Force**.
- The **Balance Sheet Policy Task Force** will review the **costs, benefits, and institutional implications** of the Federal Reserve's balance sheet framework.
- **Raj Chetty**, Professor of Economics at Harvard University and Director of Opportunity Insights, was appointed to lead the **Data Task Force**.
- The **Data Task Force** will focus on improving the **quality, accuracy, and timeliness** of economic data used for monetary policy decision-making.
- **Asha Sharma**, Executive Vice President (EVP) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of the Microsoft Xbox Division, was appointed to head the **Productivity and Jobs Task Force**.

About US Fed :

- The **United States Federal Reserve (US Fed)** was established in **1913** and serves as the **central banking system** of the United States.
- Chair : Kevin Warsh
- The US Fed conducts a comprehensive review of its monetary policy framework **approximately every five years** to improve policy effectiveness and adapt to changing economic conditions.

Dr. Srinivasa Kumar Tummala Takes Charge as Secretary of the Ministry of Earth Sciences

- **Government of India (GoI)** appointed **Dr. Srinivasa Kumar Tummala** as the new **Secretary, Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)**.
- The appointment was approved by the **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)** for a **tenure of 2 years** from the date of assuming office or until further orders, whichever is earlier.
- Before this appointment, **Dr. Srinivasa Kumar Tummala** served as the **Head of the Indian Ocean Tsunami Warning and Mitigation System (IOTWMS) Secretariat** under the **UNESCO Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (UNESCO-IOC)** in **Perth, Australia**.

Ukraine's Parliament Confirms Serhii Koretskyi as New Prime Minister

- **Ukraine's Parliament (Verkhovna Rada)** approved the appointment of **Sergii Koretskyi** as the **Prime Minister (PM)** of Ukraine, succeeding **Yulia Svyrydenko**.
- **Sergii Koretskyi** was serving as the **Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** of **Naftogaz of Ukraine**, the country's state-owned energy company, before becoming Prime Minister.
- He secured **289 votes** in the **450-member Verkhovna Rada**, obtaining parliamentary approval for his appointment as Prime Minister.

Vivek Nishant Nath Appointed as Director (Commercial) of NMDC Limited

- **Shri Vivek Nishant Nath** has assumed charge as **Director (Commercial)** of **NMDC Limited**, India's largest iron ore producer, following his appointment by the **Ministry of Steel, Government of India (GoI)**.
- He has been appointed as Director (Commercial) on the NMDC Board for a **5-year tenure** from the date of assuming charge, or until further orders, whichever is earlier.

Mindaugas Sinkevičius Assumes Office as the 20th Prime Minister of Lithuania

- **Mindaugas Sinkevičius**, leader of the **Lithuanian Social Democratic Party (LSDP)**, was sworn in as the **20th Prime Minister (PM) of Lithuania**.
- He assumed office after the **Lithuanian Parliament (Seimas)** approved the **government manifesto** presented by the **LSDP-led coalition**.

- **Mindaugas Sinkevičius** succeeded **Inga Ruginienė**, who **stepped down on 14 July 2026**.

About Lithuania :

- President : Gitanas Nausėda
- Capital : Vilnius
- Currency : Euro

Amitabh Bachchan Becomes Brand Ambassador for Policybazaar's Insurance Awareness Campaign

- **Policybazaar**, India's leading online insurance marketplace, appointed **Amitabh Bachchan** as its **Brand Ambassador** to lead the nationwide awareness campaign **"Parivaar Sabse Pehle" (Family Comes First)**.
- The **"Parivaar Sabse Pehle"** campaign has been developed by **MagicCircle Communications** to promote awareness about **health insurance** and **term insurance** across India.

About Policybazaar :

- Founded : **2008** and is a **PB Fintech Limited** company.
- Headquarters : **Gurugram, Haryana**.
- **Joint Group Chief Executive Officer (CEO) and Executive Director (ED) : Sarbvir Singh**

Harjit Singh Grewal Appointed as New Chairperson of the National Commission for Minorities

- **Harjit Singh Grewal** was appointed as the **Chairperson** of the **National Commission for Minorities (NCM)**, with the appointment notified by the **Ministry of Minority Affairs**.
- The Chairperson's post had remained vacant since **April 2025** after the completion of the tenure of **Iqbal Singh Lalpura**.
- **Harjit Singh Grewal** will serve a **3-year tenure** from the date of assuming office or until further orders.
- Along with him, **Munawari Begum** was appointed as the **Vice-Chairperson**, and **Glenn E. Souza Ticlo** was appointed as a **Member** of the NCM.
- The **National Commission for Minorities (NCM)** is a **Statutory Body** constituted under the **National Commission for Minorities Act, 1992**.
- The NCM functions at the **Union Government level** and addresses matters concerning **notified minority communities** in India.
- The Commission consists of a **Chairperson**, **Vice-Chairperson**, and **Members**, all appointed by the **Central Government**.

Rahul Himalian Takes Additional Charge as Chairman & Managing Director of Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited

- The **Ministry of Railways (MoR)** appointed **Rahul Himalian**, Director (Tourism & Marketing), **Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited (IRCTC)**, as the additional **Chairman & Managing Director (CMD)** of IRCTC.
- **Rahul Himalian** succeeds **Sanjay Kumar Jain**, following his resignation as CMD of IRCTC.
- His appointment as additional **CMD of IRCTC** will take effect from **20 July 2026**.
- He will continue to hold his existing position as **Director (Tourism & Marketing)**, IRCTC, while serving as additional CMD.

About IRCTC :

- **Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation Limited (IRCTC)** was established in **1999**.
- IRCTC is a **Schedule 'A' Navratna Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE)** under the **Ministry of Railways (MoR)**.
- **IRCTC** is responsible for **railway ticketing**, **catering**, **tourism**, and **hospitality services** across Indian Railways.
- **Headquarters of IRCTC**: **New Delhi, Delhi**.

About Ministry of Railways :

- Cabinet Minister : Ashwini Vaishnaw
- Minister of State : V. Somanna, Ravneet Singh Bittu

Senegal President Bassirou Diomaye Faye Elected Economic Community of West African States Chairman

- **Bassirou Diomaye Diakhar Faye**, **President of Senegal**, was elected as the new **Chairman** of the **Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS)** during the **69th Ordinary Session** of the **ECOWAS Authority of Heads of State and Government** held in **Freetown, Sierra Leone**.
- **Bassirou Diomaye Diakhar Faye** will serve a **mandatory one-year term** as **ECOWAS Chairman** and succeeded **President Julius Maada Bio of Sierra Leone**, who had served as ECOWAS Chairman since **June 2025**.
- **Senegal** assumed the **ECOWAS Chairmanship** for the **first time** since the establishment of ECOWAS in **1975**.

About Senegal :

- Prime Minister : Ahmadou Al Aminou Lo

- Capital : Dakar
- Currency : West African CFA franc

Andy Burnham Sworn In as the New Prime Minister of the United Kingdom

- **Andy Burnham** became the **59th Prime Minister (PM)** of the **United Kingdom (UK)** after **Keir Starmer** resigned from the post.
- **King Charles III** invited **Andy Burnham** to **Buckingham Palace** to form the new government through the traditional **"kissing hands"** ceremony.
- **Andy Burnham** secured nearly **55% of the vote** in the **Labour Party leadership election**, defeating **Reform UK's Robert Kenyon** by a margin of more than **9,000 votes**.
- The leadership election recorded a record **voter turnout of 59%**.

Government Appoints Anurag Jain as New Chief Executive Officer of National Institution for Transforming India Aayog

- The **Government of India (GoI)** appointed **Anurag Jain** as the new **Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** of **NITI (**National Institution for Transforming India**) Aayog**, with the appointment approved by the **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)** through the **Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT)**.
- **Anurag Jain** assumed charge **with immediate effect** for a **tenure of two years or until further orders, whichever is earlier**.

About NITI Aayog :

- **NITI Aayog (National Institution for Transforming India)** was established on **1 January 2015**, replacing the **Planning Commission**.
- **NITI Aayog** is the **Government of India's premier public policy think tank**, responsible for promoting **cooperative federalism**, **policy innovation**, and **sustainable development**.
- The **Prime Minister of India** is the **Chairperson of NITI Aayog**, while the **CEO** is appointed by the **Central Government** to oversee its **administration and policy implementation**.

Kanishka Narayan Appointed as the United Kingdom's First Minister for Artificial Intelligence in Prime Minister Andy Burnham's Cabinet

- **Kanishka Narayan**, a Bihar-born British-Indian **Labour Member of Parliament (MP)**, has been appointed as the United Kingdom's **first Minister for Artificial Intelligence (AI)** under the government led by **Prime Minister Andy Burnham**.

- The appointment marks the creation of the United Kingdom's **first dedicated ministerial portfolio for Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, reflecting the country's growing focus on **AI governance** and **technological innovation**.
- The **Artificial Intelligence (AI) portfolio** will function jointly under the **Cabinet Office** and the **Department for Business, Innovation, Science and Trade**.

Indian Administrative Service Officer Keshav Chandra Takes Charge as Secretary of the Ministry of Mines

- **Shri Keshav Chandra**, a 1995-batch **Indian Administrative Service (IAS)** officer of the **AGMUT cadre**, assumed charge as the **Secretary, Ministry of Mines**, Government of India.
- **Keshav Chandra** succeeded **Piyush Goyal**, who was appointed as the **Secretary General** of the **National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)**.
- Before assuming his new role, **Keshav Chandra** served as the **Chairperson** of the **New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC)**.

About Ministry of Mines :

- Cabinet Minister : G. Kishan Reddy
- Minister of State : Satish Chandra Dubey

Infosys Names Ashiss Kumar Dash as CEO Designate and Future Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer

- **Infosys Limited**, **India's second-largest Information Technology (IT) services company**, appointed **Ashiss Kumar Dash** as its **Chief Executive Officer (CEO) Designate**.
- **Ashiss Kumar Dash** will assume charge as the **Managing Director (MD) & CEO** of **Infosys** from **1 April 2027**, following the completion of **Salil Parekh's second term**.
- **Ashiss Kumar Dash** has been appointed for a **five-year term (2027–2032)**, subject to **shareholders' approval**.
- **Salil Parekh** will continue as **Managing Director (MD) & CEO** until **31 March 2027** to ensure a **smooth leadership transition**.

About Infosys Limited :

- **Founded : 1981**
- Headquarters : **Bengaluru, Karnataka**.

Five-Time World Chess Champion Viswanathan Anand Assumes Charge as Interim FIDE President

- **Viswanathan Anand**, **India's five-time World Chess Champion** and **Deputy President of the International Chess Federation (FIDE)**, assumed charge as the **Interim President of FIDE**.
- **Viswanathan Anand** took over as **Interim President** after **FIDE President Arkady Vladimirovich Dvorkovich** voluntarily **suspended his duties**.
- **Arkady Dvorkovich** stepped aside following **sanctions imposed by the European Union (EU)** and **Switzerland** over **Russia's war against Ukraine**.
- **Viswanathan Anand** is the **only Indian** to have won the **World Chess Championship five times**, making him one of the greatest chess players in history.

Pralhad Joshi Assumes Additional Charge as India's Union Education Minister

- **Union Minister Pralhad Venkatesh Joshi**, currently heading the **Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution (MoCAF&PD)** and the **Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)**, was assigned additional charge as the **10th Union Minister of Education**.
- **Pralhad Venkatesh Joshi** assumed the additional responsibility following the resignation of **Dharmendra Pradhan** at **Kartavya Bhavan, New Delhi, Delhi**.
- **President Droupadi Murmu**, acting on the advice of **Prime Minister Narendra Modi**, accepted the resignation of **Dharmendra Pradhan** with immediate effect under **Clause (2) of Article 75 of the Constitution of India**.

Bangladesh President Mohammed Shahabuddin Steps Down Due to Health Reasons

- **Bangladesh President Mohammed Shahabuddin** resigned from office nearly **two years before completing his five-year term**, citing serious health problems, including **autonomic neuropathy**, which occasionally causes loss of consciousness.
- **Mohammed Shahabuddin**, a former judge and veteran of **Bangladesh's 1971 Liberation War**, assumed office as the **22nd President of Bangladesh in April 2023**.
- **Parliament Speaker Hafiz Uddin Ahmad** accepted the resignation and, under **Article 54 of the Constitution of Bangladesh**, assumed charge as the **Acting President**.
- Under **Article 54 of the Constitution of Bangladesh**, the **Acting President** will discharge presidential duties until a **new President is elected by Parliament**.

About Bangladesh :

- **Capital :** Dhaka
- **Currency :** Taka

Appointments Committee of the Cabinet Appoints Satya Pal Kumar as New Director of Financial Intelligence Unit–India

- The **Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)** appointed **Satya Pal Kumar**, a **2005-batch Indian Revenue Service (IRS)** officer of the Income Tax cadre, as the **Director of the Financial Intelligence Unit–India (FIU-IND)** under the **Department of Revenue (DoR), Ministry of Finance (MoF)**.
- The appointment was made as part of a **Joint Secretary-level reshuffle**, and **Satya Pal Kumar** succeeded **Pankaj Kumar Mishra** (IRS, 1989 batch), who had served as Director of FIU-IND since **May 2016**.
- **Satya Pal Kumar** has been appointed for a **5-year tenure** at the rank of **Joint Secretary to the Government of India (GoI)**.

About Financial Intelligence Unit–India (FIU-IND) :

- The **Financial Intelligence Unit–India (FIU-IND)** is the national financial intelligence agency responsible for **receiving, processing, analysing, and disseminating** information relating to **suspect financial transactions** to various law enforcement and regulatory agencies.
- **FIU-IND** was established in **2004**, functions under the **Department of Revenue (DoR), Ministry of Finance (MoF)**, and is headquartered in **New Delhi, Delhi**.

AWARDS AND HONOURS

R. Vairamuthu Conferred 60th Jnanpith Award 2025

- **Tamil poet, lyricist, and writer R. Vairamuthu** was conferred the **60th Jnanpith Award (2025)**, India's highest literary honour, at a ceremony held in **New Delhi**.
- The award was presented by **Dr. Karan Singh**, noted scholar and statesman, in recognition of **R. Vairamuthu's outstanding contribution to Tamil literature**.
- With this honour, **R. Vairamuthu** became the **third Tamil writer from Tamil Nadu** to receive the **Jnanpith Award**, after a gap of **24 years**.

About the Jnanpith Award

- Established: 1961
- Presented by: Bharatiya Jnanpith
- Purpose: To honour lifetime outstanding contribution to Indian literature.
- Eligibility: Authors writing in any of the languages listed in the Eighth Schedule of the Constitution of India.

72nd National Film Awards 2026 Winners Announced

- The **72nd National Film Awards** were announced in **New Delhi** to honour the best Indian films certified by the **Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC)** between **1 January 2024 and 31 December 2024**.
- The awards were selected by a **jury headed by Malayalam filmmaker Jayaraj**.
- **Major Winners:**
  - **Best Feature Film: Article 370**
  - **Best Actor: Kartik Aaryan** (*Chandu Champion*) and **Mammootty** (*Bramayugam*)
  - **Best Actress: Yami Gautam** (*Article 370*)
  - **Best Director: Rajkumar Periasamy** (*Amaran*)
  - **Best Feature Film Providing Wholesome Entertainment: Kalki 2898 AD**
  - **Best Film Promoting National & Social Values: Captain Miller**

Prime Minister Narendra Modi Conferred Indonesia's Highest Civilian Award 'Bintang Adipurna'

- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** was conferred the **'Bintang Adipurna'**, the **highest civilian award of Indonesia**, by **President Prabowo Subianto** during his official visit to **Jakarta, Indonesia**.
- The award recognises **Prime Minister Modi's outstanding contribution to strengthening India–Indonesia bilateral relations** and promoting **international cooperation**.
- The honour was presented at **Istana Merdeka (Presidential Palace)** in **Jakarta**.
- **Bintang Adipurna** is Indonesia's **highest non-military civilian honour**, awarded to individuals for their exceptional contribution to **strengthening relations with Indonesia, promoting** friendship, and enhancing international cooperation.
- Accepting the award, **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** dedicated the honour to the **1.4 billion people of India** and thanked the **Government and people of Indonesia** for the recognition and warm hospitality.

Nita Ambani Receives American Association of Physicians of Indian Origin (AAPI) Humanitarian Award 2026

- **Nita Ambani**, **Founder and Chairperson of Reliance Foundation**, received the **American Association of Physicians of Indian Origin (AAPI) Humanitarian Award** during the **American Association of Physicians of Indian Origin (AAPI) Annual Convention 2026**, held in **Tampa, Florida, United States of America (USA)**.
- The award was presented by **Dr. Amit Chakrabarty**, **President of the American Association of Physicians of Indian Origin (AAPI)**, in recognition of her contributions to **healthcare,**

education, sports, culture, rural transformation, women's empowerment, disaster response, and preservation of India's arts and cultural heritage through the **Reliance Foundation**.

About American Association of Physicians of Indian Origin (AAPI)

- Established: 1982
- Headquarters: United States of America (USA)
- President: Dr. Amit Chakrabarty
- Objective: To represent physicians of Indian origin practising in the United States of America (USA) and promote professional excellence, healthcare initiatives, medical education, and community service.

Acharya Ranchhodlal Goswami Selected for Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar 2025

- **Acharya Ranchhodlal Goswami from Ahmedabad, Gujarat**, has been selected for the **Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar 2025, announced by the Sangeet Natak Akademi under the Union Ministry of Culture for the 2024–25 awards cycle.**
- He has been honoured for his outstanding contribution to the preservation and promotion of **Haveli Sangeet**, a traditional devotional music **form associated with the Pushtimarg tradition.**
- Acharya Ranchhodlal Goswami, aged **32 years**, is the **16th-generation Acharya of the historic Goswami Haveli located in Doshiwada ni Pol, Kalupur, Ahmedabad.**
- The tradition preserves early forms of Indian classical music, **including Prabandha, Dhrupad, and Dhamar, which later influenced the development of Khayal singing.**

Department of Telecommunications (DoT) Wins World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) Prize 2026 for Samriddh Gram Initiative

- The **Department of Telecommunications (DoT)**, under the **Ministry of Communications**, won the **World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) Prize 2026** for its flagship **Samriddh Gram: Integrated Phygital Service Delivery Model**, enabled by the **BharatNet** initiative.
- The award was presented during the **World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) Forum 2026** held in **Geneva, Switzerland**, under **Action Line C6 – Enabling Environment**.
- **Samriddh Gram** is a rural digital transformation initiative built on the **BharatNet** broadband network to convert digital connectivity into socio-economic opportunities by establishing **Samriddhi Kendras** in villages across India.

About Department of Telecommunications (DoT)

- Ministry: Ministry of Communications

- Union Minister for Communications: Jyotiraditya M. Scindia
- Headquarters: New Delhi

About International Telecommunication Union (ITU)

- Established: 1865
- Headquarters: Geneva, Switzerland
- Specialized Agency of: United Nations (UN)
- Director-General: Doreen Bogdan-Martin

Prime Minister Narendra Modi Conferred Seychelles' 'Guardian of the Blue Horizon' Presidential Honour

- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** was conferred the **'Guardian of the Blue Horizon' Presidential Honour** by **President Dr. Patrick Herminie** of **Seychelles**.
- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** became the **first recipient** of this prestigious civilian honour instituted by the **Republic of Seychelles**.
- The award recognises exceptional leadership in **climate action**, **environmental conservation**, **Blue Economy**, **sustainable ocean governance**, and support for **Small Island Developing States (SIDS)**.
- The honour is expected to further strengthen **India-Seychelles cooperation** in **sustainable development**, **Blue Economy**, and **maritime security** in the **Indian Ocean Region (IOR)**.

Sunil Bharti Mittal Receives 2026 US-India Strategic Partnership Forum Leadership Award

- **Sunil Bharti Mittal**, Founder and Chairman of **Bharti Enterprises**, received the **2026 Leadership Award** from the **US-India Strategic Partnership Forum (USISPF)**.
- He was honoured for his **outstanding contribution to strengthening economic and commercial ties between India and North America**.
- The award was presented during the **9th US-India Strategic Partnership Forum (USISPF) Annual Leadership Summit** held in **Washington, D.C., United States**.
- The event also marked the growing **India-United States commercial partnership** ahead of the **250th Independence Day of the United States**.
- The **US-India Strategic Partnership Forum (USISPF) Leadership Award** recognises individuals who have made exceptional contributions to strengthening **economic, commercial, and strategic relations between India and the United States**.

About US-India Strategic Partnership Forum (USISPF)

- Established: 2017

- Headquarters: Washington, D.C., United States

Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) Wins Gold at National Awards for e-Governance 2026 for Artificial Intelligence (AI)-Powered Mental Health Platform

- The **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)** received the **Gold Award** at the **National Awards for e-Governance 2026** under the category **"Innovation through the Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Other New Age Technologies to Deliver Citizen-Centric Services."**
- The award was conferred for **ICMR-MINDS**, an **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-powered mental health management platform** designed to improve access to quality mental healthcare across India.
- The award was presented during the **29th National Conference on e-Governance (NCeG)**, held in **Jaipur, Rajasthan**, on **1–2 July 2026**.
- **Dr. Jitendra Singh**, **Union Minister of State for Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions**, presented the award to the **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)**.

About Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)

- Established: 1911 (as Indian Research Fund Association); renamed Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) in 1949
- Headquarters: New Delhi
- Parent Ministry: Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
- Director General: Dr. Rajiv Bahl

American Filmmaker James Gray to Receive Pardo alla Carriera at 79th Locarno Film Festival 2026

- **American filmmaker James Gray** will be honoured with the prestigious **Pardo alla Carriera (Honorary Career Leopard Award)** at the **79th Locarno Film Festival** on **9 August 2026**.
- The award will be presented before the screening of his latest film, **Paper Tiger**, at **Piazza Grande**, one of **Europe's largest open-air cinemas**, in **Locarno, Switzerland**.
- The **Pardo alla Carriera** recognises filmmakers for their **lifetime contribution to world cinema** and their enduring influence on the global film industry.
- As part of the festival, James Gray's acclaimed films **We Own the Night (2007)** and **Two Lovers (2008)** will also be screened.
- James Gray made his directorial debut with **Little Odessa (1994)**, which won the **Silver Lion Award** at the **Venice Film Festival**.

Ajit Doval Selected for Lokmanya Tilak National Award 2026

- **National Security Advisor (NSA) Ajit Doval** has been selected for the **44th Lokmanya Tilak National Award 2026** for his outstanding contribution to **India's national security, counter-terrorism strategy, covert operations, and border management**.
- The award will be presented by **Union Minister of Home Affairs Amit Shah** at a ceremony in **Pune, Maharashtra on 1 August 2026**, marking the **106th death anniversary of freedom fighter Bal Gangadhar Tilak**.
- The award comprises a **memento, citation, and cash prize of ₹1 lakh**.
- The announcement was made by **Dr Rohit Tilak, President of Lokmanya Tilak Smarak Trust**, in Pune in the presence of **Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis** and **Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde**.

DEFENCE NEWS

Indian Navy to Induct INS Mahendragiri, Sixth Indigenous Project 17A Stealth Frigate

- The **Indian Navy (IN)** is set to commission its **sixth Project 17A indigenous stealth frigate**, **INS Mahendragiri (F38)**, at **Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh**, on **11 July 2026**.
- INS Mahendragiri is named after the **Mahendragiri mountain range** in the Eastern Ghats and is the **first Indian Naval warship** to bear this name.
- INS Mahendragiri has been designed in-house by the Indian Navy's **Warship Design Bureau (WDB)**.
- The frigate has been constructed by **Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL), Mumbai**.
- **Project 17A** is India's programme for building advanced indigenous stealth frigates with **enhanced combat capabilities**.
- INS Mahendragiri incorporates **advanced stealth features**, **enhanced survivability**, **reduced radar signature**, and a **high degree of automation**.
- The warship is powered by a **Combined Diesel or Gas (CODOG) propulsion system**, enabling high-speed operations with long endurance.

India and Rwanda Strengthen Defence Cooperation at the 2nd Joint Defence Cooperation Committee Meeting

- The **2nd Joint Defence Cooperation Committee (JDCC) Meeting** between **India and Rwanda** was held in **New Delhi** on **6–7 July 2026**.
- The meeting focused on expanding **bilateral defence cooperation** in the areas of **military training**, **joint military exercises**, **medical cooperation**, and **defence industries**.

- Both countries agreed on an **Implementation Plan** with **defined timelines** for the action items arising from the JDCC meeting.
- The meeting was **co-chaired** by **Amitabh Prasad**, Joint Secretary, Ministry of Defence (India), and **Brigadier General Louis Kanobayier**, Chief for Joint Force Development, Training and Doctrine (Chief J7), **Rwanda Defence Force (RDF) Headquarters**.
- The Indian delegation included representatives from the Department of Defence, **Department of Defence Production (DDP)**, **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)**, Ministry of External Affairs (MEA), **Armed Forces Medical Services (AFMS)**, Headquarters Integrated Defence Staff (HQ IDS), and the Indian Armed Forces.

About Rwanda :

- President : Paul Kagame
- Prime Minister : Justin Nsengiyumva
- Capital : Kigali
- Currency : Rwandan franc (RWF)

Jawahar Institute of Mountaineering & Winter Sports Pahalgam Leads 22-Member Mountaineering Expedition to Mt Khyam Tso Massif in Ladakh

- The **Jawahar Institute of Mountaineering & Winter Sports (JIM & WS), Pahalgam** successfully conducted a **22-member mountaineering expedition** to the **Mt Khyam Tso Massif** in the **Rumtse Phu region, Ladakh**.
- The expedition was **flagged off on 26 June 2026** by Team Leader **Col Hem Chandra Singh**.
- After a structured acclimatization programme in Ladakh, the team **successfully summited Peak Pt 5901M on 2 July 2026** despite extreme weather conditions.
- During the expedition, **Col Hem Chandra Singh** achieved a **historic first-ever paragliding flight** from an altitude of **5,600 metres** from Peak Pt 5901M.

Adani Defence to Establish ₹2,500 Crore Missile Production Facility in Madhya Pradesh

- **Adani Defence and Aerospace**, part of the Adani Group, invested **₹2,500 crore** to establish **South Asia's largest private-sector missile ecosystem** in **Shivpuri, Madhya Pradesh (MP)**.
- The **foundation stone** of the facility was laid by **Mohan Yadav**, Chief Minister of Madhya Pradesh, and **Jyotiraditya Scindia**, Union Minister for Communications.
- The Shivpuri facility aims to create an **end-to-end indigenous missile ecosystem** for the production of **medium- and long-range missile systems**.

- The project will become **India's first private-sector defence complex** to integrate **composite propellant production**, **Trinitrotoluene (TNT) manufacturing**, and **missile system integration** at a single location.

Defence Research & Development Organisation Successfully Conducts Flight Test of Pinaka Long-Range Guided Rocket with 60 km Minimum Range

- **Defence Research & Development Organisation (DRDO)** successfully conducted the flight test of the **Pinaka Long Range Guided Rocket (LRGR)** at the **Integrated Test Range (ITR), Chandipur, Odisha**.
- The Pinaka LRGR was successfully tested for a user-defined **minimum range of 60 kilometres (km)**.
- During the trial, the Long Range Guided Rocket (LRGR) successfully executed all planned in-flight manoeuvres and **struck the target with exact precision**, following the predicted trajectory.

About DRDO:

- Founded: 1958
- Headquarters: New Delhi, India
- Parent Ministry: Ministry of Defence, Government of India
- Chairman: Rajesh Kumar Singh

Bisleri International Joins Hands with Indian Coast Guard to Promote Coastal Sustainability

- **Bisleri International Private Limited** signed a **Letter of Association (LoA)** with the **Indian Coast Guard (ICG) (Kerala and Mahe)** to promote **plastic waste management** and environmental sustainability across coastal regions.
- The collaboration is being implemented through Bisleri's flagship initiative **Bottles for Change (BFC)**, expanding its reach to coastal and marine ecosystems.
- The initiative reinforces Bisleri International's commitment to **environmental sustainability and marine conservation**.
- The agreement is aligned with the Indian Coast Guard's mission – **"Plastic Free Oceans"**.
- The LoA was signed by **Dr. Angelo George**, Chief Executive Officer (CEO), Bisleri International, and **Ashish Mehrotra**, Deputy Inspector General (DIG), Indian Coast Guard.

About Bisleri International :

- **Established: 1969**

- **Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra**
- **Known For: Bisleri bottled water and premium beverage products.**

Indian Army to Acquire 450 Carl Gustaf M4 Launchers to Boost High-Altitude Firepower

- **Indian Army** issued a **Request for Proposal (RFP)** in **July 2026** to procure **450 Carl Gustaf Mark-IV (M4) 84 mm lightweight recoilless rocket launchers**.
- The **Carl Gustaf M4** is a **shoulder-fired, multi-role recoilless rifle system** designed for **infantry support**, **anti-armour operations**, **bunker destruction**, and battlefield combat.
- The Carl Gustaf weapon system is developed by **Saab, Sweden**, and has been in service with the Indian Army since **1974** through earlier **M2 and M3 variants**.
- The **M4 variant weighs less than 7 kg**, compared to 14 kg (M2) and 10 kg (M3), significantly **improving mobility and endurance**, especially in **high-altitude regions**.
- The Carl Gustaf M4 will be **manufactured in India** at Saab's facility in **Reliance MET City, Jhajjar, Haryana**.

INS Sudarshini Joins Grand Parade of Sails at Sail Boston 2026 During Lokayan 2026 Voyage

- **Indian Naval Sail Training Ship (STS) INS Sudarshini** arrived at **Boston, United States of America (USA)** on **12 July 2026** after successfully participating in the **Sail4th 250 celebrations at New York**.
- INS Sudarshini participated in the **Grand Parade of Sails**, marking the commencement of **Sail Boston 2026**.
- **Shri Raghuram Sastry**, Consul General of India in Boston, embarked on INS Sudarshini during the Grand Parade of Sails and the ship's ceremonial entry into Boston.

India and Japan Hold 8th Defence Policy Dialogue to Strengthen Strategic Defence Cooperation

- **India and Japan** held the **8th Defence Policy Dialogue** in **Tokyo, Japan**, on **13 July 2026** to strengthen bilateral defence and strategic cooperation.
- The Indian delegation was led by **Defence Secretary Shri Rajesh Kumar Singh**, while the Japanese delegation was headed by **Vice Minister of Defence for International Affairs Mr. Kano Koji**.
- Both countries reviewed the progress made since the previous dialogue and reaffirmed their commitment to further strengthening the **India–Japan Special Strategic and Global Partnership**.
- The dialogue included discussions on the **regional and global security environment** and exchanged views on issues of **mutual strategic interest**.

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Indian Navy's INS Surat and Japan's JS Takanami Conduct Joint Naval Exercise off Mumbai Coast

- The **Japan Maritime Self-Defence Force (JMSDF)** warship **JS Takanami (DD-110)** conducted a **Passage Exercise (PASSEX)** with the Indian Navy warship **INS Surat** off the coast of **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.
- The PASSEX focused on **validating communication procedures, tactical manoeuvres**, and **enhancing interoperability** between the Indian Navy and the Japan Maritime Self-Defence Force (JMSDF).
- The exercise reflects the strengthening **India–Japan Strategic Partnership** and their shared commitment to a **Free, Open, Secure, and Rules-Based Indo-Pacific Region**.

Raksha Rajya Mantri Sanjay Seth Reviews Canteen Services Department at 80th Board of Control Canteen Services Meeting in Ranchi

- **Raksha Rajya Mantri Sanjay Seth** reviewed the functioning of the **Canteen Services Department (CSD)** during the **80th meeting of the Board of Control Canteen Services (BOCCS)** held in **Ranchi, Jharkhand**, on **14 July 2026**.
- The meeting focused on improving **operational efficiency**, **administrative reforms**, and enhancing **service quality** for serving **Defence personnel**, **Ex-servicemen**, and their **dependents**.
- Major agenda items included **enhancement of budgetary support** for CSD, **modernisation of CSD depots**, extension of Central and State Government **subsidies on electric two-wheelers (EVs)** purchased through CSD, **induction of cooperative products** into the supply chain, and **human resource-related reforms**.

Indian Navy to Conduct Operation Southern Readiness 26-2 at Kochi's Southern Naval Command

- **Indian Navy** will host **Operation Southern Readiness 26-2** at the **Southern Naval Command, Kochi (Kerala)** from **20–23 July 2026** as a **four-day multinational maritime training engagement**.
- The exercise will be conducted in partnership with the **Combined Maritime Forces (CMF)** under the aegis of **Combined Task Force 154 (CTF 154)**, the Indian Navy-led and CMF's dedicated **Training Task Force**.
- The exercise will bring together personnel from **CMF Partner Nations** to strengthen **professional maritime security training**, gain **practical operational experience**, and exchange **Best Practices**.

Indian Navy to Commission INS Malvan, the Latest Indigenous ASW Shallow Water Craft

- **The Indian Navy** will commission **INS Malvan** on **22 July 2026**, the **second Mahe-class Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC)**.
- The commissioning ceremony will be presided over by **Air Chief Marshal A.P. Singh, Chief of the Air Staff**, in the presence of **Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan**, Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief (FOC-in-C), **Western Naval Command**.
- **INS Malvan** has been built by **Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL), Kochi**, showcasing India's growing capability in **indigenous naval shipbuilding**.
- The warship has **over 80% indigenous content**, reflecting the success of the **Aatmanirbhar Bharat** initiative in the defence sector.

Indian Air Force Joins Australia's Exercise Pitch Black 2026 with Rafale Fighter Jets

- **The Indian Air Force (IAF)** is participating in **Exercise Pitch Black 2026**, the **Royal Australian Air Force (RAAF)'s** premier **biennial multinational air combat exercise**, scheduled from **20 July to 7 August 2026** at **RAAF Base Darwin, Northern Australia**.
- **Exercise Pitch Black** derives its name from its focus on **night flying** over the vast unpopulated regions of **Northern Australia** and has a **45-year history** as one of the world's leading **multinational air warfare exercises**.
- The **2026 edition** features one of the **largest-ever multinational contingents**, bringing together military personnel for **Large Force Employment (LFE) missions** and **multinational air combat operations**.

India Launches Operation Amistad for Earthquake Relief in Venezuela

- **India** launched **Operation Amistad**, a **Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief (HADR)** mission, to assist **Venezuela** after devastating magnitude **7.2 and 7.5 earthquakes** caused heavy loss of life, injuries, and widespread destruction.
- **Operation Amistad** reflects India's solidarity with the Government and people of Venezuela and highlights India's commitment to providing **humanitarian assistance** during natural disasters.
- The term **"Amistad"** is a Spanish word meaning **"Friendship"**, symbolizing India's support and cooperation with Venezuela during the crisis.
- As part of the mission, **two Indian Air Force (IAF) C-17 Globemaster aircraft** were deployed to transport humanitarian relief and rescue teams to the affected areas.

About Venezuela :

- President : Delcy Rodríguez
- Capital : Caracas

- Currency : Venezuelan bolívar

Indian Air Force Successfully Concludes the 5th Warfare & Aerospace Strategy Programme

- The **5th edition of the Capstone Seminar**, marking the successful culmination of the **Warfare & Aerospace Strategy Programme (WASP)**, was held on **29 June 2026**.
- The seminar was graced by **Chief of the Air Staff (CAS) Air Chief Marshal A.P. Singh** as the Chief Guest.
- The event was attended by **former Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) General Anil Chauhan (Retd.)**, former Chiefs of the Air Staff, and distinguished defence veterans, highlighting the programme's strategic significance.
- The **Capstone Seminar** is the concluding event of the **six-month Warfare & Aerospace Strategy Programme (WASP)**.
- **WASP** is jointly conducted by the **Centre for Aerospace Power and Strategic Studies (CAPSS), New Delhi**, and the **College of Air Warfare (CAW), Hyderabad**.

Indian Navy Joins 30th Edition of RIMPAC 2026 Maritime Exercise in Hawaii, United States of America

- **Indian Navy (IN)** participated in the **30th edition of Rim of the Pacific (RIMPAC) 2026**, the world's largest multinational maritime warfare exercise, hosted by the **United States (US) Navy** under the U.S. Pacific Fleet at **Joint Base Pearl Harbor-Hickam (JBPHH)**, Hawaii,United States of America(USA).
- RIMPAC 2026 is being conducted from **24 June to 31 July 2026** as a five-week biennial multinational maritime warfare exercise in and around the Hawaiian Islands.
- The theme of RIMPAC 2026 is **"Partners: Integrated and Prepared"**, highlighting collective defence readiness, interoperability, and a shared commitment to a free, open and inclusive Indo-Pacific.

Defence Acquisition Council Clears ₹52,000 Crore Defence Procurement Proposals to Strengthen Armed Forces

- The **Defence Acquisition Council (DAC)**, chaired by Raksha Mantri **Rajnath Singh**, accorded **Acceptance of Necessity (AoN)** to multiple defence acquisition proposals on **3 July 2026**.
- The **total value of the AoN approvals is approximately ₹52,000 crore**.
- **Acceptance of Necessity (AoN)** is the in-principle administrative approval required before the procurement of defence equipment.

- For the **Indian Army**, DAC approved the procurement of **AKASH TARANG Anti-Unmanned Aerial Vehicles (UAV) Electronic Warfare System**, **Man Portable Anti-Tank Guided Missile (MPATGM) Systems**, **Medium Range Surface-to-Air Missile (MRSAM) Weapon System**, **Very Short Range Air Defence System (V-SHORADS)**, **Active Protection System (APS) for Tanks**, and **Jet-Based Kamikaze Drone System**.

General Dhiraj Seth Launches 'VIJAY' Roadmap to Transform the Indian Army into a Future-Ready Force

- **General Dhiraj Seth** assumed charge as the **31st Chief of the Army Staff (COAS)** of the **Indian Army (IA)** and unveiled the **'VIJAY' roadmap** to build a technology-driven, future-ready military force.
- **VIJAY** stands for **Vigilance, Innovation, Jointness and Integration, Aatmanirbharta, and Yodha first**.
- The VIJAY roadmap is aligned with the **Ministry of Defence (MoD)**'s **'Decade of Transformation (2023–2032)'**, focusing on transforming the Indian Army into a digitized, technology-enabled, self-reliant (**Aatmanirbhar**), and multi-domain-capable force.
- The **VIJAY framework** was developed under the direction of the Chief of the Army Staff (COAS) and will be implemented across all **operational commands of the Indian Army**.

United States of America Hands Over 21st MH-60R Seahawk to Indian Navy, Boosting Bilateral Defence Cooperation

- The **United States of America (USA)** delivered the **21st MH-60R Seahawk multi-role maritime helicopter** to the **Indian Navy (IN)** at **Kochi, Kerala**, further strengthening the **India–USA defence partnership** and enhancing India's **maritime security capabilities**.
- The induction of the **MH-60R Seahawk** will enhance the **Indian Navy's operational readiness**, strengthen its **Anti-Submarine Warfare (ASW)** capabilities, and improve **interoperability** with the **United States Navy (US Navy)** in the **Indian Ocean Region (IOR)**.
- India signed a **Foreign Military Sales (FMS) Agreement** with the **USA** in **February 2020** to procure **24 MH-60R Seahawk helicopters** at a total cost of **USD 2.6 billion**.

Indian Air Force Retains World's Third-Ranked Independent Air Force Position in World Directory of Modern Military Aircraft 2026 Rankings

- The **Indian Air Force (IAF)** has retained its position as the **World's 3rd Most Powerful Independent Air Force** for the **5th consecutive year** in the **World Directory of Modern Military Aircraft (WDMMA) 2026 Global Air Power Rankings**.
- In the **Independent Air Force Rankings**, only the **United States** and **Russia** rank above the **Indian Air Force (IAF)**, placing **India at 3rd position globally**.
- The **World Directory of Modern Military Aircraft (WDMMA)** assessed **129 air services** across **103 countries** using its **True Value Rating (TVR)** system.

Defence Research and Development Organisation Signs Two Strategic Industry Agreements to Advance the AEW&C Mk-II Programme

- **Centre for Air Borne Systems (CABS),** Defence Research and Development Organisation **(DRDO)** signed a contract with **AI Engineering Services Limited (AIESL), New Delhi** for the conversion of **six Airbus A321 aircraft** from commercial to **green configuration** under the **Airborne Early Warning & Control (AEW&C) Mk-II Programme**.
- **CABS, DRDO** also signed a separate contract with **Adani Defence Systems and Technologies Limited (ADSTL), Ahmedabad** to serve as the **Development-cum-Production Partner (DcPP)** for the **Mission Systems** of the **AEW&C Mk-II Programme**.

Rajnath Singh Welcomes Completion of India's First Tri-Service All-Women Global Sailing Expedition

- **Raksha Mantri Shri Rajnath Singh** flagged-in **'Samudra Pradakshina'**, the **first-ever Tri-Service all-women circumnavigation sailing expedition**, through **video conferencing** on **22 July 2026**.
- The expedition was carried out aboard the **Indian Army Sailing Vessel (IASV) Triveni**, with **9 women officers** from the **Indian Army, Indian Navy, and Indian Air Force** successfully completing the historic mission.
- The expedition lasted **314 days**, covered nearly **25,500 nautical miles**, and traversed **4 oceans**, making it one of India's most significant **Tri-Service maritime expeditions**.

India Successfully Develops First Indigenous 350 kg Thrust Class Expendable Turbojet Engine

- India achieved a major milestone in **indigenous aero-engine technology** with the successful development of the country's **first indigenous Expendable Turbojet Engine** in the **350 kg thrust class**.
- The engine was designed and developed by the **Gas Turbine Research Establishment (GTRE)** under the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)**.

- **Azad Engineering, Hyderabad**, was selected by GTRE as the **industry partner** for the **manufacturing and assembly** of the engine.

Defence Research and Development Organisation Successfully Conducts Maiden Flight Test of Indigenous Kusha Long-Range Surface-to-Air Missile

- The **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** successfully conducted the maiden flight test of the **'Kusha' Long-Range Surface-to-Air Missile (LR-SAM)** from **APJ Abdul Kalam Island** off the coast of **Odisha**.
- During the flight test, the **Kusha LR-SAM** successfully intercepted an **electronic target** simulating a **high-speed, high-altitude aerial threat**, demonstrating its **precision**, **accuracy**, and **operational readiness**.
- The **Kusha** is an **indigenously developed long-range air defence missile system** designed to provide **multi-layered aerial defence** against a wide range of airborne threats.
- The missile system is capable of intercepting and neutralising **fighter aircraft**, **stealth aircraft**, **Unmanned Aerial Vehicles (UAVs)**, **cruise missiles**, **Precision-Guided Munitions (PGMs)**, and selected classes of **ballistic missiles** over an **extended range and altitude**.
- The **M1 interceptor missile** is a **short-to-medium-range variant** capable of destroying aerial targets up to **150 km**.
- The **M2 interceptor missile** is a **medium-to-long-range variant** with an **operational range of 250 km**.
- The **M3 interceptor missile** is the **long-range variant**, capable of intercepting threats at distances of **350–400 km**, providing **extended air defence coverage**.

About DRDO:

- Founded: 1958
- Headquarters: New Delhi, India
- Parent Ministry: Ministry of Defence, Government of India
- Chairman: Rajesh Kumar Singh

Raghu Vamsi Aerospace Announces ₹600 Crore Investment for Superalloy Manufacturing Plant in Telangana

- **Raghu Vamsi Aerospace Group** announced an investment of **over ₹600 crore** to establish an **integrated nickel-based superalloy manufacturing facility** in **Telangana**.
- The announcement was made during the **Farnborough International Airshow 2026** held in the **United Kingdom (UK)**, one of the world's leading **aerospace and defence exhibitions**.

- The project aims to strengthen **India's domestic manufacturing capabilities** for **high-performance nickel-based superalloys** and reduce the country's **dependence on imports**.
- The project will be led by **Dr. S. K. Jha**, former Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of **Mishra Dhatu Nigam Limited (MIDHANI)**, India's premier **special metals manufacturer**.

About Raghu Vamsi Aerospace Group :

- **It** was established in **2015** and is headquartered in **Hyderabad, Telangana**.
- The company is a **precision manufacturing and deep-tech enterprise** serving the **aerospace**, **defence**, and **energy sectors**.

ACQUISITIONS & MERGERS

Fairfax Emerges as Preferred Bidder to Acquire 60.72% Stake in IDBI Bank

- Canada-based **Fairfax Financial Holdings Limited (Fairfax)** emerged as the **preferred bidder** to acquire a **60.72% stake** in **IDBI Bank Limited** from the **Government of India (GoI)** and **Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC)**.
- The proposed acquisition is valued at **Rs. 52,932 crore (approximately USD 5.5 billion)**, making it one of the largest banking acquisition deals in India.
- If approved, the transaction will become the **largest foreign investment in an Indian bank**, subject to regulatory approvals.

About IDBI Bank Limited :

- Established : **1964**
- Headquartered in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.
- **MD & CEO : Rakesh Sharma**
- Tagline : **"Bank Aisa Dost Jaisa."**

State Bank of India Joins Global Banking Consortium to Fund Sun Pharma's US$11.75 Billion Organon Acquisition

- **State Bank of India (SBI)** plans to join a consortium of global lenders to finance **Sun Pharmaceutical Industries'** acquisition of US-based **Organon & Co.** in an overseas deal valued at **US$11.75–12 billion**, subject to board approval.
- **SBI** is expected to commit up to **US$1 billion**, becoming the **only Indian bank** participating in the syndicated loan alongside global lenders such as **Citigroup**, **JPMorgan Chase**, and **Mitsubishi UFJ Financial Group (MUFG)**.

- Around **US$10 billion** of the acquisition cost will be **financed through debt**, while **Sun Pharma** will contribute approximately **US$1.75 billion as equity**.

State Bank of India Acquires National Housing Bank's 10% Stake in RMBS Development Company Limited.

- **State Bank of India (SBI)**, India's largest and oldest **Public Sector Bank (PSB)**, acquired the **National Housing Bank's (NHB's) 10% stake** in **RMBS Development Company Limited (RDCL)**.
- **RDCL** is a **Middle-Layer Non-Banking Financial Company (NBFC)** focused on developing the **Residential Mortgage-Backed Securities (RMBS)** market in India.
- Following the acquisition, **NHB's shareholding** in RDCL **declined from 39% to 29%**.
- The acquisition is expected to strengthen RDCL's role in developing a **deeper secondary mortgage market** in India.
- **RDCL** enables banks and non-bank lenders to **pool housing loans**, convert them into **tradable securities**, **unlock capital**, **improve liquidity**, and support **fresh housing lending**.

About RDCL :

- **RMBS Development Company Limited (RDCL)** was established in **2024**.
- **RDCL** was incorporated with a **paid-up capital of ₹500 crore**.
- **Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC)** holds a **10% stake** in RDCL.
- **HDFC Bank**, **ICICI Bank**, and **Bajaj Finance** each hold a **7% stake** in RDCL.
- **Aditya Birla Housing Finance**, **Tata Capital Housing Finance**, **Truhome Finance**, **Grihum Housing Finance**, **Hero Housing Finance**, and **IIFL Home Finance** each hold a **5% stake** in RDCL.

About National Housing Bank (NHB) :

- **Founded :** 9 July 1988
- **Headquarters :** New Delhi, India
- **Managing Director :** Sanjay Shukla
- **Chairman :** Prabhanjan Mohapatra
- **National Housing Bank (NHB)** is the **apex housing finance institution** in India and plays a key role in promoting the **housing finance ecosystem**.

TPG and Partners Acquire Aseem Infrastructure Finance Limited to Strengthen Climate Infrastructure Finance

- **TPG Inc.**, a global alternative asset management firm, signed definitive agreements to acquire a **100% stake** in **Aseem Infrastructure Finance Limited (AIFL)** from the **National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF)** and other shareholders for an undisclosed amount.
- The acquisition will be carried out through **TPG Rise Climate**, TPG's dedicated climate investing platform, in partnership with the **Government of Singapore Investment Corporation (GIC)** and **ICICI Bank Limited**.

About Aseem Infrastructure Finance Limited :

- **Aseem Infrastructure Finance Limited (AIFL)** was established in **2020** as a **sustainable infrastructure debt financier**.
- AIFL is headquartered in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.
- AIFL was incubated by the **National Investment and Infrastructure Fund (NIIF)** to promote **infrastructure financing** and **sustainable development**.

Aviva to Become the First Foreign Company with 100% Ownership of an Indian Life Insurance Business

- **Aviva Plc (United Kingdom)** announced the acquisition of the remaining **26% stake** in **Aviva Life Insurance Company India Limited (Aviva India)** from its Joint Venture (JV) partner, **Dabur Invest Corp. (DIC)**.
- With this acquisition, Aviva Plc will increase its shareholding from **74% to 100%**, becoming the **first foreign insurer to achieve 100% ownership** of its Indian life insurance business.
- The acquisition follows the Government of India's decision to allow **100% Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)** in the insurance sector in **May 2026**.

State Bank of India Divests 1.42% Stake in SBI Funds Management Through Pre-Initial Public Offering Placement

- **State Bank of India (SBI)** sold a **1.42% stake** in its asset management subsidiary **SBI Funds Management Limited (SBIFM)** through a **pre-Initial Public Offering (IPO) placement**, raising **₹1,655 crore**.
- SBI sold **2.88 crore equity shares** to **30 institutional investors** at **₹574 per share**, which was the upper end of the IPO price band.
- The pre-IPO placement was completed ahead of the **₹11,700 crore IPO**, which is scheduled to open on **14 July 2026**.
- The 30 institutional investors included **Tata AIG General Insurance**, **Go Digit General Insurance**, **360 ONE Funds**, and **Bennett Coleman**, among others.

About SBI Funds Management Limited (SBIFM) :

- **SBI Funds Management Limited (SBIFM)** is **India's largest Asset Management Company (AMC)** and operates as a **joint venture** between **State Bank of India (SBI)** and **Amundi**, Europe's largest asset manager.

Competition Commission of India Approves ₹16,660 Crore Acquisition of Royal Challengers Bengaluru by Aditya Birla-Led Consortium

- The **Competition Commission of India (CCI)** has approved the **₹16,660 crore all-cash acquisition** of **Royal Challengers Sports Pvt. Ltd. (RCSPL)**, the owner of the **Royal Challengers Bengaluru (RCB)** franchises in both the Indian Premier League (IPL) and the Women's Premier League (WPL).
- The acquiring consortium is led by the **Aditya Birla Group** and includes **The Times of India Group** (Times Internet Ltd. and Times Cricket), **Bolt Ventures**, Blackstone-backed **Asia Investment Topco II**, and **ICONIQ Group**.
- The ₹16,660 crore transaction values RCB at approximately **USD 1.78 billion**, making it one of the **largest acquisitions of an IPL franchise**.
- The acquisition reflects the **rapidly growing commercial value** of sports franchises and rising investor interest in India's sports ecosystem.

Mediterranean Shipping Company Group to Acquire 49% Stake in Adani Vizhinjam Port for ₹13,220 Crore

- Switzerland-based **Mediterranean Shipping Company (MSC) Group**, the **world's largest container shipping company**, will acquire a **49% stake** in **Adani Vizhinjam Port Pvt. Ltd. (AVPPL)** for **US$1.397 billion (around ₹13,220 crore)**, subject to regulatory approvals.
- The investment will be made through **Terminal Investment Ltd. (TiL)**, the **port operating and investment arm** of the MSC Group.
- The transaction values **Adani Vizhinjam Port Pvt. Ltd. (AVPPL)** at approximately **US$2.85 billion (around ₹26,960 crore)**, making it one of the **largest foreign investments** in India's port sector.
- The deal is regarded as the **largest foreign private investment** in India's domestic port infrastructure.

Competition Commission of India Clears Anantam Highways Trust's Acquisition of Seven Special Purpose Vehicles and InvIT Unit Allotment to Build India Infrastructure Fund, Dilip Buildcon and DIPL

- **The Competition Commission of India (CCI)** approved the proposed combination involving the **acquisition of seven Special Purpose Vehicles (SPVs)** by **Anantam Highways Trust (InvIT)** and the **issuance of InvIT units** to **Build India Infrastructure Fund (BIIF)**, **Dilip Buildcon Limited (DBL)**, and **DBL Infraventures Pvt. Ltd. (DIPL)**.
- The **seven SPVs** involved in the transaction are **DAK Package I Expressway Pvt. Ltd.**, **Bethamangala Expressway Pvt. Ltd.**, **Katra Expressway Pvt. Ltd.**, **Raipur-Visakhapatnam-CG-2 Highways Ltd.**, **Bangarupalem Gudipala Highways Ltd.**, **Poondiyankuppam Highways Ltd.**, and **Mehgama-Hansdiha Highways Ltd.**
- The proposed combination includes (a) **acquisition of the shareholding of seven SPVs by Anantam Highways Trust (InvIT)** and (b) **issuance of InvIT units to BIIF, DBL, and DIPL**.
- **Anantam Highways Trust (InvIT)** is a contributory, determinate, irrevocable trust established under the Indian Trusts Act and is **registered with SEBI as an Infrastructure Investment Trust (InvIT)** under the SEBI InvIT Regulations.

Competition Commission of India Approves Two Major Acquisition Deals in India's Asset Management and Sports Sectors

- The **Competition Commission of India (CCI)**, under the **Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA)**, approved **two major acquisition proposals** under the provisions of the **Competition Act, 2002**.
- **Approval 1**: Germany-based **DWS Group GmbH & Co. KGaA (DWS Group)** received approval to acquire a **40% stake** in **Nippon Life India Alternative Investment Fund (AIF) Management Limited (NIAIF)**.
- The **DWS Group–NIAIF transaction** is valued at approximately **₹733 crore**.

Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited Signs Agreement to Acquire 40% Stake in Tiki Tar and Shell India Private Limited for ₹85 Crore

- **Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL)**, a **'Maharatna' Public Sector Undertaking (PSU)** under the **Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas (MoPNG)**, signed a **Share Purchase Agreement (SPA)** to acquire a **40% equity stake** in **Tiki Tar and Shell India Private Limited (TTSIPL)**.
- The **acquisition value is ₹85 crore**, aimed at strengthening BPCL's presence in the **bitumen and road infrastructure materials** segment.

Kotak Mahindra Bank Announces ₹281.7 Crore Acquisition of Deutsche Bank India's Retail and Wealth Management Business

- **Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited (KMBL)**, a private sector bank, announced the **acquisition of Deutsche Bank India's Retail Banking, Private Banking, and Wealth Management business** for **₹281.7 crore**.
- The acquisition is subject to regulatory approvals, including approval from the **Competition Commission of India (CCI)**.
- The transaction is expected to be **completed by September 2027**.
- The acquired business portfolio includes approximately **₹29,000 crore in loans**, **₹16,000 crore in deposits**, and **₹10,500 crore in Assets Under Management (AUM)**.

About Kotak Mahindra Bank:

- Headquarters: Mumbai, Maharashtra, India
- Managing Director & CEO: Ashok Vaswani
- Tagline: Let's Make Money Simple
- Merger: ING Vysya Bank merged with Kotak Mahindra Bank in 2015

Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited Completes ₹2,312 Crore Acquisition of IBV Brazil Petroleo, Becomes Sole Owner

- **Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL)**, through its overseas subsidiary **BPRL Ventures BV** (Bharat PetroResources Limited Ventures BV), acquired the remaining **34.6% stake** of **Videocon Energy Brazil Limited (VEBL)** in **IBV Brazil Petroleo Limitada**.
- With this acquisition, BPCL's shareholding in IBV Brazil Petroleo Limitada increased from **65.40% to 100%**, making it a **wholly owned subsidiary** of BPRL Ventures BV.
- The acquisition was completed through a deal valued at **₹2,312 crore**.
- The transaction was executed under the **Corporate Insolvency Resolution Process (CIRP)** of **VOVL Limited**.

About BPCL :

- **Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL)** is a **'Maharatna' Public Sector Undertaking (PSU)** functioning under the **Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas (MoPNG)**.
- BPCL was **established in 1952** and is headquartered in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

Jammu & Kashmir Bank to Divest 0.5% Stake in PNB MetLife to MetLife International for ₹120.1 Crore

- **Jammu & Kashmir (J&K) Bank** signed a **Share Purchase Agreement (SPA)** to sell its **0.5% stake** in **PNB MetLife India Insurance Company** to **MetLife International Holdings, LLC** for approximately **₹120.1 crore**.
- Under the transaction, **J&K Bank** will divest **10.25 million equity shares** in **PNB MetLife** at a price of **₹117.20 per share**, taking the total transaction value to **₹120.1 crore**.
- After completion of the deal, **J&K Bank's shareholding** in **PNB MetLife** will reduce from **3.034% to 2.534%** (approximately **3% to 2.5%**).

About Jammu & Kashmir Bank Limited :

- It is an Indian **banking and financial services company**.
- Headquarters : **Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir**.
- **MD & CEO : Amitava Chatterjee**

Competition Commission of India Clears The Brink's Company's 100% Acquisition of NCR Atleos Corporation

- The **Competition Commission of India (CCI)** has approved the acquisition of **100% equity share capital** of **NCR Atleos Corporation** by **The Brink's Company**.
- The **Proposed Combination** involves the acquisition of **100% ownership** of **NCR Atleos Corporation (Target)** by **The Brink's Company (Acquirer)**.
- After completion of the transaction, **NCR Atleos Corporation** will become a **wholly owned and controlled subsidiary** of **The Brink's Company**.
- **The Brink's Company** is a global provider of **cash and valuables management**, **digital retail solutions**, and **ATM managed services**, operating in **over 100 countries.**

About CCI:

- The Competition Commission of India (CCI) is a statutory body within the Ministry of Corporate Affairs and is responsible for enforcing the Competition Act of 2002.
- Founded: October 14, 2003
- Headquarters: New Delhi, India
- Chairperson: Ravneet Kaur

Reserve Bank of India Clears Areion Group's ₹936 Crore Takeover of Aviom India Housing Finance

- The **Reserve Bank of India (RBI)** approved **Areion Group's ₹936 crore acquisition** of **Aviom India Housing Finance**, marking a major step in the company's **insolvency resolution process**.

- The **RBI** also granted '**Fit-and-Proper**' approval to **Manish Lalwani**, promoter of **Areion Group**, which is mandatory for a **change in control** of a **regulated financial institution**.
- **Aviom India Housing Finance** entered the **Corporate Insolvency Resolution Process (CIRP)** in **February 2025** due to **debt defaults** and **accounting irregularities**.

Odisha Initiates Land Acquisition for Indian Oil Corporation's ₹61,077 Crore Paradip Petrochemical Complex

- The **Government of Odisha** has initiated the **land acquisition process** for **Indian Oil Corporation (IOC)'s ₹61,077 crore Paradip Petrochemical Complex**, marking **IOC's largest-ever single-location investment**.
- The **Paradip Petrochemical Complex** will be developed around a **1.5 Million Tonnes Per Annum (MTPA) dual-feed naphtha cracker**, supported by multiple **downstream petrochemical units** and the proposed **Paradip Plastic Park**.
- The **Odisha Government** has started the mandatory **Social Impact Assessment (SIA)** for acquiring approximately **220 acres of private land**, which forms part of the total **2,200 acres required** for the integrated project.

About Indian Oil Corporation :

- **Headquarters : New Delhi, India**
- **Chairman :** Arvindar Singh Sahney

Competition Commission of India Clears Go Digit Infoworks–Go Digit General Insurance Merger

- The **Competition Commission of India (CCI)**, under the **Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MoCA)**, approved the proposed merger of **Go Digit Infoworks Services Private Limited (Infoworks)** with **Go Digit General Insurance Limited (GDGIL)**.
- The merger is the **first-ever merger** between an insurance company and a non-insurance holding company under the **Sabka Bima Sabki Raksha (Amendment of Insurance Laws) Act, 2025**, making it an important milestone in **India's insurance sector**.

About Go Digit General Insurance Limited (GDGIL) :

- Established: **December 2016**
- Headquarters : **Pune, Maharashtra**, and is backed by **Fairfax Financial Holdings**.

Kotak Mahindra Mutual Fund Crosses 5% Shareholding in South Indian Bank Through Open Market Purchase

- **Kotak Mahindra Asset Management Company (KMAMC)** announced that **Kotak Mahindra Mutual Fund (KMMF)** increased its stake in **South Indian Bank** to **more than 5%** through an **open market purchase**.
- Before the acquisition, **KMMF** held **12.04 crore shares (4.5981%)** in South Indian Bank and acquired an additional **1.47 crore shares (0.5614%)**, increasing its total holding to **13.51 crore shares (5.1595%)**.

RANKING AND REPORTS

MRF Limited Becomes India's Most Valuable and Strongest Tyre Brand in Brand Finance India 100 – 2026 Report

- **MRF Limited (Madras Rubber Factory Limited)** has been recognised as the **Most Valuable Tyre Brand** and the **Strongest Tyre Brand in India** in the **Brand Finance India 100 – 2026 Report**.
- MRF Limited also secured the position of the **3rd Strongest Tyre Brand in the World** in the **Brand Finance Tyres 25 – 2026 Rankings**.
- The company achieved a **Brand Strength Index (BSI) score of 87.7 out of 100**, highlighting strong **customer loyalty, brand reputation, marketing efficiency, and business performance**.
- In the **Brand Finance India 100 – 2026 Report**, MRF Limited was ranked among the **Top 50 Most Valuable Brands in India**.

About MRF Limited (Madras Rubber Factory Limited)

- Established: 1946
- Headquarters: Chennai, Tamil Nadu, India
- Founder: K. M. Mammen Mappillai

About Brand Finance

- Established: 1996
- Headquarters: London, United Kingdom

India Ranks 94th in United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDG) Index 2026

- **India** ranked **94th** among **167 countries** in the **United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDG) Index 2026**, achieving its **highest-ever ranking** with an overall score of **68.3 out of 100**.

- The **Sustainable Development Report 2026** was released by the **United Nations Sustainable Development Solutions Network (SDSN)**.
- Since the adoption of the **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)** in **2015**, India has improved its ranking by **18 places**, rising from **112th** to **94th**, making it one of the fastest-improving major economies.
- However, India continues to rank behind **Bhutan, Maldives, Nepal, and Sri Lanka** in South Asia.

Rank	Country
1	Finland
2	Sweden
3	Denmark
94	India
165	Chad
166	Central African Republic
167	South Sudan

Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) Releases Report on Index of Services Production (ISP)

- The **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)** released the report of the **Technical Advisory Committee on the Index of Services Production (ISP)**, marking a significant step towards strengthening India's economic statistics.
- The proposed **Index of Services Production (ISP)** will be a **high-frequency monthly indicator** to measure the performance of India's **formal services sector**.
- The **base year** for the index has been fixed as **2024–25**.
- The **trial release** of the **Index of Services Production (ISP)** is scheduled for **14 July 2026**.
- The **services sector** contributes nearly **53% of India's Gross Value Added (GVA)**, making it the largest contributor to the Indian economy.

About Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation:

- **Minister of State (Independent Charge):** Rao Inderjit Singh
- **Constituency:** Gurgaon, Haryana

Jaipur Ranked 6th Globally in Happy City Index 2026; Only Indian City in Global Top 10

- **Jaipur**, Rajasthan, became the **only Indian city** to feature in the **Top 10 of the Happy City Index 2026**, securing the **6th position globally**.
- The **Happy City Index 2026** recognises cities based on **governance, economy, health, environment, mobility, citizen well-being, and quality of life**.
- Jaipur was recognised for its high quality of life, rich cultural heritage, good governance, sustainable urban development, and modern infrastructure.
- The ranking highlights Jaipur's success in balancing heritage conservation with urban growth and smart city development.
- **London (United Kingdom)** secured the **1st rank** in the **Happy City Index 2026**.

Top 10 Cities in Happy City Index 2026

Rank	City	Country
1	London	United Kingdom
2	New York City	United States
3	Paris	France
4	Tokyo	Japan
5	Madrid	Spain
6	**Jaipur**	**India**
7	Rome	Italy
8	Dubai	United Arab Emirates
9	Berlin	Germany
10	Barcelona	Spain

India Ranked 125th in Global Passport Index 2026

- **India** ranked **125th** out of **197 countries** in the **Global Passport Index (GPI) 2026**, published by **Global Citizen Solutions**.
- India slipped **one position** from **124th** in the previous edition, despite improving its **overall composite score to 45.1**, the **highest in the last five years**.
- The **Global Passport Index (GPI)** evaluates passports based on **Enhanced Mobility (50%)**, **Quality of Living (25%)**, and **Investment Opportunities (25%)**.
- India ranked **136th** in **Enhanced Mobility**, **118th** in **Quality of Living**, and **94th** in **Investment Opportunities**.

Top 10 Countries in Global Passport Index 2026

Rank	Country
1	Sweden
2	Switzerland
3	Finland
4	Germany
5	Denmark
5	Netherlands
6	Ireland
7	United Kingdom
8	Norway
9	Singapore

United States Ranked World's Most Influential Country in U.S. News & World Report 2026; India Placed 16th

- According to the **U.S. News & World Report 2026** global rankings, the **United States** has been ranked as the **world's most influential country**, reflecting its leadership in **economic strength, military capability, diplomacy, innovation, and cultural influence**.
- The rankings assess countries based on their **overall global influence and national performance** across multiple governance and development indicators.
- **India** secured the **16th position**, highlighting its growing global influence driven by rapid economic growth, digital transformation, strategic partnerships, and expanding diplomatic engagement.

Top 10 Most Influential Countries in the World – 2026

Rank	Country
1	United States
2	United Kingdom
3	Germany
4	France
5	Japan
6	Netherlands

7	Sweden
8	Switzerland
9	China
10	Canada

Madhya Pradesh Tops India in New Geographical Indication (GI) Registrations During Financial Year 2025–26

- India granted **125 new Geographical Indication (GI) registrations** during **Financial Year (FY) 2025–26**, taking the **total number of registered Geographical Indication (GI) products to 822**.
- **Madhya Pradesh** emerged as the **top state** with **26 new Geographical Indication (GI) registrations**, followed by **West Bengal (24)** and **Himachal Pradesh (13)**.
- The rise in **Geographical Indication (GI)** registrations reflects growing efforts by states to protect **traditional products, indigenous knowledge, handicrafts, agricultural produce, and cultural heritage** while improving market access for farmers and artisans.

State-wise New Geographical Indication (GI) Registrations in Financial Year 2025–26

Rank	State	New GI Tags
1	Madhya Pradesh	**26**
2	West Bengal	**24**
3	Himachal Pradesh	**13**
4	Jharkhand	**11**
5	Gujarat	**7**
5	Ladakh	**7**
7	Assam	**6**
8	Uttar Pradesh	**5**
8	Rajasthan	**5**
8	Tamil Nadu	**5**
8	Goa	**5**

MOUS AND AGREEMENT

India–United Kingdom Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) Comes into Force

- The **Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA)** between **India** and the **United Kingdom (UK)** came into effect on **15 July 2026**, marking a major milestone in bilateral economic and trade relations.
- The agreement aims to increase **bilateral trade to USD 100 billion by 2030** from the current level of around **USD 55–60 billion**, while promoting **trade, investment, supply chain integration, employment generation, and long-term economic cooperation**.
- **India–UK bilateral trade** currently stands at around **USD 55–60 billion**, including **USD 25.12 billion in merchandise trade (FY 2025–26)** and **USD 35.44 billion in services trade (2024)**.

Serum Institute of India Partners with Gates Medical Research Institute for Tuberculosis Vaccine Manufacturing

- **Serum Institute of India (SII)** has entered into an agreement with the **Gates Medical Research Institute (Gates MRI)** to establish manufacturing capacity for the **M72/AS01E Tuberculosis (TB) vaccine candidate**.
- Under the partnership, **Serum Institute of India** will manufacture and supply the **M72/AS01E Tuberculosis vaccine candidate** on a large scale, subject to the successful completion of **Phase III clinical trials** and necessary **regulatory approvals**.
- The agreement aims to strengthen global efforts against **Tuberculosis (TB)**, one of the world's deadliest infectious diseases, and enhance India's position as a leading global centre for **vaccine manufacturing**.

About Serum Institute of India (SII)

- Established: 1966
- Headquarters: Pune, Maharashtra
- Founder: Dr. Cyrus S. Poonawalla

India-Israel Bilateral Investment Agreement (BIA) Comes into Force

- The **Bilateral Investment Agreement (BIA)** between the **Government of India** and the **Government of the State of Israel** came into force on **4 July 2026**.
- The agreement was **signed on 8 September 2025** in **New Delhi**.
- According to the **Ministry of Finance**, the **Bilateral Investment Agreement (BIA)** aims to strengthen **bilateral economic relations**, promote **cross-border investments**, and provide a **secure, transparent, and predictable investment environment**.

- The agreement provides **protection to investments and investors** while preserving the **sovereign right of governments** to pursue legitimate public policy objectives.
- Under the agreement, **India** has reduced the **local remedies exhaustion period** for **Israeli investors** from **5 years** (under India's **2015 Model Bilateral Investment Treaty (BIT)**) to **3 years**, enabling quicker access to **international arbitration** after exhausting domestic legal remedies.
-

About Israel

- Capital: Jerusalem
- Currency: Israeli Shekel
- President: Isaac Herzog
- Prime Minister: Benjamin Netanyahu

Adani Enterprises Limited and International Resources Holding Sign Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Odisha Government for ₹1.08 Lakh Crore Greenfield Aluminium Project

- **Adani Enterprises Limited (AEL)** and **Abu Dhabi-based International Resources Holding (IRH)**, a **International Holding Company (IHC) Group** entity, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Government of Odisha** to develop a **USD 11.5 billion (around ₹1.08 lakh crore)** integrated **greenfield aluminium project** in Odisha.
- **Adani Enterprises Limited (AEL)** and **International Resources Holding (IRH)** will establish a **50:50 Joint Venture (JV)** to execute the project.
- The project is expected to become **Odisha's largest Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) proposal** and **India's largest Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) in the metallurgy sector**.

About Adani Enterprises Limited (AEL)

- Headquarters: Ahmedabad, Gujarat
- Chairman: Gautam Adani
- Managing Director (MD): Rajesh Adani

About Odisha:

- **Chief Minister:** Mohan Charan Majhi
- **Governor:** Hari Babu Kambhampati
- **Capital:** Bhubaneswar

- **National Parks:** Simlipal National Park, Bhitarkanika National Park, Nandankanan National Park
- **Wildlife Sanctuaries:** Bhitarkanika Wildlife Sanctuary, Chilika Wildlife Sanctuary, Balukhand-Konark Wildlife Sanctuary, Debrigarh Wildlife Sanctuary, Gahirmatha Marine Wildlife Sanctuary, Satkosia Gorge Wildlife Sanctuary, Chandaka-Dampara Wildlife Sanctuary, Kuldiha Wildlife Sanctuary, Baisipalli Wildlife Sanctuary, Sunabeda Wildlife Sanctuary

India and Australia Launch Roadmap for Sports Collaboration to Strengthen Bilateral Sports Cooperation

- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** announced the **India–Australia Roadmap for Sports Collaboration** during his visit to **Australia** to strengthen long-term cooperation in **coaching**, **sports science**, **athlete development**, **sports technology**, **major sporting events**, and **women in sports**.
- The roadmap builds upon the **2023 Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) on Cooperation in Sports** and provides a comprehensive framework for collaboration in **skill development**, **capacity building**, **sports research**, **sports governance**, and **sports industry partnerships**.
- The initiative aims to enhance cooperation ahead of major international sporting events, including the **Commonwealth Games 2030** in **Ahmedabad** and the **Olympic and Paralympic Games 2032** in **Brisbane, Australia**, while supporting India's long-term aspiration to host the **Olympic Games**.
- India and Australia will collaborate on **sports event management**, **athlete training**, **sports infrastructure**, **support systems**, and **competition preparation** to improve performance in international sporting events.

About Australia

- Capital: Canberra
- Prime Minister: Anthony Albanese
- Currency: Australian Dollar (AUD)

Department of Posts (DoP) and Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) Sign Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) for India's Largest Rural Telecom Network Survey

- The **Department of Posts (DoP)** and the **Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** to conduct **India's largest-ever rural telecom network performance survey** across **5.68 lakh villages**.

- The survey aims to assess the **availability**, **coverage**, and **quality** of mobile telecom services in rural India and provide scientific data to support **evidence-based policy decisions** and strengthen the country's digital infrastructure.
- The initiative will evaluate the performance of major telecom service providers, including **Bharti Airtel**, **Reliance Jio**, **Vodafone Idea (Vi)**, and **Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited (BSNL)**.
- The survey will cover **all States and Union Territories** and identify issues such as **poor network coverage**, **call drops**, **weak signal strength**, and **slow internet connectivity**, particularly in remote and underserved villages.

About Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI)

- Established: 1997
- Headquarters: New Delhi
- Chairperson: Anil Kumar Lahoti

About Department of Posts (DoP)

- Ministry: Ministry of Communications
- Established: 1854
- Headquarters: New Delhi
- Chairperson: Shri Subrat Das

India and New Zealand Upgrade Bilateral Ties to Strategic Partnership; Sign 10 Agreements and Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs)

- **India** and **New Zealand** upgraded their bilateral relationship to a **Strategic Partnership** by launching the **India–New Zealand Strategic Partnership Roadmap 2030** and signing **10 agreements and Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs)** during **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's** official visit to **New Zealand**.
- The **Strategic Partnership Roadmap 2030** aims to strengthen cooperation in **defence**, **security**, **trade and investment**, **maritime cooperation**, **agriculture**, **tourism**, **sports**, **culture**, **education**, **scientific research**, and **global affairs**.
- The two countries signed key agreements on **maritime cooperation**, **hydrography and nautical cartography**, **mutual logistics support between the Indian Navy and the New Zealand Defence Force**, **counter-terrorism**, **disaster management**, **animal husbandry and dairying**, **tourism**, **sports**, **maritime heritage**, and **cultural cooperation**.

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- India and New Zealand also agreed to **double bilateral trade to New Zealand Dollar (NZD) 7 billion (approximately ₹35,000 crore) by 2030** and establish a **Maritime Security Dialogue** to strengthen cooperation in the **Indo-Pacific region**.

About New Zealand

- Capital: Wellington
- Prime Minister: Christopher Luxon
- Currency: New Zealand Dollar (NZD)

India and Australia Announce 18 Agreements and Initiatives at the Third India–Australia Annual Summit

- **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** and **Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese** announced **18 agreements and initiatives** during the **Third India–Australia Annual Summit**, marking a major expansion of the **India–Australia Comprehensive Strategic Partnership**.
- The agreements strengthen cooperation in **defence**, **maritime security**, **clean energy**, **civil nuclear energy**, **cybersecurity**, **critical technologies**, **education**, **skill development**, **research**, **mining**, and **cultural cooperation**, while reaffirming the shared vision of a free, open, inclusive, and rules-based Indo-Pacific.
- The major outcomes include the **Joint Declaration on Defence and Security Cooperation (JDDSC)**, **Maritime Security Cooperation Roadmap (MSCR)**, **India–Australia Joint Declaration on Energy Security**, and the **finalisation of the Administrative Arrangement under the India–Australia Civil Nuclear Cooperation Agreement**.
- Both countries launched the **Australia–India Partnership for Cyber, Critical Technologies and Supply Chains (PACTS)** and signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** under the **Australia–Canada–India Technology and Innovation Partnership (ACITI)** to strengthen cooperation in **cybersecurity**, **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, **critical technologies**, **innovation**, and **resilient supply chains**.

Air India Signs Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Singapore-Based SIA Engineering Company Limited (SIAEC) to Strengthen Aviation Maintenance, Repair and Overhaul (MRO) Sector

- **Air India** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Singapore-based SIA Engineering Company Limited (SIAEC)** to explore collaboration in the **Maintenance, Repair and Overhaul (MRO)** sector.

- The **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** aims to support the development of **India as a global aviation Maintenance, Repair and Overhaul (MRO) hub**.
- The agreement was signed in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**, by **Campbell Wilson**, **Chief Executive Officer (CEO) and Managing Director (MD) of Air India**, and **Chin Yau Seng**, **Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of SIA Engineering Company Limited (SIAEC)**.

About Air India

- Headquarters: New Delhi
- Chief Executive Officer (CEO) and Managing Director (MD): Campbell Wilson
- Parent Company: Tata Group
- Industry: Aviation

Sharnbasva University Signs Five-Year Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Industrial University of Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam

- **Sharnbasva University**, **Kalaburagi, Karnataka**, signed a **five-year Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Industrial University of Ho Chi Minh City (IUH)**, **Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam**.
- The **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** aims to strengthen **academic collaboration, collaborative research, faculty exchange, student exchange, and scientific and cultural cooperation** between the two universities.
- The collaboration will initially focus on **Engineering, Technology, and Management Studies**.

About Vietnam

- **Capital:** Hanoi
- **Currency:** Vietnamese dong
- **President:** Tô Lâm
- **Prime Minister:** Lê Minh Hưng

Garuda Aerospace Signs Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Micron Instruments to Develop Indigenous Defence Drone Technologies

- **Garuda Aerospace**, a **Chennai-based drone technology company**, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Micron Instruments**, a manufacturer of **precision fuzes, defence ammunition systems, and critical military components**.
- The partnership aims to develop **next-generation indigenous defence solutions** by combining expertise in **advanced manufacturing, defence engineering, and innovation**.

- Under the collaboration, the companies will jointly develop **loitering munitions, payload-enabled Unmanned Aerial Vehicles (UAVs), and advanced unmanned defence systems**.
- The **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** will integrate **Micron Instruments' expertise in custom-designed precision fuzes** with **Garuda Aerospace's advanced drone technologies**.

About Garuda Aerospace

- Established: 2015
- Headquarters: Chennai, Tamil Nadu
- Founder and Chief Executive Officer (CEO): Agnishwar Jayaprakash

Four States Sign Payment Agreement for Narmada Projects

- The **States of Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat, Rajasthan, and Maharashtra** signed a **payment agreement** in **New Delhi** to resolve long-pending financial issues related to the **Narmada Project**.
- The agreement settles the **cost-sharing** of the **Sardar Sarovar Project** and the **Indira Sagar Project** in accordance with the **Narmada Water Disputes Tribunal (NWDT) Award**.
- The signing ceremony was attended by **Union Home Minister Amit Shah** and **Union Minister for Jal Shakti C. R. Patil**.
- The agreement covers **rehabilitation and resettlement expenses, compensation for submerged land, construction costs, interest on borrowings, and settlement of pending financial liabilities** among the participating states.

India and Australia Launch Australia-India Partnership for Cyber, Critical Technologies and Supply Chains (PACTS) to Strengthen Strategic Technology Cooperation

- **India** and **Australia** launched the **Australia-India Partnership for Cyber, Critical Technologies and Supply Chains (PACTS)** during the **third India- Australia Annual Summit** held in **Melbourne, Australia**, in the presence of **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** and **Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese**.
- The **Australia-India Partnership for Cyber, Critical Technologies and Supply Chains (PACTS)** aims to strengthen cooperation in cybersecurity, artificial intelligence, semiconductors, critical minerals, digital resilience, defence research, and resilient supply chains.

- The partnership will bring together government institutions, private companies, universities, research organisations, and defence technology developers to promote innovation, technology collaboration, investment, and commercialisation of research.
- The partnership focuses on **five key pillars**: **Supply Chain Flexibility and Diversification**, **Critical Technologies**, **Cybersecurity**, **Digital Resilience**, and **Defence Research Cooperation**.

Herbalife India and Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Madras Launch India's First Centre of Excellence for Plant Cell Fermentation

- **Herbalife International India Private Limited** and the **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Madras** launched **India's first Centre of Excellence (CoE)** dedicated to **Plant Cell Fermentation Technology**.
- The **Centre of Excellence (CoE)** aims to promote **research in sustainable biomanufacturing** and develop **next-generation plant-based health and wellness products**.
- It will serve as a collaborative platform for **researchers, students, entrepreneurs, industry experts**, and **start-ups** to transform scientific research into commercial applications.
- The Centre will focus on the sustainable production of **herbal biomass**, **enriched herbal extracts**, and **high-value plant compounds** using **plant cell fermentation technology**.

About Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Madras

- Established: 1959
- Location: ChenX`nai, Tamil Nadu

India and Seychelles Sign 19 Agreements to Strengthen Bilateral Cooperation

- **India** and **Seychelles** signed **19 agreements and initiatives** during **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's three-day visit** to **Seychelles**.
- The agreements were announced after bilateral talks between **Prime Minister Narendra Modi** and **President Dr. Patrick Herminie** in **Victoria**, the capital of **Seychelles**.
- The initiatives cover **maritime security, defence, digital payments, healthcare, education, agriculture, infrastructure, space cooperation, and financial assistance**.
- India reaffirmed its commitment to the **MAHASAGAR (Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across Regions)** initiative to strengthen **maritime security**, **Blue Economy**, **disaster preparedness**, and **regional stability** in the **Indian Ocean Region (IOR)**.

- India announced defence assistance, including an **indigenously built Fast Patrol Vessel**, **10 utility vehicles**, **five Laser Radial sailing boats**, the **refit of PS Zoroaster**, and the **upgrade of the Dornier maritime surveillance aircraft** of the **Seychelles Coast Guard**.

About Seychelles

- Capital: Victoria
- President: Dr. Patrick Herminie
- Currency: Seychellois Rupee (SCR)

Rajasthan and Haryana Sign Agreement for Yamuna Water Project

- The **Governments of Rajasthan and Haryana** signed an agreement for the **Yamuna Water Project** in **New Delhi**.
- The agreement was signed in the presence of **Union Minister for Home Affairs and Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah** to resolve the **nearly 30-year-old Yamuna water dispute** between the two states.
- The project aims to supply **Rajasthan's allocated share of Yamuna River water** through an **underground pipeline network** from the **Western Yamuna Canal**.
- Rajasthan will receive **about 580 Million Cubic Metres (MCM)** of water as per the **1994 Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) on the Sharing of the Utilisable Surface Waters of the Upper Yamuna Basin**.

About Haryana:

- **Chief Minister:** Nayab Singh Saini
- **Governor:** Prof. Ashim Kumar Ghosh
- **Capital:** Chandigarh
- **National Parks:** Sultanpur National Park, Kalesar National Park
- **Wildlife Sanctuaries:** Kalesar Wildlife Sanctuary, Bhindawas Lake Wildlife Sanctuary, Morni Hills Wildlife Sanctuary, Khaparwas Wildlife Sanctuary, Nahar Wildlife Sanctuary, Abubshahar Wildlife Sanctuary

Ministry of Tourism Signs Memorandum of Understanding with Google India to Boost Digital Tourism Promotion

- The **Ministry of Tourism** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Google India Private Limited** in **New Delhi** to enhance the **digital visibility of India's tourism destinations**.
- The MoU was signed in the presence of **Union Minister of Tourism and Culture Gajendra Singh Shekhawat**.

- The partnership aims to leverage **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**, **digital technologies**, **data-driven insights**, and **capacity building** to attract more **domestic and international tourists**.
- The collaboration seeks to promote India's **cultural, historical, spiritual, and natural attractions** through Google's digital ecosystem.
- The MoU focuses on improving the **online discoverability** of tourism destinations and enhancing **visitor engagement** through innovative digital solutions.
- The partnership supports the Government's vision of **digital transformation**, **sustainable tourism development**, and strengthening the **Incredible India** campaign.

ACME Group Signs Nearly US$1 Billion Green Methanol Supply Agreement with Mitsubishi Gas Chemical

- **ACME Group** has signed a **binding long-term agreement** worth nearly **US$1 billion** with **Mitsubishi Gas Chemical (MGC), Japan**, to supply **100,000 tonnes of green methanol annually** from its upcoming production facility at **Paradip, Odisha**.
- The agreement was announced during the **16th India-Japan Annual Summit** and strengthens **India-Japan cooperation in clean energy, sustainable industrial development, and resilient supply chains**.
- The green methanol produced by **ACME Group** will primarily be used as **marine fuel in Japan**, supporting the shipping industry's efforts to reduce greenhouse gas emissions and meet global environmental standards.

Andhra Pradesh Partners with United Nations Human Settlements Programme for Sustainable Urban Development

- The **Government of Andhra Pradesh (AP)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **United Nations Human Settlements Programme (UN-Habitat)** to establish a long-term partnership for promoting **sustainable, inclusive, and climate-resilient urban development** in the state.
- The partnership aims to establish a **Centre of Excellence (CoE) for Urban Affairs** in **Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh**, which will support urban planning, climate-resilient cities, digital governance, municipal finance, and implementation of **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)**.

- The **Municipal Administration Department, Government of Andhra Pradesh** signed the MoU with **United Nations Human Settlements Programme (UN-Habitat)** to strengthen urban development initiatives across the state.

About United Nations Human Settlements Programme (UN-Habitat)

- Established: 1978
- Headquarters: Nairobi, Kenya
- Parent Organisation: United Nations Economic and Social Council (UN ECOSOC)
- Executive Director**:** Anacláudia Rossbach

About Andhra Pradesh:

- **Chief Minister:** Chandrababu Naidu
- **Governor:** Retd. S. Abdul Nazeer
- **Capital:** Amaravati
- **National Parks:** Papikonda National Park, Sri Venkateswara National Park, Rajiv Gandhi (Rameswaram) National Park
- **Wildlife Sanctuaries:** Coringa, Kolleru, Krishna, Kambalakonda, Rollapadu Wildlife Sanctuaries

Controller General of Patents, Designs and Trade Marks Signs MoU with Council of Scientific and Industrial Research-National Institute of Science Communication and Policy Research for National Knowledge Resource Consortium

- The **Office of the Controller General of Patents, Designs and Trade Marks (CGPDTM)** and the **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research- National Institute of Science Communication and Policy Research (CSIR-NIScPR)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** to enable CGPDTM's participation in the **National Knowledge Resource Consortium (NKRC)**.
- The MoU was signed by **Prof. (Dr.) Unnat P. Pandit, Controller General of Patents, Designs and Trade Marks (CGPDTM)**, and **Dr. Geeta Vani Rayasam, Director, Council of Scientific and Industrial Research-National Institute of Science Communication and Policy Research (CSIR-NIScPR)** at **Saraswati Hall, Bouddhik Sampada Bhawan, New Delhi**.
- Under the agreement, **the Controller General of Patents, Designs and Trade Marks (CGPDTM)** will receive access to the **National Knowledge Resource Consortium (NKRC) digital knowledge platform**, which provides international scientific journals, e-books, databases, patents, and other academic resources.

Paras Semiconductors to Set Up ₹6,200 Crore Advanced Semiconductor Packaging Facility in

Madhya Pradesh

- **Paras Semiconductors Private Limited**, a subsidiary of **Paras Defence and Space Technologies Limited**, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Department of Science and Technology, Government of Madhya Pradesh**, through the **Madhya Pradesh State Electronics Development Corporation Limited (MPSeDC)**.
- The **Memorandum of Understanding** aims to establish a **greenfield Advanced Integrated Circuit (IC) Packaging and Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT) facility** in the **Indore–Ujjain region of Madhya Pradesh**.
- **Paras Semiconductors** will invest approximately **₹6,200 crore** to develop the advanced semiconductor packaging facility.

About Madhya Pradesh State Electronics Development Corporation Limited (MPSeDC)

- **Established: 1988**
- **Headquarters: Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh**
- **Administrative Department: Department of Science and Technology, Government of Madhya Pradesh**
- **Objective:** To promote **electronics manufacturing, information technology, digital governance, and investment** in the electronics sector across Madhya Pradesh.

India–Sri Lanka Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement (DTAA) Strengthened with Principal Purpose Test (PPT)

- **India** has strengthened its **Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement (DTAA) with Sri Lanka** by incorporating the **Principal Purpose Test (PPT)**, an internationally recognised anti-abuse provision under the **Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) Base Erosion and Profit Shifting (BEPS) framework**.
- The amendment was introduced through a **Protocol notified by the Ministry of Finance** and came into force on **19 June 2026** after completion of domestic legal procedures by both countries.
- The revised provisions will apply in **India for income derived from 1 April 2027**.

Visvesvaraya Technological University Signs Memorandum of Understanding with Google to Promote Artificial Intelligence and Industry-Oriented Skills

- **Visvesvaraya Technological University (VTU)** entered into an **academic partnership** with **Google** through a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** to enhance **skill development, practical learning, and employment opportunities** for engineering students.

- The **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** was signed by **S. Vidyashankar**, **Vice-Chancellor of Visvesvaraya Technological University (VTU)**, **Prasad B. Rampure**, **Registrar (Administration) of VTU**, and **Sanjay Jain**, **Head of Google for Education India**.
- The **Centre of Excellence (CoE)** will be developed in phases with an estimated investment of **₹20 crore**.
- **Simulation Enabled Experiential Learning (SEEL)**, an advanced digital learning platform, has been launched through the **Mysuru e-learning centre** to provide online practical laboratory experiences.

About Visvesvaraya Technological University (VTU)

- **Established: 1998**
- **Headquarters: Belagavi, Karnataka**
- **Named After: Sir Mokshagundam Visvesvaraya**, Bharat Ratna awardee and renowned engineer
- **Objective:** Promote **technical education, research, innovation, and industry collaboration** by affiliating and supporting engineering institutions across Karnataka.

Paralympic Committee of India and Cerebral Palsy Sports Federation of India Sign Memorandum of Understanding for India's Bid to Host 2029 World Abilitysport Games

- The **Paralympic Committee of India (PCI)** and the **Cerebral Palsy Sports Federation of India (CPSFI)** signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** in **New Delhi, Delhi** to jointly pursue **India's bid** to host the **2029 World Abilitysport Games**.
- The partnership aims to prepare and submit a **competitive bid** to bring the **international multi-sport event for athletes with disabilities** to India, strengthening the country's role in the **global Paralympic movement**.
- India previously hosted the **International Wheelchair and Amputee Sports Federation (IWAS) World Games** in **Bengaluru, Karnataka**, in **2009**.

About Paralympic Committee of India (PCI)

- Established: 1992
- Headquarters: New Delhi
- President: Devendra Jhajharia
- Affiliation: International Paralympic Committee (IPC)

- **Objective:** Promote, develop, and manage **Para sports** in India, select and support Indian athletes for **Paralympic Games** and other international Para sporting events, and encourage inclusive sports participation for persons with disabilities.

Engineers India Limited and Council of Scientific and Industrial Research-Institute of Minerals and Materials Technology Sign Memorandum of Understanding for Critical Minerals Collaboration

- **Engineers India Limited (EIL)**, a public sector engineering consultancy company, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research-Institute of Minerals and Materials Technology (CSIR-IMMT), Bhubaneswar**, to strengthen collaboration in:
  - **Mineral processing**
  - **Extractive metallurgy**
  - **Critical and strategic minerals value chain**
- The **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** was signed by:
  - **Rajiv Agarwal** – Director (Technical), **Engineers India Limited (EIL)**
  - **Ramanuj Narayan** – Director, **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research-Institute of Minerals and Materials Technology (CSIR-IMMT)**

APPS & PORTALS

India Launches Online Registration Portal for Coal Exchanges to Modernise Coal Trading Ecosystem

- **Union Minister of Coal and Mines, G. Kishan Reddy**, in the presence of **Minister of State Satish Chandra Dubey** and **Coal Secretary Vikram Dev Dutt**, launched the **Online Portal Application for Registration of Coal Exchanges** in **New Delhi** during the **Curtain Raiser Event for Indian Mining Week 2026**.
- The launch marks India's transition from a policy framework to **operational readiness for Coal Exchanges**, inviting eligible entities to apply for registration under the regulatory oversight of the **Coal Controller Organisation (CCO)**.
- A **Coal Exchange** is an **online trading platform** where buyers and sellers of coal and processed coal products can undertake **delivery-based coal contracts** approved by the Authority.

About Ministry of Coal :

- Cabinet Minister : G. Kishan Reddy

- Minister of State : Satish Chandra Dubey

Union Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal Launches e-VSP Portal to Expand Digital Access to Hindi Legal Literature

- **Union Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal** launched the **e-VSP (Vidhi Sahitya Prakashan) Portal**, developed by the **Legislative Department**, to provide digital access to **Hindi legal literature**.
- The **e-VSP Portal** offers **Supreme Court and High Court judgments**, **legal journals**, reference books, **Acts**, **legal publications**, and other Hindi legal resources on a single digital platform.
- The portal aims to make **legal knowledge** easily accessible to **lawyers, judges, law students, teachers, researchers, and citizens** worldwide, thereby promoting **inclusive access to justice**.
- The e-VSP Portal has been jointly developed by the **Legislative Department**, **Official Languages Wing**, **Vidhi Sahitya Prakashan (VSP)**, and the **National Informatics Centre (NIC)**.

Aadhaar App Surpasses 40 Million Downloads, Strengthening Digital Identity Services

- The **Aadhaar App** has crossed **40 million (4 crore) downloads**, highlighting the growing trust of residents in **digital-first identity services**.
- The **Aadhaar App** serves as a **one-stop digital platform** for **Aadhaar-related services**, including **address update**, **mobile number update**, **email update**, **biometric lock/unlock**, and **e-Aadhaar download**.
- Since its launch, the **Aadhaar App** has facilitated over **11.65 lakh address updates**, enabling users to update their Aadhaar address from home without visiting an **Aadhaar Centre**.

About Ministry of Electronics & IT :

- Cabinet Minister : Ashwini Vaishnaw
- Minister of state : Jitin Prasada

Ministry of Law Launches Online Fresh Application Module for Notary Public Recruitment

- **Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Law & Justice, Arjun Ram Meghwal**, launched the **"Fresh Application Module"** on the **Notary Portal** for online applications for appointment as **Notary Public**.
- The module has been launched under the provisions of the **Notaries Act, 1952** and the **Notaries Rules, 1956** to simplify the appointment process for Notaries.
- The **Fresh Application Module** enables eligible **legal practitioners and advocates** to submit their Notary Public applications **online through the Notary Portal**.

- The module has been developed by the **Department of Legal Affairs** in collaboration with the **National Informatics Centre (NIC)** to ensure a **transparent, efficient, and citizen-friendly** application process.
- The **Fresh Application Module** has been integrated with the **existing Notary Portal**, which already provides various online services related to the appointment of Notaries.

About Ministry of Law and Justice :

- Union Minister : Arjun Ram Meghwal

Union Health Minister Jagat Prakash Nadda Launches Aarogya Setu 2.0 as India's National Digital Health App

- **Union Minister of Health and Family Welfare, Jagat Prakash Nadda**, launched **Aarogya Setu 2.0**, transforming the application into a **Personal Health Record (PHR)** and citizen-facing digital health platform under the **Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM)**.
- **Aarogya Setu** was originally developed by the Government of India during the **COVID-19 pandemic** as a national digital public good for **contact tracing, risk awareness, and citizen engagement**.
- After fulfilling its pandemic-related role, the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)** formally transferred Aarogya Setu to the **National Health Authority (NHA)** for its long-term integration into India's digital health ecosystem.

About Ministry of Health and Family Welfare :

- Cabinet Minister : J. P. Nadda
- Minister of State : Anupriya Patel, Prataprao Ganpatrao Jadhav

Union Minister Amit Shah Unveils FCRA 2.0 Portal and e-OCI Card to Strengthen Digital Governance and Citizen Services

- **Union Home Minister Amit Shah** launched the **FCRA 2.0 Portal and e-OCI Card** in New Delhi to enhance digital governance, transparency, citizen convenience, and national security.
- The initiatives align with **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's** vision of **"Minimum Government, Maximum Governance"** by promoting technology-driven, transparent, and efficient governance.
- The FCRA 2.0 Portal has been developed to simplify compliance under the **Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA)** and strengthen the monitoring and enforcement of foreign contributions.
- The new portal provides **end-to-end digital services** for FCRA registration, renewals, annual returns, and other applications, eliminating the need for physical document submission.

Government Strengthens Senior Citizen Re-Employment Through National Career Service Portal

- The **Central Government** reaffirmed its commitment to promote **active ageing** and enhance employment opportunities for senior citizens through the **National Career Service (NCS) Portal**.
- The **Senior Citizen Re-employment Initiative** under the NCS Portal has recorded significant growth in **registrations, employer participation, and job opportunities**, enabling experienced professionals to remain part of the workforce.
- The Government has taken note of the **UNFPA-India's India Ageing Report 2023**, which projects a sharp increase in India's **elderly population** in the coming decades.

About Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment :

- Cabinet Minister : Virendra Kumar Khatik
- Minister of State : Ramdas Athawale, B. L. Verma

Government Launches Unified Mission Vatsalya Portal to Strengthen Child Protection System

- **Mission Vatsalya** is a **Centrally Sponsored Scheme (CSS)** implemented by States and Union Territories (UTs) for the care, protection, rehabilitation, and reintegration of **Children in Need of Care and Protection (CNCP)** and **Children in Conflict with Law (CCL)**.
- The primary objective of Mission Vatsalya is to ensure care, protection, rehabilitation, and reintegration of children in difficult circumstances, including **missing, abandoned, and vulnerable children**.
- The **Ministry of Women and Child Development (MoWCD)** has developed an integrated unified **Mission Vatsalya Portal** in consultation and coordination with States and UTs.
- The TrackChild Module is implemented with the support of multiple stakeholders, including the **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)**, **Ministry of Railways**, State Governments, UT Administrations, **Child Welfare Committees (CWCs)**, **Juvenile Justice Boards (JJBs)**, and the **National Legal Services Authority (NALSA)**.

About Ministry of Women and Child Development :

- Cabinet Minister : Annapurna Devi
- Minister of State : Savitri Thakur

Indian Council of Agricultural Research – Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute Unveils DeepDATA Mobile App to Document India's Deep-Sea Fish Biodiversity

- The **Indian Council of Agricultural Research – Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute (ICAR-CMFRI)** launched **DeepDATA**, a mobile application developed under the **Deep Ocean Mission** of the **Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)** in **Kochi, Kerala**.

- **DeepDATA** aims to provide **scientifically verified information** on deep-sea fish species while enabling users to **contribute field observations** for building a **national digital repository** of India's deep-sea biodiversity.
- **DeepDATA** serves as a **digital learning and documentation platform**, offering verified information on **taxonomy, distinguishing characteristics, distribution, and conservation status** of deep-sea fish species.

About ICAR-CMFRI :

- **ICAR-CMFRI** is a premier marine fisheries research institute functioning under the **Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)** and is headquartered in **Kochi, Kerala**.

Indian Council of Agricultural Research–Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute Launches 'Shark Aware' App and E-Learning Module to Promote Shark Conservation

- **Indian Council of Agricultural Research–Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute (ICAR-CMFRI)** launched the **"Shark Aware" mobile application** and an **interactive e-learning module** to enhance awareness, identification, and conservation of **protected and endangered sharks and rays** in India.
- The digital tools were released by **Kerala Fisheries Minister V. E. Abdul Gafoor** and developed by a scientific team led by **Dr. Livi Wilson**, Senior Scientist, Finfish Fisheries Division, ICAR-CMFRI, with financial support from the **National Fisheries Development Board (NFDB)**.

Ministry of Panchayati Raj Unveils Atmanirbhar Panchayat Programme, SAMARTH Portal and Model OSR Rules to Empower Panchayati Raj Institutions

- **Union Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh**, heading the **Ministry of Panchayati Raj (MoPR)** and the **Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying (MoFAHD)**, launched the **Atmanirbhar Panchayat Programme**, **SAMARTH Panchayat Portal**, and released the **Model Own Source of Revenue (OSR) Rules** at **Krishi Bhawan, New Delhi, Delhi**.
- The initiatives aim to strengthen the **financial autonomy, digital governance, and revenue generation capacity** of **Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs)** in line with the vision of **Viksit Bharat @2047**.
- The **Atmanirbhar Panchayat Programme**, launched by the **Ministry of Panchayati Raj (MoPR)**, enables **Gram Panchayats (GPs) and Block Panchayats** to identify local assets and convert them into **sustainable revenue-generating projects**, thereby enhancing their **Own Source Revenue (OSR)** and promoting **financial self-reliance**.

About Ministry of Panchayati Raj :

- Cabinet Minister : Lalan Singh
- Minister of State : S. P. Singh Baghel

ENVIRONMENT

Bihar's 700-Year-Old Banyan Identified as the World's Oldest Scientifically Dated Banyan Tree

- Scientists identified a **banyan tree in Munger district, Bihar**, as the **world's oldest accurately dated banyan tree**, estimating its age at around **700 years** using **high-precision radiocarbon dating**.
- The research was published in the journal **Quaternary Research** and is the **first scientific study** to determine the age of a banyan tree (*Ficus benghalensis*) using **scientific evidence** instead of folklore, historical records, or local traditions.
- The study was led by **Dr. Trina Bose** of the **Birbal Sahni Institute of Palaeosciences (BSIP), Lucknow**, an autonomous institute under the **Department of Science and Technology (DST)**, along with Dr. Mayank Shekhar and Dr. Akhilesh K. Yadava.
- The study was initiated after the **Bihar Forest Department** requested the scientific determination of the age of the **Munger Banyan Tree**.

Scientists Develop Ultra-Sensitive Ammonia Sensor for Portable, Wearable, and Self-Powered Toxic Gas Detection

- **Scientists** have developed an **advanced ammonia sensing platform** capable of detecting ammonia gas at extremely low concentrations while operating efficiently at **room temperature**.
- The technology was developed by researchers at the **Centre for Nano and Soft Matter Sciences (CeNS), Bengaluru**, an autonomous institute under the **Department of Science and Technology (DST)**.
- The sensor is based on a hybrid **Vanadium Oxide–Vanadium Sulfide (VOx/VS2) heterostructure**, engineered through a controlled surface transformation process.

Chitkara University Establishes ₹20-Crore Atal Incubation Centre to Boost Deep-Tech Startups

- **Chitkara University, Punjab** launched the **Atal Incubation Centre–Chitkara Incubation Foundation (AIC-CIF)** and **AIC-PRIDE Labs** to strengthen India's **deep-tech startup ecosystem**.
- The initiative involves a combined investment of **₹20 crore over a period of five years**.

- The incubation ecosystem will support startups working in **Drone Technologies, Agritech, and Renewable Energy**.
- The primary objective of **AIC-CIF** is to promote **research commercialisation, entrepreneurship, and technology-led economic growth** by nurturing deep-tech startups.

Ashoka Trust for Research in Ecology and the Environment Scientists Discover Two New Species of Rare Solitary Bees in Arunachal Pradesh's Siang Valley

- **Researchers from the Ashoka Trust for Research in Ecology and the Environment (ATREE), Bengaluru (Karnataka)** discovered **two new species of rare solitary bees** during the **Siang Expedition** in the **Siang Valley, Arunachal Pradesh (AR)**.
- The newly discovered bee species are **Elaphropoda triangulata** and **Habropoda adi**, and the findings were published in the **European Journal of Taxonomy**.
- The discovery highlights the **rich biodiversity and ecological importance** of the **Eastern Himalayas**, one of the world's **biodiversity hotspots**.

Union Minister Bhupender Yadav Inaugurates 4th Animal Taxonomy Summit (ATS 4.0) in Kolkata

- **Union Minister Bhupender Yadav**, Ministry of **Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)**, inaugurated the **4th Animal Taxonomy Summit (ATS 4.0)** in **Kolkata, West Bengal**.
- **ATS 4.0** was held from **30 June to 2 July 2026** to commemorate the **111th Foundation Day of the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)**.
- The summit highlighted India's **biodiversity research**, promoted **wildlife conservation**, and documented **709 new faunal records**.
- During the summit, the annual publications **Animal Discoveries–2025** and **Plant Discoveries–2025** were officially released.

Indian Council of Agricultural Research–Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute Discovers New Deep-Sea Fish Species 'Cyttopsis indica' in Arabian Sea

- Researchers from the **Indian Council of Agricultural Research–Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute (ICAR-CMFRI)** discovered a new deep-sea fish species named ***Cyttopsis indica*** **(Indian dory)**.
- The new species was discovered in the **Arabian Sea** off the **Kerala Coast**.
- The detailed findings of the discovery were published in the ***Indian Journal of Fisheries***.
- *Cyttopsis indica* was discovered in the eastern region of the **Lakshadweep Sea**.

- The species was found at a depth of approximately **350–500 metres** below sea level.
- *Cyttopsis indica* belongs to the genus ***Cyttopsis***, a primitive group of marine fishes commonly known as **"dories"**.

High-Resolution Radio Survey Uncovers Hidden Weakly Active Black Holes in Nearby Galaxies

- Astronomers discovered a **hidden population of weakly active supermassive black holes** in nearby galaxies using **high-resolution radio observations**, revealing black holes that were previously difficult to detect.
- The discovery is significant because weakly active black holes **inject energy into their surroundings through jets and outflows**, influencing **star formation** and the long-term evolution of galaxies.
- Astronomers believe that almost every galaxy contains a **supermassive black hole at its centre**, but many remain extremely faint and escape conventional detection.
- The research was conducted by an international team of astronomers, including **Dr. Aru Beri** from the **Indian Institute of Astrophysics (IIA)**, an autonomous institute under the **Department of Science and Technology (DST)**.

Researchers Discover Five New *Allographa* Lichen Species in the Western Ghats

- A team of researchers discovered **five new species** of **lichen-forming fungi** belonging to the genus **Allographa** from the **Western Ghats of India**, a globally significant **biodiversity hotspot**.
- The discovery is significant because **Allographa species** are important **bioindicators of forest health** and **environmental quality**, being highly sensitive to **pollution and habitat changes**.
- The findings will help identify **ecologically sensitive areas**, strengthen **long-term environmental monitoring**, and support **evidence-based conservation policies** and **sustainable forest management**.
- The **five newly discovered species** are:
    1. **Allographa keralensis** (named after Kerala)
    2. **Allographa nayakae** (named in honour of Dr. Sanjeeva Nayaka)
    3. **Allographa paraconsanguinea**
    4. **Allographa persistinspersa**
    5. **Allographa semicarbonisata**

Scientists Discover New Damselfly Species 'Lestes paloti' in the Western Ghats of Kerala

- A team of **Indian odonatologists** discovered a new species of spreadwing damselfly, **Lestes paloti**, from the **Western Ghats** in **Kerala**.
- **Lestes paloti** belongs to the **Lestidae family** under the **Order Odonata** (dragonflies and damselflies).
- The discovery was published in the **International Journal of Odonatology**, an internationally reputed peer-reviewed journal dedicated to research on dragonflies and damselflies.
- The species was named **Lestes paloti** in honour of **Dr. Muhamed Jafer Palot** of the **Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)**, Kozhikode, recognising his significant contributions to **Indian odonatology** and the documentation of **Western Ghats fauna**.

Zoological Survey of India Identifies Two New Spider Species, *Simonia lawbah* and *Hamataliwa papikonda*

- Scientists from the **Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)** discovered and documented **two new spider species—Simonia lawbah** from **Meghalaya** and **Hamataliwa papikonda** from **Andhra Pradesh (AP)**—highlighting **India's rich and underexplored biodiversity**.
- The discoveries were published in the peer-reviewed journals **Zootaxa** and **Records of the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)**, marking significant additions to **India's arachnological records**.

About Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) :

- The **Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)** was established in **1916** and is headquartered in **Kolkata, West Bengal**.
- **ZSI** functions under the **Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)**, **Government of India (GoI)** and is **India's premier organization** for **faunal research**, **taxonomy**, and **biodiversity documentation**.

About Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change :

- Cabinet Minister : Bhupender Yadav
- Minister of State : Kirti Vardhan Singh

Researchers Discover New Bracket Fungus Species *Microporellus kolhapurensis* in Maharashtra

- Researchers from **Maharashtra** discovered a new **polypore (bracket) fungus species** named **Microporellus kolhapurensis** in **Bhudargad taluka, Kolhapur district, Maharashtra**, growing on **rotting wood** in the **Bediv area near the Ajra border**.
- The newly discovered fungus was named **Microporellus kolhapurensis** after **Kolhapur district** in recognition of the region's **rich biodiversity**.

- The discovery was made by **Dr. Anjali Patil**, Head, Department of Botany, **Rajaram College, Kolhapur**, along with research scholar **Yogesh Patil** during field studies in the **Bediv area of Bhudargad taluka**.

About Botanical Survey of India (BSI) :

- Established : **1890**
- Headquarters : **Kolkata, West Bengal**
- It functions under the **Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)**, and is responsible for the **survey, documentation, conservation, and research** of India's plant diversity.

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

GalaxEye Loses Contact with World's First OptoSAR Satellite Drishti After Suspected Space Weather Anomaly

- **Bengaluru-based space startup GalaxEye** lost communication with **Mission Drishti**, the world's first **OptoSAR (Optical + Synthetic Aperture Radar)** Earth observation satellite, after an onboard anomaly.
- Mission Drishti was launched on **3 May 2026** aboard **SpaceX's Falcon 9 rocket**, marking a major milestone for India's private space sector.
- Drishti was the **world's first satellite to integrate Electro-Optical (EO) and Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR)** sensors on a single platform.
- The combination of **EO and SAR technology** enabled **all-weather, day-and-night, and continuous Earth observation**, overcoming limitations of conventional optical satellites.

India and Indonesia Sign Landmark Deal for Export of Astra Mk 1 Missiles

- **India and Indonesia** signed a **landmark defence agreement** for the export of the **Astra Mk 1 Beyond Visual Range Air-to-Air Missile (BVRAAM)**, making **Indonesia** the **first foreign country** to import India's indigenously developed Astra missile system.
- The agreements were announced during **Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Indonesia**, strengthening bilateral defence cooperation under India's **Act East Policy**.
- The defence package also includes the export of **BrahMos supersonic cruise missiles** and cooperation in defence technology, maritime security, and critical minerals.
- The **BrahMos Missile Defence System contract** was signed between **BrahMos Aerospace** and the **Ministry of Defence of Indonesia**.

- The **Astra Mk 1 export agreement** was signed between **Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL)** and **Republikorp**.

Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh Launches Phase-III of Biomedical Research Career Programme with ₹1,500 Crore Joint Department of Biotechnology–Wellcome Trust Funding

- **Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh** launched **Phase-III** of the **Biomedical Research Career Programme (BRCP)** with a total outlay of **₹1,500 crore** to strengthen India's biomedical research ecosystem.
- **Phase-III of BRCP** has funding support of **₹1,000 crore** from the **Department of Biotechnology (DBT)** and **₹500 crore** from the **Wellcome Trust, United Kingdom (UK)**.
- The programme is jointly implemented by the **Department of Biotechnology (DBT)**, Government of India, and the **Wellcome Trust (UK)** through the **DBT–Wellcome Trust India Alliance**.

Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency Successfully Completes Japan's First Reusable Rocket Lift-off and Landing Test

- The **Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)** successfully conducted the **first lift-off and landing test** of its **RV-X reusable rocket prototype** at the **Noshiro Testing Center, Akita Prefecture, Japan**.
- During the test, the **RV-X rocket** lifted off to approximately **10 metres (33 feet)**, remained airborne for about **40 seconds**, and completed a **safe vertical landing**.
- The test marked **Japan's first successful lift-off and landing demonstration** of a reusable rocket prototype.
- **RV-X** successfully demonstrated **Vertical Take-Off and Vertical Landing (VTVL)** technology, a key capability for future reusable launch vehicles.
- The **RV-X reusable rocket** was jointly developed by the **Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)** and **Mitsubishi Heavy Industries (MHI)**.

About Japan:

- Capital: Tokyo
- Currency: Japanese Yen (JPY)
- Prime Minister: Sanae Takaichi

Indian Space Research Organisation Successfully Conducts Three Critical Gaganyaan Crew Module System Tests

- The **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** successfully conducted **three critical tests** of the **Gaganyaan Crew Module (CM)** systems as part of India's **Human Spaceflight Programme**.
- The successful tests mark another **significant milestone** towards India's first crewed orbital mission under the **Gaganyaan Mission**.
- The first test validated the **Crew Module Uprighting System (CMUS)** through a **Float Inflation Test**.
- The **Crew Module Uprighting System (CMUS)** ensures that the Crew Module returns to an **upright position after splashdown** in the sea, which is a **critical astronaut safety feature**.

About ISRO:

- Established: 15 August 1969
- Headquarters: Bangalore, Karnataka
- Chairman: V. Narayanan

Technology Development Board Supports K. N. Biosciences' Indigenous C-Phycocyanin Production Project Using Spirulina

- **Technology Development Board (TDB)** under the **Department of Science & Technology (DST)**, Government of India, has extended financial assistance to **M/s K. N. Biosciences (India) Private Limited, Hyderabad** for the project **"Production of C-Phycocyanin using Spirulina sp. as a Cell Factory."**
- The project aims to commercialise **indigenous technology** for producing **C-Phycocyanin**, a **natural blue pigment**, reducing India's dependence on **imported natural colourants** and strengthening **biotechnology-based sustainable manufacturing**.

Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology and Drone Federation India Launch National Innovation Challenge for Drone Application and Research 2.0 to Promote Indigenous Chip-Based Drone Innovation

- The **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, in partnership with the **Drone Federation India (DFI)**, launched the **2nd edition of the National Innovation Challenge for Drone Application and Research (NIDAR 2.0)** for **2026–27** under the **SwaYaan Initiative** at **Electronics Niketan, New Delhi**.
- During the launch event, **S. Krishnan, Secretary, MeitY**, formally unveiled the **problem statements, poster, and rulebook** for **NIDAR 2.0**.

- **NIDAR 2.0** focuses on developing **autonomous drone systems, indigenous avionics, and core drone components**, promoting self-reliance (**Aatmanirbharta**) in **India's drone ecosystem**.

About Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology :

- Cabinet Minister : Ashwini Vaishnaw
- Minister of State : Jitin Prasada

Scientists Develop Ultrafast Organic Anode Material for Next-Generation Rechargeable Batteries

- **Researchers from the Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science (IACS)** and **S. N. Bose National Centre for Basic Sciences (SNBNCBS)**, both under the **Department of Science and Technology (DST)**, developed a new **porous organic anode material** for **high-performance lithium-ion batteries**.
- The newly developed material is a **Covalent Organic Framework (COF)**, a porous organic material designed to improve **energy storage capacity**, **fast charging**, and **battery durability**.
- The research team was led by **Dr. Urmimala Maitra (IACS)** and **Dr. Pradip Pachfule (SNBNCBS)**.
- The **COF-based anode material** enables lithium ions to move more efficiently, resulting in **faster charging**, **improved ion transport**, **enhanced charge storage**, and **greater structural stability**.

Kerala-Based HEX20 Successfully Launches Its Second Satellite 'KOYO' on SpaceX Transporter-17 Mission

- Kerala-based private spacetech startup **HEX20** successfully launched its second satellite, **KOYO (Kinetic Optical Yaw Observer)** aboard **SpaceX's Transporter-17 mission** from **Vandenberg Space Force Base, California, USA**.
- KOYO successfully entered **Earth orbit** as a **multi-payload technology demonstration platform**, carrying **81 payloads** for in-orbit technology validation and commissioning of international payloads.
- The primary objective of the **KOYO Mission** is to qualify and validate **space hardware** before operational deployment through real-time in-orbit testing.

CSIR-Central Road Research Institute Launches Platinum Jubilee Celebrations with Nationwide Rollout of Indigenous Road Technologies

- **CSIR–Central Road Research Institute (CSIR-CRRI)** commenced its **Platinum Jubilee Celebrations** from **16 July 2026 to 16 July 2027**, marking **75 years of scientific excellence** in road infrastructure research.
- As part of the celebrations, CSIR-CRRI launched the **first phase of nationwide implementation** of its advanced indigenous road infrastructure technologies across **16 towns/locations** in India.
- The initiative aims to **demonstrate, commercialise, and scale up** innovative road construction and maintenance technologies through collaboration with industry and implementing agencies.

Tata Consultancy Services Signs Expanded Artificial Intelligence-Driven Global Network Operations Deal with ABB

- **Tata Consultancy Services (TCS)** signed a **multi-million, multi-year agreement** with **ABB** to transform ABB's global network operations using **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**.
- The agreement marks the next phase of the **20-year partnership** between TCS and ABB, expanding TCS's role to deliver **end-to-end AI-driven global network operations**.
- The main objective is to transform ABB's global network into a **standardised, centrally managed, AI-driven digital infrastructure** through an integrated **Network-as-a-Service (NaaS)** model.

About ABB :

- **ABB** is a **Swedish-Swiss technology company** specialising in **electrification and automation**, formed in **1988** through the merger of **ASEA (Sweden)** and **Brown, Boveri & Cie (BBC) (Switzerland)**.
- **Headquarters**: **Zurich, Switzerland**.

Ministry of Food Processing Industries & National Institute of Food Technology Entrepreneurship and Management -Thanjavur Launch Pilot Baking Skill Training Programme at ITC-Trichy

- The **Ministry of Food Processing Industries (MoFPI)**, in collaboration with the **National Institute of Food Technology Entrepreneurship and Management (NIFTEM), Thanjavur**, launched a pilot **Short-Term Skill Training Programme (STSTP)** on the **Assistant Baking Technician (NSQF Level 3) Certificate Programme** at the **ITC – Integrated Consumer Goods Manufacturing and Logistics (ITC-ICML) facility** in **Trichy, Tamil Nadu**.
- The programme was inaugurated by **Prof. V. Palanimuthu, Director, NIFTEM-Thanjavur**, in the presence of **Surjeet Singh Roria, General Manager (GM) & Head, ITC-ICML**, and **Padmanabhan T., Senior HR Manager, ITC-ICML**.

- The objective of the STSTP is to **upskill youth in food processing, manufacturing, and allied sectors**, thereby **enhancing employability** and **promoting entrepreneurship** in the food processing industry.

VELS Institute of Science, Technology, & Advanced Studies Launches India's First Artificial Intelligence-Integrated Vertical University Campus in Chennai

- **Padma Shri Sridhar Vembu**, Chief Scientist and Co-founder of **Zoho Corporation Pvt. Ltd.**, inaugurated the **Thiruvanmiyur campus** of **VELS Institute of Science, Technology, & Advanced Studies (VISTAS)** in **Chennai, Tamil Nadu**.
- The newly inaugurated VISTAS Thiruvanmiyur campus is regarded as **India's first Artificial Intelligence (AI)-integrated vertical university campus**.
- The inauguration ceremony was presided over by **Dr. Ishari K. Ganesh, Founder and Chancellor of VISTAS**, along with **Dr. Preetha Ganesh, Vice-President (VP), VELS Group of Institutions**.

pi-labs and Google Cloud Join Hands to Develop Secure Artificial Intelligence Solutions for India

- **pi-labs**, an Indian **Artificial Intelligence (AI) and deepfake detection company**, entered into a **strategic partnership with Google Cloud** to develop secure, scalable, and mission-ready AI solutions for India.
- The collaboration aims to strengthen **regional security operations**, **digital governance**, public sector organisations, and **critical enterprise infrastructure** through AI-powered technologies.
- Under the partnership, pi-labs will combine its indigenous AI capabilities with the **Google Distributed Cloud Tactical Appliance** to meet the evolving requirements of government institutions and critical infrastructure.

About pi-labs:

- **pi-labs** is an Indian **cyber forensics, cybersecurity, and intelligence company** that develops **Sovereign Artificial Intelligence (AI) solutions** for security, digital governance, and critical infrastructure protection.
- pi-labs is recognised under the **NASSCOM DeepTech League** and is supported by the **NVIDIA Inception Programme**, which promotes AI and deep technology startups.
- Founder & CEO : Ankush Tiwari

Bharat Tex 2026 Showcases India's Textile Excellence and Global Business Opportunities

- **Bharat Tex 2026** showcases India's textile ecosystem by bringing together manufacturers, handloom cooperatives, traditional artisans, technology startups, and global buyers under one platform.
- The event is guided by the **5F Vision – Farm → Fibre → Factory → Fashion → Foreign**, highlighting India's complete textile value chain from raw material production to global exports.

Skyroot Aerospace Launches India's First Privately Developed Orbital Rocket Vikram-1 Under Mission Aagaman

- **Skyroot Aerospace Private Limited**, a **Hyderabad (Telangana)-based** private spacetech company, successfully launched **Vikram-1**, **India's first privately developed orbital-class launch vehicle**, under **Mission Aagaman (Arrival)** from **Satish Dhawan Space Centre (SDSC-SHAR), Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh**.
- With this mission, **India** became the **3rd country** after the **United States (USA)** and **China** to achieve **private orbital launch capability**, following the **Indian Space Policy, 2023**.
- **Skyroot Aerospace** was founded in **2018** and previously created history by launching **Vikram-S**, **India's first private suborbital rocket**, in **November 2022**.

Jio Receives Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre Clearance to Launch Indigenous 1,600-Satellite Low Earth Orbit Broadband Constellation

- **Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited (Jio)**, the telecom arm of **Reliance Industries Limited (RIL)**, received technical approval from the **Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe)** to deploy a **Low Earth Orbit (LEO) satellite constellation** of around **1,600 satellites**.
- The proposal was evaluated in consultation with the **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** and the **Wireless Planning & Coordination (WPC) Wing** of the **Department of Telecommunications (DoT)** under the **Ministry of Communications**.

About Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited :

- **Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited** was established in **2007** and is headquartered at **Ghansoli, Navi Mumbai, Maharashtra**.
- **Jio** operates as a subsidiary of **Jio Platforms**, which is part of **Reliance Industries Limited (RIL)**, and is one of India's **largest telecom and digital services providers**.

India Commissions First-Ever Geothermal Wells in Ladakh to Power Geothermal Energy Development

- **India** commissioned its **first-ever geothermal wells** at **Puga Valley, Ladakh**, marking a major milestone in the country's **renewable energy sector**.
- The project was inaugurated by **Lieutenant Governor V.K. Saxena** at **Puga Valley, Ladakh**, located at an altitude of **over 14,000 feet**.
- **Two geothermal wells**, each drilled to a depth of **1,000 metres**, have been successfully commissioned, making them the **deepest geothermal wells in India**.

Union Minister Shri Pralhad Joshi Launches White Rabbit Technology-Based Indian Standard Time Network in Bengaluru

- **Union Minister Pralhad Joshi** (**Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution (MoCAF&PD)** and **Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)**) inaugurated the **White Rabbit Technology-based Indian Standard Time (IST) Distribution Demonstration Network** at the **Regional Reference Standards Laboratory (RRSL), Jakkur, Bengaluru, Karnataka**.
- The initiative has been launched under the vision of **"One Nation, One Time"** to establish a uniform, highly precise, secure, and indigenous **Indian Standard Time (IST)** network, reducing India's dependence on **foreign GPS-based time sources** and strengthening **digital sovereignty**.

Indian Analog Astronaut Captain Aman Johri Completes Microgravity Mission to Advance Space Research on Maharashtra Crops

- **Captain Aman Johri**, an **Indian Analog Astronaut**, successfully completed a **microgravity research flight** under **Project Astra Farm**, marking a major milestone in **India's space biotechnology** and **sustainable space food systems**.
- The mission focused on studying **Maharashtra-grown onions and potatoes**, which were flown aboard a specially designed **passive microgravity payload**.
- The research was conducted in collaboration with the **National Research Council Canada (NRC-CNRC)** to analyse the behaviour of agricultural crops under **microgravity conditions**.

CSIR-Indian Institute of Chemical Technology Develops India's First Indigenous Technology to Produce HFO-1234yf Green Refrigerant

- **CSIR–Indian Institute of Chemical Technology (CSIR-IICT), Hyderabad** has developed India's first indigenous process technology for manufacturing **Hydrofluoroolefin-1234yf (HFO-1234yf)**, a next-generation **green refrigerant** for refrigeration and air-conditioning systems.

- **HFO-1234yf** is designed to replace **Hydrofluorocarbons (HFCs)** because it has **Zero Ozone Depletion Potential (ODP)**, **Very Low Global Warming Potential (GWP)**, and a short atmospheric lifetime of about **11 days**.

Central Drugs Standard Control Organization Approves Novo Nordisk's Wegovy for Treatment of Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatohepatitis

- **India's drug regulator**, the **Central Drugs Standard Control Organization (CDSCO)**, approved **Novo Nordisk's Wegovy (Semaglutide Injection 2.4 mg)** for the treatment of **Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatohepatitis (MASH)**.
- The approval covers **noncirrhotic MASH** in adults with **moderate to advanced liver fibrosis**, along with a **reduced-calorie diet** and **increased physical activity**.
- **Wegovy** became the **first and only GLP-1 Receptor Agonist (GLP-1 RA)** approved globally and in India for treating **noncirrhotic MASH** with **moderate to advanced liver fibrosis**.
- **MASH (Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatohepatitis)** is a progressive liver disease caused by **fat accumulation in the liver**, leading to **chronic inflammation** and **liver damage**.

Indian Space Research Organisation Successfully Tests SOLVE Launch Vehicle for Gaganyaan Crew Module Parachute System at Sriharikota

- The **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** successfully conducted the **first static ground test** of the **Sub-Orbital Launch Vehicle for Experiments (SOLVE)**.
- The test was conducted at the **Static Test Facility** of the **Satish Dhawan Space Centre (SDSC)**, **Sriharikota**, **Andhra Pradesh**.
- **SOLVE** is a **solid-propellant**, **sub-orbital launch vehicle** developed as a dedicated test platform for the **Gaganyaan Mission**.
- The test successfully validated the **solid motor** for the **Integrated Parachute Test (IPT)** of the **Gaganyaan Crew Module**.
- **SOLVE** is designed to simulate the **Crew Module's deceleration** at an altitude of **10 km to 17 km** before human spaceflight.

About ISRO :

- Established: 15 August 1969
- Headquarters: Bangalore, Karnataka
- Chairman: V. Narayanan

Indiahandmade: A Digital Marketplace for India's Traditional Crafts

- **Indiahandmade** is a dedicated digital marketplace for **handloom and handicraft products**, launched in **2023** under the **Digital India Initiative**.
- The platform was developed by the **Digital India Corporation (DIC)** under the **Ministry of Textiles** to promote India's traditional handloom and handicraft sector through digital commerce.
- India is home to an estimated **64.66 lakh handloom and handicraft artisans**, making the sector a major source of employment, inclusive livelihoods, and cultural heritage.
- **Women account for 71% of handloom weavers and 64% of total artisans** (as of August 2025), highlighting the sector's role in **women empowerment** and **rural employment**.
- Indiahandmade enables artisans and weavers to sell handmade products online, providing them with **direct market access** without relying heavily on intermediaries.

Central Council for Research in Ayurvedic Sciences Unveils Three Key Initiatives to Advance Ayurveda Research and Digital Transformation

- **Vaidya Rajesh Kotecha**, Secretary, **Ministry of AYUSH**, chaired the **5th Executive Committee (EC) Meeting** of the **Central Council for Research in Ayurvedic Sciences (CCRAS)** in **New Delhi, Delhi**.
- **CCRAS** is the **apex research body** under the Ministry of AYUSH (Ayurveda, Yoga & Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, Sowa-Rigpa and Homeopathy).
- The meeting aimed to strengthen **evidence-based Ayurveda research**, education, scientific communication, and **digital governance**.
- The meeting was attended by **Hoveyda Abbas** (Additional Secretary & Financial Adviser, Ministry of AYUSH), **Satyajit Paul** (Senior Statistical Adviser), **Dr. N. Srikanth** (Deputy Director General, CCRAS), **Deepak Kochhar** (Deputy Director–Administration, CCRAS), and other Executive Committee members.
- **Three major initiatives** were launched during the meeting: **Research Methodology Textbook**, **CCRAS PRAYATNA 2026–27**, and the **CCRAS Digital Ecosystem Dashboard**.

China Launches HY-2E Oceanographic Satellite to Strengthen Marine Observation

- **China** successfully launched its latest oceanographic satellite, **Haiyang (HY)-2E**, aboard a **Long March 4B rocket** from the **Jiuquan Satellite Launch Center**, Northwest China.
- The launch marked China's **47th space mission in 2026** and the **654th flight** of the **Long March rocket series**.
- **HY-2E** is designed to replace the **HY-2B satellite**, which was launched in 2018.

- **HY-2E** will operate together with the existing **HY-2C and HY-2D satellites** to monitor the **global marine dynamic environment**.

About China :

- President : Xi Jinping
- Capital : Beijing
- Currency : Renminbi

Poshan Tracker: India's Digital Platform for Real-Time Nutrition Governance

- **POSHAN Abhiyaan (Prime Minister's Overarching Scheme for Holistic Nourishment)** is India's flagship **National Nutrition Mission**, launched on **8 March 2018**, to improve nutrition outcomes through convergence, technology, and community mobilisation.
- POSHAN Abhiyaan functions under the **Ministry of Women and Child Development (MoWCD)** and follows a **Jan Andolan (People's Movement)** approach with time-bound targets, digital monitoring, and a multi-ministerial framework.
- Under Union Budget 2021–22, POSHAN Abhiyaan, Anganwadi Services, and the Scheme for Adolescent Girls were merged under **Mission POSHAN 2.0 (Mission Saksham Anganwadi and Poshan 2.0)**.

Centre Forms ICAR Expert Committee to Address Issues of Totapuri Mango Growers in Andhra Pradesh

- **Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan** directed **ICAR (Indian Council of Agricultural Research)** to constitute a **high-level expert committee** to address the problems faced by **Totapuri mango growers** in **Andhra Pradesh**.
- The decision was taken after farmers reported a **sharp fall in Totapuri mango prices**, resulting in heavy financial losses and **declining farm incomes**.
- The committee will conduct a **comprehensive study** of the **Totapuri mango value chain**, covering cultivation, production costs, processing, marketing, domestic trade, exports, and farmers' income.
- The committee will also analyse **demand-supply dynamics**, processing capacity and utilisation, export market conditions, and the **factors responsible for the recent price decline**.

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- **Field visits** will be conducted **within 10 days**, during which the committee will interact with **farmers, processors, exporters, Farmer Producer Organisations (FPOs)**, and Andhra Pradesh Government officials.

About Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare :

- Cabinet Minister : Shivraj Singh Chouhan
- Minister of State : Bhagirath Choudhary, Ram Nath Thakur

Indian Space Research Organisation Clears CE20 Cryogenic Engine with Successful Hot Test for Launch Vehicle Mark-3-M7 Launch

- The **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** successfully conducted the **Flight Acceptance Hot Test** of the **CE20 Cryogenic Engine** for the **LVM3-M7 (Launch Vehicle Mark-3 Mission-7)**.
- The test was conducted at the **Main Engine & Stage Test Facility (MET)** of the **ISRO Propulsion Complex (IPRC), Mahendragiri, Tamil Nadu**.
- During the test, the CE20 Cryogenic Engine operated at **19.5 tonnes of thrust for 45 seconds** and **22 tonnes of thrust for 25 seconds**, successfully validating its performance for the LVM3-M7 mission.
- The **Nozzle Protection System (NPS)** was used for the **first time** during a CE20 engine flight acceptance test.

About ISRO:

- Established: 15 August 1969
- Headquarters: Bangalore, Karnataka
- Chairman: V. Narayanan

IBM Unveils World's First Sub-1 Nanometre Semiconductor Chip Technology

- **IBM** unveiled the world's first **sub-1 nanometre (0.7 nm / 7 angstrom) semiconductor chip technology**, marking a major breakthrough in next-generation computing and semiconductor manufacturing.
- The innovation moves chip manufacturing beyond the traditional nanometre era toward **atomic-scale (angstrom-level) engineering**, overcoming the physical limits of conventional chip scaling.
- The chip is built using IBM's **3D "Nanostack" transistor architecture**, the industry's first three-dimensional nanosheet-based transistor design.

- The 0.7 nm (7 angstrom) chip packs nearly **100 billion transistors** on a chip approximately the size of a fingernail, almost **twice the transistor density** of IBM's 2 nm chip launched in 2021.

Sub-Mission on Agricultural Mechanization: Advancing Farm Productivity Through Modern Mechanization

- **The Sub-Mission on Agricultural Mechanization (SMAM)** was launched in **2014–15** as a **Centrally Sponsored Scheme (CSS)** under the **Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana (RKVY)** to promote farm mechanization across India.
- **Objective:** To **"reach the unreached"** by extending mechanization benefits to **small & marginal farmers, women farmers, SCs, STs, Farmer Producer Organisations (FPOs), Self-Help Groups (SHGs)**, and rural entrepreneurs.
- **Farm mechanization** covers the **entire crop cycle** including land preparation, sowing, irrigation, plant protection, harvesting, and post-harvest management, improving productivity and **reducing labour dependence**.

India and Australia Enhance Traditional Knowledge Protection Through CSIR-Traditional Knowledge Digital Library Pact

- **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)** and **IP Australia** signed an Agreement for access to the **CSIR–Traditional Knowledge Digital Library (CSIR-TKDL)** during the **3rd India–Australia Annual Summit** held in **Melbourne, Australia**, on **9 July 2026**.
- The Agreement was concluded in the presence of Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** and Australian Prime Minister **Anthony Albanese**.
- The TKDL Access Agreement was one of the **18 key outcomes** of the India–Australia Annual Summit covering **defence, security, energy, education, skill development, science & technology, film-making, traditional knowledge, and repatriation of cultural properties**.
- TKDL was established in **2001** by the Government of India as a **joint initiative of CSIR and the Ministry of AYUSH**.

About Australia :

- Prime Minister : Anthony Albanese
- Capital : Canberra
- Currency : Australian dollar

Indian Space Research Organisation Completes IMAT-05 Main Parachute Airdrop Test for Gaganyaan G1 Mission in Madhya Pradesh

- **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** successfully conducted the **Integrated Main Parachute Airdrop Test-05 (IMAT-05)** for the **Gaganyaan G1 Mission** at the **Aerial Delivery Research and Development Establishment (ADRDE) Drop Zone, Sheopur, Madhya Pradesh**.
- **IMAT-05** was conducted to validate the **Main Parachute System** under maximum expected load conditions for the first uncrewed Gaganyaan G1 Mission.
- During the test, a simulated payload was dropped from an altitude of **2.5 kilometres (km)** using an **Indian Air Force (IAF) IL-76 aircraft** to verify the performance, reliability, and structural integrity of the Main Parachute System.

About ISRO (Indian Space Research Organisation) :

- Established : **15 August 1969**
- Headquarters : **Bengaluru, Karnataka**
- Chairman : **V. Narayanan**.

Centre for Studies of International Relations Launches International Centre for Civilizational Studies "Manas and Mahabharata" in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan

- **Centre for Studies of International Relations (CSIR), New Delhi**, in collaboration with the **Manas National Academy**, established the **International Centre for Civilizational Studies "Manas and Mahabharata"** in **Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan**.
- The International Centre for Civilizational Studies aims to strengthen **scientific, educational, and cultural cooperation** between India and Kyrgyzstan through **comparative civilizational and epic studies**.
- The Centre was **inaugurated** during the visit of an Indian delegation to Kyrgyzstan from **4–7 July 2026**.
- The Centre will promote comparative civilizational studies, **humanitarian diplomacy**, international scientific cooperation, and **researcher training**.

About Kyrgyzstan :

- President : Sadyr Japarov
- Capital : Bishkek
- Currency : Kyrgyzstani som

National Aeronautics and Space Administration Astronaut Anil Menon to Embark on Maiden Mission to the International Space Station

- **National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) astronaut Anil Menon** is scheduled to launch to the **International Space Station (ISS)** on **14 July 2026** aboard the **Roscosmos Soyuz MS-29 spacecraft**.
- The launch will take place from the **Baikonur Cosmodrome, Kazakhstan**.
- **Anil Menon** will travel with Roscosmos cosmonauts **Pyotr Dubrov** and **Anna Kikina** as part of **Expedition 74/75**.
- The Soyuz MS-29 spacecraft will automatically dock with the **Prichal module** of the ISS after a **two-orbit, three-hour journey**.
- On arrival, the crew will join NASA astronauts **Jessica Meir**, **Jack Hathaway**, **Chris Williams**, ESA astronaut **Sophie Adenot**, and Roscosmos cosmonauts **Sergey Kud-Sverchkov**, **Serhei Mikaev**, and **Andrey Fedyaev**.

Ministry of Road Transport and Highways Entrusts Indian Institute of Technology Madras and Centre for Development of Advanced Computing with Centralised National Bridge Health Monitoring Platform

- The **Union Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH)** plans to centralise the **National Bridge Health Monitoring Software** by involving **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Madras** and the **Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC)**.
- The software is linked to the **Bridge Health Monitoring System (BHMS)**, which uses **sensor-based technology** for **real-time monitoring** of bridges on the **National Highway network**.
- The **Bridge Health Monitoring System (BHMS)** continuously monitors bridge movement, stress, vibration, and structural health using **sensors installed on bridge components**.

Chinese AI Startup DeepSeek Reportedly Developing Indigenous AI Inference Chip

- **DeepSeek** is a Chinese **Artificial Intelligence (AI) startup** headquartered in **Hangzhou, China**.
- In **July 2026**, DeepSeek was linked to the development of a **custom AI chip** designed for **AI inference workloads** and to reduce China's dependence on foreign semiconductor technology.
- **AI Inference** is the stage where a trained AI model processes inputs and generates outputs such as text, images, or predictions.

- **AI Training** is the process of building an AI model using large datasets and high computational power, requiring more advanced hardware than inference.
- The AI chip project reportedly began around **July 2025** and remained in an early development stage during 2026.
- **United States (US) restrictions** on the export of advanced **NVIDIA AI chips** to China have accelerated the development of **indigenous AI hardware**.

National Aeronautics and Space Administration Plans to Repurpose PROMISE Mars Rover as Lunar Explorer for Artemis Mission

- **National Aeronautics and Space Administration** (**NASA)** is considering repurposing **PROMISE (Polar Rover for Observation, Mapping, and In-Situ Exploration)** into a lunar rover for the **Artemis Programme**.
- PROMISE is a **full-scale engineering model** that was originally built to support the **Curiosity and Perseverance Mars rover missions**.
- If approved, PROMISE will explore the **Moon's South Pole**, one of the key target regions of the Artemis Programme.
- The rover will **map lunar terrain**, search for **water ice** and other resources, identify sites for future lunar infrastructure, and support NASA's long-term goal of establishing a permanent human presence on the Moon.

Council of Scientific and Industrial Research–Central Institute of Mining and Fuel Research Develops India's First Mobile Smart Algal Liquid Tree for Air Purification

- **Scientists at the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research–Central Institute of Mining and Fuel Research (CSIR-CIMFR)**, Dhanbad, Jharkhand, developed India's first mobile "Liquid Tree", called the **Smart Algal Liquid Tree (SALT)**.
- **SALT (Smart Algal Liquid Tree)** is an innovative **air purification system** designed to improve air quality in densely populated urban and industrial areas where planting conventional trees is difficult.
- SALT is a compact container filled with water and **microalgae**, which are microscopic single-celled organisms that perform **photosynthesis** by absorbing **carbon dioxide (CO_2)** and releasing **oxygen (O_2)**.
- Microalgae are responsible for generating nearly **50% of the Earth's oxygen** through photosynthesis.

South Korea to Launch Fourth Medium-Sized Earth Observation Satellite on SpaceX Falcon 9 Rocket

- **South Korea** is set to launch its **4th next-generation medium-sized Earth Observation Satellite** aboard a **SpaceX Falcon 9 rocket** from **Vandenberg Space Force Base, California, USA**.
- The satellite has been developed under the **Korea AeroSpace Administration (KASA)**.
- The **500-kg satellite** carries indigenous **high-resolution imaging payloads** capable of capturing images of the entire **Korean Peninsula** every three days.
- The satellite will be placed in **Low Earth Orbit (LEO)** at an altitude of approximately **888 km**.
- After launch, the satellite will undergo **four months of in-orbit testing** before becoming fully operational in the **first half of 2027**.

About South Korea :

- **President :** Lee Jae Myung
- **Prime Minister :** Han Seong-sook
- **Capital :** Seoul
- **Currency :** Korean Republic won

Government of India Approves Dixon Technologies–Vivo Mobile India Joint Venture for Smartphone Manufacturing in India

- The **Government of India (GoI)** approved the formation of a **Joint Venture (JV)** between **Dixon Technologies (India) Limited** and **Vivo Mobile India Limited (VMI)** for the manufacturing of electronic devices and smartphones in India.
- As per the JV agreement and shareholders' agreement, the proposed entity will function as an **Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM)** for electronic devices, particularly smartphones.
- Under the shareholding structure, **Dixon Technologies will hold a 51% stake**, while **Vivo Mobile India Limited (VMI) will own the remaining 49% stake** in the Joint Venture.
- The Joint Venture (JV) will be incorporated with an **initial paid-up capital of ₹5 crore**, contributed by both companies in proportion to their respective shareholding.

China Successfully Recovers Long March-10B Reusable Rocket Booster for the First Time

- **China** successfully achieved the first **controlled recovery of an orbital-class reusable rocket booster** following the maiden launch of the **Long March-10B carrier rocket** from **Hainan Province, China**.
- The **Long March-10B** was developed by the **China Academy of Launch Vehicle Technology (CALT)** and successfully placed its payload into orbit, while its **first-stage booster** was recovered on a **sea-based net platform**.
- This mission marks China's **first-ever controlled recovery of an orbital-class reusable rocket booster**, representing a major breakthrough in the country's **reusable space technology**.
- The achievement comes more than a decade after **SpaceX**, which became the first company in the world to recover an orbital-class rocket booster with the **Falcon 9 in 2015**.

About China:

- Capital: Beijing
- Currency: Renminbi (CNY)

AgniKul Cosmos and ICEYE Join Hands to Build India's End-to-End Synthetic Aperture Radar Satellite Ecosystem

- **AgniKul Cosmos Private Limited**, an Indian private space startup, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with **ICEYE**, a Finland-based Earth observation company, to jointly develop an end-to-end **Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR)** Earth-observation ecosystem from India.
- The MoU was signed during the **Bharat Innovates Summit**, held in **Nice, France**, from **30 June to 1 July 2026**.
- The collaboration combines ICEYE's advanced **SAR satellite technology** with AgniKul Cosmos' **indigenous launch vehicle capability**.
- The partnership aims to establish a **sovereign end-to-end space ecosystem** in India, reducing dependence on foreign space systems.
- **Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR)** satellites use **radar technology** instead of optical cameras to capture high-resolution Earth images, irrespective of **cloud cover, weather conditions, or day and night**.

Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission: Powering India's Digital Healthcare Ecosystem

- **Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM)** was launched in **September 2021** by the **Government of India** to create an integrated, citizen-centric national digital health ecosystem.

- ABDM is one of the world's largest digital health ecosystems, with over **104 crore health records** linked to more than **93 crore Ayushman Bharat Health Account (ABHA)** accounts.
- The mission supports **Universal Health Coverage (UHC)** by enabling quality healthcare services, reducing paperwork, shortening waiting times, and improving healthcare accessibility.
- ABDM securely manages digital patient records, connects patients, hospitals, doctors, laboratories, pharmacies, insurers, and enables **seamless portability of health records** across ABDM-enabled healthcare facilities.

Indian Space Research Organisation Successfully Demonstrates High-Thrust Semi-Cryogenic Engine Power Head Test

- **Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)** successfully conducted a **hot test** of the **Semi-Cryogenic Engine Power Head Test Article (PHTA)** at the **ISRO Propulsion Complex (IPC), Mahendragiri, Tamil Nadu**.
- The hot test achieved **88% of the target thrust**, generating **175 tonnes of thrust**, marking a major milestone in the development of India's next-generation rocket propulsion system.
- The test was the **8th hot test in the PHTA test series**, following earlier successful tests at **47% (94 tonnes) and 60% (120 tonnes)** of full thrust.
- The successful **175-tonne test** has provided ISRO with confidence to proceed towards the **full-thrust demonstration of 200 tonnes**.
- The **SE2000 Semi-Cryogenic Engine** is designed to produce **2,000 kilonewtons (kN) of thrust** and will power the **SC120 (Semi-Cryogenic Stage)**.

About ISRO:

- Established: 15 August 1969
- Headquarters: Bangalore, Karnataka
- Chairman: V. Narayanan

Gautam Buddha University Collaborates with Space Kidz India and Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre to Support World's First All-Girls Lunar Mission

- **Gautam Buddha University (GBU)** has entered into a strategic partnership with **Space Kidz India** and the **Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe)** to support **Mission ShakthiSAT**, the world's first all-girls international lunar mission.

- **Mission ShakthiSAT** aims to advance space technology, promote **STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics) education**, and encourage **women-led leadership** in the space sector.
- The mission is an **international student space initiative** designed to empower **12,000 young girls from 108 countries** through hands-on experience in **satellite development, space technology, research, and innovation**.
- A major objective of Mission ShakthiSAT is to foster **global scientific collaboration, interdisciplinary learning**, and inspire greater **female participation** in the global space ecosystem.

Indian Institute of Technology Delhi, Sorbonne University to Introduce Joint Master's and PhD Courses in Biological Science from 2026

- **Indian Institute of Technology Delhi (IIT Delhi) and Sorbonne University, France** have expanded their strategic partnership by launching a joint **Master of Science (MSc) in Biological Science (Biol. Sci) and Doctor of Philosophy (PhD)** programmes from **2026**.
- The collaboration is anchored by the **Franco-Indian Integrated Health Campus**, established to integrate **engineering, medicine, life sciences, social sciences, and digital technologies**.
- The partnership extends beyond healthcare to promote **research, education, and innovation** in **Artificial Intelligence (AI), robotics, and materials science**.
- The Franco-Indian Integrated Health Campus programmes are coordinated by **IIT Delhi**, following the visit of an IIT Delhi delegation led by **Professor Rangan Banerjee** to Sorbonne University.

Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh Launches Four Advanced R&D Facilities and Unveils ₹44.46 Crore Hostel Project at CSIR-Indian Institute of Chemical Technology Hyderabad

- **Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh** inaugurated **four Advanced R&D facilities** and laid the foundation stone of a **₹44.46 crore, 200-student hostel complex** at **CSIR–Indian Institute of Chemical Technology (CSIR-IICT), Hyderabad**.
- The four facilities inaugurated include the **Advanced R&D Facility for Fluorochemicals**, **Continuous Processing Platform for Industrial Chemicals**, **Sustainable Engineering Complex (SustEC)**, and the **500 KLD Decentralized Effluent Treatment Plant for the Siripuram Handloom Cluster**.
- The **₹44.46 crore hostel complex** will strengthen residential infrastructure for young researchers and promote a better research ecosystem.

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- The programme witnessed participation from scientists, industry representatives, startups, technology partners, research scholars, and students, highlighting the focus on **industry-academia collaboration**.

Technology Development Board Supports Puretronics India to Commercialise India's First Indigenous Contactless Programmable Load Measurement System

- The **Technology Development Board (TDB)** under the **Department of Science & Technology (DST)** has provided financial assistance to **M/s Puretronics India Private Limited, Mumbai** for the project **"LMO – Load Measurement Overload Sensor (India's First Fully Contactless Programmable Load Measurement System)"**.
- The project aims to commercialize **India's first indigenous fully contactless programmable load measurement system**, bridging a critical technology gap in India's industrial automation ecosystem.
- The **LMO (Load Magnetic Overload Sensor)** is designed for elevators, material handling systems, cable machinery, industrial automation, cranes, hoists, and other safety-critical applications.

Directorate General of Civil Aviation Successfully Conducts India's First Satellite-Based Landing System Approach on an IndiGo Airbus A320

- The **Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA)** under the **Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA)** successfully conducted **India's first Satellite-Based Landing System (SLS) approach** on a commercial jet aircraft using an **IndiGo Airbus A320** at **Maharana Pratap Airport, Udaipur, Rajasthan**.
- The demonstration used **GAGAN (GPS Aided GEO Augmented Navigation)**, India's **indigenous Satellite-Based Augmentation System (SBAS)**, marking a major milestone in satellite-guided precision landings in India.
- The approach was carried out using **Localiser Performance with Vertical Guidance (LPV) technology**, which provides both **lateral (left-right) and vertical (up-down) guidance** to the runway.

About Directorate General of Civil Aviation :

- **Headquarters : New Delhi, India**
- **Director General :** Vir Vikram Yadav
- **Union Minister of** Minister of Civil Aviation **:** Kinjarapu Ram Mohan Naidu
- **Minister of State :** Murlidhar Mohol

CSIR-National Chemical Laboratory Launches Modernized State-of-the-Art Skill Development Centre

- **CSIR–National Chemical Laboratory (CSIR-NCL), Pune** inaugurated its newly renovated **State-of-the-Art Skill Development Center** to strengthen scientific and technical skill development.
- The **Skill Development Center** was inaugurated by **Dr. Ashish Lele, Director, CSIR-NCL**.
- **Chief Guest**: **Dr. Vinay Kumar**, Nodal Scientist for the **CSIR-Integrated Skill Initiative (CSIR-HRDC), Ghaziabad**.
- The **modernization of the facility** was sponsored by **Envalior** under its **Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)** initiative.
- Other dignitaries present included **Dr. Rajesh Gonnade (NCL Skill Nodal Officer)** and **Mrs. Kanika Goel (Controller of Administration – COA, CSIR-NCL)**.

Self-Help Entrepreneur–Livelihoods and Enterprise Application for Prosperity and Sustainability: A Digital Platform to Empower Lakhpati Didis Across Rural India

- **SHE-LEAPS** stands for **Self-Help Entrepreneur–Livelihoods and Enterprise Application for Prosperity and Sustainability**.
- **SHE-LEAPS** is a **digital platform** designed to **empower women** associated with **Self-Help Groups (SHGs)** across rural India.
- The platform provides a **unified system** for **enterprise creation, performance tracking, livelihood generation, enterprise growth**, and **financial inclusion**.
- **SHE-LEAPS** supports both **farm and non-farm rural enterprises**, helping build a stronger and sustainable rural economy.
- The **SHE-LEAPS mobile application** has been developed by the **Digital India Corporation** and implemented under the **LokOS platform**.

MANAS: India's Digital Platform to Combat Drug Abuse and Trafficking

- **National Narcotics Helpline MANAS** stands for **Madak Padarth Nishedh Asoochna Kendra**.
- **MANAS** was launched on **18 July 2024** under the aegis of the **Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB)**, **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA)**, in collaboration with the **Digital India Corporation (DIC)**.
- **Objective of MANAS**: To provide a secure, confidential, technology-driven platform for **reporting drug trafficking**, substance abuse, and providing **counselling and rehabilitation support**.

- **MANAS** integrates the vision of **Digital India** with the mission of **Nasha Mukt Bharat**.
- The platform is accessible through the **National Helpline Number – 1933**, Official Web Portal, Email, and the **UMANG App**.
- **MANAS** enables citizens to **confidentially report drug trafficking**, drug peddling, illegal cultivation of narcotic substances, and other drug-related activities **without revealing their identity**.

Indian Institute of Technology Delhi and Defence Research and Development Organisation Develop India's First Indigenous Tactical Aerostat with 20 km Surveillance Capability

- The **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi**, in collaboration with the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** and a domestic startup, developed **India's first indigenous tactical aerostat**.
- The indigenous tactical aerostat is a **low-cost, high-altitude, balloon-based platform** capable of carrying **surveillance and communication payloads** with an operational coverage of **up to 20 km**.
- The platform is equipped with **Electro-optical (EO) cameras, Infrared (IR) sensors**, and **communication relay systems** for persistent aerial surveillance and communication support.
- Compared to drones, the tactical aerostat offers **higher endurance, greater payload capacity, persistent surveillance**, and **extended communication support**.

About DRDO :

- **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)** is India's premier **military research agency**.
- Established : **1958**
- Headquarters : **New Delhi, Delhi**.
- Parent Ministry: Ministry of Defence, Government of India
- Chairman: Rajesh Kumar Singh

Ministry of Civil Aviation Clears India's First Private PinS Satellite-Based Instrument Approach Procedure for Helicopters

- The **Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA)** approved **India's first Private Point-in-Space (PinS) Instrument Approach Procedure** for helicopter operations at **Undavalli Heliport, Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh**.
- The **PinS Instrument Approach Procedure** was developed by the **Airports Authority of India (AAI)** and approved by the **Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA)**.

- The procedure has been developed in accordance with DGCA regulations and the **International Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO)** Standards and Recommended Practices (SARPs).
- **Point-in-Space (PinS)** is a **satellite-guided instrument approach procedure** designed specifically for helicopter operations.
- The system is based on **Performance-Based Navigation (PBN)** using the **Global Navigation Satellite System (GNSS)** together with India's **GAGAN (GPS Aided GEO Augmented Navigation)** system.

About Ministry of Civil Aviation :

- Cabinet Minister : Kinjarapu Ram Mohan Naidu
- Minister of State : Murlidhar Kisan Mohol

National Commission for Women Launches 24×7 Women Helpline 14490 for Digital Complaint Registration and Support

- **National Commission for Women (NCW)** is the **apex statutory body** established to protect, promote, and safeguard the **rights and interests of women** in India.
- **NCW** works on issues such as **dowry, domestic violence, equal employment opportunities, labour exploitation**, and women's welfare and empowerment.
- To support women in distress, NCW operates the **24×7 Women Helpline – 14490**, providing a **Digital Complaint Registration System** for women affected by violence and abuse.
- The **Women Helpline – 14490** is a **toll-free**, easy-to-remember short code linked to the existing **NCW Helpline – 7827170170**.

LokOS: Driving Digital Transformation of Rural Livelihoods and Self-Help Groups

- **LokOS (Lok = People, OS = Operating System)** is a web and mobile digital platform developed under the **Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana–National Rural Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NRLM)** for the **end-to-end digitization of Self-Help Groups (SHGs)** and their federations.
- **DAY-NRLM** is the Government of India's flagship **rural poverty alleviation programme**, promoting self-employment, skilled jobs, and sustainable livelihoods for poor rural households.
- **LokOS digitizes the functioning** of Self-Help Groups (SHGs) and Community-Based Organizations (CBOs) by maintaining member records, profiles, savings, loans, repayments, financial transactions, livelihood records, and government scheme convergence.
- The platform reduces manual record-keeping, enables **real-time transaction tracking**, enhances transparency, accountability, and operational efficiency, and digitally captures nearly **₹2 lakh crore worth of SHG financial transactions annually**.

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National Institute of Electronics & Information Technology to Set Up Two Centres of Excellence to Boost India's Semiconductor Skill Ecosystem

- **The National Institute of Electronics & Information Technology (NIELIT)** announced the establishment of **2 Centres of Excellence (CoEs)** in **Ahmedabad (Gujarat)** and **Guwahati (Assam)** to strengthen **India's semiconductor ecosystem** through **specialised skill development**.
- The initiative supports the **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) 2.0**, approved with an outlay of **₹1.28 lakh crore**, to build a **skilled semiconductor manufacturing workforce**.
- The **CoEs** will provide **specialised training** in **Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT)** and **Assembly, Testing, Marking and Packaging (ATMP)** technologies.

About NIELIT :

- **NIELIT** was established in **1994** as the **Department of Electronics Accreditation of Computer Courses (DOEACC) Society**.
- The organisation was renamed as **NIELIT in 2011**.
- **Headquarters**: **New Delhi, Delhi**.
- **Parent Ministry**: **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**.

Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur to Set Up ECOGEN Centre of Excellence to Advance Green Hydrogen Research

- **The Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Kanpur** announced the establishment of the **Centre of Excellence on Innovative and Integrated Ecosystem for Green Hydrogen (ECOGEN)** on **20 July 2026**.
- The proposal has been approved by the **Government of Uttar Pradesh** and sanctioned by the **Uttar Pradesh New and Renewable Energy Development Agency (UPNEDA)** under the **Uttar Pradesh Green Hydrogen Policy, 2024**.
- **Green Hydrogen** is produced through **electrolysis of water** using **renewable energy sources** such as **solar and wind power**, making it a **low-carbon fuel** with no direct **carbon dioxide (CO_2)** emissions during production.

Indian Council of Medical Research Licenses Three Indigenous Biomedical Technologies to Indian Industry for Healthcare Innovation

- The **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)** licensed **three indigenous biomedical technologies** to Indian pharmaceutical and vaccine companies under its **Medical Innovations Patent Mitra** initiative.
- The technology transfers aim to **accelerate the commercialisation** of publicly funded research, strengthen **India's biomedical innovation ecosystem**, and provide **affordable healthcare solutions**.
- **SHetA2**, a novel **anti-HPV therapeutic candidate** for the treatment of **Cervical Intraepithelial Neoplasia (CIN)**, has been licensed to **Emcure Pharmaceuticals Ltd.**
- **SHetA2** was jointly developed by **Dr. Showket Hussain** of **ICMR–National Institute of Cancer Prevention and Research (ICMR-NICPR)** and **Dr. Doris M. Benbrook** of the **Stephenson Cancer Center, University of Oklahoma, USA**.
- **SHetA2** is a **first-in-class targeted therapeutic candidate** that selectively destroys **HPV-induced precancerous and cervical cancer cells** while sparing healthy cells, offering a **safe, affordable, and minimally invasive** treatment option.

About Indian Council of Medical Research :

- **Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)** is **India's apex body** for the **formulation, coordination, and promotion of biomedical research**.
- **Headquarters: New Delhi, Delhi**.
- **Parent Ministry: Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW)**.
- **Head: Dr. Rajiv Bahl**.

United States Air Force's YFQ-44A Fury Successfully Conducts First Live Air Intercept Missile - 120 AMRAAM Missile Test

- The **United States Air Force (USAF)** successfully conducted the **first live missile launch** by a **Collaborative Combat Aircraft (CCA)** using the **YFQ-44A Fury drone** at **Edwards Air Force Base, California, USA**.
- The **YFQ-44A Fury** fired a live **AIM-120 Advanced Medium-Range Air-to-Air Missile (AMRAAM)** at a digital target over the **Mojave Desert**.
- The successful test marked the **first-ever live Air Intercept Missile launch** by a **US Collaborative Combat Aircraft (CCA)**.
- The live-fire test was conducted in coordination with the **412th Test Wing's Air Dominance Combined Test Force**, comprising active-duty military personnel, government civilians, and government contractors.

James Webb Space Telescope Discovers New Giant Exoplanet 'Beta Pictoris d'

- **Astronomers** using National Aeronautics and Space Administration **(NASA)'s James Webb Space Telescope (JWST)** discovered a new giant exoplanet, **Beta Pictoris d**, located **63 light-years** from Earth and estimated to be about **23 million years old**.
- With the discovery of **Beta Pictoris d**, the **Beta Pictoris system** has become only the **second known planetary system** with at least **three directly imaged planets**.

About NASA :

- Formed : July 29, 1958
- Headquarters : Washington, D.C
- **Administrator** : Jared Isaacman

Tata Consultancy Services and Google Cloud Launch Gemini Experience Centre in Kolkata to Accelerate AI Innovation for Consumer Businesses

- **Tata Consultancy Services (TCS)**, in collaboration with **Google Cloud**, launched a **Gemini Experience Centre (GEC)** in **Kolkata, West Bengal**, to showcase **Artificial Intelligence (AI)**-driven innovations for **consumer businesses**.
- The **Kolkata Gemini Experience Centre** is the **3rd GEC in India**, following the centres established in **Chennai** and **Bengaluru**.
- **TCS** plans to establish **10 Gemini Experience Centres (GECs)** globally by the **end of 2026**, including **4 centres in India**.
- The **Gemini Experience Centre (GEC)** is built using **Google Cloud** infrastructure and **Google's Gemini AI models** to accelerate enterprise AI adoption.

Paninian India Unveils India's First Privately Developed Turbofan Engine Programme

- **Paninian India Private Limited**, a deep-tech and aerospace startup, launched the **Yantur 4.5 kilo-Newton (kN) Turbofan Engine Programme**, envisioned as India's first privately developed turbofan engine in its class.
- The **Yantur Engine Programme** marks a significant milestone in developing indigenous private-sector capability in **compact aerospace propulsion** for **next-generation autonomous systems**.
- The **Yantur 4.5 kN Turbofan Engine** is being developed to power **Svayatt L1**, Paninian India's **long-range autonomous cruise missile platform**.

Council of Scientific and Industrial Research Transfers Four Indigenous Technologies to Industry and Launches IoT-Based Rural Water Monitoring System

- The **Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)** organized a **Technology Transfer Event** at **CSIR Headquarters, New Delhi**, to promote **technology commercialization**, **industry collaboration**, and **indigenous innovation**.
- The event was organized by **CSIR–Central Scientific Instruments Organisation (CSIR-CSIO), Chandigarh**, bringing together **scientists**, **industry partners**, **technology adopters**, and **strategic stakeholders**.
- During the event, **4 indigenous technologies** were transferred to industry, an **IoT-enabled rural water monitoring system** was commercially launched, and **royalty received from Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)** for defence technologies was recognized.

Institute of Advanced Study in Science and Technology Scientists Pioneer Borophene-Based Bio-Lubricant Using Castor Oil

- Scientists from the **Institute of Advanced Study in Science and Technology (IASST), Guwahati**, an autonomous institute under the **Department of Science and Technology (DST)**, achieved a major breakthrough by demonstrating the first-ever use of **Borophene (2D nanomaterial)** as a high-performance **lubricant additive in castor oil**.
- The research is considered a significant advancement in **sustainable lubrication technology** and has the potential to transform **renewable energy systems**, marine applications, **green lubrication technologies**, and sustainable manufacturing.

Over 3.75 Lakh Beneficiaries Supported Under Department of Science and Technology's INSPIRE Programme in Five Years: Dr. Jitendra Singh

- The **Government of India** reaffirmed its commitment to nurturing scientific talent through the **Department of Science and Technology (DST)** flagship **Innovation in Science Pursuit for Inspired Research (INSPIRE) Programme**, which has supported **more than 3.75 lakh students and researchers** over the last five years.
- The INSPIRE Programme develops scientific talent through four major components: **INSPIRE-MANAK**, **INSPIRE Scholarship for Higher Education (SHE)**, **INSPIRE Fellowship**, and **INSPIRE Faculty Fellowship**.

Microsoft India and Indian Institute of Technology Delhi Launch UNNATI AI 2.0 to Boost India's Artificial Intelligence Innovation Ecosystem

- **Microsoft India**, in collaboration with the **Foundation for Innovation and Technology Transfer (FITT)**, **Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi**, launched **UNNATI AI 2.0**, the second phase of its flagship **Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)** initiative.

- **UNNATI AI** stands for **"Unnati se Pragati"**, meaning **"Progress through Growth."**
- **UNNATI AI 2.0** aims to strengthen India's **Artificial Intelligence (AI) talent pipeline** by **democratizing AI access**, **promoting innovation**, and **expanding opportunities in Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities**.

National Council for Vocational Education and Training Grants Awarding Body -Dual Recognition to National Institute of Rural Development and Panchayati Raj to Strengthen Rural Skill Certification

- The **National Council for Vocational Education and Training (NCVET)** signed an agreement with the **National Institute of Rural Development and Panchayati Raj (NIRDPR)** under the **Ministry of Rural Development (MoRD)**, granting NIRDPR recognition as an **Awarding Body (AB-Dual)**.
- The agreement-signing ceremony was chaired by **Niranjan Kumar Sudhansu**, **Additional Secretary, Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE)** and **Executive Member of NCVET**, in the presence of officials from NCVET and NIRDPR.
- As of **July 2026**, NCVET has recognised **52 Standard Awarding Bodies** and **107 Dual Awarding Bodies** across India.

China Successfully Launches Sea-Based Gravity-1 Rocket, Deploys Nine Satellites into Orbit

- Chinese commercial aerospace company **Orienspace (ORIENSPACE)** successfully launched the **Gravity-1 Y4 carrier rocket** from a **sea-based launch platform** in the **East China Sea**, placing **9 satellites** into their designated orbits.
- The mission marked the **3rd flight** of the **Gravity-1 rocket** and its **first long-range (far-sea) maritime launch**, representing a major milestone in **China's commercial space programme**.
- The launch took place from a launch vessel operated by the **Oriental Aerospace Port** in **Haiyang, Yantai, Shandong Province**, **China's only commercial maritime launch base**.

National Institute of Electronics and Information Technology and Semi-Conductor Laboratory Mohali Sign Memorandum of Understanding to Integrate India's Indigenous 1.2 µm Process Design Kit with eChipHub

- The **National Institute of Electronics and Information Technology (NIELIT)**, an Autonomous Scientific Society under the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, signed a **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)** with the **Semi-Conductor Laboratory (SCL), Mohali, Punjab**, an autonomous organisation under **MeitY**, to make India's indigenous **1.2 micrometre (µm) Process Design Kit (PDK)** available through the **eChipHub platform**.

- The collaboration aims to strengthen **India's semiconductor ecosystem** and accelerate the objectives of the **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM)** by promoting **indigenous semiconductor technology**, **innovation**, and **skill development**.

About NIELIT :

- **NIELIT** is a pioneer in **digital empowerment** and **Electronics & Information and Communication Technology (E&ICT) skill development** with a nationwide network of **56 NIELIT Centres**, **700+ Accredited Institutes**, and **8,000+ Facilitation Centres**.
- **NIELIT** has been granted the status of **"Deemed to be University"** by the **Ministry of Education**, with its main campus at **Ropar, Punjab**, and **11 constituent campuses** located across India.

SpaceX Successfully Conducts 13th Starship Test Flight, Launches 20 Starlink V3 Satellites

- **SpaceX** successfully completed the **13th integrated test flight** of its **Starship launch system** from **Starbase, Texas, United States of America (USA)**.
- During the mission, **Starship** successfully deployed **20 next-generation Starlink Version 3 (V3) satellites** into orbit, marking the **first-ever deployment of Starlink V3 satellites**.
- The mission marked the **second test flight of Starship Version 3 (V3)** and represented another major milestone in **SpaceX's reusable launch vehicle programme**.

Bihar to Set Up Permanent National Skill Training Institute for Women Campus and Skill India International Centre in Patna

- The **Government of Bihar** and the **Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE)** announced the establishment of the **permanent National Skill Training Institute for Women (NSTI-W), Patna campus** and the **Skill India International Centre (SIIC), Bihar** to strengthen **women's skilling** and **global employment opportunities**.
- The initiative was announced by **Samrat Choudhary**, **Chief Minister (CM) of Bihar**, and **Jayant Chaudhary**, **Minister of State (Independent Charge), MSDE** and **Minister of State for Education**, Government of India.
- The **foundation stone** for the projects was laid by **Dilip Kumar**, **Director General (DG), Directorate General of Training (DGT)**.

National Forensic Sciences University Goa's Digital Forensics Laboratory Recognized as Examiner of Electronic Evidence Under the Information Technology Act

- The **Digital Forensics Laboratory at the National Forensic Sciences University (NFSU), Goa Campus** has been notified as an **Examiner of Electronic Evidence under Section 79A of**

the Information Technology (IT) Act, 2000 by the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**.

- The recognition authorizes the **NFSU Goa Digital Forensics Laboratory** to examine and certify electronic evidence in **Computer (Media) Forensics** and **Mobile Device Forensics**, ensuring the legal admissibility of digital evidence in courts.
- NFSU Goa has become the **second laboratory under NFSU** and one of only **21 notified forensic laboratories in India** to receive this recognition.

National Aeronautics and Space Administration Unveils Artificial Intelligence-Based PRAXIS Mission Concept for Direct Sampling of Saturn's Ring Particles

- The **National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)** has proposed an **Artificial Intelligence (AI)-powered mission concept** named **PRAXIS (Planetary Rings Autonomous EXploration with In-situ Sampling)** under **Phase I of the NASA Innovative Advanced Concepts (NIAC) 2026 Program**.
- The **PRAXIS mission** aims to achieve the **first-ever direct collection and in-situ analysis of particles from Saturn's rings**, addressing one of the highest priorities in **planetary science decadal surveys**.
- The project is being led by **Dr. B. Marco Quadrelli**, Principal and Group Supervisor of the **Robotics Modelling and Simulation Group** at **NASA's Jet Propulsion Laboratory (JPL)** in California, United States (USA).
- The primary objective of PRAXIS is to provide the **first direct observations of millimetre- to centimetre-sized (mm–cm) ring particles**, which were not directly studied by **NASA's Cassini mission**.

About NASA :

- Formed : July 29, 1958
- Headquarters : Washington, D.C
- Administrator : Jared Isaacman

NVIDIA, Microsoft, International Business Machines Corporation Launch Open Secure AI Alliance to Enhance Artificial Intelligence Security

- **NVIDIA**, **Microsoft Corporation**, **IBM (International Business Machines Corporation)**, along with leading **technology companies** and **research institutions**, launched the **Open Secure AI Alliance (OSAA)** to strengthen the **security, trustworthiness, and resilience** of **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** systems through **open collaboration** and **shared security standards**.

- The **Open Secure AI Alliance (OSAA)** aims to promote **secure-by-design AI development**, improve the **security, transparency, and reliability** of AI systems, facilitate **information sharing** on **AI-related threats and vulnerabilities**, and encourage the adoption of **common AI security standards** across the global AI ecosystem.

About NVIDIA Corporation :

- **Founded : 1993**
- **Headquarters : Santa Clara, California, United States of America (USA)**, specializes in **Graphics Processing Units (GPUs)**, **AI computing platforms**, and **accelerated computing**
- **President : Jensen Huang**

Ministry of Earth Sciences Marks 20th Foundation Day with Launch of New Weather, Ocean and Earth Science Initiatives

- The **Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)** celebrated its **20th Foundation Day** at **Prithvi Bhawan, New Delhi, Delhi**, marking 20 years of contributions in **weather forecasting, earth system science, oceanography, seismology, and polar research**.
- The 20th Foundation Day celebrations were presided over by **Dr. N. Kalaiselvi**, Secretary, **Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)**.
- The **India Meteorological Department (IMD)** established **13 Centres of Excellence (CoEs)** to strengthen specialised meteorological research and enhance India's weather forecasting capabilities.

SPORTS NEWS

Wimbledon 2026: Jannik Sinner and Linda Noskova Win Singles Titles

- **World No. 1 Jannik Sinner (Italy)** won the **men's singles title at Wimbledon 2026** for the **second consecutive year**, defeating **Alexander Zverev (Germany)** in a four-set final.
- In the men's singles final, **Jannik Sinner defeated Alexander Zverev** with a score of **6-7 (7-9), 7-6 (7-2), 6-3, 6-4** in a match lasting **3 hours and 46 minutes**.
- With this victory, Sinner successfully **defended his Wimbledon title** and registered his **10th consecutive victory over Alexander Zverev**.

S. Aswath Becomes India's 98th Chess Grandmaster

- **17-year-old S. Aswath** from **Nagercoil, Tamil Nadu** became **India's 98th Chess Grandmaster (GM)** after securing his **third and final GM norm** at the **2026 Pune International Grandmaster Round Robin Tournament**.

- Aswath achieved the Grandmaster title requirement after defeating **United States' FIDE Master (FM) Kannan Vaidyanathan** with the **black pieces** in the final round.
- He finished the tournament with **7 points from 9 rounds**, including **6 wins, 2 draws, and 1 loss**, securing the **runner-up position**.
- The **Grandmaster title** is awarded by the **International Chess Federation (FIDE)** to players who achieve:
    - **Three Grandmaster (GM) norms**
    - **FIDE rating of 2500 or above**
- With Aswath's achievement, India's total number of **Chess Grandmasters has increased to 98**, bringing the country closer to achieving its **100th Grandmaster milestone**.

About International Chess Federation (FIDE)

- Full Form: Fédération Internationale des Échecs (International Chess Federation)
- Established: 1924
- Headquarters: Lausanne, Switzerland

Leander Paes Appointed Player Ambassador of Asian Tennis Federation (ATF)

- **Indian tennis legend Leander Paes** has been appointed as the **Player Ambassador of the Asian Tennis Federation (ATF)**.
- The announcement was made during a ceremony held on the sidelines of the **Wimbledon Championships in London**, in the presence of **ATF President Yuriy Polskiy**, senior officials, players, and members of the international tennis community.
- As the **Player Ambassador**, Leander Paes will work with the **Asian Tennis Federation (ATF)** to promote tennis across Asia, mentor emerging players, support grassroots development programmes, and represent the federation at major international events.
- Paes is the **only Indian tennis player to have won an Olympic medal**, securing a **bronze medal in Men's Singles at the 1996 Atlanta Olympic Games**.

India Wins Five Gold Medals at 56th International Physics Olympiad (IPhO) 2026

- **India** secured **5 gold medals** at the **56th International Physics Olympiad (IPhO) 2026**, with **all five members** of the Indian team winning gold medals.
- With this achievement, **India** finished in **joint first place** along with **China, Kazakhstan, Russia, South Korea, and Taiwan**.
- The **56th International Physics Olympiad (IPhO) 2026** was held in **Bucaramanga, Colombia**, with **381 students from 87 countries** participating.

- The five Indian gold medalists are:
  - **Kanishk Jain – Pune, Maharashtra**
  - **Riddhesh Anant Bendale – Indore, Madhya Pradesh**
  - **Rishit Garg – Dwarka, Delhi**
  - **Shresth Suraiya – Mumbai, Maharashtra**
  - **Svarit Joshi – Ahmedabad, Gujarat**

About International Physics Olympiad (IPhO)

- **Established: 1967**
- **Type:** Annual international competition for **secondary/high school students** in Physics.
- **Objective:** Promote excellence in **Physics education**, scientific talent, and international cooperation among young students.
- **Indian Nodal Organisation: Homi Bhabha Centre for Science Education (HBCSE), Tata Institute of Fundamental Research (TIFR), Mumbai**.

Delhi Unveils 'Mayur' as Official Mascot for 22nd Commonwealth Table Tennis Championship 2026

- **Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta** unveiled **'Mayur'**, the official mascot of the **22nd Commonwealth Table Tennis Championship 2026**, at a special ceremony in **New Delhi**.
- The **22nd Commonwealth Table Tennis Championship 2026** will be held from **27 July to 2 August 2026** at the **Thyagraj Stadium, New Delhi**.
- The championship is expected to witness participation from **over 35 Commonwealth countries**, making it one of the largest editions of the tournament.

Rohit Sharma Becomes First Indian to Score an One Day International Century at Lord's

- **India captain Rohit Sharma** became the **first Indian men's cricketer to score an One Day International (ODI) century at Lord's Cricket Ground, London, England**, during the **India–England ODI series**.
- Rohit Sharma scored his **34th One Day International century**, helping India chase **387/3** posted by **England**, led by **Ben Duckett's 141-run innings**.
- At **39 years and 80 days**, Rohit Sharma became the **oldest Indian cricketer to score an international century across all formats**, surpassing **Sachin Tendulkar's record** of **38 years and 327 days**.

PV Sindhu Wins BWF Japan Open 2026, Becomes First Indian to Clinch Super 750 Title

- **Pusarla Venkata Sindhu (PV Sindhu)** created history by winning the **BWF Japan Open 2026** title, defeating **World No. 3 Akane Yamaguchi (Japan)** in the final by **21-17, 21-17** at **Tokyo, Japan**.
- With this victory, **PV Sindhu became the first Indian badminton player to win a BWF Super 750 tournament**.
- The victory marked Sindhu's return to a major international title after winning the **BWF World Championships 2019** and ended her long wait for a prestigious title.
- The **BWF (Badminton World Federation)** is the global governing body for badminton, headquartered in **Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia**.
- The **Japan Open** is one of the prestigious tournaments conducted under the **BWF World Tour** series.

Lionel Messi Becomes the First Footballer to Play in Three FIFA World Cup Finals

- **Argentina's Lionel Messi** created history by becoming the **first footballer to play in three different FIFA World Cup finals** after featuring in the **2026 FIFA World Cup Final** against **Spain** at **MetLife Stadium, New Jersey, United States**.
- At **39 years of age**, Messi also became the **oldest outfield player** to play in **three FIFA World Cup finals**.
- Messi's **three FIFA World Cup final appearances**:
    - **2014 FIFA World Cup** – Argentina lost to **Germany**.
    - **2022 FIFA World Cup** – Argentina defeated **France** to win the title.
    - **2026 FIFA World Cup** – Argentina lost **1-0** to **Spain** after extra time.

About FIFA:

- Founded: 1904
- Headquarters: Zürich, Switzerland
- President: Gianni Infantino

India Wins 1 Gold and 3 Silver Medals at the 37th International Biology Olympiad (IBO) 2026

- **India** created history by winning **1 Gold Medal and 3 Silver Medals** at the **37th International Biology Olympiad (IBO) 2026**, held in **Vilnius, Lithuania**.
- **All four members** of the Indian team won medals.
- **Medal Winners:**
    - **Bhavya Gunwal (Mahendragarh, Haryana) – Gold Medal**
    - **Soumil Maity (Howrah, West Bengal) – Silver Medal**

  - **Nishit Kalani (Pali, Rajasthan) – Silver Medal**
  - **Anmol Kumar (Mansa, Punjab) – Silver Medal**
- **IBO 2026** witnessed participation from **307 students representing 78 countries**. A total of **31 Gold, 61 Silver, and 91 Bronze Medals** were awarded.

India Wins Four Gold Medals at 58th International Chemistry Olympiad (IChO) 2026

- **India** created history at the **58th International Chemistry Olympiad (IChO) 2026** by winning **four Gold medals**, becoming the **first country** to have **all four participants** win **Gold medals** in a single edition of the competition.
- The **58th International Chemistry Olympiad (IChO) 2026** was held in **Tashkent, Uzbekistan**, from **10–19 July 2026**, with the participation of **363 students from 93 countries**, making it the **largest edition** of the Olympiad to date.
- **India** participated in the **International Chemistry Olympiad** for the **27th time** and finished **joint first** in the overall medal tally along with **China, Vietnam, and Individual Participants Group B (Russia)**.

Spain Wins 2026 Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA) World Cup; Rodri Named Golden Ball Winner

- **Spain** won the **2026 Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA) World Cup**, defeating **Argentina** in the final to secure its **second FIFA World Cup title**.
- **Rodri (Spain)** won the **FIFA World Cup Golden Ball**, awarded to the **Best Player of the Tournament**, for his outstanding performances throughout the competition.
- **Lionel Messi (Argentina)** finished as the runner-up for the **Golden Ball**, after scoring **8 goals** and providing **4 assists** during the tournament.
- The **FIFA World Cup Golden Ball**, instituted in **1978**, is presented to the tournament's **Best Player** based on overall performance, with the winner selected by **accredited journalists** from a shortlist prepared by the **FIFA Technical Study Group**.

Indian Contingent to Wear Jute-Viscose Apparel at Commonwealth Games 2026

- **Indian athletes and officials** will wear **jute-viscose blended apparel** during the **Commonwealth Games 2026** to be held in **Glasgow, Scotland**, from **23 July to 2 August 2026**.
- The eco-friendly apparel has been developed by the **National Jute Board (NJB)** under the **Ministry of Textiles** to promote **sustainable textiles, natural fibres, value-added jute products, and the Make in India initiative**.

- The apparel is made from **100% biodegradable jute-viscose blended fabric**, showcasing India's commitment to **environmentally sustainable textile innovation**.

About National Jute Board (NJB)

- Administrative Ministry: Ministry of Textiles
- Headquarters: Kolkata, West Bengal
- Established under the National Jute Board Act, 2008, the apex body under the Ministry of Textiles, Government of India, was enacted in Parliament on February 12, 2009, and formally constituted in April 2010
- Objective: To promote the production, marketing, export, diversification, and value addition of jute and jute products in India.

Former India Captain Sourav Ganguly Inducted into International Cricket Council (ICC) Hall of Fame

- **Former India captain Sourav Ganguly** was inducted into the **International Cricket Council (ICC) Hall of Fame**, becoming the **12th Indian cricketer** to receive one of cricket's highest individual honours.
- The **International Cricket Council (ICC) Hall of Fame** recognises **retired cricketers** who have made exceptional contributions to the game through **outstanding performances, leadership, and lasting impact** on international cricket.

About International Cricket Council (ICC)

- Established: 1909
- Headquarters: Dubai, United Arab Emirates
- Chairman: Jay Shah

India Wins 5 Medals at Global Skills Challenge Australia 2026

- **India** won **five medals** at the **Global Skills Challenge (GSC) Australia 2026**, securing **three gold**, **one silver**, and **one bronze** medal.
- The competition was held in **Australia**, with participation from **16 WorldSkills member countries**.
- The **Global Skills Challenge (GSC)** is an international skill competition conducted as a **simulation of the WorldSkills Competition**, enabling participants to compete under global standards.
- Nearly **600 competitors, experts, translators, and officials** participated in the event.
- **India's medal winners** are:

- **Pavan Bhadravati Suresha (Karnataka)** – **Gold** in **Additive Manufacturing**
- **Mausam Kumar Giri (Bihar)** – **Gold** in **Cloud Computing**
- **Vishnupriya Sunil (Delhi)** – **Gold** in **Health and Social Care**
- **Harsh Ramesh Pawar (Maharashtra)** – **Silver** in **3D Digital Game Art**
- **Muskan (Haryana)** – **Bronze** in **Painting and Decorating**

Harshavardhan G.B. Becomes India's 97th Chess Grandmaster

- **Harshavardhan G.B.**, a **22-year-old** chess player from **Chennai, Tamil Nadu**, became **India's 97th Chess Grandmaster (GM)**.
- He secured his **third and final Grandmaster norm** at the **2nd Chola Chess Grandmaster Norm Round Robin Tournament** held in **Chennai**.
- Harshavardhan remained **unbeaten throughout the tournament**, scoring **6.5 out of 9 points**.
- He also crossed the **2500 live Fédération Internationale des Échecs (FIDE) rating** required to earn the **Grandmaster** title.
- He is currently coached by **Grandmaster Deepan Chakkravarthy**.

About Fédération Internationale des Échecs (FIDE)

- Established: 1924
- Headquarters: Lausanne, Switzerland
- President: Arkady Dvorkovich

India Tops Medal Tally at International Shooting Sport Federation Junior World Championship 2026

- **India** finished **first** in the medal standings at the **5th International Shooting Sport Federation (ISSF) Junior World Championship 2026 (Rifle/Pistol/Shotgun)** held in **Suhl, Germany**.
- The championship featured **over 800 shooters** from **70 national federations**, with **India fielding an 84-member contingent**.
- India won a total of **24 medals**:
  - **7 Gold**
  - **8 Silver**
  - **9 Bronze**
- This marked **India's second consecutive ISSF Junior World Championship medal tally title**, after topping the **2024 edition held in Lima, Peru**.

About International Shooting Sport Federation (ISSF)

- **Established: 1907**

- **Headquarters: Munich, Germany**
- **President: Luciano Rossi**

About Germany

- **Capital: Berlin**
- **Chancellor: Friedrich Merz**
- **President: Frank-Walter Steinmeier**
- **Currency: Euro (€)**

Cristiano Ronaldo Becomes Oldest Goalscorer in Men's FIFA World Cup Knockout History

- **Portugal** captain **Cristiano Ronaldo** became the **oldest player to score in a men's Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA) World Cup knockout match** after converting a penalty against **Croatia** in the **Round of 32**.
- At the age of **41 years and 147 days**, Ronaldo scored the equaliser as **Portugal defeated Croatia 2–1** to qualify for the **Round of 16**.
- Portugal will now face **Spain**, the **2010 FIFA World Cup champions**, in the Round of 16.
- Ronaldo surpassed the previous record held by **Lionel Messi** to become the oldest goalscorer in a FIFA World Cup knockout-stage match.

About Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA)

- **Established: 1904**
- **Headquarters: Zürich, Switzerland**
- **President: Gianni Infantino**

About Portugal

- **Capital: Lisbon**
- **President: António José Seguro**
- **Prime Minister: Luís Montenegro**
- **Currency: Euro (€)**

Neymar Jr. Announces Retirement from International Football After 2026 FIFA World Cup

- **Brazilian football star Neymar Jr.** announced his retirement from **international football** following **Brazil's 2–1 defeat to Norway** in the **Round of 16** of the **2026 Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA) World Cup** at **MetLife Stadium**.
- The announcement marked the end of a **16-year international career (2010–2026)**, during which Neymar became **Brazil's all-time highest goalscorer in men's international football**.

- Neymar's farewell came at the **same stadium where he scored his first international goal for Brazil in 2010**, making his international career come full circle.

About Brazil

- **Capital: Brasília**
- **President: Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva**
- **Currency: Brazilian Real**

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi Becomes Youngest Player to Represent India in International Cricket

- **Vaibhav Sooryavanshi** became the **youngest player to represent India in international cricket** after making his **Twenty20 International (T20I)** debut against **England** at **Old Trafford, Manchester**.
- He made his debut at the age of **15 years and 99 days**, surpassing the long-standing record of **Sachin Tendulkar**, who debuted for India at **16 years and 205 days** in a **Test match against Pakistan** at **Karachi** in **November 1989**.
- With his debut, **Vaibhav Sooryavanshi** also became the **youngest Indian men's Twenty20 International (T20I) cricketer**.

About International Cricket Council (ICC)

- **Established: 1909**
- **Headquarters: Dubai, United Arab Emirates**
- **Chairman: Jay Shah**
- **Chief Executive Officer (CEO): Sanjog Gupta**

Australia Wins Record Seventh International Cricket Council (ICC) Women's Twenty20 (T20) World Cup Title

- **Australia** defeated host nation **England** by **7 wickets** in the **International Cricket Council (ICC) Women's Twenty20 (T20) World Cup 2026 Final** at the **Lord's Cricket Ground, London** to win a **record seventh Women's T20 World Cup title**.
- After being asked to bat first, **England** scored **150/4 in 20 overs**, with captain **Nat Sciver-Brunt** remaining unbeaten on **58**, while **Freya Kemp** contributed an unbeaten **44**.
- Australia chased down the target by scoring **153/3 in 17.1 overs**, completing the **highest successful run chase in a Women's T20 World Cup final**.

23rd Commonwealth Games 2026 to be Held in Glasgow, Scotland with 120-Member Indian Contingent

- The **23rd Commonwealth Games** will be held in **Glasgow, Scotland** from **23 July to 2 August 2026**, featuring participation from **74 Commonwealth countries** over **11 days**.
- The Games will include **10 sports disciplines** with **six para sports events**, making it the **largest inclusive para sports programme** in Commonwealth Games history.
- **India** has announced a **120-member contingent** across **13 sports disciplines**, with major medal hopes resting on athletes including **Neeraj Chopra (Athletics)**, **Mirabai Chanu (Weightlifting)**, **Lovlina Borgohain (Boxing)**, **Srihari Nataraj (Swimming)**, and **Murali Sreeshankar (Athletics)**.

Mascot and Anthem of Badminton World Federation World Championships 2026 Unveiled in New Delhi

- **Union Minister for Youth Affairs and Sports Mansukh Mandaviya** and **Dr. Himanta Biswa Sarma, President of Badminton Association of India and Chief Minister of Assam**, unveiled the official **mascot 'Peacko'** and launched the championship anthem for the **Badminton World Federation (BWF) World Championships 2026** in **New Delhi, Delhi**.
- The **30th edition of the Badminton World Federation World Championships** will be held from **17–23 August 2026** at the **Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium, New Delhi**.
- The official mascot **'Peacko'** is inspired by the **Indian Peafowl (Peacock)** and represents the **pride, vibrancy, and sporting spirit of India**.

Lovlina Borgohain Secures India's First Medal at Commonwealth Games 2026

- **Lovlina Borgohain**, India's **Tokyo Olympic bronze medallist**, secured **India's first medal at the Commonwealth Games 2026** even before the **opening ceremony** of the event held in **Glasgow, Scotland**.
- Lovlina received a **direct entry into the semifinals** of the **women's 75 kg boxing event** due to the absence of seven participants in the category, confirming her medal position as per the **Commonwealth Games boxing rules**, where all semifinalists are assured of medals.
- The **women's 75 kg boxing category** featured only **five boxers**, allowing Lovlina to qualify directly for the last four stage without participating in the quarterfinals.

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi Becomes Youngest Batter to Score a Fifty in Twenty20 International Cricket

- **Vaibhav Sooryavanshi** became the **youngest batter to score a half-century in Twenty20 International (T20I) cricket**, achieving the feat during the **first T20I against Zimbabwe** in **Harare, Zimbabwe**.

- At the age of **15 years and 118 days**, he reached his **fifty in just 19 balls**, becoming the **youngest player to score a fifty in international cricket**.
- With this achievement, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi also became:
  - **Youngest player from an International Cricket Council (ICC) Full Member nation** to score a T20I fifty.
  - **Youngest Indian** to score a **fifty in international cricket**, surpassing **Sachin Tendulkar**.
  - **Youngest Indian** to score a **fifty in Twenty20 International cricket**, surpassing **Rohit Sharma**.

Youngest Players to Score a Fifty in Twenty20 International Cricket

1. **Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (India) – 15 years, 118 days**
2. **Louis Bruce (Gibraltar) – 16 years, 56 days**
3. **Kavin Chaddha (Indonesia) – 16 years, 76 days**
4. **Alusine Turay (Sierra Leone) – 16 years, 89 days**
5. **Tenjin Rabgey (Bhutan) – 16 years, 118 days**

Mirabai Chanu Wins Gold; Raja Muthupandi Bags Silver at Commonwealth Games 2026

- **India's Mirabai Chanu** won the **Gold Medal** in the **Women's 48 kg weightlifting event** at the **Commonwealth Games 2026** held in **Glasgow, Scotland**.
- **Mirabai Chanu** lifted a **total of 190 kg** (**85 kg in Snatch + 105 kg in Clean and Jerk**) to successfully defend her title.
- With this victory, she became the **first Indian weightlifter to win three consecutive Commonwealth Games Gold Medals**.
- She also secured **India's first Gold Medal** at the **Commonwealth Games 2026**.
- **Ruth Asuquo Nyong (Nigeria)** won the **Silver Medal**, while **Irene Jane Henry (Malaysia)** secured the **Bronze Medal** in the Women's 48 kg event.

Anahat Singh Becomes First Indian to Win World Junior Squash Championships Girls' Singles Title

- **India's Anahat Singh** won the **Girls' Singles title** at the **World Squash Junior Championships 2026**, becoming the **first Indian** to win the prestigious championship.
- In the final, **18-year-old Anahat Singh** defeated **Ruqayya Salem of Egypt** in **straight games (11–3, 11–7, 11–9)** to clinch the title.
- With this victory, **Anahat Singh** became the **first non-Egyptian player** to win the **Girls' Singles title** since **Amanda Sobhy (United States of America)** won it in **2010**.

Indian Grandmasters Rohith Krishna S and Raja Rithvik R Win Gold and Silver at Menuires International Chess Open Masters Tournament 2026

- **Indian Grandmasters Rohith Krishna S and Raja Rithvik R** secured the **gold and silver medals respectively** at the inaugural **Menuires International Chess Open - Masters Tournament 2026** held in **Les Ménuires, France**.
- Both Indian players finished **jointly at the top of the leaderboard** with **7 points from 9 rounds** and remained **unbeaten throughout the tournament**.
- **Rohith Krishna S** won the **gold medal** by securing a superior **tie-break score of 43 points**, while **Raja Rithvik R** finished second with a **tie-break score of 41.5 points**.

Sharmila Dhankar Wins Historic Gold Medal and Shilpa Shyla Secures Bronze Medal in Women's F57 Shot Put at Commonwealth Games 2026

- **Sharmila Dhankar** won the **Gold Medal** and **Shilpa Shyla** secured the **Bronze Medal** in the **Women's F57 Shot Put** event at the **Commonwealth Games 2026**.
- The achievement marked a **historic milestone for India's Para Athletics**, as it became **India's first-ever Gold Medal in Para Athletics at the Commonwealth Games**.
- India also created history by winning **two medals in the same Para Athletics event for the first time** at the **Commonwealth Games**.
- **Sharmila Dhankar** produced her season-best performance with a throw of **9.81 metres** to clinch the **Gold Medal**.

Sarvesh Anil Kushare Wins Silver Medal in Men's High Jump at Commonwealth Games 2026

- **Sarvesh Anil Kushare** won the **Silver Medal** in the **Men's High Jump** event at the **Commonwealth Games 2026** held in **Glasgow, Scotland**.
- The **Indian national record holder** cleared a **best height of 2.25 metres**, securing his **first-ever medal at a major multi-sport event**.
- **Romaine Beckford (Jamaica)** won the **Gold Medal**, while **Jack Kimani (Scotland)** secured the **Bronze Medal** with a best jump of **2.20 metres**.

About Commonwealth Games Federation (CGF)

- Headquarters: London, United Kingdom
- Founded: 1930 (as the British Empire Games Federation)
- President: Dr. Donald Rukare

Ajaya Babu Wins Silver Medal in Men's 79 Kilogram Weightlifting Event at Commonwealth Games 2026

- **Ajaya Babu** won the **Silver Medal** in the **Men's 79 Kilogram Weightlifting** event at the **Commonwealth Games 2026** held in **Glasgow, Scotland**.
- Representing **India**, the weightlifter from **Vizianagaram district, Andhra Pradesh**, lifted a **combined total of 330 kilograms**, missing the **Gold Medal** by just **1 kilogram**.
- Ajaya Babu successfully lifted **149 kilograms in the Snatch** and **181 kilograms in the Clean and Jerk**, finishing with a total lift of **330 kilograms**.

India's Esha Singh Wins Gold and Manu Bhaker Secures Bronze in Women's 25 Metre Pistol Event at International Shooting Sport Federation World Cup 2026

- **Esha Singh** won the **Gold Medal** in the **Women's 25 Metre Pistol** event at the **International Shooting Sport Federation (ISSF) World Cup 2026** held in **Hangzhou, China**.
- **Manu Bhaker** won the **Bronze Medal** in the same event, giving **India two medals** in the competition.
- In the final, **Esha Singh** scored **40 hits** to defeat **Zhang Yueyue (China)**, who secured the **Silver Medal** with **37 hits**.

About International Shooting Sport Federation (ISSF)

- Established: 17 July 1907
- Headquarters: Munich, Germany
- President: Luciano Rossi

Gulveer Singh and Harjinder Kaur Win Silver Medals as India's Medal Tally Reaches 12 at Commonwealth Games 2026

- **Gulveer Singh** created history by becoming the **first Indian athlete to win a medal in the Men's 10,000 Metre race** at the **Commonwealth Games**, securing the **Silver Medal** at the **Commonwealth Games 2026** in **Glasgow, Scotland**.
- The **reigning Asian champion** clocked **27 minutes 49.78 seconds** to finish second behind **Ky Robinson (Australia)**, who won the **Gold Medal**.
- **Harjinder Kaur** won the **Silver Medal** in the **Women's 69 Kilogram Weightlifting** event with a **combined lift of 227 kilograms**.
- With these victories, **India's medal tally** at the **Commonwealth Games 2026** reached **12 medals**, comprising:
    - **2 Gold**
    - **7 Silver**
    - **3 Bronze**

India Wins Bronze in 10m Air Rifle Mixed Team Event at International Shooting Sport Federation (ISSF) World Cup

- **India's Sonam Uttam Maskar and Himanshu Dhillon** won the **bronze medal** in the **10m Air Rifle Mixed Team** event at the **International Shooting Sport Federation (ISSF) World Cup**.
- With this achievement, **India's overall medal tally** at the tournament reached **4 medals**, comprising **1 Gold, 1 Silver and 2 Bronze**.
- In the qualification round, **Sonam Uttam Maskar (317.2)** and **Himanshu Dhillon (317.4)** registered a combined score of **634.6** to qualify for the medal round.

About International Shooting Sport Federation (ISSF)

- Established: 17 July 1907
- Headquarters: Munich, Germany
- President: Luciano Rossi

Ajinkya Rahane Announces Retirement from International Cricket

- **Senior Indian cricketer Ajinkya Rahane** has announced his **retirement from international cricket with immediate effect**, bringing an end to his international career across all formats.
- Rahane last represented **India** in **2023** during the **Test series against the West Indies**, while his final **One Day International (ODI)** appearance came in **2018** against **England**.

India Secures Historic Gold and Silver in Men's 100m T47 Para Athletics at Commonwealth Games 2026

- **India created history at the Commonwealth Games 2026 in Glasgow** by securing a **historic one-two finish** in the **Men's 100-metre T47 Para Athletics event**.
- **Dilip Mahadu Gavit** won the **gold medal**, clocking a **Games record and season-best time of 10.71 seconds**, while **Mohammed Basil Morssinganakath** claimed the **silver medal** with a **season-best time of 10.83 seconds**.
- **Kevin Santos (England)** won the **bronze medal** with a timing of **10.85 seconds**.

OBITUARIES

Veteran Playback Singer S. Janaki Passed away at the Age of 88

- **Legendary playback singer Sistla Sreeramamurthy (S.) Janaki**, popularly known as the **"Nightingale of South India"** and **"Nightingale of the South"**, passed away at the age of **88** in **Mysuru, Karnataka** after battling age-related health issues.
- S. Janaki won **4 National Film Awards for Best Female Playback Singer**.

- She received her National Film Awards for **"Senthoora Poove" from 16 Vayathinile (Tamil, 1977)**, **"Ettumanoor Ambalathil" from Oppol (Malayalam, 1981)**, **"Vennello Godari Andam" from Sitara (Telugu, 1984)**, and **"Inji Iduppazhagi" from Thevar Magan (Tamil, 1992)**.
- She was honoured with **33 State Film Awards**, one of the highest recognitions received by an Indian playback singer.
- S. Janaki was selected for the **Padma Bhushan in 2013** for her contribution to Arts, but she **declined the honour**.

Former Qatari Emir Sheikh Hamad bin Khalifa Al Thani Passed away at 74

- **Sheikh Hamad bin Khalifa Al Thani**, the former Emir of Qatar, passed away at the age of **74**.
- Sheikh Hamad bin Khalifa Al Thani was born in **1952** into the **Al Thani royal family**, which has ruled Qatar since 1851.
- Before becoming Emir of Qatar, he served as **Commander of the Armed Forces, Defence Minister, and Crown Prince**.

Veteran Congress Leader and Former Rajya Sabha MP H. Hanumanthappa Passed away at 94

- Veteran **Indian National Congress (INC)** leader and former Member of Parliament (MP) **H. Hanumanthappa** passed away at the age of **94** in **Chitradurga, Karnataka**.
- H. Hanumanthappa was born on **13 May 1932** in **Guddadarangenahalli, Chitradurga district, Karnataka**.

Acclaimed Tamil Author and Sahitya Akademi Awardee Poomani Passed away at 79

- **Renowned Tamil writer and novelist Poomani**, whose original name was **Pulithurai Manickavasagam**, passed away at the age of **79** in **Chennai, Tamil Nadu**.
- Poomani was born on **12 May 1947** in **Andipatti, Thoothukudi district, Tamil Nadu**.
- He adopted the pen name **"Poomani"** and became widely known for his realistic portrayal of life in the **Karisal Bhoomi** region of southern Tamil Nadu.
- Poomani was honoured with the prestigious **Sahitya Akademi Award in 2014** in the Tamil language category for his acclaimed novel **"Agnaadi"**.
- Poomani received several prestigious honours, including the **Vishnupuram Award (2011)**, **Gitanjali Literary Prize (2012)**, **Sahitya Akademi Award (2014)**, and the **Tamil Nadu State Film Award – Special Prize (1996)**.

Padma Shri Recipient and Renowned Nokkuvidya Pavakkali Artist Moozhikkal Pankajakshi Passed away at 90

- **Padma Shri awardee Moozhikkal Pankajakshi**, the renowned **Nokkuvidya Pavakkali exponent**, passed away at the age of 90 in **Koothattukulam (Monippally), Kottayam district, Kerala**.
- Born on **14 March 1936** at Urulikunnath, Pala, Kottayam district, Kerala, she was one of the foremost practitioners of Kerala's traditional **Nokkuvidya Pavakkali (puppetry)** art form.
- She was conferred the **Padma Shri**, India's fourth-highest civilian award, in **2020** for her outstanding contribution to the field of Arts.

West Indies Cricket Great Sir Garfield Sobers Passed away at the Age of 89

- **Sir Garfield Sobers**, the legendary **West Indies cricketer** and widely regarded as one of the **greatest all-rounders** in cricket history, passed away in **Saint Michael, Barbados**, at the age of **89**.
- He was born on **28 July 1936** in **Bridgetown, Barbados**.
- He represented the **West Indies** in **93 Test matches** between **1954 and 1974**, scoring **8,032 Test runs** at an impressive batting average of **57.78** and claiming **235 Test wickets**.
- In **2000**, he was named among **Wisden's Five Cricketers of the 20th Century**, one of the highest recognitions in cricket.
- In **2009**, he was inducted into the **International Cricket Council (ICC) Hall of Fame** in recognition of his extraordinary achievements.
- The prestigious **Sir Garfield Sobers Trophy** is awarded annually to the **ICC Men's Cricketer of the Year**, commemorating his lasting legacy in world cricket.

Padma Awardee and Legendary Pandavani Artist Teejan Bai Passed Away at 70

- Renowned **Pandavani** singer and Padma awardee **Teejan Bai** passed away at the age of 70 in **Raipur, Chhattisgarh**.
- Teejan Bai was born on **8 August 1956** in **Ganiyari village, Durg district, Chhattisgarh**.
- She dedicated her life to transforming **Pandavani**, a traditional folk storytelling art, into an internationally acclaimed art form.
- The **Government of India (GoI)** honoured Teejan Bai with the **Padma Shri (1988)**.
- She was awarded the **Padma Bhushan (2003)** for her outstanding contribution to the field of **Art**.
- Teejan Bai received the **Padma Vibhushan (2019)**, India's second-highest civilian award, for her exceptional contribution to **Indian folk art**.
- She was conferred the prestigious **Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 1995**.

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Padma Shri Awardee and 'Bridge Man of India' Girish Bharadwaj Passed away at 76

- **Girish Bharadwaj**, popularly known as the **"Bridge Man of India"**, was a renowned Indian social worker and engineer who passed away at the age of 76 in Sullia, Karnataka.
- He was born on **2 May 1950** in **Sullia, Dakshina Kannada district, Karnataka**.
- He was conferred the **Padma Shri in 2017**, India's fourth-highest civilian award, by the Government of India (GoI) for his outstanding contribution to **Social Work**.
- He was renowned for building **more than 150 low-cost suspension (hanging) bridges**, connecting remote villages to essential services and significantly improving **rural connectivity and social welfare**.

Former Afghanistan Pace Bowler Shapoor Zadran Passed away at the Age of 38

- **Shapoor Zadran**, former **Afghanistan fast bowler** and one of the pioneers of Afghanistan's rise in international cricket, **passed away at the age of 38 in New Delhi, Delhi**.
- He was born on **8 July 1987** in **Paktia Province, Afghanistan**.
- Shapoor Zadran was known for his **left-arm pace** and played a crucial role in Afghanistan's early international cricket journey.
- He represented Afghanistan in **44 One Day Internationals (ODIs)** and **36 Twenty20 Internationals (T20Is)** between 2009 and 2020.

Former U.S. Federal Reserve Chairman Alan Greenspan Passed Away at 99

- **Alan Greenspan**, former **Chairman of the U.S. Federal Reserve (Fed)**, **passed away at the age of 99 in Washington, D.C., USA**.
- Alan Greenspan served as the **Chairman of the U.S. Federal Reserve from 1987 to 2006**, making him one of the **longest-serving central bank chiefs** in U.S. history.
- He was popularly known as the **"Fed Wizard"** for his significant influence on **U.S. monetary policy** and global financial markets.
- During his tenure, he guided the American economy through major events including the **1987 Stock Market Crash**, the **Dot-com Boom**, and the **September 11 (9/11) terrorist attacks**.

Padma Shri Awardee and Renowned Marathi Theatre Icon Vijaya Mehta Passed Away

- **Vijaya Mehta**, popularly known as **"Bai,"** passed away at the age of **92** in **Mumbai, Maharashtra**.

- She was born in **1934** in **Vadodara,**Gujarat.
- **Vijaya Mehta** was one of the **founder-members of the Rangayan theatre group**, along with **Vijay Tendulkar, Arvind Deshpande, and Shreeram Lagoo**, playing a pioneering role in the growth of **experimental Marathi theatre**.
- She authored the acclaimed autobiography **Zimma: A Memoir**, which chronicles her journey in theatre and cinema.

Noted Tamil Poet and Sahitya Akademi Awardee Puviyarasu Passed Away at the Age of 96

- Renowned Tamil poet, translator, screenwriter, and actor **Puviyarasu** passed away at the age of **96** in **Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu**.
- **Puviyarasu** was born in **1930** at **Lingamanayakkan Puthur, Udumalpet, Coimbatore district, Tamil Nadu**.
- His original name was **Jagannathan**, and he later adopted the pen name **Puviyarasu**.
- He worked as a **Tamil teacher** and began publishing poetry in **1952**.
- **Puviyarasu** was a **founding member of the Vaanampaadi Movement**, which promoted **Tamil free verse poetry** and modern literary expression.

Former Mizoram Governor and Puducherry Lt Governor Lt Gen M.M. Lakhera Passed Away

- **Lieutenant General (Retired) Madan Mohan (M.M.) Lakhera**, former **Governor of Mizoram** and former **Lieutenant Governor (Lt Gov) of Puducherry**, passed away at the age of **88** in **Dehradun, Uttarakhand**.
- **M.M. Lakhera** was born on **21 October 1937** in **Jakhand, United Provinces, British India (present-day Uttarakhand)**.
- He was commissioned into the **Indian Army (IA)** from the **Indian Military Academy (IMA), Dehradun**, in **June 1958**.
- During his military career, he gained extensive experience in **counter-insurgency operations**.

Kevin Keegan, England Football Icon and Two-Time Ballon d'Or Winner, Passed away at 75

- **England football legend Joseph Kevin Keegan** passed away at the age of **75** in the **United Kingdom (UK)**.
- **Joseph Kevin Keegan** was born on **14 February 1951** in **Armthorpe, Doncaster, Yorkshire, England**.

- He was a legendary **England footballer** and **manager**, regarded as one of **England's greatest footballers**.

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